

# Hold On to Your Cash:

## Managerial Speech Uncertainty and Financing Conservatism

Sina Soleimanipour\*

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### Abstract

*Abstract placeholder.* A two-paragraph abstract following finance/econ convention will be drafted last (T47) once §I introduction is finalized. Target: 150–200 words. Key claims: (i) managerial Q&A speech uncertainty (UncAnsMgr) predicts within-firm cash accumulation (HC) and leverage reduction (HL) at the firm-quarter horizon, concentrated among credit-constrained firms (HFC); (ii) the effect operates through a precautionary financing channel (Opler et al. 1999; Bates et al. 2009) and is consistent with the financial conservatism cluster documented by Minton and Wruck (2001); (iii) exploratory tests on capital expenditure reveal a competition-moderated investment response interpretable through Grenadier’s (2002) competitive real options framework.

**Keywords:** TODO.

**JEL classification:** TODO.

## 1 Introduction

*Section placeholder.* Drafting deferred to T46 (per skeleton convention: introduction written AFTER the body, once core claims are stable).

## 2 Conceptual Framework and Empirical Strategy

*Section placeholder.* Drafting in T44.

## 3 Main Empirical Analyses

### 3.1 Data, Sample, Variables, and Specification

We construct a quarterly panel of 112,968 earnings-call transcripts covering 2,429 unique firms over fiscal years 2002–2018, sourced from S&P Capital IQ. Call-level speech metrics are merged with Compustat quarterly fundamentals and CRSP daily security data. Following Bates et al. (2009), we exclude financial firms (SIC 6000–6999) and regulated utilities (SIC 4900–4999); we refer to this filtered universe as the Main sample throughout.

The dependent variables are CashRatio (cheq/atq, the linear cash-to-assets form adopted by Bates et al. 2009), Leverage ((dlttq+dlcq)/atq),

and DebtToCapital. The primary speech-uncertainty regressor is UncAnsMgr, a call-level measure of manager Q&A uncertainty constructed from the Dzieliński et al. (2021) uncertainty wordlist applied to the all-manager pooled aggregation in the spirit of Bushee et al. (2018); full construction details appear in §2. Base controls are lnAssets, TobinsQ, ROA, Capex, DivDummy, sCFO, and a unit-by-DV Lagged DV. Extended controls add SalesGrowth, RDSales, CashFlowAt, and DailyVola. The reciprocal control rule applies: leverage enters as a control in cash regressions, and cash enters as a control in leverage regressions.

We estimate PanelOLS specifications across a four-step fixed-effects ladder (Industry + Calendar Year, Firm + Calendar Year, Industry + Calendar Year-Quarter, Firm + Calendar Year-Quarter), with standard errors clustered at the firm level. Each main suite reports twelve columns: contemporaneous and one-quarter-lead dependent variables crossed with the FE ladder. Inference for the IV in this section follows the one-tailed convention pre-committed in §2.

## 4 Additional Analyses

*Section placeholder.* Drafting in T43.

## 5 Discussion and Conclusion

*Section placeholder. Drafting in T45.*

## References

- Bates, T. W., K. M. Kahle, and R. M. Stulz (2009). Why do U.S. firms hold so much more cash than they used to? *The Journal of Finance* 64(5), 1985–2021.
- Bushee, B. J., I. D. Gow, and D. J. Taylor (2018). Linguistic complexity in firm disclosures: Obfuscation or information? *Journal of Accounting Research* 56(1), 85–121. Procedural precedent for pooled all-manager presentation measure via Ian Gow’s published replication code ([github.com/iangow/bgt](https://github.com/iangow/bgt)). Co-foundational with Dzieliński et al. (2021) for our UncAnsMgr construct (DWZ wordlist + BGT pooling).
- Dzieliński, M., A. F. Wagner, and R. J. Zeckhauser (2021). Straight talkers and vague talkers: The effects of managerial style in earnings conference calls. M-RCBG Faculty Working Paper Series 2017-02, Mossavar-Rahmani Center for Business and Government, Harvard Kennedy School. 2021 revision. Originates CEO-level UncAnsCEO / UncPreCEO measures using Loughran-McDonald (2011) uncertainty wordlist. CFO analysis in Internet Appendix. Sample 2003–2015 Thomson Reuters StreetEvents.

Table 1: Summary Statistics

| Variable                        | Unit | N      | Mean    | SD       | Min     | P25     | Median  | P75      | Max       |
|---------------------------------|------|--------|---------|----------|---------|---------|---------|----------|-----------|
| <i>A. Independent Variables</i> |      |        |         |          |         |         |         |          |           |
| GEPU_log                        | C    | 88,205 | 4.6872  | 0.3672   | 3.8626  | 4.3797  | 4.7238  | 4.9666   | 5.5106    |
| GPR_log                         | C    | 88,205 | 4.5838  | 0.2554   | 4.1614  | 4.4165  | 4.5111  | 4.7251   | 5.8825    |
| PRisk                           | C    | 85,995 | 99.6187 | 146.5189 | 0.0000  | 17.0778 | 53.3729 | 120.1973 | 1192.4308 |
| PRisk_lag                       | C    | 81,766 | 99.6985 | 146.6775 | 0.0000  | 17.1376 | 53.4047 | 120.2397 | 1192.4308 |
| PRisk_lag2                      | C    | 80,627 | 99.9614 | 147.2392 | 0.0000  | 17.1702 | 53.4446 | 120.2666 | 1192.4308 |
| TotalSimilarity                 | F    | 22,403 | 3.4277  | 5.6522   | 1.0000  | 1.1246  | 1.5865  | 3.0903   | 80.1876   |
| US_EPU_log                      | C    | 88,205 | 4.7123  | 0.3661   | 3.8018  | 4.4805  | 4.6891  | 4.9625   | 5.6478    |
| UncAnsCEO                       | C    | 71,748 | 0.7806  | 0.3925   | 0.0000  | 0.5147  | 0.7415  | 1.0018   | 2.5874    |
| UncAnsMgr                       | C    | 84,729 | 0.8189  | 0.3344   | 0.0000  | 0.5891  | 0.7874  | 1.0135   | 2.1014    |
| UncAnsNoCEO                     | C    | 80,387 | 0.8505  | 0.5457   | 0.0000  | 0.5042  | 0.7913  | 1.1204   | 3.1912    |
| UncPreCEO                       | C    | 71,727 | 0.6602  | 0.3917   | 0.0000  | 0.3810  | 0.6001  | 0.8723   | 2.2432    |
| UncPreMgr                       | C    | 86,795 | 0.8938  | 0.3508   | 0.0000  | 0.6456  | 0.8534  | 1.0952   | 2.1548    |
| UncPreNoCEO                     | C    | 85,444 | 1.1176  | 0.6136   | 0.0000  | 0.7185  | 1.0123  | 1.3822   | 4.4188    |
| <i>B. Dependent Variables</i>   |      |        |         |          |         |         |         |          |           |
| BGTAvg_Amihud                   | C    | 86,978 | 0.0167  | 0.1003   | 0.0000  | 0.0002  | 0.0010  | 0.0041   | 2.3333    |
| BGTAvg_Amihud_lead1             | C    | 82,808 | 0.0158  | 0.0980   | 0.0000  | 0.0002  | 0.0009  | 0.0038   | 2.3333    |
| BGTAvg_Spread                   | C    | 87,086 | 0.0018  | 0.0027   | 0.0001  | 0.0005  | 0.0009  | 0.0018   | 0.0168    |
| BGTAvg_Spread_lead1             | C    | 82,914 | 0.0017  | 0.0025   | 0.0001  | 0.0004  | 0.0009  | 0.0017   | 0.0168    |
| BGTDelta_Amihud                 | C    | 86,557 | -0.0011 | 0.0281   | -0.6913 | -0.0004 | -0.0000 | 0.0001   | 0.3352    |
| BGTDelta_Amihud_lead1           | C    | 82,475 | -0.0009 | 0.0271   | -0.6913 | -0.0003 | -0.0000 | 0.0001   | 0.3352    |
| BGTDelta_Spread                 | C    | 85,189 | -0.0001 | 0.0008   | -0.0044 | -0.0002 | -0.0000 | 0.0001   | 0.0030    |
| BGTDelta_Spread_lead1           | C    | 81,145 | -0.0001 | 0.0008   | -0.0044 | -0.0002 | -0.0000 | 0.0001   | 0.0030    |
| BGTLevel_Amihud                 | C    | 86,935 | 0.0151  | 0.0847   | 0.0000  | 0.0002  | 0.0009  | 0.0038   | 1.6839    |
| BGTLevel_Amihud_lead1           | C    | 82,766 | 0.0143  | 0.0831   | 0.0000  | 0.0002  | 0.0009  | 0.0035   | 1.6839    |
| BGTLevel_Spread                 | C    | 87,018 | 0.0017  | 0.0026   | 0.0001  | 0.0004  | 0.0009  | 0.0017   | 0.0164    |
| BGTLevel_Spread_lead1           | C    | 82,843 | 0.0016  | 0.0024   | 0.0001  | 0.0004  | 0.0009  | 0.0016   | 0.0164    |
| CCCL                            | C    | 88,205 | 0.0032  | 0.0563   | 0.0000  | 0.0000  | 0.0000  | 0.0000   | 1.0000    |
| Capex                           | C    | 87,627 | 0.0487  | 0.0536   | 0.0000  | 0.0176  | 0.0324  | 0.0592   | 0.5203    |
| Capex_lead                      | C    | 81,582 | 0.0481  | 0.0525   | 0.0000  | 0.0175  | 0.0321  | 0.0585   | 0.5203    |
| Capex_lead2                     | C    | 73,542 | 0.0476  | 0.0513   | 0.0000  | 0.0175  | 0.0321  | 0.0581   | 0.5203    |
| Capex_lead3                     | C    | 66,062 | 0.0472  | 0.0506   | 0.0000  | 0.0174  | 0.0319  | 0.0576   | 0.5203    |
| Capex_lead4                     | C    | 58,987 | 0.0465  | 0.0498   | 0.0000  | 0.0172  | 0.0316  | 0.0569   | 0.5203    |
| CashRatio                       | C    | 87,990 | 0.1708  | 0.1806   | 0.0000  | 0.0368  | 0.1047  | 0.2435   | 0.9938    |
| CashRatio_lead                  | C    | 82,236 | 0.1715  | 0.1748   | 0.0000  | 0.0407  | 0.1112  | 0.2447   | 0.9938    |
| ChangDebtChoice                 | C    | 20,448 | 0.7598  | 0.4272   | 0.0000  | 1.0000  | 1.0000  | 1.0000   | 1.0000    |
| ChangDebtChoice_lead            | C    | 18,720 | 0.7974  | 0.4019   | 0.0000  | 1.0000  | 1.0000  | 1.0000   | 1.0000    |
| ChangExternalFunding            | C    | 87,532 | 0.2506  | 0.4334   | 0.0000  | 0.0000  | 0.0000  | 1.0000   | 1.0000    |
| ChangExternalFunding_lead       | C    | 81,563 | 0.2446  | 0.4299   | 0.0000  | 0.0000  | 0.0000  | 0.0000   | 1.0000    |
| DISP                            | C    | 37,446 | 0.0017  | 0.0028   | 0.0000  | 0.0003  | 0.0007  | 0.0018   | 0.0179    |
| DISP_lead                       | C    | 37,015 | 0.0017  | 0.0027   | 0.0000  | 0.0003  | 0.0007  | 0.0018   | 0.0179    |
| DSPREAD                         | C    | 87,119 | -0.0002 | 0.0017   | -0.0081 | -0.0004 | -0.0000 | 0.0001   | 0.0064    |
| DSPREAD_lead1                   | C    | 82,964 | -0.0002 | 0.0016   | -0.0081 | -0.0004 | -0.0000 | 0.0001   | 0.0064    |
| DebtToCapital                   | C    | 87,760 | 0.3450  | 0.3541   | 0.0000  | 0.0689  | 0.3064  | 0.4914   | 4.4691    |
| DebtToCapital_lead              | C    | 82,024 | 0.3495  | 0.3536   | 0.0000  | 0.0773  | 0.3110  | 0.4958   | 4.4691    |
| DeltaILLIQ                      | C    | 86,906 | -0.0013 | 0.0249   | -0.5050 | -0.0006 | -0.0000 | 0.0001   | 0.3003    |
| DeltaILLIQ_lead1                | C    | 82,735 | -0.0012 | 0.0243   | -0.5050 | -0.0005 | -0.0000 | 0.0001   | 0.3003    |
| DivPayerQ                       | C    | 88,134 | 0.4235  | 0.4941   | 0.0000  | 0.0000  | 0.0000  | 1.0000   | 1.0000    |
| DivPayerQ_lead1                 | C    | 83,755 | 0.4290  | 0.4949   | 0.0000  | 0.0000  | 0.0000  | 1.0000   | 1.0000    |
| EquityDelayCon_lead             | F    | 13,212 | -0.0270 | 0.0772   | -0.2577 | -0.0814 | -0.0293 | 0.0233   | 0.3006    |
| Leverage                        | C    | 87,994 | 0.2330  | 0.2240   | 0.0000  | 0.0470  | 0.2065  | 0.3455   | 3.9453    |
| Leverage_lead                   | C    | 82,242 | 0.2352  | 0.2248   | 0.0000  | 0.0530  | 0.2090  | 0.3480   | 3.9453    |
| PayoutRatio_q                   | C    | 70,695 | 0.2420  | 0.6534   | 0.0000  | 0.0000  | 0.0000  | 0.2794   | 9.2194    |
| PayoutRatio_q_lead_qtr          | C    | 68,167 | 0.2437  | 0.6562   | 0.0000  | 0.0000  | 0.0000  | 0.2816   | 9.2194    |
| PostCallAmihud                  | C    | 86,906 | 0.0118  | 0.0680   | 0.0000  | 0.0002  | 0.0007  | 0.0031   | 1.9001    |
| PostCallAmihud_lead1            | C    | 82,735 | 0.0112  | 0.0669   | 0.0000  | 0.0002  | 0.0007  | 0.0028   | 1.9001    |
| PostCallSpread                  | C    | 87,119 | 0.0017  | 0.0028   | -0.0075 | 0.0004  | 0.0008  | 0.0017   | 0.0250    |
| PostCallSpread_lead1            | C    | 82,964 | 0.0016  | 0.0027   | -0.0075 | 0.0004  | 0.0008  | 0.0016   | 0.0250    |
| RDSales                         | C    | 87,647 | 0.1047  | 0.9342   | 0.0000  | 0.0000  | 0.0048  | 0.0636   | 39.7688   |
| RDSales_lead                    | C    | 81,607 | 0.0990  | 0.9084   | 0.0000  | 0.0000  | 0.0050  | 0.0638   | 39.7688   |
| RepurchaseIntensity             | C    | 83,734 | 0.0073  | 0.0148   | 0.0000  | 0.0000  | 0.0000  | 0.0074   | 0.0919    |
| RepurchaseIntensity_lead_qtr    | C    | 80,289 | 0.0075  | 0.0149   | 0.0000  | 0.0000  | 0.0000  | 0.0078   | 0.0919    |
| SEC_Letters_fwd                 | C    | 88,205 | 0.1264  | 0.4873   | 0.0000  | 0.0000  | 0.0000  | 0.0000   | 12.0000   |
| <i>C. Firm Controls</i>         |      |        |         |          |         |         |         |          |           |
| AbsSurpDec                      | C    | 61,544 | 2.9300  | 1.4255   | 0.0000  | 2.0000  | 3.0000  | 4.0000   | 5.0000    |

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| Variable    | Unit | N      | Mean    | SD      | Min       | P25     | Median  | P75     | Max       |
|-------------|------|--------|---------|---------|-----------|---------|---------|---------|-----------|
| CashFlowAt  | C    | 87,670 | 0.1019  | 0.1147  | -3.0324   | 0.0608  | 0.1032  | 0.1526  | 0.4874    |
| DISP_lag    | C    | 36,411 | 0.0016  | 0.0027  | 0.0000    | 0.0003  | 0.0007  | 0.0017  | 0.0179    |
| DailyVola   | C    | 82,599 | 36.7556 | 21.2437 | 9.4388    | 22.9709 | 31.2762 | 43.8148 | 211.9160  |
| DivDummy    | C    | 88,134 | 0.4755  | 0.4994  | 0.0000    | 0.0000  | 0.0000  | 1.0000  | 1.0000    |
| EarnVol     | C    | 87,440 | 0.0701  | 0.1907  | 0.0006    | 0.0163  | 0.0315  | 0.0695  | 19.5101   |
| FirmMat     | C    | 87,571 | -0.0432 | 2.1826  | -317.5714 | -0.0078 | 0.2191  | 0.4195  | 0.9252    |
| Loss        | C    | 88,129 | 0.1953  | 0.3964  | 0.0000    | 0.0000  | 0.0000  | 0.0000  | 1.0000    |
| NegCall     | C    | 86,858 | 0.9210  | 0.3024  | 0.0000    | 0.7038  | 0.8798  | 1.0943  | 2.3901    |
| ROA         | C    | 87,552 | 0.0386  | 0.1330  | -3.9826   | 0.0146  | 0.0525  | 0.0925  | 0.5490    |
| SalesGrowth | C    | 87,506 | 0.1173  | 0.3849  | -1.0000   | -0.0043 | 0.0745  | 0.1762  | 10.3051   |
| StockPrice  | C    | 87,188 | 38.6939 | 51.7195 | 0.0345    | 14.8975 | 28.2400 | 48.1700 | 2080.0200 |
| SurpDec     | C    | 61,544 | 1.2085  | 3.0260  | -5.0000   | -1.0000 | 2.0000  | 4.0000  | 5.0000    |
| TobinsQ     | C    | 87,363 | 2.1363  | 1.5197  | 0.3847    | 1.2681  | 1.6791  | 2.4362  | 35.6144   |
| Turnover    | C    | 87,188 | 0.0273  | 0.0420  | 0.0000    | 0.0083  | 0.0160  | 0.0310  | 3.7726    |
| UncQue      | C    | 81,031 | 1.4398  | 0.4831  | 0.0000    | 1.1216  | 1.4108  | 1.7268  | 3.5945    |
| lnAssets    | C    | 87,994 | 7.4710  | 1.6607  | -0.5692   | 6.3008  | 7.3763  | 8.5436  | 12.4592   |
| sCFO        | C    | 83,662 | 0.0619  | 0.2233  | 0.0014    | 0.0236  | 0.0395  | 0.0664  | 32.4035   |

*Notes:* Summary statistics for variables used in the hypothesis tests. Sample period: 2002–2018. Anchor sample (H1, Main): 88,205 earnings-call observations across 1,884 firms. Unit column: C = call-level, F = firm-year. N varies by row because each variable is summarized on its anchor panel's Main sample (complete cases per variable); per-suite samples differ due to lags, control availability, and merges.

Table 2: H1: Speech Uncertainty and Cash Holdings

|                     | (1)                           | (2)                           | (3)                           | (4)                           | (5)                           | (6)                           | (7)                           | (8)                           | (9)                           | (10)                          | (11)                          | (12)                          |
|---------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|
|                     | CashRatio                     |                               |                               |                               |                               |                               | CashRatio_lead                |                               |                               |                               |                               |                               |
| UncAnsCEO           | 0.0002<br>(0.0013)            | 0.0001<br>(0.0012)            | -0.0001<br>(0.0014)           | -0.0003<br>(0.0012)           | 0.0001<br>(0.0014)            | -0.0001<br>(0.0012)           | <b>0.0028*</b><br>(0.0020)    | 0.0020<br>(0.0016)            | 0.0025<br>(0.0020)            | <b>0.0021*</b><br>(0.0016)    | <b>0.0026*</b><br>(0.0020)    | <b>0.0022*</b><br>(0.0016)    |
| UncPreCEO           | -0.0005<br>(0.0013)           | 0.0016<br>(0.0014)            | -0.0005<br>(0.0013)           | 0.0013<br>(0.0014)            | -0.0004<br>(0.0013)           | 0.0014<br>(0.0014)            | -0.0006<br>(0.0025)           | 0.0027<br>(0.0024)            | -0.0007<br>(0.0025)           | 0.0023<br>(0.0024)            | -0.0006<br>(0.0025)           | 0.0022<br>(0.0024)            |
| UncAnsMgr           | <b>0.0038**</b><br>(0.0017)   | <b>0.0033**</b><br>(0.0016)   | <b>0.0072***</b><br>(0.0017)  | <b>0.0035**</b><br>(0.0016)   | <b>0.0046***</b><br>(0.0017)  | <b>0.0034**</b><br>(0.0016)   | -0.0010<br>(0.0029)           | 0.0015<br>(0.0023)            | <b>0.0053**</b><br>(0.0029)   | 0.0007<br>(0.0023)            | -0.0004<br>(0.0029)           | 0.0004<br>(0.0023)            |
| UncPreMgr           | 0.0009<br>(0.0019)            | -0.0030<br>(0.0020)           | <b>0.0033**</b><br>(0.0018)   | -0.0029<br>(0.0020)           | 0.0008<br>(0.0019)            | -0.0027<br>(0.0020)           | 0.0023<br>(0.0034)            | -0.0024<br>(0.0038)           | <b>0.0078***</b><br>(0.0032)  | -0.0021<br>(0.0038)           | 0.0022<br>(0.0033)            | -0.0021<br>(0.0038)           |
| Leverage            | <b>-0.0196***</b><br>(0.0039) | <b>-0.0352***</b><br>(0.0061) | <b>-0.0145***</b><br>(0.0031) | <b>-0.0248***</b><br>(0.0062) | <b>-0.0147***</b><br>(0.0032) | <b>-0.0250***</b><br>(0.0062) | <b>-0.0365***</b><br>(0.0099) | <b>-0.0243***</b><br>(0.0090) | <b>-0.0308***</b><br>(0.0085) | <b>-0.0162*</b><br>(0.0091)   | <b>-0.0304***</b><br>(0.0086) | <b>-0.0155*</b><br>(0.0091)   |
| lnAssets            | <b>-0.0016***</b><br>(0.0004) | <b>-0.0165***</b><br>(0.0018) | -0.0002<br>(0.0003)           | <b>-0.0172***</b><br>(0.0018) | <b>-0.0016*</b><br>(0.0005)   | <b>-0.0168***</b><br>(0.0018) | <b>-0.0028***</b><br>(0.0008) | <b>-0.0290***</b><br>(0.0030) | <b>0.0010**</b><br>(0.0005)   | <b>-0.0292***</b><br>(0.0031) | <b>-0.0026***</b><br>(0.0008) | <b>-0.0293***</b><br>(0.0031) |
| TobinsQ             | <b>0.0057***</b><br>(0.0006)  | <b>0.0051***</b><br>(0.0011)  | <b>0.0053***</b><br>(0.0006)  | <b>0.0041***</b><br>(0.0013)  | <b>0.0047***</b><br>(0.0006)  | <b>0.0038***</b><br>(0.0013)  | <b>0.0067***</b><br>(0.0012)  | 0.0019<br>(0.0014)            | <b>0.0065***</b><br>(0.0010)  | 0.0012<br>(0.0015)            | <b>0.0054***</b><br>(0.0010)  | 0.0013<br>(0.0015)            |
| ROA                 | <b>-0.0143**</b><br>(0.0062)  | 0.0121<br>(0.0082)            | <b>-0.0641***</b><br>(0.0078) | <b>-0.0297***</b><br>(0.0078) | <b>-0.0596***</b><br>(0.0078) | <b>-0.0278***</b><br>(0.0095) | <b>-0.0621***</b><br>(0.0138) | <b>-0.0273**</b><br>(0.0135)  | <b>-0.1364***</b><br>(0.0135) | <b>-0.0717***</b><br>(0.0152) | <b>-0.1292***</b><br>(0.0134) | <b>-0.0697***</b><br>(0.0153) |
| Capex               | <b>-0.1070***</b><br>(0.0112) | <b>-0.2294***</b><br>(0.0225) | <b>-0.1383***</b><br>(0.0127) | <b>-0.2399***</b><br>(0.0233) | <b>-0.1403***</b><br>(0.0130) | <b>-0.2315***</b><br>(0.0232) | <b>-0.1520***</b><br>(0.0178) | <b>-0.2140***</b><br>(0.0338) | <b>-0.2099***</b><br>(0.0193) | <b>-0.2308***</b><br>(0.0335) | <b>-0.2189***</b><br>(0.0200) | <b>-0.2331***</b><br>(0.0338) |
| DivDummy            | <b>-0.0044***</b><br>(0.0011) | -0.0018<br>(0.0018)           | <b>-0.0048***</b><br>(0.0011) | -0.0026<br>(0.0018)           | <b>-0.0045***</b><br>(0.0011) | -0.0022<br>(0.0018)           | <b>-0.0066***</b><br>(0.0021) | -0.0052<br>(0.0036)           | <b>-0.0058***</b><br>(0.0020) | -0.0053<br>(0.0035)           | <b>-0.0061***</b><br>(0.0020) | -0.0054<br>(0.0036)           |
| sCFO                | <b>0.0120**</b><br>(0.0054)   | 0.0010<br>(0.0023)            | <b>0.0144**</b><br>(0.0071)   | 0.0018<br>(0.0026)            | <b>0.0133**</b><br>(0.0066)   | 0.0017<br>(0.0026)            | <b>0.0159**</b><br>(0.0072)   | 0.0047<br>(0.0033)            | <b>0.0186**</b><br>(0.0091)   | 0.0053<br>(0.0034)            | <b>0.0170**</b><br>(0.0083)   | 0.0051<br>(0.0034)            |
| Lagged_DV           | <b>0.8507***</b><br>(0.0065)  | <b>0.6289***</b><br>(0.0102)  | <b>0.8598***</b><br>(0.0065)  | <b>0.6394***</b><br>(0.0101)  | <b>0.8560***</b><br>(0.0067)  | <b>0.6406***</b><br>(0.0101)  | <b>0.7112***</b><br>(0.0128)  | <b>0.2198***</b><br>(0.0154)  | <b>0.7263***</b><br>(0.0121)  | <b>0.2314***</b><br>(0.0156)  | <b>0.7171***</b><br>(0.0123)  | <b>0.2319***</b><br>(0.0156)  |
| SalesGrowth         |                               |                               | <b>-0.0123***</b><br>(0.0033) | <b>-0.0174***</b><br>(0.0034) | <b>-0.0115***</b><br>(0.0032) | <b>-0.0167***</b><br>(0.0034) |                               |                               | <b>-0.0132***</b><br>(0.0048) | <b>-0.0163***</b><br>(0.0037) | <b>-0.0121**</b><br>(0.0048)  | <b>-0.0159***</b><br>(0.0037) |
| RDSales             |                               |                               | <b>0.0045*</b><br>(0.0023)    | -0.0003<br>(0.0007)           | <b>0.0045*</b><br>(0.0023)    | -0.0002<br>(0.0007)           |                               |                               | <b>0.0064*</b><br>(0.0034)    | -0.0048<br>(0.0030)           | <b>0.0066*</b><br>(0.0035)    | -0.0047<br>(0.0030)           |
| CashFlowAt          |                               |                               | <b>0.1065***</b><br>(0.0122)  | <b>0.1273***</b><br>(0.0160)  | <b>0.1031***</b><br>(0.0122)  | <b>0.1266***</b><br>(0.0161)  |                               |                               | <b>0.1702***</b><br>(0.0179)  | <b>0.1446***</b><br>(0.0190)  | <b>0.1598***</b><br>(0.0178)  | <b>0.1419***</b><br>(0.0191)  |
| DailyVola           |                               |                               | <b>0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>-0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000)  | -0.0000<br>(0.0000)           |                               |                               | <b>0.0004***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0002***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0001*</b><br>(0.0000)    |
| Extended Controls   |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| Industry FE         | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               |
| Firm FE             |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |
| Year FE             | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               |
| Year-Quarter FE     |                               |                               |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| N                   | 65,128                        | 65,128                        | 62,504                        | 62,504                        | 62,504                        | 62,504                        | 60,619                        | 60,619                        | 59,440                        | 59,440                        | 59,440                        | 59,440                        |
| R <sup>2</sup>      | 0.819                         | 0.452                         | 0.822                         | 0.457                         | 0.823                         | 0.458                         | 0.636                         | 0.093                         | 0.643                         | 0.106                         | 0.646                         | 0.106                         |
| Adj. R <sup>2</sup> | 0.819                         | 0.437                         | 0.822                         | 0.442                         | 0.823                         | 0.442                         | 0.636                         | 0.067                         | 0.643                         | 0.080                         | 0.645                         | 0.079                         |

Notes: \*  $p < 0.10$ , \*\*  $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\*  $p < 0.01$  (one-tailed for IVs,  $\beta > 0$ ; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms).  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ).

Table 3: H1 Robustness: Orthogonal Speaker Partition

|                     | (1)                           | (2)                           | (3)                           | (4)                           | (5)                           | (6)                           | (7)                           | (8)                           | (9)                           | (10)                          | (11)                          | (12)                          |
|---------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|
|                     | CashRatio                     |                               |                               |                               |                               |                               | CashRatio_lead                |                               |                               |                               |                               |                               |
| UncAnsCEO           | <b>0.0025***</b><br>(0.0010)  | <b>0.0022***</b><br>(0.0009)  | <b>0.0045***</b><br>(0.0010)  | <b>0.0019**</b><br>(0.0009)   | <b>0.0028***</b><br>(0.0010)  | <b>0.0020***</b><br>(0.0009)  | <b>0.0025*</b><br>(0.0016)    | <b>0.0029**</b><br>(0.0013)   | <b>0.0060***</b><br>(0.0016)  | <b>0.0025**</b><br>(0.0013)   | <b>0.0026*</b><br>(0.0016)    | <b>0.0024**</b><br>(0.0013)   |
| UncAnsNoCEO         | 0.0005<br>(0.0006)            | 0.0006<br>(0.0005)            | <b>0.0018***</b><br>(0.0006)  | <b>0.0008*</b><br>(0.0005)    | <b>0.0008*</b><br>(0.0006)    | <b>0.0008*</b><br>(0.0005)    | -0.0015<br>(0.0009)           | -0.0008<br>(0.0007)           | 0.0006<br>(0.0009)            | -0.0010<br>(0.0007)           | -0.0014<br>(0.0009)           | -0.0011<br>(0.0007)           |
| UncPreCEO           | -0.0000<br>(0.0010)           | 0.0007<br>(0.0010)            | 0.0012<br>(0.0010)            | 0.0003<br>(0.0010)            | 0.0000<br>(0.0010)            | 0.0004<br>(0.0010)            | -0.0001<br>(0.0019)           | 0.0019<br>(0.0017)            | 0.0023<br>(0.0019)            | 0.0014<br>(0.0016)            | -0.0003<br>(0.0019)           | 0.0013<br>(0.0016)            |
| UncPreNoCEO         | -0.0002<br>(0.0008)           | -0.0018<br>(0.0010)           | <b>0.0012*</b><br>(0.0008)    | -0.0016<br>(0.0010)           | -0.0000<br>(0.0008)           | -0.0015<br>(0.0010)           | 0.0005<br>(0.0015)            | -0.0022<br>(0.0018)           | <b>0.0034***</b><br>(0.0014)  | -0.0020<br>(0.0018)           | 0.0009<br>(0.0014)            | -0.0020<br>(0.0018)           |
| Leverage            | <b>-0.0193***</b><br>(0.0040) | <b>-0.0366***</b><br>(0.0063) | <b>-0.0142***</b><br>(0.0031) | <b>-0.0262***</b><br>(0.0064) | <b>-0.0143***</b><br>(0.0032) | <b>-0.0263***</b><br>(0.0064) | <b>-0.0345***</b><br>(0.0100) | <b>-0.0252***</b><br>(0.0093) | <b>-0.0288***</b><br>(0.0085) | <b>-0.0173*</b><br>(0.0093)   | <b>-0.0284***</b><br>(0.0085) | <b>-0.0165*</b><br>(0.0093)   |
| lnAssets            | <b>-0.0016***</b><br>(0.0004) | <b>-0.0178***</b><br>(0.0018) | -0.0001<br>(0.0002)           | <b>-0.0184***</b><br>(0.0018) | <b>-0.0017**</b><br>(0.0004)  | <b>-0.0181***</b><br>(0.0018) | <b>-0.0026***</b><br>(0.0008) | <b>-0.0294***</b><br>(0.0030) | <b>0.0012**</b><br>(0.0005)   | <b>-0.0296***</b><br>(0.0031) | <b>-0.0025***</b><br>(0.0008) | <b>-0.0297***</b><br>(0.0031) |
| TobinsQ             | <b>0.0058***</b><br>(0.0006)  | <b>0.0051***</b><br>(0.0011)  | <b>0.0054***</b><br>(0.0006)  | <b>0.0042***</b><br>(0.0013)  | <b>0.0048***</b><br>(0.0006)  | <b>0.0039***</b><br>(0.0013)  | <b>0.0065***</b><br>(0.0012)  | 0.0016<br>(0.0014)            | <b>0.0063***</b><br>(0.0010)  | 0.0009<br>(0.0015)            | <b>0.0052***</b><br>(0.0010)  | 0.0011<br>(0.0015)            |
| ROA                 | <b>-0.0141**</b><br>(0.0060)  | 0.0112<br>(0.0081)            | <b>-0.0652***</b><br>(0.0081) | <b>-0.0319***</b><br>(0.0095) | <b>-0.0607***</b><br>(0.0081) | <b>-0.0300***</b><br>(0.0095) | <b>-0.0583***</b><br>(0.0142) | <b>-0.0266**</b><br>(0.0133)  | <b>-0.1318***</b><br>(0.0139) | <b>-0.0712***</b><br>(0.0150) | <b>-0.1251***</b><br>(0.0138) | <b>-0.0695***</b><br>(0.0151) |
| Capex               | <b>-0.1094***</b><br>(0.0116) | <b>-0.2389***</b><br>(0.0229) | <b>-0.1407***</b><br>(0.0132) | <b>-0.2485***</b><br>(0.0239) | <b>-0.1436**</b><br>(0.0134)  | <b>-0.2405***</b><br>(0.0238) | <b>-0.1537***</b><br>(0.0184) | <b>-0.2222***</b><br>(0.0350) | <b>-0.2124***</b><br>(0.0198) | <b>-0.2406***</b><br>(0.0349) | <b>-0.2224***</b><br>(0.0206) | <b>-0.2434***</b><br>(0.0352) |
| DivDummy            | <b>-0.0048***</b><br>(0.0011) | -0.0020<br>(0.0019)           | <b>-0.0053***</b><br>(0.0011) | -0.0029<br>(0.0019)           | <b>-0.0049**</b><br>(0.0011)  | -0.0025<br>(0.0019)           | <b>-0.0070**</b><br>(0.0021)  | -0.0052<br>(0.0037)           | <b>-0.0063***</b><br>(0.0020) | -0.0055<br>(0.0036)           | <b>-0.0065***</b><br>(0.0020) | -0.0056<br>(0.0036)           |
| sCFO                | <b>0.0103**</b><br>(0.0044)   | 0.0008<br>(0.0023)            | <b>0.0126**</b><br>(0.0060)   | 0.0015<br>(0.0025)            | <b>0.0115**</b><br>(0.0054)   | 0.0014<br>(0.0025)            | <b>0.0155**</b><br>(0.0072)   | 0.0045<br>(0.0031)            | <b>0.0184**</b><br>(0.0093)   | 0.0053<br>(0.0034)            | <b>0.0168**</b><br>(0.0085)   | 0.0052<br>(0.0034)            |
| Lagged_DV           | <b>0.8492***</b><br>(0.0066)  | <b>0.6282***</b><br>(0.0106)  | <b>0.8579***</b><br>(0.0065)  | <b>0.6388***</b><br>(0.0104)  | <b>0.8536***</b><br>(0.0067)  | <b>0.6400***</b><br>(0.0104)  | <b>0.7139***</b><br>(0.0129)  | <b>0.2244***</b><br>(0.0154)  | <b>0.7278***</b><br>(0.0123)  | <b>0.2359***</b><br>(0.0156)  | <b>0.7183***</b><br>(0.0124)  | <b>0.2364***</b><br>(0.0156)  |
| SalesGrowth         |                               |                               | <b>-0.0127***</b><br>(0.0033) | <b>-0.0186***</b><br>(0.0033) | <b>-0.0118**</b><br>(0.0033)  | <b>-0.0179***</b><br>(0.0033) |                               |                               | <b>-0.0133***</b><br>(0.0050) | <b>-0.0161***</b><br>(0.0037) | <b>-0.0122**</b><br>(0.0049)  | <b>-0.0157***</b><br>(0.0038) |
| RDSales             |                               |                               | <b>0.0049**</b><br>(0.0022)   | -0.0009<br>(0.0007)           | <b>0.0049**</b><br>(0.0022)   | -0.0007<br>(0.0007)           |                               |                               | <b>0.0070*</b><br>(0.0036)    | -0.0052<br>(0.0032)           | <b>0.0072*</b><br>(0.0037)    | -0.0051<br>(0.0032)           |
| CashFlowAt          |                               |                               | <b>0.1098***</b><br>(0.0122)  | <b>0.1323***</b><br>(0.0163)  | <b>0.1061***</b><br>(0.0123)  | <b>0.1317***</b><br>(0.0164)  |                               |                               | <b>0.1715***</b><br>(0.0183)  | <b>0.1464***</b><br>(0.0195)  | <b>0.1610***</b><br>(0.0182)  | <b>0.1436***</b><br>(0.0196)  |
| DailyVola           |                               |                               | <b>0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>-0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>0.0001**</b><br>(0.0000)   | -0.0000<br>(0.0000)           |                               |                               | <b>0.0004***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0002***</b><br>(0.0001)  | 0.0001<br>(0.0000)            |
| Extended Controls   |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| Industry FE         | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               |
| Firm FE             |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |
| Year FE             | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               |
| Year-Quarter FE     |                               |                               |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| N                   | 61,120                        | 61,120                        | 58,681                        | 58,681                        | 58,681                        | 58,681                        | 56,891                        | 56,891                        | 55,809                        | 55,809                        | 55,809                        | 55,809                        |
| R <sup>2</sup>      | 0.819                         | 0.454                         | 0.821                         | 0.460                         | 0.822                         | 0.460                         | 0.638                         | 0.097                         | 0.645                         | 0.110                         | 0.647                         | 0.110                         |
| Adj. R <sup>2</sup> | 0.819                         | 0.438                         | 0.821                         | 0.444                         | 0.822                         | 0.443                         | 0.638                         | 0.070                         | 0.645                         | 0.083                         | 0.646                         | 0.082                         |

Notes: \*  $p < 0.10$ , \*\*  $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\*  $p < 0.01$  (one-tailed for IVs,  $\beta > 0$ ; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms).  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ).

Table 4: H1.1: Product Similarity–Moderated Speech Uncertainty and Cash Holdings

|                         | (1)                           | (2)                           | (3)                           | (4)                           | (5)                           | (6)                           | (7)                           | (8)                           |
|-------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|
|                         |                               | CashRatio                     |                               |                               |                               | CashRatio_lead                |                               |                               |
| UncAnsMgr_c             | <b>0.0045***</b><br>(0.0011)  | <b>0.0035***</b><br>(0.0009)  | <b>0.0046***</b><br>(0.0011)  | <b>0.0035***</b><br>(0.0009)  | <b>0.0026*</b><br>(0.0019)    | <b>0.0032**</b><br>(0.0015)   | <b>0.0025*</b><br>(0.0019)    | <b>0.0029**</b><br>(0.0015)   |
| z_log_TotalSimilarity   | <b>0.0057***</b><br>(0.0007)  | <b>0.0030**</b><br>(0.0017)   | <b>0.0055***</b><br>(0.0007)  | <b>0.0029**</b><br>(0.0017)   | <b>0.0109***</b><br>(0.0014)  | <b>0.0087***</b><br>(0.0035)  | <b>0.0109***</b><br>(0.0014)  | <b>0.0088***</b><br>(0.0035)  |
| UncAnsMgr_c_x_zlogTSIMM | 0.0017<br>(0.0014)            | 0.0014<br>(0.0012)            | 0.0017<br>(0.0014)            | 0.0014<br>(0.0012)            | -0.0014<br>(0.0027)           | -0.0027<br>(0.0020)           | -0.0013<br>(0.0027)           | -0.0026<br>(0.0020)           |
| Leverage                | <b>-0.0122***</b><br>(0.0027) | <b>-0.0169***</b><br>(0.0065) | <b>-0.0124***</b><br>(0.0028) | <b>-0.0170***</b><br>(0.0065) | <b>-0.0322***</b><br>(0.0060) | -0.0114<br>(0.0095)           | <b>-0.0322***</b><br>(0.0060) | -0.0110<br>(0.0094)           |
| lnAssets                | <b>-0.0021***</b><br>(0.0004) | <b>-0.0172***</b><br>(0.0017) | <b>-0.0018***</b><br>(0.0004) | <b>-0.0168***</b><br>(0.0017) | <b>-0.0033***</b><br>(0.0007) | <b>-0.0302***</b><br>(0.0029) | <b>-0.0033***</b><br>(0.0007) | <b>-0.0302***</b><br>(0.0029) |
| TobinsQ                 | <b>0.0045***</b><br>(0.0006)  | <b>0.0032***</b><br>(0.0011)  | <b>0.0044***</b><br>(0.0006)  | <b>0.0029***</b><br>(0.0011)  | <b>0.0053***</b><br>(0.0009)  | -0.0001<br>(0.0015)           | <b>0.0053***</b><br>(0.0009)  | -0.0000<br>(0.0016)           |
| ROA                     | <b>-0.0601***</b><br>(0.0076) | <b>-0.0329***</b><br>(0.0090) | <b>-0.0572***</b><br>(0.0076) | <b>-0.0309***</b><br>(0.0090) | <b>-0.1302***</b><br>(0.0128) | <b>-0.0759***</b><br>(0.0145) | <b>-0.1268***</b><br>(0.0129) | <b>-0.0738***</b><br>(0.0146) |
| Capex                   | <b>-0.1578***</b><br>(0.0127) | <b>-0.2392***</b><br>(0.0218) | <b>-0.1543***</b><br>(0.0125) | <b>-0.2312***</b><br>(0.0216) | <b>-0.2458***</b><br>(0.0197) | <b>-0.2288***</b><br>(0.0332) | <b>-0.2435***</b><br>(0.0197) | <b>-0.2294***</b><br>(0.0335) |
| DivDummy                | <b>-0.0033***</b><br>(0.0011) | -0.0024<br>(0.0018)           | <b>-0.0029***</b><br>(0.0011) | -0.0020<br>(0.0018)           | -0.0032<br>(0.0020)           | -0.0043<br>(0.0035)           | -0.0032<br>(0.0020)           | -0.0043<br>(0.0035)           |
| sCFO                    | <b>0.0122**</b><br>(0.0055)   | 0.0026<br>(0.0030)            | <b>0.0119**</b><br>(0.0054)   | 0.0026<br>(0.0030)            | <b>0.0165**</b><br>(0.0071)   | <b>0.0062*</b><br>(0.0033)    | <b>0.0162**</b><br>(0.0070)   | <b>0.0060*</b><br>(0.0033)    |
| SalesGrowth             | <b>-0.0101***</b><br>(0.0028) | <b>-0.0116***</b><br>(0.0029) | <b>-0.0095***</b><br>(0.0027) | <b>-0.0111***</b><br>(0.0029) | <b>-0.0113***</b><br>(0.0039) | <b>-0.0095***</b><br>(0.0033) | <b>-0.0106***</b><br>(0.0039) | <b>-0.0091***</b><br>(0.0033) |
| RDSales                 | <b>0.0041***</b><br>(0.0015)  | 0.0014<br>(0.0009)            | <b>0.0041***</b><br>(0.0015)  | <b>0.0015*</b><br>(0.0009)    | <b>0.0057***</b><br>(0.0022)  | -0.0006<br>(0.0017)           | <b>0.0057***</b><br>(0.0022)  | -0.0005<br>(0.0017)           |
| CashFlowAt              | <b>0.1013***</b><br>(0.0111)  | <b>0.1279***</b><br>(0.0141)  | <b>0.1009***</b><br>(0.0112)  | <b>0.1271***</b><br>(0.0141)  | <b>0.1582***</b><br>(0.0163)  | <b>0.1418***</b><br>(0.0177)  | <b>0.1551***</b><br>(0.0163)  | <b>0.1393***</b><br>(0.0178)  |
| DailyVola               | -0.0000<br>(0.0000)           | <b>-0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>0.0000*</b><br>(0.0000)    | -0.0000<br>(0.0000)           | <b>0.0002***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0002***</b><br>(0.0000)  | 0.0001<br>(0.0000)            |
| Lagged_DV               | <b>0.8574***</b><br>(0.0060)  | <b>0.6646***</b><br>(0.0096)  | <b>0.8581***</b><br>(0.0060)  | <b>0.6658***</b><br>(0.0096)  | <b>0.7044***</b><br>(0.0112)  | <b>0.2571***</b><br>(0.0155)  | <b>0.7048***</b><br>(0.0112)  | <b>0.2577***</b><br>(0.0155)  |
| Industry FE             | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               |
| Firm FE                 |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |
| Year FE                 | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               |
| Year-Quarter FE         |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| N                       | 73,707                        | 73,707                        | 73,707                        | 73,707                        | 70,191                        | 70,191                        | 70,191                        | 70,191                        |
| R <sup>2</sup>          | 0.834                         | 0.484                         | 0.835                         | 0.484                         | 0.657                         | 0.116                         | 0.658                         | 0.116                         |
| Adj. R <sup>2</sup>     | 0.834                         | 0.471                         | 0.834                         | 0.471                         | 0.657                         | 0.094                         | 0.658                         | 0.093                         |

Notes: \*  $p < 0.10$ , \*\*  $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\*  $p < 0.01$  (one-tailed for IVs,  $\beta > 0$ ; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms).  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ).

Table 5: H1.1.r: Product Similarity–Moderated Speech Uncertainty and Cash Holdings (Robustness: CEO Q&amp;A Speaker Partition)

|                         | (1)                           | (2)                           | (3)                           | (4)                           | (5)                           | (6)                           | (7)                           | (8)                           |
|-------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|
|                         | CashRatio                     |                               |                               |                               | CashRatio.Lead                |                               |                               |                               |
| UncAnsCEO_c             | <b>0.0029***</b><br>(0.0010)  | <b>0.0016**</b><br>(0.0008)   | <b>0.0029***</b><br>(0.0010)  | <b>0.0017**</b><br>(0.0008)   | <b>0.0025*</b><br>(0.0016)    | <b>0.0026**</b><br>(0.0012)   | <b>0.0024*</b><br>(0.0016)    | <b>0.0025**</b><br>(0.0012)   |
| z_log_TotalSimilarity   | <b>0.0058***</b><br>(0.0008)  | <b>0.0031**</b><br>(0.0019)   | <b>0.0056***</b><br>(0.0008)  | <b>0.0030**</b><br>(0.0019)   | <b>0.0118***</b><br>(0.0016)  | <b>0.0070**</b><br>(0.0036)   | <b>0.0118***</b><br>(0.0016)  | <b>0.0071**</b><br>(0.0036)   |
| UncAnsCEO_c.x_zlogTSIMM | -0.0002<br>(0.0014)           | -0.0008<br>(0.0011)           | -0.0002<br>(0.0013)           | -0.0008<br>(0.0011)           | -0.0007<br>(0.0024)           | -0.0029<br>(0.0015)           | -0.0007<br>(0.0024)           | -0.0028<br>(0.0015)           |
| Leverage                | <b>-0.0155***</b><br>(0.0026) | <b>-0.0245***</b><br>(0.0061) | <b>-0.0157***</b><br>(0.0026) | <b>-0.0247***</b><br>(0.0061) | <b>-0.0327***</b><br>(0.0064) | <b>-0.0157*</b><br>(0.0088)   | <b>-0.0326***</b><br>(0.0065) | <b>-0.0152*</b><br>(0.0088)   |
| lnAssets                | <b>-0.0023***</b><br>(0.0004) | <b>-0.0173***</b><br>(0.0017) | <b>-0.0021***</b><br>(0.0004) | <b>-0.0169***</b><br>(0.0017) | <b>-0.0036***</b><br>(0.0008) | <b>-0.0300***</b><br>(0.0031) | <b>-0.0036***</b><br>(0.0008) | <b>-0.0301***</b><br>(0.0031) |
| TobinsQ                 | <b>0.0047***</b><br>(0.0006)  | <b>0.0040***</b><br>(0.0013)  | <b>0.0046***</b><br>(0.0006)  | <b>0.0037***</b><br>(0.0013)  | <b>0.0053***</b><br>(0.0009)  | 0.0008<br>(0.0015)            | <b>0.0053***</b><br>(0.0009)  | 0.0010<br>(0.0015)            |
| ROA                     | <b>-0.0592***</b><br>(0.0078) | <b>-0.0297***</b><br>(0.0094) | <b>-0.0563***</b><br>(0.0078) | <b>-0.0277***</b><br>(0.0095) | <b>-0.1262***</b><br>(0.0133) | <b>-0.0725***</b><br>(0.0153) | <b>-0.1227***</b><br>(0.0133) | <b>-0.0705***</b><br>(0.0154) |
| Capex                   | <b>-0.1563***</b><br>(0.0135) | <b>-0.2378***</b><br>(0.0242) | <b>-0.1527***</b><br>(0.0133) | <b>-0.2293***</b><br>(0.0241) | <b>-0.2500***</b><br>(0.0208) | <b>-0.2249***</b><br>(0.0359) | <b>-0.2481***</b><br>(0.0208) | <b>-0.2267***</b><br>(0.0363) |
| DivDummy                | <b>-0.0036***</b><br>(0.0011) | -0.0025<br>(0.0018)           | <b>-0.0032***</b><br>(0.0011) | -0.0021<br>(0.0018)           | <b>-0.0036*</b><br>(0.0021)   | -0.0052<br>(0.0035)           | <b>-0.0035*</b><br>(0.0021)   | -0.0053<br>(0.0036)           |
| sCFO                    | <b>0.0133**</b><br>(0.0067)   | 0.0019<br>(0.0027)            | <b>0.0129**</b><br>(0.0065)   | 0.0018<br>(0.0026)            | <b>0.0163**</b><br>(0.0082)   | 0.0054<br>(0.0036)            | <b>0.0160**</b><br>(0.0081)   | 0.0053<br>(0.0035)            |
| SalesGrowth             | <b>-0.0129***</b><br>(0.0032) | <b>-0.0174***</b><br>(0.0034) | <b>-0.0122***</b><br>(0.0031) | <b>-0.0168***</b><br>(0.0033) | <b>-0.0147***</b><br>(0.0047) | <b>-0.0163***</b><br>(0.0036) | <b>-0.0139***</b><br>(0.0047) | <b>-0.0159***</b><br>(0.0036) |
| RDSales                 | <b>0.0040*</b><br>(0.0023)    | -0.0004<br>(0.0007)           | <b>0.0040*</b><br>(0.0023)    | -0.0002<br>(0.0007)           | <b>0.0054*</b><br>(0.0033)    | -0.0049<br>(0.0030)           | <b>0.0054*</b><br>(0.0033)    | -0.0048<br>(0.0030)           |
| CashFlowAt              | <b>0.1017***</b><br>(0.0121)  | <b>0.1280***</b><br>(0.0158)  | <b>0.1015***</b><br>(0.0122)  | <b>0.1274***</b><br>(0.0159)  | <b>0.1618***</b><br>(0.0173)  | <b>0.1492***</b><br>(0.0192)  | <b>0.1584***</b><br>(0.0174)  | <b>0.1465***</b><br>(0.0193)  |
| DailyVola               | -0.0000<br>(0.0000)           | <b>-0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>0.0001**</b><br>(0.0000)   | -0.0000<br>(0.0000)           | <b>0.0002***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0002***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0001*</b><br>(0.0000)    |
| Lagged_DV               | <b>0.8487***</b><br>(0.0066)  | <b>0.6401***</b><br>(0.0100)  | <b>0.8495***</b><br>(0.0066)  | <b>0.6414***</b><br>(0.0100)  | <b>0.7049***</b><br>(0.0120)  | <b>0.2330***</b><br>(0.0156)  | <b>0.7053***</b><br>(0.0120)  | <b>0.2335***</b><br>(0.0156)  |
| Industry FE             | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               |
| Firm FE                 |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |
| Year FE                 | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               |
| Year-Quarter FE         |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| N                       | 63,739                        | 63,739                        | 63,739                        | 63,739                        | 60,641                        | 60,641                        | 60,641                        | 60,641                        |
| $R^2$                   | 0.825                         | 0.459                         | 0.825                         | 0.459                         | 0.652                         | 0.109                         | 0.652                         | 0.109                         |
| Adj. $R^2$              | 0.824                         | 0.444                         | 0.825                         | 0.444                         | 0.651                         | 0.083                         | 0.652                         | 0.082                         |

Notes: \*  $p < 0.10$ , \*\*  $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\*  $p < 0.01$  (one-tailed for IVs,  $\beta > 0$ ; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms).  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ).



Table 6: H1.1b: Binary Product Similarity–Moderated Speech Uncertainty and Cash Holdings

|                         | (1)                           | (2)                           | (3)                           | (4)                           | (5)                           | (6)                           | (7)                           | (8)                           |
|-------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|
|                         |                               | CashRatio                     |                               |                               |                               | CashRatio.Lead                |                               |                               |
| UncAnsMgr.c             | <b>0.0044***</b><br>(0.0014)  | <b>0.0038***</b><br>(0.0012)  | <b>0.0044***</b><br>(0.0014)  | <b>0.0037***</b><br>(0.0012)  | <b>0.0033*</b><br>(0.0023)    | <b>0.0039**</b><br>(0.0018)   | <b>0.0032*</b><br>(0.0023)    | <b>0.0036**</b><br>(0.0018)   |
| HighTSIMM               | <b>0.0060***</b><br>(0.0011)  | 0.0014<br>(0.0018)            | <b>0.0058***</b><br>(0.0011)  | 0.0014<br>(0.0018)            | <b>0.0122***</b><br>(0.0021)  | <b>0.0052*</b><br>(0.0033)    | <b>0.0121***</b><br>(0.0021)  | <b>0.0051*</b><br>(0.0033)    |
| UncAnsMgr.c.x.HighTSIMM | 0.0010<br>(0.0022)            | -0.0006<br>(0.0018)           | 0.0010<br>(0.0022)            | -0.0006<br>(0.0018)           | -0.0000<br>(0.0038)           | -0.0014<br>(0.0031)           | 0.0001<br>(0.0038)            | -0.0013<br>(0.0031)           |
| Leverage                | <b>-0.0109***</b><br>(0.0028) | <b>-0.0171***</b><br>(0.0064) | <b>-0.0113**</b><br>(0.0029)  | <b>-0.0173***</b><br>(0.0065) | <b>-0.0298***</b><br>(0.0071) | -0.0120<br>(0.0094)           | <b>-0.0298***</b><br>(0.0071) | -0.0117<br>(0.0094)           |
| InAssets                | <b>-0.0018***</b><br>(0.0004) | <b>-0.0169***</b><br>(0.0017) | <b>-0.0016***</b><br>(0.0004) | <b>-0.0166***</b><br>(0.0017) | <b>-0.0029***</b><br>(0.0007) | <b>-0.0294***</b><br>(0.0029) | <b>-0.0029***</b><br>(0.0007) | <b>-0.0294***</b><br>(0.0029) |
| TobinsQ                 | <b>0.0046***</b><br>(0.0005)  | <b>0.0032***</b><br>(0.0011)  | <b>0.0045***</b><br>(0.0005)  | <b>0.0030***</b><br>(0.0011)  | <b>0.0055***</b><br>(0.0009)  | 0.0000<br>(0.0015)            | <b>0.0056***</b><br>(0.0009)  | 0.0001<br>(0.0016)            |
| ROA                     | <b>-0.0633***</b><br>(0.0076) | <b>-0.0332***</b><br>(0.0090) | <b>-0.0603**</b><br>(0.0076)  | <b>-0.0313***</b><br>(0.0090) | <b>-0.1360***</b><br>(0.0129) | <b>-0.0767***</b><br>(0.0145) | <b>-0.1324***</b><br>(0.0129) | <b>-0.0746***</b><br>(0.0146) |
| Capex                   | <b>-0.1488***</b><br>(0.0122) | <b>-0.2384***</b><br>(0.0217) | <b>-0.1455***</b><br>(0.0121) | <b>-0.2303***</b><br>(0.0216) | <b>-0.2302***</b><br>(0.0192) | <b>-0.2276***</b><br>(0.0332) | <b>-0.2278***</b><br>(0.0192) | <b>-0.2282***</b><br>(0.0335) |
| DivDummy                | <b>-0.0039***</b><br>(0.0010) | -0.0025<br>(0.0018)           | <b>-0.0035***</b><br>(0.0010) | -0.0022<br>(0.0018)           | <b>-0.0043**</b><br>(0.0019)  | -0.0046<br>(0.0035)           | <b>-0.0042**</b><br>(0.0019)  | -0.0047<br>(0.0035)           |
| sCFO                    | <b>0.0127**</b><br>(0.0058)   | 0.0026<br>(0.0030)            | <b>0.0124**</b><br>(0.0056)   | 0.0026<br>(0.0030)            | <b>0.0172**</b><br>(0.0075)   | <b>0.0062*</b><br>(0.0033)    | <b>0.0169**</b><br>(0.0074)   | <b>0.0061*</b><br>(0.0032)    |
| SalesGrowth             | <b>-0.0094***</b><br>(0.0028) | <b>-0.0116***</b><br>(0.0029) | <b>-0.0088**</b><br>(0.0027)  | <b>-0.0111***</b><br>(0.0029) | <b>-0.0099**</b><br>(0.0040)  | <b>-0.0095***</b><br>(0.0033) | <b>-0.0092**</b><br>(0.0039)  | <b>-0.0091***</b><br>(0.0034) |
| RDSales                 | <b>0.0045***</b><br>(0.0015)  | 0.0014<br>(0.0009)            | <b>0.0045***</b><br>(0.0015)  | <b>0.0015*</b><br>(0.0009)    | <b>0.0064***</b><br>(0.0022)  | -0.0005<br>(0.0017)           | <b>0.0064***</b><br>(0.0022)  | -0.0004<br>(0.0017)           |
| CashFlowAt              | <b>0.1018***</b><br>(0.0110)  | <b>0.1278***</b><br>(0.0140)  | <b>0.1014***</b><br>(0.0111)  | <b>0.1271***</b><br>(0.0141)  | <b>0.1588***</b><br>(0.0164)  | <b>0.1415***</b><br>(0.0178)  | <b>0.1558***</b><br>(0.0164)  | <b>0.1390***</b><br>(0.0178)  |
| DailyVola               | -0.0000<br>(0.0000)           | <b>-0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>0.0001**</b><br>(0.0000)   | -0.0000<br>(0.0000)           | <b>0.0002***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0002***</b><br>(0.0000)  | 0.0001<br>(0.0000)            |
| Lagged_DV               | <b>0.8623***</b><br>(0.0060)  | <b>0.6650***</b><br>(0.0096)  | <b>0.8628***</b><br>(0.0060)  | <b>0.6662***</b><br>(0.0096)  | <b>0.7130***</b><br>(0.0113)  | <b>0.2581***</b><br>(0.0155)  | <b>0.7133***</b><br>(0.0114)  | <b>0.2587***</b><br>(0.0155)  |
| Industry FE             | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               |
| Firm FE                 |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |
| Year FE                 | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               |
| Year-Quarter FE         |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| N                       | 73,707                        | 73,707                        | 73,707                        | 73,707                        | 70,191                        | 70,191                        | 70,191                        | 70,191                        |
| R <sup>2</sup>          | 0.833                         | 0.484                         | 0.834                         | 0.484                         | 0.656                         | 0.116                         | 0.657                         | 0.115                         |
| Adj. R <sup>2</sup>     | 0.833                         | 0.471                         | 0.834                         | 0.471                         | 0.656                         | 0.093                         | 0.656                         | 0.092                         |

Notes: \*  $p < 0.10$ , \*\*  $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\*  $p < 0.01$  (one-tailed for IVs,  $\beta > 0$ ; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms).  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ).

Table 7: H1.1b.r: Binary Product Similarity–Moderated Speech Uncertainty and Cash Holdings (Robustness: CEO Q&amp;A Speaker Partition)

|                         | (1)                           | (2)                           | (3)                           | (4)                           | (5)                           | (6)                           | (7)                           | (8)                           |
|-------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|
|                         | CashRatio                     |                               |                               |                               | CashRatio_lead                |                               |                               |                               |
| UncAnsCEO_c             | <b>0.0037***</b><br>(0.0013)  | <b>0.0029***</b><br>(0.0010)  | <b>0.0037***</b><br>(0.0013)  | <b>0.0029***</b><br>(0.0010)  | <b>0.0033*</b><br>(0.0020)    | <b>0.0035***</b><br>(0.0015)  | <b>0.0031*</b><br>(0.0020)    | <b>0.0033**</b><br>(0.0015)   |
| HighTSIMM               | <b>0.0058***</b><br>(0.0012)  | 0.0005<br>(0.0019)            | <b>0.0056**</b><br>(0.0012)   | 0.0006<br>(0.0019)            | <b>0.0123***</b><br>(0.0022)  | 0.0022<br>(0.0033)            | <b>0.0122***</b><br>(0.0022)  | 0.0021<br>(0.0033)            |
| UncAnsCEO_c.x.HighTSIMM | -0.0013<br>(0.0020)           | -0.0025<br>(0.0017)           | -0.0012<br>(0.0020)           | -0.0024<br>(0.0017)           | -0.0009<br>(0.0031)           | -0.0016<br>(0.0025)           | -0.0008<br>(0.0031)           | -0.0015<br>(0.0025)           |
| Leverage                | <b>-0.0141***</b><br>(0.0029) | <b>-0.0245***</b><br>(0.0061) | <b>-0.0144***</b><br>(0.0030) | <b>-0.0247***</b><br>(0.0061) | <b>-0.0298***</b><br>(0.0079) | <b>-0.0155*</b><br>(0.0088)   | <b>-0.0298***</b><br>(0.0079) | <b>-0.0150*</b><br>(0.0088)   |
| InAssets                | <b>-0.0020***</b><br>(0.0004) | <b>-0.0170***</b><br>(0.0017) | <b>-0.0018***</b><br>(0.0004) | <b>-0.0166***</b><br>(0.0017) | <b>-0.0031***</b><br>(0.0008) | <b>-0.0294***</b><br>(0.0031) | <b>-0.0031***</b><br>(0.0008) | <b>-0.0295***</b><br>(0.0031) |
| TobinsQ                 | <b>0.0048***</b><br>(0.0006)  | <b>0.0041***</b><br>(0.0013)  | <b>0.0047***</b><br>(0.0006)  | <b>0.0037***</b><br>(0.0013)  | <b>0.0054***</b><br>(0.0009)  | 0.0010<br>(0.0015)            | <b>0.0054***</b><br>(0.0010)  | 0.0011<br>(0.0015)            |
| ROA                     | <b>-0.0622***</b><br>(0.0078) | <b>-0.0298***</b><br>(0.0094) | <b>-0.0591***</b><br>(0.0077) | <b>-0.0278***</b><br>(0.0095) | <b>-0.1322***</b><br>(0.0133) | <b>-0.0728***</b><br>(0.0153) | <b>-0.1284***</b><br>(0.0133) | <b>-0.0708***</b><br>(0.0154) |
| Capex                   | <b>-0.1469***</b><br>(0.0131) | <b>-0.2372***</b><br>(0.0242) | <b>-0.1437***</b><br>(0.0129) | <b>-0.2288***</b><br>(0.0241) | <b>-0.2316***</b><br>(0.0203) | <b>-0.2238***</b><br>(0.0360) | <b>-0.2297***</b><br>(0.0203) | <b>-0.2257***</b><br>(0.0364) |
| DivDummy                | <b>-0.0042***</b><br>(0.0011) | -0.0026<br>(0.0018)           | <b>-0.0037***</b><br>(0.0011) | -0.0022<br>(0.0018)           | <b>-0.0046**</b><br>(0.0020)  | -0.0054<br>(0.0035)           | <b>-0.0046**</b><br>(0.0020)  | -0.0055<br>(0.0036)           |
| sCFO                    | <b>0.0139**</b><br>(0.0070)   | 0.0020<br>(0.0027)            | <b>0.0135**</b><br>(0.0068)   | 0.0019<br>(0.0026)            | <b>0.0172**</b><br>(0.0087)   | 0.0056<br>(0.0036)            | <b>0.0169**</b><br>(0.0086)   | 0.0055<br>(0.0035)            |
| SalesGrowth             | <b>-0.0122***</b><br>(0.0032) | <b>-0.0174***</b><br>(0.0034) | <b>-0.0114***</b><br>(0.0032) | <b>-0.0168***</b><br>(0.0033) | <b>-0.0134***</b><br>(0.0048) | <b>-0.0164***</b><br>(0.0036) | <b>-0.0125***</b><br>(0.0047) | <b>-0.0159***</b><br>(0.0037) |
| RDSales                 | <b>0.0045*</b><br>(0.0023)    | -0.0004<br>(0.0007)           | <b>0.0045*</b><br>(0.0023)    | -0.0002<br>(0.0007)           | <b>0.0064*</b><br>(0.0034)    | -0.0048<br>(0.0030)           | <b>0.0065*</b><br>(0.0034)    | -0.0047<br>(0.0030)           |
| CashFlowAt              | <b>0.1027***</b><br>(0.0121)  | <b>0.1282***</b><br>(0.0158)  | <b>0.1024***</b><br>(0.0122)  | <b>0.1275***</b><br>(0.0159)  | <b>0.1633***</b><br>(0.0176)  | <b>0.1491***</b><br>(0.0192)  | <b>0.1599***</b><br>(0.0176)  | <b>0.1464***</b><br>(0.0193)  |
| DailyVola               | -0.0000<br>(0.0000)           | <b>-0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>0.0001**</b><br>(0.0000)   | -0.0000<br>(0.0000)           | <b>0.0002***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0002***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0001*</b><br>(0.0000)    |
| Lagged_DV               | <b>0.8533***</b><br>(0.0067)  | <b>0.6406***</b><br>(0.0100)  | <b>0.8540***</b><br>(0.0067)  | <b>0.6418***</b><br>(0.0100)  | <b>0.7139***</b><br>(0.0122)  | <b>0.2340***</b><br>(0.0157)  | <b>0.7143***</b><br>(0.0122)  | <b>0.2345***</b><br>(0.0157)  |
| Industry FE             | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               |
| Firm FE                 |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |
| Year FE                 | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               |
| Year-Quarter FE         |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| N                       | 63,739                        | 63,739                        | 63,739                        | 63,739                        | 60,641                        | 60,641                        | 60,641                        | 60,641                        |
| $R^2$                   | 0.824                         | 0.459                         | 0.825                         | 0.459                         | 0.650                         | 0.108                         | 0.651                         | 0.108                         |
| Adj. $R^2$              | 0.824                         | 0.444                         | 0.825                         | 0.444                         | 0.650                         | 0.083                         | 0.650                         | 0.082                         |

Notes: \*  $p < 0.10$ , \*\*  $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\*  $p < 0.01$  (one-tailed for IVs,  $\beta > 0$ ; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms).  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ).

Table 8: H1.2: Financial Constraint–Moderated Speech Uncertainty and Cash Holdings (Three-Category)

|                       | (1)                            | (2)                            | (3)                            | (4)                            | (5)                            | (6)                            | (7)                            | (8)                            |
|-----------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|
|                       |                                | CashRatio                      |                                |                                |                                | CashRatio.lead                 |                                |                                |
| UncAnsMgr_c           | <b>0.0053</b> ***<br>(0.0012)  | <b>0.0035</b> ***<br>(0.0010)  | <b>0.0050</b> ***<br>(0.0012)  | <b>0.0035</b> ***<br>(0.0010)  | <b>0.0035</b> **<br>(0.0020)   | <b>0.0032</b> **<br>(0.0015)   | <b>0.0028</b> *<br>(0.0020)    | <b>0.0031</b> **<br>(0.0015)   |
| Unrated               | <b>0.0062</b> ***<br>(0.0012)  | -0.0014<br>(0.0033)            | -0.0004<br>(0.0015)            | -0.0014<br>(0.0033)            | <b>0.0110</b> ***<br>(0.0020)  | -0.0035<br>(0.0058)            | -0.0032<br>(0.0029)            | -0.0035<br>(0.0058)            |
| UncAnsMgr_c.x.Unrated | <b>0.0059</b> ***<br>(0.0024)  | <b>0.0040</b> **<br>(0.0021)   | <b>0.0064</b> ***<br>(0.0024)  | <b>0.0040</b> **<br>(0.0021)   | <b>0.0099</b> **<br>(0.0044)   | <b>0.0096</b> ***<br>(0.0036)  | <b>0.0110</b> ***<br>(0.0044)  | <b>0.0098</b> ***<br>(0.0036)  |
| Leverage              | <b>-0.0095</b> ***<br>(0.0030) | <b>-0.0154</b> **<br>(0.0072)  | <b>-0.0104</b> ***<br>(0.0032) | <b>-0.0155</b> **<br>(0.0073)  | <b>-0.0241</b> ***<br>(0.0075) | -0.0076<br>(0.0106)            | <b>-0.0261</b> ***<br>(0.0080) | -0.0074<br>(0.0106)            |
| InAssets              | <b>0.0005</b> **<br>(0.0002)   | <b>-0.0165</b> ***<br>(0.0019) | <b>-0.0016</b> ***<br>(0.0005) | <b>-0.0161</b> ***<br>(0.0019) | <b>0.0021</b> ***<br>(0.0004)  | <b>-0.0299</b> ***<br>(0.0031) | <b>-0.0028</b> ***<br>(0.0009) | <b>-0.0299</b> ***<br>(0.0031) |
| TobinsQ               | <b>0.0051</b> ***<br>(0.0006)  | <b>0.0040</b> ***<br>(0.0012)  | <b>0.0045</b> ***<br>(0.0006)  | <b>0.0037</b> ***<br>(0.0012)  | <b>0.0057</b> ***<br>(0.0010)  | -0.0000<br>(0.0016)            | <b>0.0048</b> ***<br>(0.0010)  | 0.0001<br>(0.0016)             |
| ROA                   | <b>-0.0647</b> ***<br>(0.0078) | <b>-0.0328</b> ***<br>(0.0092) | <b>-0.0603</b> ***<br>(0.0078) | <b>-0.0309</b> ***<br>(0.0093) | <b>-0.1397</b> ***<br>(0.0132) | <b>-0.0800</b> ***<br>(0.0149) | <b>-0.1329</b> ***<br>(0.0132) | <b>-0.0779</b> ***<br>(0.0150) |
| Capex                 | <b>-0.1378</b> ***<br>(0.0118) | <b>-0.2415</b> ***<br>(0.0234) | <b>-0.1391</b> ***<br>(0.0121) | <b>-0.2330</b> ***<br>(0.0232) | <b>-0.2038</b> ***<br>(0.0187) | <b>-0.2262</b> ***<br>(0.0349) | <b>-0.2119</b> ***<br>(0.0194) | <b>-0.2268</b> ***<br>(0.0353) |
| DivDummy              | <b>-0.0045</b> ***<br>(0.0011) | <b>-0.0032</b> *<br>(0.0019)   | <b>-0.0047</b> ***<br>(0.0011) | -0.0028<br>(0.0019)            | <b>-0.0051</b> ***<br>(0.0019) | -0.0040<br>(0.0035)            | <b>-0.0064</b> ***<br>(0.0020) | -0.0040<br>(0.0035)            |
| sCFO                  | <b>0.0112</b> *<br>(0.0049)    | 0.0024<br>(0.0029)             | <b>0.0105</b> **<br>(0.0045)   | 0.0024<br>(0.0029)             | <b>0.0174</b> **<br>(0.0075)   | <b>0.0068</b> *<br>(0.0035)    | <b>0.0161</b> **<br>(0.0068)   | <b>0.0066</b> *<br>(0.0034)    |
| SalesGrowth           | <b>-0.0092</b> ***<br>(0.0029) | <b>-0.0108</b> ***<br>(0.0030) | <b>-0.0084</b> ***<br>(0.0028) | <b>-0.0102</b> ***<br>(0.0030) | <b>-0.0095</b> **<br>(0.0041)  | <b>-0.0079</b> **<br>(0.0034)  | <b>-0.0084</b> **<br>(0.0041)  | <b>-0.0075</b> **<br>(0.0034)  |
| RDSales               | <b>0.0044</b> ***<br>(0.0016)  | <b>0.0024</b> *<br>(0.0013)    | <b>0.0044</b> ***<br>(0.0016)  | <b>0.0025</b> **<br>(0.0012)   | <b>0.0063</b> ***<br>(0.0024)  | -0.0001<br>(0.0020)            | <b>0.0064</b> ***<br>(0.0024)  | -0.0001<br>(0.0019)            |
| CashFlowAt            | <b>0.1031</b> ***<br>(0.0114)  | <b>0.1278</b> ***<br>(0.0149)  | <b>0.1006</b> ***<br>(0.0115)  | <b>0.1270</b> ***<br>(0.0151)  | <b>0.1676</b> ***<br>(0.0171)  | <b>0.1389</b> ***<br>(0.0183)  | <b>0.1597</b> ***<br>(0.0170)  | <b>0.1364</b> ***<br>(0.0184)  |
| DailyVola             | 0.0000<br>(0.0000)             | <b>-0.0001</b> ***<br>(0.0000) | <b>0.0001</b> *<br>(0.0000)    | -0.0000<br>(0.0000)            | <b>0.0004</b> ***<br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0001</b> ***<br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0003</b> ***<br>(0.0001)  | 0.0001<br>(0.0000)             |
| Lagged_DV             | <b>0.8672</b> ***<br>(0.0060)  | <b>0.6558</b> ***<br>(0.0101)  | <b>0.8644</b> ***<br>(0.0061)  | <b>0.6571</b> ***<br>(0.0101)  | <b>0.7275</b> ***<br>(0.0114)  | <b>0.2449</b> ***<br>(0.0153)  | <b>0.7206</b> ***<br>(0.0115)  | <b>0.2457</b> ***<br>(0.0153)  |
| Industry FE           | Yes                            |                                | Yes                            |                                | Yes                            |                                | Yes                            |                                |
| Firm FE               |                                | Yes                            |                                | Yes                            |                                | Yes                            |                                | Yes                            |
| Year FE               | Yes                            | Yes                            |                                |                                | Yes                            | Yes                            |                                |                                |
| Year-Quarter FE       |                                |                                | Yes                            | Yes                            |                                |                                | Yes                            | Yes                            |
| N                     | 67,544                         | 67,544                         | 67,544                         | 67,544                         | 66,216                         | 66,216                         | 66,216                         | 66,216                         |
| R <sup>2</sup>        | 0.831                          | 0.469                          | 0.832                          | 0.469                          | 0.651                          | 0.106                          | 0.654                          | 0.106                          |
| Adj. R <sup>2</sup>   | 0.831                          | 0.454                          | 0.832                          | 0.454                          | 0.651                          | 0.082                          | 0.653                          | 0.081                          |

Notes: \*  $p < 0.10$ , \*\*  $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\*  $p < 0.01$  (one-tailed for IVs,  $\beta > 0$ ; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). Fiscal years 2002-2016.  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ).

Table 9: H1.2.r: Financial Constraint–Moderated Speech Uncertainty and Cash Holdings (Three-Category, Robustness: CEO Q&amp;A Speaker Partition)

|                       | (1)                           | (2)                           | (3)                           | (4)                           | (5)                           | (6)                           | (7)                           | (8)                           |
|-----------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|
|                       |                               | CashRatio                     |                               |                               |                               | CashRatio_lead                |                               |                               |
| UncAnsCEO_c           | <b>0.0032***</b><br>(0.0010)  | <b>0.0015**</b><br>(0.0008)   | <b>0.0030***</b><br>(0.0010)  | <b>0.0016**</b><br>(0.0008)   | <b>0.0029**</b><br>(0.0016)   | <b>0.0025**</b><br>(0.0012)   | <b>0.0024*</b><br>(0.0016)    | <b>0.0024**</b><br>(0.0012)   |
| Unrated               | <b>0.0063***</b><br>(0.0012)  | -0.0008<br>(0.0034)           | -0.0011<br>(0.0017)           | -0.0008<br>(0.0034)           | <b>0.0101***</b><br>(0.0021)  | -0.0035<br>(0.0060)           | -0.0047<br>(0.0031)           | -0.0036<br>(0.0061)           |
| UncAnsCEO_c.x_Unrated | <b>0.0032*</b><br>(0.0022)    | 0.0005<br>(0.0020)            | <b>0.0036*</b><br>(0.0022)    | 0.0006<br>(0.0020)            | <b>0.0059*</b><br>(0.0037)    | 0.0012<br>(0.0033)            | <b>0.0064**</b><br>(0.0037)   | 0.0014<br>(0.0033)            |
| Leverage              | <b>-0.0134***</b><br>(0.0031) | <b>-0.0226***</b><br>(0.0068) | <b>-0.0143***</b><br>(0.0034) | <b>-0.0229***</b><br>(0.0068) | <b>-0.0248***</b><br>(0.0085) | -0.0109<br>(0.0095)           | <b>-0.0266***</b><br>(0.0091) | -0.0105<br>(0.0095)           |
| lnAssets              | <b>0.0005**</b><br>(0.0002)   | <b>-0.0163***</b><br>(0.0020) | <b>-0.0019***</b><br>(0.0006) | <b>-0.0158***</b><br>(0.0020) | <b>0.0021***</b><br>(0.0004)  | <b>-0.0299***</b><br>(0.0033) | <b>-0.0032***</b><br>(0.0010) | <b>-0.0300***</b><br>(0.0033) |
| TobinsQ               | <b>0.0054***</b><br>(0.0007)  | <b>0.0049***</b><br>(0.0014)  | <b>0.0047***</b><br>(0.0007)  | <b>0.0045***</b><br>(0.0014)  | <b>0.0056***</b><br>(0.0010)  | 0.0007<br>(0.0015)            | <b>0.0046***</b><br>(0.0010)  | 0.0008<br>(0.0015)            |
| ROA                   | <b>-0.0625***</b><br>(0.0080) | <b>-0.0279***</b><br>(0.0097) | <b>-0.0581***</b><br>(0.0080) | <b>-0.0258***</b><br>(0.0098) | <b>-0.1353***</b><br>(0.0137) | <b>-0.0751***</b><br>(0.0158) | <b>-0.1284***</b><br>(0.0135) | <b>-0.0730***</b><br>(0.0159) |
| Capex                 | <b>-0.1355***</b><br>(0.0129) | <b>-0.2383***</b><br>(0.0259) | <b>-0.1367***</b><br>(0.0131) | <b>-0.2295***</b><br>(0.0258) | <b>-0.2061***</b><br>(0.0199) | <b>-0.2231***</b><br>(0.0377) | <b>-0.2138***</b><br>(0.0206) | <b>-0.2250***</b><br>(0.0381) |
| DivDummy              | <b>-0.0047***</b><br>(0.0012) | <b>-0.0034*</b><br>(0.0019)   | <b>-0.0049***</b><br>(0.0012) | -0.0030<br>(0.0019)           | <b>-0.0054***</b><br>(0.0020) | -0.0049<br>(0.0035)           | <b>-0.0067***</b><br>(0.0021) | -0.0051<br>(0.0036)           |
| sCFO                  | <b>0.0119**</b><br>(0.0055)   | 0.0017<br>(0.0025)            | <b>0.0109**</b><br>(0.0049)   | 0.0016<br>(0.0025)            | <b>0.0176**</b><br>(0.0088)   | 0.0064<br>(0.0040)            | <b>0.0161**</b><br>(0.0078)   | 0.0063<br>(0.0039)            |
| SalesGrowth           | <b>-0.0119***</b><br>(0.0036) | <b>-0.0166***</b><br>(0.0035) | <b>-0.0108***</b><br>(0.0035) | <b>-0.0159***</b><br>(0.0034) | <b>-0.0124**</b><br>(0.0051)  | <b>-0.0143***</b><br>(0.0036) | <b>-0.0109**</b><br>(0.0050)  | <b>-0.0139***</b><br>(0.0036) |
| RDSales               | <b>0.0041*</b><br>(0.0025)    | 0.0013<br>(0.0016)            | 0.0041<br>(0.0025)            | 0.0015<br>(0.0016)            | <b>0.0063*</b><br>(0.0038)    | -0.0052<br>(0.0042)           | <b>0.0063*</b><br>(0.0038)    | -0.0051<br>(0.0042)           |
| CashFlowAt            | <b>0.1043***</b><br>(0.0126)  | <b>0.1304***</b><br>(0.0172)  | <b>0.1017***</b><br>(0.0127)  | <b>0.1297***</b><br>(0.0174)  | <b>0.1729***</b><br>(0.0182)  | <b>0.1504***</b><br>(0.0198)  | <b>0.1644***</b><br>(0.0181)  | <b>0.1476***</b><br>(0.0199)  |
| DailyVola             | <b>0.0000*</b><br>(0.0000)    | <b>-0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>0.0001**</b><br>(0.0000)   | -0.0000<br>(0.0000)           | <b>0.0004***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0003***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0001*</b><br>(0.0000)    |
| Lagged_DV             | <b>0.8589***</b><br>(0.0068)  | <b>0.6298***</b><br>(0.0103)  | <b>0.8555***</b><br>(0.0068)  | <b>0.6312***</b><br>(0.0103)  | <b>0.7307***</b><br>(0.0122)  | <b>0.2207***</b><br>(0.0152)  | <b>0.7228***</b><br>(0.0124)  | <b>0.2213***</b><br>(0.0152)  |
| Industry FE           | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               |
| Firm FE               |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |
| Year FE               | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               |
| Year-Quarter FE       |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| N                     | 58,157                        | 58,157                        | 58,157                        | 58,157                        | 57,042                        | 57,042                        | 57,042                        | 57,042                        |
| R <sup>2</sup>        | 0.822                         | 0.443                         | 0.823                         | 0.444                         | 0.645                         | 0.100                         | 0.648                         | 0.099                         |
| Adj. R <sup>2</sup>   | 0.821                         | 0.427                         | 0.822                         | 0.427                         | 0.645                         | 0.073                         | 0.647                         | 0.072                         |

Notes: \*  $p < 0.10$ , \*\*  $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\*  $p < 0.01$  (one-tailed for IVs,  $\beta > 0$ ; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). Fiscal years 2002-2016.  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ).

Table 10: H4a: Speech Uncertainty and Book Leverage

|                     | (1)                           | (2)                           | (3)                           | (4)                           | (5)                           | (6)                           | (7)                           | (8)                           | (9)                           | (10)                          | (11)                          | (12)                          |
|---------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|
|                     |                               |                               | Leverage                      |                               |                               |                               |                               |                               | Leverage Lead                 |                               |                               |                               |
| UncAnsCEO           | 0.0002<br>(0.0015)            | -0.0002<br>(0.0015)           | -0.0003<br>(0.0015)           | -0.0001<br>(0.0015)           | -0.0003<br>(0.0015)           | -0.0002<br>(0.0015)           | 0.0054<br>(0.0026)            | 0.0044<br>(0.0026)            | 0.0056<br>(0.0026)            | 0.0047<br>(0.0026)            | 0.0056<br>(0.0026)            | 0.0047<br>(0.0026)            |
| UncPreCEO           | 0.0011<br>(0.0013)            | -0.0014<br>(0.0014)           | 0.0011<br>(0.0013)            | -0.0006<br>(0.0014)           | 0.0011<br>(0.0013)            | -0.0005<br>(0.0014)           | 0.0045<br>(0.0030)            | -0.0015<br>(0.0027)           | 0.0041<br>(0.0030)            | -0.0008<br>(0.0027)           | 0.0042<br>(0.0030)            | -0.0004<br>(0.0027)           |
| UncAnsMgr           | -0.0002<br>(0.0017)           | -0.0018<br>(0.0019)           | -0.0011<br>(0.0018)           | -0.0011<br>(0.0019)           | 0.0004<br>(0.0017)            | -0.0012<br>(0.0019)           | <b>-0.0050*</b><br>(0.0033)   | <b>-0.0073**</b><br>(0.0033)  | <b>-0.0074**</b><br>(0.0034)  | <b>-0.0069**</b><br>(0.0034)  | <b>-0.0049*</b><br>(0.0033)   | <b>-0.0064**</b><br>(0.0034)  |
| UncPreMgr           | 0.0018<br>(0.0018)            | 0.0016<br>(0.0021)            | -0.0001<br>(0.0018)           | 0.0006<br>(0.0021)            | 0.0014<br>(0.0018)            | 0.0004<br>(0.0021)            | 0.0015<br>(0.0040)            | 0.0006<br>(0.0042)            | -0.0001<br>(0.0040)           | 0.0002<br>(0.0043)            | 0.0021<br>(0.0040)            | 0.0001<br>(0.0043)            |
| lnAssets            | <b>0.0029***</b><br>(0.0008)  | <b>0.0113***</b><br>(0.0021)  | <b>0.0025***</b><br>(0.0008)  | <b>0.0136***</b><br>(0.0021)  | <b>0.0035***</b><br>(0.0009)  | <b>0.0139***</b><br>(0.0021)  | <b>0.0069***</b><br>(0.0016)  | <b>0.0135***</b><br>(0.0042)  | <b>0.0060***</b><br>(0.0016)  | <b>0.0161***</b><br>(0.0042)  | <b>0.0076***</b><br>(0.0018)  | <b>0.0164***</b><br>(0.0042)  |
| TobinsQ             | <b>0.0021**</b><br>(0.0010)   | 0.0006<br>(0.0015)            | <b>0.0020*</b><br>(0.0010)    | 0.0008<br>(0.0015)            | <b>0.0024**</b><br>(0.0011)   | 0.0009<br>(0.0016)            | <b>0.0060***</b><br>(0.0023)  | 0.0031<br>(0.0030)            | <b>0.0062***</b><br>(0.0023)  | <b>0.0047*</b><br>(0.0027)    | <b>0.0067***</b><br>(0.0024)  | 0.0043<br>(0.0028)            |
| ROA                 | <b>-0.0860***</b><br>(0.0118) | <b>-0.1273***</b><br>(0.0164) | <b>-0.0579***</b><br>(0.0127) | <b>-0.0782***</b><br>(0.0150) | <b>-0.0605***</b><br>(0.0128) | <b>-0.0782***</b><br>(0.0152) | <b>-0.1445***</b><br>(0.0226) | <b>-0.1858***</b><br>(0.0261) | <b>-0.0981***</b><br>(0.0236) | <b>-0.1218***</b><br>(0.0238) | <b>-0.1018***</b><br>(0.0237) | <b>-0.1211***</b><br>(0.0240) |
| Capex               | 0.0125<br>(0.0148)            | -0.0109<br>(0.0275)           | 0.0131<br>(0.0169)            | 0.0021<br>(0.0273)            | 0.0138<br>(0.0168)            | -0.0013<br>(0.0274)           | <b>0.1133***</b><br>(0.0291)  | 0.0616<br>(0.0499)            | <b>0.1318***</b><br>(0.0314)  | <b>0.0834*</b><br>(0.0499)    | <b>0.1321***</b><br>(0.0317)  | <b>0.0874*</b><br>(0.0502)    |
| DivDummy            | <b>0.0031**</b><br>(0.0015)   | 0.0028<br>(0.0024)            | <b>0.0044***</b><br>(0.0015)  | 0.0036<br>(0.0025)            | <b>0.0043***</b><br>(0.0015)  | 0.0037<br>(0.0025)            | <b>0.0071**</b><br>(0.0034)   | <b>0.0107**</b><br>(0.0050)   | <b>0.0082**</b><br>(0.0033)   | <b>0.0117**</b><br>(0.0050)   | <b>0.0087***</b><br>(0.0033)  | <b>0.0122**</b><br>(0.0050)   |
| sCFO                | -0.0039<br>(0.0025)           | 0.0001<br>(0.0022)            | <b>-0.0056*</b><br>(0.0030)   | -0.0015<br>(0.0019)           | <b>-0.0051*</b><br>(0.0028)   | -0.0016<br>(0.0019)           | -0.0070<br>(0.0053)           | -0.0060<br>(0.0051)           | -0.0085<br>(0.0059)           | -0.0068<br>(0.0052)           | -0.0080<br>(0.0056)           | -0.0069<br>(0.0052)           |
| CashRatio           | <b>-0.0284***</b><br>(0.0064) | <b>-0.0297***</b><br>(0.0092) | <b>-0.0319***</b><br>(0.0066) | <b>-0.0267***</b><br>(0.0094) | <b>-0.0288***</b><br>(0.0067) | <b>-0.0261***</b><br>(0.0095) | <b>-0.0514***</b><br>(0.0124) | <b>-0.0289*</b><br>(0.0161)   | <b>-0.0569***</b><br>(0.0125) | <b>-0.0284*</b><br>(0.0157)   | <b>-0.0529***</b><br>(0.0128) | <b>-0.0281*</b><br>(0.0157)   |
| Lagged_DV           | <b>0.9396***</b><br>(0.0172)  | <b>0.7622***</b><br>(0.0134)  | <b>0.9371***</b><br>(0.0182)  | <b>0.7548***</b><br>(0.0134)  | <b>0.9375***</b><br>(0.0182)  | <b>0.7548***</b><br>(0.0135)  | <b>0.8347***</b><br>(0.0360)  | <b>0.3754***</b><br>(0.0267)  | <b>0.8321***</b><br>(0.0378)  | <b>0.3686***</b><br>(0.0275)  | <b>0.8321***</b><br>(0.0379)  | <b>0.3673***</b><br>(0.0275)  |
| SalesGrowth         |                               |                               | <b>0.0100***</b><br>(0.0034)  | <b>0.0140***</b><br>(0.0029)  | <b>0.0094***</b><br>(0.0034)  | <b>0.0136***</b><br>(0.0029)  |                               |                               | 0.0047<br>(0.0062)            | <b>0.0083*</b><br>(0.0046)    | 0.0038<br>(0.0062)            | <b>0.0079*</b><br>(0.0047)    |
| RDSales             |                               |                               | <b>-0.0020**</b><br>(0.0009)  | -0.0001<br>(0.0014)           | <b>-0.0021**</b><br>(0.0009)  | -0.0001<br>(0.0014)           |                               |                               | -0.0023<br>(0.0019)           | 0.0013<br>(0.0037)            | -0.0024<br>(0.0020)           | 0.0013<br>(0.0037)            |
| CashFlowAt          |                               |                               | <b>-0.0332**</b><br>(0.0159)  | <b>-0.0931***</b><br>(0.0171) | <b>-0.0304*</b><br>(0.0161)   | <b>-0.0915***</b><br>(0.0171) |                               |                               | <b>-0.0704**</b><br>(0.0276)  | <b>-0.1412***</b><br>(0.0277) | <b>-0.0628**</b><br>(0.0278)  | <b>-0.1361***</b><br>(0.0279) |
| DailyVola           |                               |                               | <b>0.0002***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0003***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0002***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0004***</b><br>(0.0001)  |                               |                               | 0.0001<br>(0.0001)            | <b>0.0003***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0002**</b><br>(0.0001)   | <b>0.0005***</b><br>(0.0001)  |
| Extended Controls   |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| Industry FE         | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               |
| Firm FE             |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |
| Year FE             | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               |
| Year-Quarter FE     |                               |                               |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| N                   | 65,132                        | 65,132                        | 62,508                        | 62,508                        | 62,508                        | 62,508                        | 60,626                        | 60,626                        | 59,447                        | 59,447                        | 59,447                        | 59,447                        |
| R <sup>2</sup>      | 0.889                         | 0.613                         | 0.891                         | 0.617                         | 0.891                         | 0.618                         | 0.714                         | 0.175                         | 0.715                         | 0.183                         | 0.716                         | 0.185                         |
| Adj. R <sup>2</sup> | 0.889                         | 0.603                         | 0.891                         | 0.606                         | 0.891                         | 0.606                         | 0.714                         | 0.152                         | 0.715                         | 0.159                         | 0.716                         | 0.161                         |

Notes: \*  $p < 0.10$ , \*\*  $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\*  $p < 0.01$  (one-tailed for IVs,  $\beta < 0$ ; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms).  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ).

Table 11: H4a Robustness: Orthogonal Speaker Partition

|                     | (1)                           | (2)                           | (3)                           | (4)                           | (5)                           | (6)                           | (7)                           | (8)                           | (9)                           | (10)                          | (11)                          | (12)                          |
|---------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|
|                     |                               |                               | Leverage                      |                               |                               |                               |                               |                               | Leverage Lead                 |                               |                               |                               |
| UncAnsCEO           | 0.0003<br>(0.0011)            | -0.0009<br>(0.0010)           | -0.0010<br>(0.0011)           | -0.0006<br>(0.0010)           | -0.0000<br>(0.0011)           | -0.0006<br>(0.0010)           | 0.0022<br>(0.0020)            | 0.0001<br>(0.0018)            | 0.0008<br>(0.0020)            | 0.0006<br>(0.0018)            | 0.0024<br>(0.0021)            | 0.0009<br>(0.0018)            |
| UncAnsNoCEO         | 0.0003<br>(0.0006)            | 0.0004<br>(0.0006)            | -0.0001<br>(0.0006)           | 0.0004<br>(0.0006)            | 0.0004<br>(0.0006)            | 0.0004<br>(0.0006)            | -0.0011<br>(0.0011)           | -0.0010<br>(0.0010)           | <b>-0.0018*</b><br>(0.0012)   | -0.0007<br>(0.0010)           | -0.0009<br>(0.0011)           | -0.0006<br>(0.0010)           |
| UncPreCEO           | 0.0021<br>(0.0011)            | -0.0005<br>(0.0011)           | 0.0011<br>(0.0011)            | -0.0001<br>(0.0012)           | 0.0018<br>(0.0012)            | -0.0001<br>(0.0012)           | 0.0052<br>(0.0026)            | -0.0011<br>(0.0022)           | 0.0039<br>(0.0026)            | -0.0004<br>(0.0022)           | 0.0052<br>(0.0027)            | 0.0000<br>(0.0022)            |
| UncPreNoCEO         | 0.0007<br>(0.0008)            | -0.0000<br>(0.0011)           | -0.0002<br>(0.0008)           | -0.0006<br>(0.0010)           | 0.0005<br>(0.0008)            | -0.0007<br>(0.0010)           | 0.0004<br>(0.0019)            | -0.0003<br>(0.0021)           | -0.0004<br>(0.0019)           | -0.0005<br>(0.0021)           | 0.0007<br>(0.0019)            | -0.0006<br>(0.0021)           |
| lnAssets            | <b>0.0030***</b><br>(0.0008)  | <b>0.0120***</b><br>(0.0022)  | <b>0.0025***</b><br>(0.0008)  | <b>0.0143***</b><br>(0.0022)  | <b>0.0036***</b><br>(0.0009)  | <b>0.0145***</b><br>(0.0022)  | <b>0.0069***</b><br>(0.0017)  | <b>0.0138***</b><br>(0.0043)  | <b>0.0058***</b><br>(0.0017)  | <b>0.0167***</b><br>(0.0043)  | <b>0.0077***</b><br>(0.0019)  | <b>0.0169***</b><br>(0.0043)  |
| TobinsQ             | <b>0.0021**</b><br>(0.0011)   | 0.0009<br>(0.0016)            | <b>0.0020*</b><br>(0.0011)    | 0.0011<br>(0.0015)            | <b>0.0024**</b><br>(0.0011)   | 0.0012<br>(0.0016)            | <b>0.0058**</b><br>(0.0024)   | 0.0036<br>(0.0029)            | <b>0.0060**</b><br>(0.0024)   | <b>0.0052**</b><br>(0.0026)   | <b>0.0065***</b><br>(0.0024)  | <b>0.0048*</b><br>(0.0026)    |
| ROA                 | <b>-0.0878***</b><br>(0.0131) | <b>-0.1305***</b><br>(0.0170) | <b>-0.0588***</b><br>(0.0137) | <b>-0.0789***</b><br>(0.0155) | <b>-0.0613***</b><br>(0.0138) | <b>-0.0788***</b><br>(0.0157) | <b>-0.1381***</b><br>(0.0238) | <b>-0.1858***</b><br>(0.0281) | <b>-0.0924***</b><br>(0.0252) | <b>-0.1185***</b><br>(0.0253) | <b>-0.0961***</b><br>(0.0253) | <b>-0.1177***</b><br>(0.0255) |
| Capex               | 0.0137<br>(0.0157)            | -0.0032<br>(0.0278)           | 0.0133<br>(0.0178)            | 0.0069<br>(0.0276)            | 0.0146<br>(0.0177)            | 0.0040<br>(0.0277)            | <b>0.1171***</b><br>(0.0308)  | 0.0624<br>(0.0522)            | <b>0.1345***</b><br>(0.0331)  | 0.0858<br>(0.0523)            | <b>0.1356***</b><br>(0.0333)  | <b>0.0906*</b><br>(0.0527)    |
| DivDummy            | <b>0.0032**</b><br>(0.0016)   | 0.0037<br>(0.0025)            | <b>0.0045***</b><br>(0.0015)  | <b>0.0046*</b><br>(0.0025)    | <b>0.0044***</b><br>(0.0015)  | <b>0.0046*</b><br>(0.0025)    | <b>0.0078**</b><br>(0.0036)   | <b>0.0129**</b><br>(0.0051)   | <b>0.0090***</b><br>(0.0035)  | <b>0.0139***</b><br>(0.0051)  | <b>0.0093***</b><br>(0.0034)  | <b>0.0144***</b><br>(0.0051)  |
| sCFO                | -0.0037<br>(0.0025)           | 0.0002<br>(0.0023)            | <b>-0.0051*</b><br>(0.0028)   | -0.0012<br>(0.0019)           | <b>-0.0046*</b><br>(0.0026)   | -0.0013<br>(0.0019)           | -0.0073<br>(0.0056)           | -0.0053<br>(0.0050)           | -0.0089<br>(0.0063)           | -0.0064<br>(0.0051)           | -0.0084<br>(0.0060)           | -0.0065<br>(0.0051)           |
| CashRatio           | <b>-0.0276***</b><br>(0.0066) | <b>-0.0316***</b><br>(0.0094) | <b>-0.0319***</b><br>(0.0069) | <b>-0.0287***</b><br>(0.0097) | <b>-0.0285***</b><br>(0.0069) | <b>-0.0280***</b><br>(0.0097) | <b>-0.0494***</b><br>(0.0125) | <b>-0.0326**</b><br>(0.0160)  | <b>-0.0555***</b><br>(0.0126) | <b>-0.0322**</b><br>(0.0155)  | <b>-0.0511***</b><br>(0.0130) | <b>-0.0319**</b><br>(0.0156)  |
| Lagged_DV           | <b>0.9387***</b><br>(0.0181)  | <b>0.7600***</b><br>(0.0136)  | <b>0.9365***</b><br>(0.0191)  | <b>0.7526***</b><br>(0.0137)  | <b>0.9369***</b><br>(0.0191)  | <b>0.7527***</b><br>(0.0137)  | <b>0.8353***</b><br>(0.0377)  | <b>0.3755***</b><br>(0.0277)  | <b>0.8325***</b><br>(0.0395)  | <b>0.3677***</b><br>(0.0284)  | <b>0.8324***</b><br>(0.0396)  | <b>0.3663***</b><br>(0.0284)  |
| SalesGrowth         |                               |                               | <b>0.0093***</b><br>(0.0036)  | <b>0.0135***</b><br>(0.0030)  | <b>0.0087**</b><br>(0.0036)   | <b>0.0131***</b><br>(0.0030)  |                               |                               | 0.0037<br>(0.0065)            | 0.0078<br>(0.0049)            | 0.0027<br>(0.0066)            | 0.0075<br>(0.0049)            |
| RDSales             |                               |                               | <b>-0.0019**</b><br>(0.0009)  | 0.0001<br>(0.0016)            | <b>-0.0020**</b><br>(0.0009)  | 0.0001<br>(0.0016)            |                               |                               | -0.0023<br>(0.0020)           | 0.0016<br>(0.0044)            | -0.0024<br>(0.0020)           | 0.0016<br>(0.0044)            |
| CashFlowAt          |                               |                               | <b>-0.0330**</b><br>(0.0161)  | <b>-0.0932***</b><br>(0.0173) | <b>-0.0301*</b><br>(0.0163)   | <b>-0.0916***</b><br>(0.0173) |                               |                               | <b>-0.0684**</b><br>(0.0285)  | <b>-0.1454***</b><br>(0.0289) | <b>-0.0604**</b><br>(0.0287)  | <b>-0.1401***</b><br>(0.0292) |
| DailyVola           |                               |                               | <b>0.0002***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0003***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0002***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0004***</b><br>(0.0001)  |                               |                               | 0.0001<br>(0.0001)            | <b>0.0003***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0002**</b><br>(0.0001)   | <b>0.0005***</b><br>(0.0001)  |
| Extended Controls   |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| Industry FE         | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               |
| Firm FE             |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |
| Year FE             | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               |
| Year-Quarter FE     |                               |                               |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| N                   | 61,124                        | 61,124                        | 58,685                        | 58,685                        | 58,685                        | 58,685                        | 56,898                        | 56,898                        | 55,816                        | 55,816                        | 55,816                        | 55,816                        |
| R <sup>2</sup>      | 0.889                         | 0.613                         | 0.891                         | 0.617                         | 0.891                         | 0.618                         | 0.714                         | 0.175                         | 0.716                         | 0.183                         | 0.717                         | 0.185                         |
| Adj. R <sup>2</sup> | 0.889                         | 0.602                         | 0.891                         | 0.606                         | 0.891                         | 0.606                         | 0.714                         | 0.151                         | 0.716                         | 0.158                         | 0.716                         | 0.160                         |

Notes: \*  $p < 0.10$ , \*\*  $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\*  $p < 0.01$  (one-tailed for IVs,  $\beta < 0$ ; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms).  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ).

Table 12: H4b: Speech Uncertainty and Debt-to-Capital

|                     | (1)                           | (2)                           | (3)                           | (4)                           | (5)                           | (6)                           | (7)                           | (8)                           | (9)                           | (10)                          | (11)                          | (12)                          |
|---------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|
|                     |                               |                               | DebtToCapital                 |                               |                               |                               |                               |                               | DebtToCapital_lead            |                               |                               |                               |
| UncAnsCEO           | 0.0007<br>(0.0022)            | 0.0006<br>(0.0022)            | -0.0004<br>(0.0023)           | 0.0003<br>(0.0023)            | -0.0005<br>(0.0023)           | 0.0002<br>(0.0023)            | 0.0048<br>(0.0045)            | 0.0040<br>(0.0041)            | 0.0051<br>(0.0045)            | 0.0043<br>(0.0041)            | 0.0049<br>(0.0045)            | 0.0044<br>(0.0041)            |
| UncPreCEO           | 0.0008<br>(0.0021)            | -0.0011<br>(0.0023)           | 0.0011<br>(0.0021)            | 0.0001<br>(0.0023)            | 0.0010<br>(0.0020)            | 0.0002<br>(0.0023)            | 0.0059<br>(0.0050)            | -0.0018<br>(0.0042)           | 0.0054<br>(0.0050)            | -0.0011<br>(0.0042)           | 0.0056<br>(0.0050)            | -0.0002<br>(0.0042)           |
| UncAnsMgr           | 0.0002<br>(0.0027)            | 0.0005<br>(0.0029)            | -0.0020<br>(0.0026)           | 0.0015<br>(0.0030)            | 0.0014<br>(0.0030)            | 0.0013<br>(0.0028)            | <b>-0.0087*</b><br>(0.0030)   | <b>-0.0077*</b><br>(0.0059)   | <b>-0.0154***</b><br>(0.0055) | <b>-0.0079*</b><br>(0.0058)   | <b>-0.0085*</b><br>(0.0055)   | -0.0069<br>(0.0059)           |
| UncPreMgr           | 0.0007<br>(0.0028)            | 0.0022<br>(0.0036)            | -0.0030<br>(0.0026)           | 0.0007<br>(0.0035)            | 0.0005<br>(0.0027)            | 0.0003<br>(0.0035)            | -0.0023<br>(0.0063)           | -0.0011<br>(0.0069)           | -0.0078<br>(0.0063)           | -0.0016<br>(0.0070)           | -0.0013<br>(0.0064)           | -0.0017<br>(0.0070)           |
| lnAssets            | <b>0.0049***</b><br>(0.0010)  | 0.0008<br>(0.0040)            | <b>0.0042***</b><br>(0.0009)  | 0.0044<br>(0.0040)            | <b>0.0066***</b><br>(0.0012)  | 0.0049<br>(0.0040)            | <b>0.0149***</b><br>(0.0025)  | 0.0015<br>(0.0075)            | <b>0.0123***</b><br>(0.0020)  | 0.0057<br>(0.0076)            | <b>0.0172***</b><br>(0.0028)  | 0.0062<br>(0.0076)            |
| TobinsQ             | <b>0.0043**</b><br>(0.0019)   | 0.0028<br>(0.0020)            | <b>0.0035*</b><br>(0.0020)    | 0.0024<br>(0.0020)            | <b>0.0043**</b><br>(0.0021)   | 0.0026<br>(0.0021)            | <b>0.0116***</b><br>(0.0040)  | 0.0055<br>(0.0053)            | <b>0.0116***</b><br>(0.0043)  | 0.0077<br>(0.0053)            | <b>0.0129***</b><br>(0.0045)  | 0.0068<br>(0.0053)            |
| ROA                 | <b>-0.1691***</b><br>(0.0241) | <b>-0.2194***</b><br>(0.0224) | <b>-0.1482***</b><br>(0.0232) | <b>-0.1672***</b><br>(0.0225) | <b>-0.1522***</b><br>(0.0235) | <b>-0.1670***</b><br>(0.0227) | <b>-0.3196***</b><br>(0.0375) | <b>-0.3319***</b><br>(0.0349) | <b>-0.2638***</b><br>(0.0389) | <b>-0.2364***</b><br>(0.0359) | <b>-0.2700***</b><br>(0.0390) | <b>-0.2345***</b><br>(0.0359) |
| Capex               | -0.0007<br>(0.0246)           | -0.0110<br>(0.0419)           | -0.0260<br>(0.0301)           | -0.0029<br>(0.0435)           | -0.0238<br>(0.0299)           | -0.0115<br>(0.0438)           | <b>0.1038**</b><br>(0.0435)   | 0.0375<br>(0.0718)            | <b>0.1075**</b><br>(0.0511)   | 0.0687<br>(0.0732)            | <b>0.1122**</b><br>(0.0515)   | 0.0757<br>(0.0737)            |
| DivDummy            | <b>0.0039*</b><br>(0.0021)    | 0.0043<br>(0.0042)            | <b>0.0060***</b><br>(0.0021)  | 0.0052<br>(0.0043)            | <b>0.0061***</b><br>(0.0021)  | 0.0053<br>(0.0043)            | <b>0.0102**</b><br>(0.0050)   | <b>0.0168*</b><br>(0.0087)    | <b>0.0121**</b><br>(0.0050)   | <b>0.0183**</b><br>(0.0087)   | <b>0.0133***</b><br>(0.0050)  | <b>0.0192**</b><br>(0.0087)   |
| sCFO                | -0.0036<br>(0.0028)           | 0.0008<br>(0.0029)            | -0.0066<br>(0.0042)           | -0.0021<br>(0.0026)           | -0.0056<br>(0.0037)           | -0.0021<br>(0.0026)           | -0.0042<br>(0.0054)           | -0.0004<br>(0.0071)           | -0.0065<br>(0.0059)           | -0.0021<br>(0.0071)           | -0.0054<br>(0.0056)           | -0.0023<br>(0.0071)           |
| CashRatio           | <b>-0.0542***</b><br>(0.0077) | <b>-0.0674***</b><br>(0.0142) | <b>-0.0599***</b><br>(0.0079) | <b>-0.0655***</b><br>(0.0147) | <b>-0.0536***</b><br>(0.0079) | <b>-0.0643***</b><br>(0.0147) | <b>-0.0937***</b><br>(0.0180) | <b>-0.0664**</b><br>(0.0266)  | <b>-0.1039***</b><br>(0.0182) | <b>-0.0662**</b><br>(0.0265)  | <b>-0.0933***</b><br>(0.0180) | <b>-0.0659**</b><br>(0.0264)  |
| Lagged_DV           | <b>0.9273***</b><br>(0.0123)  | <b>0.7897***</b><br>(0.0217)  | <b>0.9229***</b><br>(0.0133)  | <b>0.7782***</b><br>(0.0225)  | <b>0.9228***</b><br>(0.0134)  | <b>0.7785***</b><br>(0.0226)  | <b>0.7992***</b><br>(0.0297)  | <b>0.4064***</b><br>(0.0352)  | <b>0.7961***</b><br>(0.0307)  | <b>0.3955***</b><br>(0.0361)  | <b>0.7949***</b><br>(0.0311)  | <b>0.3937***</b><br>(0.0363)  |
| SalesGrowth         |                               |                               | <b>0.0105**</b><br>(0.0043)   | <b>0.0178***</b><br>(0.0046)  | <b>0.0091**</b><br>(0.0043)   | <b>0.0166***</b><br>(0.0046)  |                               |                               | -0.0034<br>(0.0084)           | 0.0078<br>(0.0076)            | -0.0053<br>(0.0085)           | 0.0069<br>(0.0077)            |
| RDSales             |                               |                               | <b>-0.0037**</b><br>(0.0018)  | 0.0003<br>(0.0017)            | <b>-0.0038**</b><br>(0.0018)  | 0.0002<br>(0.0017)            |                               |                               | <b>-0.0061*</b><br>(0.0033)   | 0.0005<br>(0.0057)            | <b>-0.0063*</b><br>(0.0033)   | 0.0005<br>(0.0057)            |
| CashFlowAt          |                               |                               | -0.0007<br>(0.0276)           | <b>-0.0666**</b><br>(0.0314)  | 0.0056<br>(0.0278)            | <b>-0.0632**</b><br>(0.0316)  |                               |                               | -0.0728<br>(0.0518)           | <b>-0.1913***</b><br>(0.0454) | -0.0548<br>(0.0517)           | <b>-0.1811***</b><br>(0.0455) |
| DailyVola           |                               |                               | <b>0.0003***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0006***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0004***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0007***</b><br>(0.0001)  |                               |                               | <b>0.0003*</b><br>(0.0001)    | <b>0.0006***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0006***</b><br>(0.0002)  | <b>0.0010***</b><br>(0.0002)  |
| Extended Controls   |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| Industry FE         | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| Firm FE             |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |
| Year FE             | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               |
| Year-Quarter FE     |                               |                               |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| N                   | 64,895                        | 64,895                        | 62,286                        | 62,286                        | 62,286                        | 62,286                        | 60,363                        | 60,363                        | 59,190                        | 59,190                        | 59,190                        | 59,190                        |
| R <sup>2</sup>      | 0.867                         | 0.620                         | 0.869                         | 0.619                         | 0.869                         | 0.620                         | 0.662                         | 0.189                         | 0.663                         | 0.191                         | 0.665                         | 0.194                         |
| Adj. R <sup>2</sup> | 0.867                         | 0.610                         | 0.869                         | 0.608                         | 0.869                         | 0.608                         | 0.662                         | 0.166                         | 0.663                         | 0.167                         | 0.664                         | 0.169                         |

Notes: \*  $p < 0.10$ , \*\*  $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\*  $p < 0.01$  (one-tailed for IVs,  $\beta < 0$ ; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms).  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ).

Table 13: H4b Robustness: Orthogonal Speaker Partition

|                     | (1)                           | (2)                           | (3)                           | (4)                           | (5)                           | (6)                           | (7)                           | (8)                           | (9)                           | (10)                          | (11)                          | (12)                          |
|---------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|
|                     |                               |                               | DebtToCapital                 |                               |                               |                               |                               |                               | DebtToCapital_lead            |                               |                               |                               |
| UncAnsCEO           | 0.0012<br>(0.0017)            | 0.0016<br>(0.0016)            | -0.0015<br>(0.0017)           | 0.0017<br>(0.0016)            | 0.0006<br>(0.0017)            | 0.0016<br>(0.0016)            | -0.0007<br>(0.0031)           | -0.0005<br>(0.0030)           | <b>-0.0050*</b><br>(0.0033)   | 0.0001<br>(0.0029)            | -0.0004<br>(0.0032)           | 0.0007<br>(0.0029)            |
| UncAnsNoCEO         | 0.0001<br>(0.0009)            | 0.0009<br>(0.0009)            | -0.0009<br>(0.0009)           | 0.0010<br>(0.0009)            | 0.0004<br>(0.0009)            | 0.0009<br>(0.0009)            | -0.0015<br>(0.0019)           | -0.0001<br>(0.0015)           | <b>-0.0040**</b><br>(0.0019)  | 0.0000<br>(0.0015)            | -0.0014<br>(0.0019)           | 0.0002<br>(0.0015)            |
| UncPreCEO           | 0.0019<br>(0.0017)            | 0.0006<br>(0.0020)            | 0.0000<br>(0.0017)            | 0.0010<br>(0.0020)            | 0.0017<br>(0.0018)            | 0.0010<br>(0.0020)            | 0.0055<br>(0.0041)            | -0.0014<br>(0.0034)           | 0.0017<br>(0.0039)            | -0.0008<br>(0.0034)           | 0.0053<br>(0.0041)            | 0.0001<br>(0.0034)            |
| UncPreNoCEO         | -0.0002<br>(0.0013)           | -0.0011<br>(0.0022)           | <b>-0.0019*</b><br>(0.0012)   | -0.0017<br>(0.0022)           | -0.0002<br>(0.0013)           | -0.0019<br>(0.0022)           | -0.0006<br>(0.0030)           | -0.0002<br>(0.0033)           | -0.0033<br>(0.0030)           | -0.0005<br>(0.0034)           | -0.0001<br>(0.0031)           | -0.0008<br>(0.0034)           |
| lnAssets            | <b>0.0053***</b><br>(0.0010)  | 0.0017<br>(0.0042)            | <b>0.0043***</b><br>(0.0009)  | 0.0047<br>(0.0042)            | <b>0.0068***</b><br>(0.0012)  | 0.0052<br>(0.0042)            | <b>0.0154***</b><br>(0.0025)  | 0.0030<br>(0.0073)            | <b>0.0122***</b><br>(0.0020)  | 0.0076<br>(0.0074)            | <b>0.0176***</b><br>(0.0028)  | 0.0080<br>(0.0074)            |
| TobinsQ             | <b>0.0041**</b><br>(0.0019)   | 0.0029<br>(0.0020)            | 0.0034<br>(0.0021)            | 0.0026<br>(0.0020)            | <b>0.0043**</b><br>(0.0021)   | 0.0028<br>(0.0021)            | <b>0.0116***</b><br>(0.0042)  | 0.0064<br>(0.0052)            | <b>0.0115***</b><br>(0.0045)  | <b>0.0087*</b><br>(0.0051)    | <b>0.0130***</b><br>(0.0046)  | 0.0078<br>(0.0052)            |
| ROA                 | <b>-0.1710***</b><br>(0.0263) | <b>-0.2214***</b><br>(0.0238) | <b>-0.1478***</b><br>(0.0251) | <b>-0.1661***</b><br>(0.0239) | <b>-0.1515***</b><br>(0.0254) | <b>-0.1658***</b><br>(0.0240) | <b>-0.3146***</b><br>(0.0411) | <b>-0.3298***</b><br>(0.0362) | <b>-0.2543***</b><br>(0.0415) | <b>-0.2279***</b><br>(0.0374) | <b>-0.2602***</b><br>(0.0417) | <b>-0.2255***</b><br>(0.0374) |
| Capex               | 0.0032<br>(0.0262)            | 0.0033<br>(0.0440)            | -0.0221<br>(0.0322)           | 0.0087<br>(0.0457)            | -0.0191<br>(0.0320)           | 0.0007<br>(0.0461)            | <b>0.1129**</b><br>(0.0464)   | 0.0361<br>(0.0755)            | <b>0.1163**</b><br>(0.0546)   | 0.0707<br>(0.0772)            | <b>0.1239**</b><br>(0.0550)   | 0.0795<br>(0.0779)            |
| DivDummy            | <b>0.0039*</b><br>(0.0022)    | 0.0057<br>(0.0044)            | <b>0.0060***</b><br>(0.0022)  | 0.0068<br>(0.0044)            | <b>0.0061***</b><br>(0.0022)  | 0.0068<br>(0.0044)            | <b>0.0109**</b><br>(0.0052)   | <b>0.0199**</b><br>(0.0090)   | <b>0.0129**</b><br>(0.0052)   | <b>0.0213**</b><br>(0.0090)   | <b>0.0140***</b><br>(0.0052)  | <b>0.0223**</b><br>(0.0090)   |
| sCFO                | -0.0034<br>(0.0028)           | 0.0010<br>(0.0028)            | -0.0060<br>(0.0040)           | -0.0016<br>(0.0025)           | -0.0050<br>(0.0035)           | -0.0016<br>(0.0025)           | -0.0040<br>(0.0055)           | 0.0000<br>(0.0069)            | -0.0064<br>(0.0060)           | -0.0014<br>(0.0069)           | -0.0051<br>(0.0056)           | -0.0017<br>(0.0069)           |
| CashRatio           | <b>-0.0518***</b><br>(0.0078) | <b>-0.0676***</b><br>(0.0148) | <b>-0.0600***</b><br>(0.0081) | <b>-0.0666***</b><br>(0.0153) | <b>-0.0532***</b><br>(0.0080) | <b>-0.0653***</b><br>(0.0153) | <b>-0.0928***</b><br>(0.0182) | <b>-0.0744***</b><br>(0.0267) | <b>-0.1049***</b><br>(0.0187) | <b>-0.0751***</b><br>(0.0267) | <b>-0.0928***</b><br>(0.0183) | <b>-0.0748***</b><br>(0.0267) |
| Lagged_DV           | <b>0.9255***</b><br>(0.0128)  | <b>0.7868***</b><br>(0.0225)  | <b>0.9223***</b><br>(0.0137)  | <b>0.7764***</b><br>(0.0233)  | <b>0.9222***</b><br>(0.0138)  | <b>0.7767***</b><br>(0.0233)  | <b>0.7960***</b><br>(0.0305)  | <b>0.4017***</b><br>(0.0357)  | <b>0.7939***</b><br>(0.0315)  | <b>0.3908***</b><br>(0.0366)  | <b>0.7926***</b><br>(0.0319)  | <b>0.3889***</b><br>(0.0367)  |
| SalesGrowth         |                               |                               | <b>0.0097**</b><br>(0.0046)   | <b>0.0171***</b><br>(0.0048)  | <b>0.0082*</b><br>(0.0047)    | <b>0.0158***</b><br>(0.0049)  |                               |                               | -0.0049<br>(0.0090)           | 0.0055<br>(0.0078)            | -0.0068<br>(0.0091)           | 0.0046<br>(0.0079)            |
| RDSales             |                               |                               | <b>-0.0031*</b><br>(0.0018)   | -0.0001<br>(0.0022)           | <b>-0.0032*</b><br>(0.0018)   | -0.0002<br>(0.0022)           |                               |                               | <b>-0.0062*</b><br>(0.0036)   | 0.0009<br>(0.0068)            | <b>-0.0064*</b><br>(0.0037)   | 0.0010<br>(0.0068)            |
| CashFlowAt          |                               |                               | -0.0047<br>(0.0292)           | <b>-0.0734**</b><br>(0.0333)  | 0.0018<br>(0.0294)            | <b>-0.0699**</b><br>(0.0334)  |                               |                               | -0.0778<br>(0.0544)           | <b>-0.1934***</b><br>(0.0471) | -0.0591<br>(0.0544)           | <b>-0.1830***</b><br>(0.0472) |
| DailyVola           |                               |                               | <b>0.0003***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0006***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0005***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0007***</b><br>(0.0001)  |                               |                               | <b>0.0002*</b><br>(0.0001)    | <b>0.0007***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0006***</b><br>(0.0002)  | <b>0.0011***</b><br>(0.0002)  |
| Extended Controls   |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| Industry FE         | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               |
| Firm FE             |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |
| Year FE             | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               |
| Year-Quarter FE     |                               |                               |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| N                   | 60,906                        | 60,906                        | 58,477                        | 58,477                        | 58,477                        | 58,477                        | 56,652                        | 56,652                        | 55,571                        | 55,571                        | 55,571                        | 55,571                        |
| R <sup>2</sup>      | 0.867                         | 0.619                         | 0.868                         | 0.616                         | 0.869                         | 0.617                         | 0.662                         | 0.186                         | 0.663                         | 0.188                         | 0.665                         | 0.191                         |
| Adj. R <sup>2</sup> | 0.867                         | 0.608                         | 0.868                         | 0.605                         | 0.869                         | 0.606                         | 0.662                         | 0.162                         | 0.663                         | 0.163                         | 0.664                         | 0.165                         |

Notes: \*  $p < 0.10$ , \*\*  $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\*  $p < 0.01$  (one-tailed for IVs,  $\beta < 0$ ; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms).  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ).



Table 14: H5: Speech Uncertainty and Analyst Forecast Dispersion (Wang 2020)

|                     | (1)                           | (2)                           | (3)                           | (4)                           | (5)                           | (6)                           | (7)                           | (8)                           | (9)                           | (10)                          | (11)                          | (12)                          |
|---------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|
|                     | DISP                          |                               |                               |                               |                               |                               | DISP <sub>lead</sub>          |                               |                               |                               |                               |                               |
| UncAnsCEO           | -0.0001<br>(0.0001)           | -0.0002<br>(0.0001)           | -0.0002<br>(0.0001)           | -0.0002<br>(0.0001)           | -0.0002<br>(0.0001)           | -0.0002<br>(0.0001)           | -0.0001<br>(0.0001)           | -0.0001<br>(0.0001)           | -0.0002<br>(0.0001)           | -0.0002<br>(0.0001)           | -0.0002<br>(0.0001)           | -0.0002<br>(0.0001)           |
| UncPreCEO           | 0.0001<br>(0.0001)            | 0.0000<br>(0.0001)            | 0.0000<br>(0.0000)            | -0.0001<br>(0.0001)           | -0.0000<br>(0.0000)           | -0.0001<br>(0.0001)           | 0.0001<br>(0.0001)            | 0.0001<br>(0.0001)            | -0.0000<br>(0.0001)           | -0.0001<br>(0.0001)           | -0.0000<br>(0.0001)           | -0.0001<br>(0.0001)           |
| UncAnsMgr           | <b>0.0002***</b><br>(0.0001)  | 0.0001<br>(0.0001)            | <b>0.0002***</b><br>(0.0001)  | 0.0001<br>(0.0001)            | <b>0.0002***</b><br>(0.0001)  | 0.0001<br>(0.0001)            | <b>0.0002**</b><br>(0.0001)   | 0.0001<br>(0.0001)            | <b>0.0002***</b><br>(0.0001)  | 0.0001<br>(0.0001)            | <b>0.0002**</b><br>(0.0001)   | 0.0001<br>(0.0001)            |
| UncPreMgr           | <b>0.0001*</b><br>(0.0001)    | <b>0.0002***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0001**</b><br>(0.0001)   | <b>0.0001**</b><br>(0.0001)   | <b>0.0001*</b><br>(0.0001)    | <b>0.0001**</b><br>(0.0001)   | <b>0.0001*</b><br>(0.0001)    | <b>0.0003**</b><br>(0.0001)   | <b>0.0002***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0002**</b><br>(0.0001)   | <b>0.0001**</b><br>(0.0001)   | <b>0.0002**</b><br>(0.0001)   |
| lnAssets            | -0.0000<br>(0.0000)           | -0.0001<br>(0.0001)           | 0.0000<br>(0.0000)            | -0.0001<br>(0.0001)           | -0.0000<br>(0.0000)           | -0.0001<br>(0.0001)           | -0.0000<br>(0.0000)           | -0.0001<br>(0.0001)           | 0.0000<br>(0.0000)            | -0.0001<br>(0.0001)           | -0.0000<br>(0.0000)           | -0.0001<br>(0.0001)           |
| TobinsQ             | <b>-0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0001**</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>-0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0001**</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>-0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000) |
| ROA                 | <b>-0.0025***</b><br>(0.0004) | <b>-0.0034***</b><br>(0.0005) | <b>-0.0010***</b><br>(0.0004) | <b>-0.0023***</b><br>(0.0005) | <b>-0.0011***</b><br>(0.0004) | <b>-0.0024***</b><br>(0.0005) | <b>-0.0035***</b><br>(0.0005) | <b>-0.0045***</b><br>(0.0006) | <b>-0.0021***</b><br>(0.0005) | <b>-0.0035***</b><br>(0.0006) | <b>-0.0021***</b><br>(0.0005) | <b>-0.0035***</b><br>(0.0006) |
| Leverage            | <b>0.0005***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0014***</b><br>(0.0003)  | <b>0.0004***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0012***</b><br>(0.0003)  | <b>0.0004***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0012***</b><br>(0.0003)  | <b>0.0004***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0013***</b><br>(0.0004)  | <b>0.0003***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0010***</b><br>(0.0003)  | <b>0.0003***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0009***</b><br>(0.0003)  |
| Capex               | -0.0006<br>(0.0006)           | <b>-0.0024***</b><br>(0.0009) | -0.0001<br>(0.0006)           | <b>-0.0019**</b><br>(0.0008)  | -0.0002<br>(0.0006)           | <b>-0.0020**</b><br>(0.0008)  | -0.0002<br>(0.0007)           | -0.0011<br>(0.0010)           | 0.0004<br>(0.0007)            | -0.0004<br>(0.0010)           | -0.0001<br>(0.0007)           | -0.0010<br>(0.0010)           |
| DivDummy            | <b>-0.0002***</b><br>(0.0000) | -0.0001<br>(0.0001)           | <b>-0.0002***</b><br>(0.0000) | -0.0001<br>(0.0001)           | <b>-0.0002***</b><br>(0.0000) | -0.0001<br>(0.0001)           | <b>-0.0001**</b><br>(0.0001)  | -0.0001<br>(0.0001)           | <b>-0.0002***</b><br>(0.0001) | -0.0001<br>(0.0001)           | <b>-0.0002***</b><br>(0.0001) | -0.0001<br>(0.0001)           |
| sCFO                | <b>0.0005*</b><br>(0.0003)    | 0.0001<br>(0.0001)            | <b>0.0005*</b><br>(0.0003)    | <b>0.0001*</b><br>(0.0001)    | <b>0.0005*</b><br>(0.0003)    | <b>0.0001*</b><br>(0.0001)    | <b>0.0008**</b><br>(0.0003)   | <b>0.0002***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0008**</b><br>(0.0003)   | <b>0.0002***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0008***</b><br>(0.0003)  | <b>0.0003***</b><br>(0.0001)  |
| Lagged_DV           | <b>0.6484***</b><br>(0.0176)  | <b>0.3880***</b><br>(0.0256)  | <b>0.6278***</b><br>(0.0177)  | <b>0.3722***</b><br>(0.0254)  | <b>0.6310***</b><br>(0.0178)  | <b>0.3758***</b><br>(0.0255)  | <b>0.5926***</b><br>(0.0213)  | <b>0.3103***</b><br>(0.0292)  | <b>0.5789***</b><br>(0.0206)  | <b>0.3019***</b><br>(0.0278)  | <b>0.5836***</b><br>(0.0209)  | <b>0.3093***</b><br>(0.0280)  |
| SurpDec             |                               |                               | <b>-0.0000</b><br>(0.0000)    | -0.0000<br>(0.0000)           | <b>-0.0000**</b><br>(0.0000)  | -0.0000<br>(0.0000)           |                               |                               | <b>-0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0000</b><br>(0.0000)    | <b>-0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0000**</b><br>(0.0000)  |
| Loss                |                               |                               | <b>0.0008***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0006***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0008***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0006***</b><br>(0.0001)  |                               |                               | <b>0.0007***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0005***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0007***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0005***</b><br>(0.0001)  |
| UncQue              |                               |                               | 0.0001<br>(0.0000)            | 0.0000<br>(0.0000)            | 0.0000<br>(0.0000)            | 0.0000<br>(0.0000)            |                               |                               | 0.0001<br>(0.0000)            | 0.0000<br>(0.0000)            | 0.0000<br>(0.0000)            | 0.0000<br>(0.0000)            |
| NegCall             |                               |                               | <b>0.0006***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0008***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0005***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0008***</b><br>(0.0001)  |                               |                               | <b>0.0007***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0009***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0005***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0008***</b><br>(0.0001)  |
| Extended Controls   |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| Industry FE         | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               |
| Firm FE             |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |
| Year FE             | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               |
| Year-Quarter FE     |                               |                               |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| N                   | 20,069                        | 20,069                        | 19,124                        | 19,124                        | 19,124                        | 19,124                        | 19,355                        | 19,355                        | 18,406                        | 18,406                        | 18,406                        | 18,406                        |
| R <sup>2</sup>      | 0.488                         | 0.204                         | 0.501                         | 0.223                         | 0.503                         | 0.223                         | 0.431                         | 0.158                         | 0.452                         | 0.179                         | 0.458                         | 0.180                         |
| Adj. R <sup>2</sup> | 0.487                         | 0.163                         | 0.500                         | 0.182                         | 0.501                         | 0.180                         | 0.430                         | 0.116                         | 0.451                         | 0.136                         | 0.455                         | 0.134                         |

Notes: \*  $p < 0.10$ , \*\*  $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\*  $p < 0.01$  (one-tailed for IVs,  $\beta > 0$ ; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms).  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ).

Table 15: H5 Robustness: Orthogonal Speaker Partition

|                     | (1)                                       | (2)                                       | (3)                                       | (4)                                      | (5)                                       | (6)                                       | (7)                                       | (8)                                       | (9)                                       | (10)                                      | (11)                                      | (12)                                      |
|---------------------|-------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|
|                     | DISP                                      |                                           |                                           |                                          |                                           |                                           | DISP <sub>lead</sub>                      |                                           |                                           |                                           |                                           |                                           |
| UncAnsCEO           | 0.0000<br>(0.0000)                        | -0.0001<br>(0.0000)                       | -0.0000<br>(0.0000)                       | -0.0002<br>(0.0000)                      | -0.0000<br>(0.0000)                       | -0.0002<br>(0.0000)                       | -0.0000<br>(0.0000)                       | -0.0001<br>(0.0001)                       | -0.0000<br>(0.0000)                       | -0.0002<br>(0.0001)                       | -0.0001<br>(0.0000)                       | -0.0002<br>(0.0001)                       |
| UncAnsNoCEO         | <b>0.0001</b> <sup>**</sup><br>(0.0000)   | 0.0000<br>(0.0000)                        | <b>0.0001</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0000)  | 0.0000<br>(0.0000)                       | <b>0.0001</b> <sup>**</sup><br>(0.0000)   | 0.0000<br>(0.0000)                        | <b>0.0001</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0000)  | 0.0000<br>(0.0000)                        | <b>0.0001</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0000)  | 0.0000<br>(0.0000)                        | <b>0.0001</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0000)  | 0.0000<br>(0.0000)                        |
| UncPreCEO           | <b>0.0001</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0001</b> <sup>*</sup><br>(0.0001)    | <b>0.0001</b> <sup>**</sup><br>(0.0000)   | -0.0000<br>(0.0001)                      | <b>0.0001</b> <sup>*</sup><br>(0.0000)    | -0.0000<br>(0.0001)                       | <b>0.0001</b> <sup>**</sup><br>(0.0000)   | 0.0001<br>(0.0001)                        | <b>0.0001</b> <sup>*</sup><br>(0.0000)    | 0.0000<br>(0.0001)                        | 0.0001<br>(0.0000)                        | 0.0000<br>(0.0001)                        |
| UncPreNoCEO         | 0.0000<br>(0.0000)                        | <b>0.0001</b> <sup>**</sup><br>(0.0000)   | <b>0.0001</b> <sup>*</sup><br>(0.0000)    | <b>0.0001</b> <sup>*</sup><br>(0.0000)   | 0.0000<br>(0.0000)                        | <b>0.0001</b> <sup>*</sup><br>(0.0000)    | 0.0000<br>(0.0000)                        | 0.0001<br>(0.0001)                        | <b>0.0001</b> <sup>*</sup><br>(0.0000)    | 0.0000<br>(0.0001)                        | 0.0000<br>(0.0000)                        | 0.0000<br>(0.0001)                        |
| lnAssets            | -0.0000<br>(0.0000)                       | -0.0001<br>(0.0001)                       | 0.0000<br>(0.0000)                        | -0.0001<br>(0.0001)                      | -0.0000<br>(0.0000)                       | -0.0001<br>(0.0001)                       | -0.0000<br>(0.0000)                       | -0.0001<br>(0.0001)                       | 0.0000<br>(0.0000)                        | -0.0001<br>(0.0001)                       | -0.0000<br>(0.0000)                       | -0.0001<br>(0.0001)                       |
| TobinsQ             | <b>-0.0001</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0001</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0001</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0001</b> <sup>**</sup><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0001</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0000</b> <sup>**</sup><br>(0.0000)  | <b>-0.0001</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0001</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0001</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0001</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0001</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0001</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0000) |
| ROA                 | <b>-0.0025</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0004) | <b>-0.0035</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0005) | <b>-0.0010</b> <sup>**</sup><br>(0.0004)  | <b>-0.0024</b> <sup>**</sup><br>(0.0005) | <b>-0.0011</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0004) | <b>-0.0025</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0005) | <b>-0.0036</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0005) | <b>-0.0046</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0006) | <b>-0.0022</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0005) | <b>-0.0035</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0006) | <b>-0.0022</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0005) | <b>-0.0035</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0006) |
| Leverage            | <b>0.0005</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0014</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0003)  | <b>0.0004</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0012</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0003) | <b>0.0004</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0012</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0003)  | <b>0.0004</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0013</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0004)  | <b>0.0003</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0010</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0003)  | <b>0.0003</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0009</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0003)  |
| Capex               | -0.0004<br>(0.0006)                       | <b>-0.0025</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0009) | 0.0001<br>(0.0006)                        | <b>-0.0021</b> <sup>*</sup><br>(0.0009)  | -0.0001<br>(0.0006)                       | <b>-0.0021</b> <sup>**</sup><br>(0.0009)  | 0.0001<br>(0.0007)                        | -0.0012<br>(0.0010)                       | 0.0007<br>(0.0007)                        | -0.0005<br>(0.0010)                       | 0.0002<br>(0.0007)                        | -0.0011<br>(0.0010)                       |
| DivDummy            | <b>-0.0002</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0000) | -0.0001<br>(0.0001)                       | <b>-0.0002</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0000) | -0.0002<br>(0.0001)                      | <b>-0.0002</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0000) | -0.0002<br>(0.0001)                       | <b>-0.0001</b> <sup>**</sup><br>(0.0001)  | -0.0001<br>(0.0001)                       | <b>-0.0002</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0001) | -0.0001<br>(0.0001)                       | <b>-0.0002</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0001) | -0.0001<br>(0.0001)                       |
| sCFO                | <b>0.0005</b> <sup>*</sup><br>(0.0003)    | <b>0.0001</b> <sup>*</sup><br>(0.0001)    | <b>0.0005</b> <sup>**</sup><br>(0.0003)   | <b>0.0002</b> <sup>**</sup><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0005</b> <sup>**</sup><br>(0.0003)   | <b>0.0002</b> <sup>**</sup><br>(0.0001)   | <b>0.0007</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0003)  | <b>0.0003</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0007</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0003)  | <b>0.0003</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0007</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0002)  | <b>0.0003</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0001)  |
| Lagged_DV           | <b>0.6440</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0179)  | <b>0.3882</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0264)  | <b>0.6247</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0179)  | <b>0.3739</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0262) | <b>0.6279</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0181)  | <b>0.3774</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0263)  | <b>0.5827</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0219)  | <b>0.3038</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0294)  | <b>0.5701</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0211)  | <b>0.2970</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0281)  | <b>0.5750</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0215)  | <b>0.3045</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0283)  |
| SurpDec             |                                           |                                           | <b>-0.0000</b> <sup>**</sup><br>(0.0000)  | -0.0000<br>(0.0000)                      | <b>-0.0000</b> <sup>**</sup><br>(0.0000)  | -0.0000<br>(0.0000)                       |                                           |                                           | <b>-0.0000</b> <sup>**</sup><br>(0.0000)  | <b>-0.0000</b> <sup>**</sup><br>(0.0000)  | <b>-0.0000</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0000</b> <sup>**</sup><br>(0.0000)  |
| Loss                |                                           |                                           | <b>0.0008</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0006</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0001) | <b>0.0008</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0006</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0001)  |                                           |                                           | <b>0.0007</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0005</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0007</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0005</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0001)  |
| UncQue              |                                           |                                           | 0.0000<br>(0.0000)                        | 0.0000<br>(0.0000)                       | 0.0000<br>(0.0000)                        | -0.0000<br>(0.0000)                       |                                           |                                           | <b>0.0001</b> <sup>*</sup><br>(0.0000)    | 0.0000<br>(0.0000)                        | 0.0000<br>(0.0000)                        | 0.0000<br>(0.0000)                        |
| NegCall             |                                           |                                           | <b>0.0006</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0008</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0001) | <b>0.0006</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0008</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0001)  |                                           |                                           | <b>0.0007</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0009</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0006</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0008</b> <sup>***</sup><br>(0.0001)  |
| Extended Controls   |                                           |                                           | Yes                                       | Yes                                      | Yes                                       | Yes                                       |                                           |                                           | Yes                                       | Yes                                       | Yes                                       | Yes                                       |
| Industry FE         | Yes                                       |                                           | Yes                                       |                                          | Yes                                       |                                           | Yes                                       |                                           | Yes                                       |                                           | Yes                                       |                                           |
| Firm FE             |                                           | Yes                                       |                                           | Yes                                      |                                           | Yes                                       |                                           | Yes                                       |                                           | Yes                                       |                                           | Yes                                       |
| Year FE             | Yes                                       | Yes                                       | Yes                                       | Yes                                      |                                           |                                           | Yes                                       | Yes                                       | Yes                                       | Yes                                       |                                           |                                           |
| Year-Quarter FE     |                                           |                                           |                                           |                                          | Yes                                       | Yes                                       |                                           |                                           |                                           |                                           | Yes                                       | Yes                                       |
| N                   | 18,992                                    | 18,992                                    | 18,109                                    | 18,109                                   | 18,109                                    | 18,109                                    | 18,338                                    | 18,338                                    | 17,427                                    | 17,427                                    | 17,427                                    | 17,427                                    |
| R <sup>2</sup>      | 0.482                                     | 0.202                                     | 0.495                                     | 0.222                                    | 0.497                                     | 0.222                                     | 0.424                                     | 0.153                                     | 0.444                                     | 0.173                                     | 0.450                                     | 0.174                                     |
| Adj. R <sup>2</sup> | 0.481                                     | 0.161                                     | 0.494                                     | 0.180                                    | 0.495                                     | 0.178                                     | 0.423                                     | 0.108                                     | 0.443                                     | 0.128                                     | 0.447                                     | 0.127                                     |

Notes: \*  $p < 0.10$ , \*\*  $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\*  $p < 0.01$  (one-tailed for IVs,  $\beta > 0$ ; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms).  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ).

Table 16: H7: Speech Uncertainty and 3-Day Post-Call Illiquidity Change ( $\Delta\text{Amihud}$ ,  $[+1, +3] - [-3, -1]$ )

|                     | (1)                          | (2)                          | (3)                           | (4)                          | (5)                          | (6)                          | (7)                          | (8)                          | (9)                           | (10)                          | (11)                         | (12)                         |
|---------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------|-------------------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------|
|                     |                              |                              | DeltaILLIQ                    |                              |                              |                              |                              |                              | DeltaILLIQ_lead1              |                               |                              |                              |
| UncAnsCEO           | 0.0005<br>(0.0004)           | 0.0005<br>(0.0004)           | 0.0004<br>(0.0004)            | 0.0004<br>(0.0004)           | 0.0004<br>(0.0004)           | 0.0004<br>(0.0004)           | 0.0003<br>(0.0005)           | 0.0004<br>(0.0006)           | 0.0004<br>(0.0006)            | 0.0004<br>(0.0006)            | 0.0003<br>(0.0006)           | 0.0004<br>(0.0006)           |
| UncPreCEO           | 0.0005<br>(0.0004)           | <b>0.0008*</b><br>(0.0005)   | 0.0004<br>(0.0004)            | 0.0006<br>(0.0005)           | 0.0003<br>(0.0004)           | 0.0006<br>(0.0005)           | 0.0002<br>(0.0004)           | 0.0002<br>(0.0004)           | 0.0003<br>(0.0004)            | 0.0002<br>(0.0005)            | 0.0003<br>(0.0004)           | 0.0002<br>(0.0005)           |
| UncAnsMgr           | -0.0003<br>(0.0005)          | -0.0005<br>(0.0005)          | -0.0013<br>(0.0005)           | -0.0005<br>(0.0006)          | -0.0005<br>(0.0005)          | -0.0005<br>(0.0006)          | 0.0001<br>(0.0007)           | -0.0003<br>(0.0008)          | -0.0008<br>(0.0007)           | -0.0004<br>(0.0008)           | -0.0001<br>(0.0007)          | -0.0004<br>(0.0008)          |
| UncPreMgr           | 0.0000<br>(0.0004)           | -0.0007<br>(0.0005)          | -0.0009<br>(0.0004)           | -0.0006<br>(0.0006)          | 0.0001<br>(0.0004)           | -0.0006<br>(0.0006)          | 0.0002<br>(0.0004)           | -0.0001<br>(0.0005)          | -0.0006<br>(0.0004)           | 0.0001<br>(0.0005)            | 0.0002<br>(0.0004)           | 0.0001<br>(0.0005)           |
| InAssets            | <b>0.0009***</b><br>(0.0001) | <b>0.0015***</b><br>(0.0004) | <b>0.0003***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0017***</b><br>(0.0004) | <b>0.0009***</b><br>(0.0001) | <b>0.0017***</b><br>(0.0004) | <b>0.0009***</b><br>(0.0001) | <b>0.0010***</b><br>(0.0004) | <b>0.0003***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0009**</b><br>(0.0004)   | <b>0.0007***</b><br>(0.0001) | <b>0.0009**</b><br>(0.0004)  |
| TobinsQ             | <b>0.0004***</b><br>(0.0001) | <b>0.0003**</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0002***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0004***</b><br>(0.0001) | <b>0.0004***</b><br>(0.0001) | <b>0.0004***</b><br>(0.0001) | <b>0.0005***</b><br>(0.0001) | <b>0.0004***</b><br>(0.0001) | <b>0.0002***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0004***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0004***</b><br>(0.0001) | <b>0.0003***</b><br>(0.0001) |
| ROA                 | 0.0018<br>(0.0017)           | 0.0023<br>(0.0024)           | 0.0004<br>(0.0016)            | 0.0010<br>(0.0024)           | 0.0003<br>(0.0016)           | 0.0009<br>(0.0024)           | <b>0.0031*</b><br>(0.0019)   | <b>0.0045*</b><br>(0.0025)   | 0.0005<br>(0.0017)            | 0.0023<br>(0.0023)            | 0.0008<br>(0.0018)           | 0.0026<br>(0.0023)           |
| Leverage            | -0.0002<br>(0.0005)          | <b>-0.0024*</b><br>(0.0013)  | 0.0002<br>(0.0005)            | <b>-0.0023*</b><br>(0.0013)  | -0.0001<br>(0.0005)          | -0.0021<br>(0.0013)          | 0.0001<br>(0.0006)           | -0.0009<br>(0.0011)          | 0.0008<br>(0.0006)            | -0.0001<br>(0.0012)           | 0.0004<br>(0.0006)           | -0.0001<br>(0.0012)          |
| Capex               | <b>0.0044**</b><br>(0.0020)  | 0.0047<br>(0.0042)           | 0.0023<br>(0.0021)            | 0.0051<br>(0.0044)           | <b>0.0047**</b><br>(0.0021)  | 0.0060<br>(0.0045)           | <b>0.0044**</b><br>(0.0021)  | 0.0034<br>(0.0044)           | 0.0029<br>(0.0022)            | 0.0037<br>(0.0045)            | <b>0.0044**</b><br>(0.0021)  | 0.0034<br>(0.0045)           |
| DivDummy            | -0.0002<br>(0.0002)          | -0.0004<br>(0.0004)          | -0.0003<br>(0.0002)           | -0.0006<br>(0.0004)          | -0.0003<br>(0.0002)          | -0.0005<br>(0.0004)          | -0.0003<br>(0.0002)          | -0.0001<br>(0.0004)          | <b>-0.0004*</b><br>(0.0002)   | -0.0002<br>(0.0004)           | -0.0004<br>(0.0002)          | -0.0002<br>(0.0004)          |
| sCFO                | 0.0001<br>(0.0003)           | -0.0003<br>(0.0003)          | -0.0002<br>(0.0003)           | -0.0002<br>(0.0003)          | 0.0001<br>(0.0003)           | -0.0002<br>(0.0003)          | -0.0000<br>(0.0003)          | <b>-0.0004*</b><br>(0.0002)  | -0.0001<br>(0.0003)           | -0.0003<br>(0.0002)           | 0.0001<br>(0.0003)           | -0.0003<br>(0.0002)          |
| Lagged_DV           | 0.0218<br>(0.0393)           | -0.0118<br>(0.0382)          | 0.0276<br>(0.0409)            | -0.0091<br>(0.0398)          | 0.0264<br>(0.0411)           | -0.0085<br>(0.0399)          | 0.0122<br>(0.0382)           | -0.0215<br>(0.0369)          | 0.0174<br>(0.0399)            | -0.0181<br>(0.0389)           | 0.0162<br>(0.0401)           | -0.0180<br>(0.0389)          |
| DailyVola           |                              |                              | <b>-0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000) | -0.0000<br>(0.0000)          | -0.0000<br>(0.0000)          | -0.0000<br>(0.0000)          |                              |                              | <b>-0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0001**</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0001**</b><br>(0.0000) |
| StockPrice          |                              |                              | -0.0000<br>(0.0000)           | <b>-0.0000**</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0000**</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0000**</b><br>(0.0000) |                              |                              | <b>-0.0000**</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>-0.0000*</b><br>(0.0000)   | <b>-0.0000**</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0000*</b><br>(0.0000)  |
| Turnover            |                              |                              | <b>0.0094***</b><br>(0.0028)  | <b>0.0046*</b><br>(0.0026)   | <b>0.0091***</b><br>(0.0028) | <b>0.0046*</b><br>(0.0026)   |                              |                              | <b>0.0151***</b><br>(0.0028)  | <b>0.0130***</b><br>(0.0028)  | <b>0.0143***</b><br>(0.0028) | <b>0.0125***</b><br>(0.0028) |
| UncQue              |                              |                              | <b>-0.0005*</b><br>(0.0003)   | 0.0000<br>(0.0003)           | -0.0000<br>(0.0003)          | 0.0000<br>(0.0003)           |                              |                              | -0.0001<br>(0.0002)           | 0.0004<br>(0.0003)            | 0.0003<br>(0.0002)           | 0.0004<br>(0.0003)           |
| Extended Controls   |                              |                              | Yes                           | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                          |                              |                              | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                          | Yes                          |
| Industry FE         | Yes                          |                              | Yes                           |                              | Yes                          |                              | Yes                          |                              | Yes                           |                               | Yes                          |                              |
| Firm FE             |                              | Yes                          |                               | Yes                          |                              | Yes                          |                              | Yes                          |                               | Yes                           |                              | Yes                          |
| Year FE             | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                           | Yes                          |                              |                              | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                           | Yes                           |                              |                              |
| Year-Quarter FE     |                              |                              |                               |                              | Yes                          | Yes                          |                              |                              |                               |                               | Yes                          | Yes                          |
| N                   | 63,736                       | 63,736                       | 60,182                        | 60,182                       | 60,182                       | 60,182                       | 63,313                       | 63,313                       | 61,060                        | 61,060                        | 61,060                       | 61,060                       |
| R <sup>2</sup>      | 0.004                        | 0.001                        | 0.003                         | 0.001                        | 0.005                        | 0.001                        | 0.004                        | 0.001                        | 0.005                         | 0.003                         | 0.005                        | 0.002                        |
| Adj. R <sup>2</sup> | 0.004                        | -0.027                       | 0.003                         | -0.028                       | 0.003                        | -0.029                       | 0.003                        | -0.027                       | 0.004                         | -0.026                        | 0.004                        | -0.028                       |

Notes: \*  $p < 0.10$ , \*\*  $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\*  $p < 0.01$  (one-tailed for IVs,  $\beta > 0$ ; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms).  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ).

Table 17: H7: Speech Uncertainty and 3-Day Post-Call Illiquidity Change ( $\Delta\text{Amihud}$ ,  $[+1, +3] - [-3, -1]$ )

|                     | (1)                          | (2)                          | (3)                           | (4)                          | (5)                           | (6)                          | (7)                          | (8)                          | (9)                           | (10)                         | (11)                          | (12)                         |
|---------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------|-------------------------------|------------------------------|-------------------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------|-------------------------------|------------------------------|-------------------------------|------------------------------|
|                     | DeltaILLIQ                   |                              |                               |                              |                               | DeltaILLIQ_lead1             |                              |                              |                               |                              |                               |                              |
| UncAnsCEO           | 0.0001<br>(0.0003)           | 0.0001<br>(0.0003)           | -0.0004<br>(0.0003)           | 0.0000<br>(0.0003)           | 0.0001<br>(0.0003)            | 0.0001<br>(0.0003)           | 0.0003<br>(0.0003)           | 0.0003<br>(0.0004)           | -0.0000<br>(0.0003)           | 0.0003<br>(0.0004)           | 0.0003<br>(0.0003)            | 0.0003<br>(0.0004)           |
| UncAnsNoCEO         | -0.0001<br>(0.0002)          | -0.0001<br>(0.0002)          | -0.0004<br>(0.0002)           | -0.0001<br>(0.0002)          | -0.0001<br>(0.0002)           | -0.0001<br>(0.0002)          | -0.0001<br>(0.0002)          | -0.0002<br>(0.0002)          | -0.0003<br>(0.0002)           | -0.0002<br>(0.0002)          | -0.0001<br>(0.0002)           | -0.0002<br>(0.0002)          |
| UncPreCEO           | <b>0.0005**</b><br>(0.0003)  | <b>0.0005*</b><br>(0.0004)   | 0.0001<br>(0.0003)            | <b>0.0005*</b><br>(0.0004)   | <b>0.0005**</b><br>(0.0003)   | 0.0005<br>(0.0004)           | 0.0002<br>(0.0003)           | 0.0001<br>(0.0003)           | -0.0001<br>(0.0003)           | 0.0000<br>(0.0003)           | 0.0002<br>(0.0003)            | 0.0001<br>(0.0003)           |
| UncPreNoCEO         | -0.0000<br>(0.0002)          | -0.0004<br>(0.0003)          | -0.0005<br>(0.0002)           | -0.0004<br>(0.0003)          | -0.0000<br>(0.0002)           | -0.0004<br>(0.0003)          | 0.0002<br>(0.0002)           | 0.0002<br>(0.0003)           | -0.0001<br>(0.0002)           | 0.0003<br>(0.0003)           | 0.0001<br>(0.0002)            | 0.0003<br>(0.0003)           |
| InAssets            | <b>0.0009***</b><br>(0.0001) | <b>0.0015***</b><br>(0.0004) | <b>0.0003***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0018***</b><br>(0.0004) | <b>0.0008***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0018***</b><br>(0.0004) | <b>0.0008***</b><br>(0.0001) | <b>0.0010***</b><br>(0.0004) | <b>0.0002***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0009**</b><br>(0.0004)  | <b>0.0006***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0009**</b><br>(0.0004)  |
| TobinsQ             | <b>0.0004***</b><br>(0.0001) | <b>0.0003**</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0002***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0005***</b><br>(0.0002) | <b>0.0004***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0005***</b><br>(0.0002) | <b>0.0004***</b><br>(0.0001) | <b>0.0004***</b><br>(0.0001) | <b>0.0002***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0004***</b><br>(0.0001) | <b>0.0004***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0004***</b><br>(0.0001) |
| ROA                 | 0.0011<br>(0.0016)           | 0.0018<br>(0.0025)           | -0.0003<br>(0.0015)           | 0.0008<br>(0.0024)           | -0.0003<br>(0.0016)           | 0.0008<br>(0.0025)           | 0.0029<br>(0.0019)           | 0.0040<br>(0.0025)           | 0.0010<br>(0.0018)            | 0.0023<br>(0.0024)           | 0.0011<br>(0.0019)            | 0.0024<br>(0.0025)           |
| Leverage            | -0.0001<br>(0.0004)          | <b>-0.0027**</b><br>(0.0014) | 0.0004<br>(0.0005)            | <b>-0.0025*</b><br>(0.0014)  | 0.0000<br>(0.0004)            | <b>-0.0024*</b><br>(0.0014)  | 0.0004<br>(0.0005)           | -0.0009<br>(0.0012)          | <b>0.0010**</b><br>(0.0005)   | -0.0003<br>(0.0012)          | 0.0008<br>(0.0005)            | -0.0003<br>(0.0012)          |
| Capex               | <b>0.0038*</b><br>(0.0021)   | 0.0052<br>(0.0046)           | 0.0015<br>(0.0021)            | 0.0055<br>(0.0048)           | <b>0.0039*</b><br>(0.0022)    | 0.0061<br>(0.0049)           | 0.0033<br>(0.0021)           | 0.0030<br>(0.0044)           | 0.0020<br>(0.0022)            | 0.0035<br>(0.0045)           | 0.0034<br>(0.0021)            | 0.0031<br>(0.0045)           |
| DivDummy            | -0.0001<br>(0.0002)          | -0.0004<br>(0.0004)          | -0.0000<br>(0.0002)           | -0.0004<br>(0.0004)          | -0.0001<br>(0.0002)           | -0.0004<br>(0.0004)          | -0.0001<br>(0.0002)          | 0.0001<br>(0.0004)           | -0.0002<br>(0.0002)           | -0.0000<br>(0.0004)          | -0.0002<br>(0.0002)           | -0.0000<br>(0.0004)          |
| sCFO                | -0.0000<br>(0.0003)          | -0.0003<br>(0.0003)          | -0.0003<br>(0.0002)           | -0.0002<br>(0.0003)          | -0.0000<br>(0.0003)           | -0.0002<br>(0.0003)          | -0.0001<br>(0.0002)          | <b>-0.0004*</b><br>(0.0002)  | -0.0002<br>(0.0002)           | -0.0003<br>(0.0002)          | 0.0000<br>(0.0003)            | -0.0003<br>(0.0002)          |
| Lagged_DV           | 0.0064<br>(0.0386)           | -0.0256<br>(0.0371)          | 0.0034<br>(0.0389)            | -0.0305<br>(0.0376)          | 0.0020<br>(0.0391)            | -0.0300<br>(0.0377)          | 0.0252<br>(0.0420)           | -0.0056<br>(0.0406)          | 0.0250<br>(0.0431)            | -0.0075<br>(0.0419)          | 0.0238<br>(0.0432)            | -0.0074<br>(0.0420)          |
| DailyVola           |                              |                              | <b>-0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000) | -0.0000<br>(0.0000)          | -0.0000<br>(0.0000)           | -0.0000<br>(0.0000)          |                              |                              | <b>-0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0001**</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0001**</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>-0.0001**</b><br>(0.0000) |
| StockPrice          |                              |                              | -0.0000<br>(0.0000)           | <b>-0.0000**</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0000**</b><br>(0.0000) |                              |                              | <b>-0.0000*</b><br>(0.0000)   | <b>-0.0000*</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>-0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0000*</b><br>(0.0000)  |
| Turnover            |                              |                              | <b>0.0084***</b><br>(0.0028)  | 0.0029<br>(0.0022)           | <b>0.0083***</b><br>(0.0028)  | 0.0029<br>(0.0023)           |                              |                              | <b>0.0136***</b><br>(0.0026)  | <b>0.0123***</b><br>(0.0028) | <b>0.0133***</b><br>(0.0026)  | <b>0.0123***</b><br>(0.0028) |
| UncQue              |                              |                              | <b>-0.0007**</b><br>(0.0003)  | -0.0001<br>(0.0003)          | -0.0001<br>(0.0003)           | -0.0001<br>(0.0003)          |                              |                              | -0.0003<br>(0.0002)           | 0.0002<br>(0.0003)           | 0.0001<br>(0.0002)            | 0.0002<br>(0.0003)           |
| Extended Controls   |                              |                              | Yes                           | Yes                          | Yes                           | Yes                          |                              |                              | Yes                           | Yes                          | Yes                           | Yes                          |
| Industry FE         | Yes                          |                              | Yes                           |                              | Yes                           |                              | Yes                          |                              | Yes                           |                              | Yes                           |                              |
| Firm FE             |                              | Yes                          |                               | Yes                          |                               | Yes                          |                              | Yes                          |                               | Yes                          |                               | Yes                          |
| Year FE             | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                           | Yes                          |                               |                              | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                           | Yes                          |                               |                              |
| Year-Quarter FE     |                              |                              |                               |                              | Yes                           | Yes                          |                              |                              |                               |                              | Yes                           | Yes                          |
| N                   | 59,870                       | 59,870                       | 56,737                        | 56,737                       | 56,737                        | 56,737                       | 59,444                       | 59,444                       | 57,537                        | 57,537                       | 57,537                        | 57,537                       |
| R <sup>2</sup>      | 0.004                        | 0.002                        | 0.002                         | 0.002                        | 0.004                         | 0.002                        | 0.004                        | 0.001                        | 0.005                         | 0.003                        | 0.005                         | 0.002                        |
| Adj. R <sup>2</sup> | 0.003                        | -0.028                       | 0.002                         | -0.029                       | 0.002                         | -0.029                       | 0.004                        | -0.029                       | 0.004                         | -0.028                       | 0.004                         | -0.029                       |

Notes: \*  $p < 0.10$ , \*\*  $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\*  $p < 0.01$  (one-tailed for IVs,  $\beta > 0$ ; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms).  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ).

Table 18: H7b: Speech Uncertainty and 3-Day Post-Call Amihud Illiquidity Level ([+1, +3])

|                     | (1)                           | (2)                           | (3)                           | (4)                           | (5)                           | (6)                           | (7)                           | (8)                           | (9)                           | (10)                          | (11)                          | (12)                          |
|---------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|
|                     |                               |                               | PostCallAmihud                |                               |                               |                               |                               |                               | PostCallAmihud_lead1          |                               |                               |                               |
| UncAnsCEO           | -0.0006<br>(0.0010)           | -0.0008<br>(0.0010)           | -0.0008<br>(0.0010)           | -0.0008<br>(0.0010)           | -0.0007<br>(0.0010)           | -0.0008<br>(0.0010)           | 0.0005<br>(0.0008)            | 0.0005<br>(0.0009)            | 0.0004<br>(0.0008)            | 0.0005<br>(0.0009)            | 0.0004<br>(0.0008)            | 0.0005<br>(0.0009)            |
| UncPreCEO           | 0.0000<br>(0.0008)            | 0.0001<br>(0.0009)            | -0.0006<br>(0.0008)           | 0.0003<br>(0.0009)            | -0.0006<br>(0.0008)           | 0.0001<br>(0.0009)            | -0.0006<br>(0.0007)           | -0.0008<br>(0.0009)           | -0.0009<br>(0.0007)           | -0.0006<br>(0.0009)           | -0.0008<br>(0.0007)           | -0.0007<br>(0.0009)           |
| UncAnsMgr           | -0.0011<br>(0.0013)           | -0.0013<br>(0.0014)           | 0.0002<br>(0.0013)            | -0.0009<br>(0.0014)           | -0.0008<br>(0.0014)           | -0.0012<br>(0.0013)           | -0.0006<br>(0.0014)           | -0.0008<br>(0.0010)           | 0.0009<br>(0.0011)            | -0.0009<br>(0.0011)           | -0.0005<br>(0.0011)           | -0.0009<br>(0.0011)           |
| UncPreMgr           | -0.0001<br>(0.0008)           | -0.0005<br>(0.0013)           | <b>0.0013**</b><br>(0.0008)   | -0.0009<br>(0.0013)           | 0.0003<br>(0.0008)            | -0.0011<br>(0.0013)           | 0.0002<br>(0.0008)            | 0.0006<br>(0.0013)            | <b>0.0019***</b><br>(0.0008)  | 0.0003<br>(0.0014)            | 0.0004<br>(0.0007)            | 0.0003<br>(0.0014)            |
| lnAssets            | <b>-0.0024***</b><br>(0.0002) | <b>-0.0046***</b><br>(0.0008) | <b>-0.0009***</b><br>(0.0001) | <b>-0.0040***</b><br>(0.0009) | <b>-0.0016***</b><br>(0.0002) | <b>-0.0043***</b><br>(0.0009) | <b>-0.0022***</b><br>(0.0002) | <b>-0.0037***</b><br>(0.0008) | <b>-0.0008***</b><br>(0.0001) | <b>-0.0033***</b><br>(0.0008) | <b>-0.0017***</b><br>(0.0002) | <b>-0.0034***</b><br>(0.0008) |
| TobinsQ             | <b>-0.0010***</b><br>(0.0002) | <b>-0.0008***</b><br>(0.0003) | <b>-0.0006***</b><br>(0.0001) | <b>-0.0010***</b><br>(0.0003) | <b>-0.0009***</b><br>(0.0002) | <b>-0.0010***</b><br>(0.0003) | <b>-0.0008***</b><br>(0.0002) | -0.0002<br>(0.0002)           | <b>-0.0003**</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>-0.0004*</b><br>(0.0002)   | <b>-0.0008***</b><br>(0.0001) | <b>-0.0004*</b><br>(0.0003)   |
| ROA                 | <b>-0.0259***</b><br>(0.0041) | <b>-0.0337***</b><br>(0.0064) | <b>-0.0125***</b><br>(0.0039) | <b>-0.0215***</b><br>(0.0061) | <b>-0.0139***</b><br>(0.0040) | <b>-0.0226***</b><br>(0.0062) | <b>-0.0258***</b><br>(0.0040) | <b>-0.0352***</b><br>(0.0057) | <b>-0.0172***</b><br>(0.0042) | <b>-0.0266***</b><br>(0.0058) | <b>-0.0176***</b><br>(0.0043) | <b>-0.0267***</b><br>(0.0060) |
| Leverage            | 0.0011<br>(0.0010)            | <b>0.0038**</b><br>(0.0019)   | -0.0017<br>(0.0010)           | -0.0016<br>(0.0017)           | -0.0010<br>(0.0010)           | -0.0014<br>(0.0018)           | 0.0004<br>(0.0009)            | 0.0017<br>(0.0018)            | -0.0014<br>(0.0009)           | -0.0016<br>(0.0018)           | -0.0006<br>(0.0009)           | -0.0008<br>(0.0018)           |
| Capex               | <b>-0.0095***</b><br>(0.0033) | -0.0042<br>(0.0081)           | <b>-0.0104***</b><br>(0.0036) | -0.0056<br>(0.0082)           | <b>-0.0144***</b><br>(0.0035) | <b>-0.0134**</b><br>(0.0081)  | <b>-0.0154***</b><br>(0.0030) | <b>-0.0229***</b><br>(0.0064) | <b>-0.0148***</b><br>(0.0033) | <b>-0.0243***</b><br>(0.0066) | <b>-0.0161***</b><br>(0.0031) | <b>-0.0203***</b><br>(0.0067) |
| DivDummy            | 0.0005<br>(0.0005)            | <b>-0.0016**</b><br>(0.0008)  | <b>0.0014**</b><br>(0.0005)   | -0.0012<br>(0.0008)           | <b>0.0011*</b><br>(0.0005)    | <b>-0.0014*</b><br>(0.0007)   | 0.0000<br>(0.0004)            | <b>-0.0019**</b><br>(0.0007)  | 0.0006<br>(0.0004)            | <b>-0.0017**</b><br>(0.0007)  | 0.0005<br>(0.0004)            | <b>-0.0017**</b><br>(0.0007)  |
| sCFO                | <b>-0.0018*</b><br>(0.0010)   | -0.0005<br>(0.0005)           | <b>-0.0023*</b><br>(0.0013)   | <b>-0.0010**</b><br>(0.0005)  | <b>-0.0023*</b><br>(0.0013)   | <b>-0.0009**</b><br>(0.0004)  | <b>-0.0017*</b><br>(0.0009)   | -0.0004<br>(0.0004)           | <b>-0.0019*</b><br>(0.0011)   | <b>-0.0008**</b><br>(0.0004)  | <b>-0.0022*</b><br>(0.0012)   | <b>-0.0008*</b><br>(0.0004)   |
| Lagged_DV           | <b>0.7099***</b><br>(0.0207)  | <b>0.6092***</b><br>(0.0244)  | <b>0.6928***</b><br>(0.0225)  | <b>0.5914***</b><br>(0.0264)  | <b>0.6942***</b><br>(0.0227)  | <b>0.5941***</b><br>(0.0264)  | <b>0.7277***</b><br>(0.0243)  | <b>0.6261***</b><br>(0.0269)  | <b>0.7170***</b><br>(0.0236)  | <b>0.6108***</b><br>(0.0273)  | <b>0.7170***</b><br>(0.0237)  | <b>0.6132***</b><br>(0.0272)  |
| DailyVola           |                               |                               | <b>0.0004***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0004***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0003***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0004***</b><br>(0.0001)  |                               | <b>0.0003***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0003***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0002***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0002***</b><br>(0.0001)  |                               |
| StockPrice          |                               |                               | <b>0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000)  |                               | <b>0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000)  |
| Turnover            |                               |                               | <b>-0.0705***</b><br>(0.0085) | <b>-0.0595***</b><br>(0.0073) | <b>-0.0653***</b><br>(0.0078) | <b>-0.0549***</b><br>(0.0068) |                               | <b>-0.0365***</b><br>(0.0070) | <b>-0.0239***</b><br>(0.0042) | <b>-0.0342***</b><br>(0.0069) | <b>-0.0216***</b><br>(0.0042) |                               |
| UncQue              |                               |                               | -0.0007<br>(0.0005)           | <b>-0.0011**</b><br>(0.0006)  | <b>-0.0013**</b><br>(0.0005)  | <b>-0.0013**</b><br>(0.0005)  |                               | -0.0002<br>(0.0004)           | <b>-0.0010**</b><br>(0.0004)  | <b>-0.0009**</b><br>(0.0004)  | <b>-0.0010**</b><br>(0.0004)  |                               |
| Extended Controls   |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| Industry FE         | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               |
| Firm FE             |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |
| Year FE             | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               |
| Year-Quarter FE     |                               |                               |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| N                   | 63,736                        | 63,736                        | 60,182                        | 60,182                        | 60,182                        | 60,182                        | 63,313                        | 63,313                        | 61,060                        | 61,060                        | 61,060                        | 61,060                        |
| R <sup>2</sup>      | 0.541                         | 0.390                         | 0.544                         | 0.398                         | 0.545                         | 0.395                         | 0.546                         | 0.395                         | 0.546                         | 0.398                         | 0.544                         | 0.392                         |
| Adj. R <sup>2</sup> | 0.541                         | 0.373                         | 0.544                         | 0.380                         | 0.544                         | 0.377                         | 0.545                         | 0.378                         | 0.545                         | 0.380                         | 0.544                         | 0.374                         |

Notes: \*  $p < 0.10$ , \*\*  $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\*  $p < 0.01$  (one-tailed for IVs,  $\beta > 0$ ; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms).  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ).

Table 19: H7b: Speech Uncertainty and 3-Day Post-Call Amihud Illiquidity Level ([+1, +3])

|                     | (1)                           | (2)                           | (3)                           | (4)                           | (5)                           | (6)                           | (7)                           | (8)                           | (9)                           | (10)                          | (11)                          | (12)                          |
|---------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|
|                     |                               |                               | PostCallAmihud                |                               |                               |                               |                               |                               | PostCallAmihud_lead1          |                               |                               |                               |
| UncAnsCEO           | -0.0007<br>(0.0005)           | -0.0011<br>(0.0006)           | -0.0006<br>(0.0006)           | -0.0012<br>(0.0006)           | -0.0011<br>(0.0005)           | -0.0014<br>(0.0006)           | 0.0001<br>(0.0005)            | 0.0000<br>(0.0006)            | <b>0.0007*</b><br>(0.0005)    | -0.0001<br>(0.0006)           | 0.0000<br>(0.0005)            | -0.0001<br>(0.0006)           |
| UncAnsNoCEO         | -0.0005<br>(0.0004)           | -0.0005<br>(0.0005)           | -0.0002<br>(0.0004)           | -0.0005<br>(0.0005)           | -0.0005<br>(0.0004)           | -0.0005<br>(0.0005)           | -0.0001<br>(0.0004)           | -0.0001<br>(0.0004)           | 0.0004<br>(0.0004)            | -0.0000<br>(0.0004)           | -0.0001<br>(0.0004)           | -0.0001<br>(0.0004)           |
| UncPreCEO           | -0.0000<br>(0.0006)           | 0.0001<br>(0.0007)            | 0.0002<br>(0.0006)            | 0.0000<br>(0.0008)            | -0.0003<br>(0.0006)           | -0.0002<br>(0.0008)           | -0.0005<br>(0.0005)           | -0.0005<br>(0.0006)           | -0.0002<br>(0.0006)           | -0.0007<br>(0.0006)           | -0.0007<br>(0.0005)           | -0.0007<br>(0.0006)           |
| UncPreNoCEO         | -0.0001<br>(0.0003)           | -0.0006<br>(0.0006)           | <b>0.0004*</b><br>(0.0003)    | -0.0007<br>(0.0006)           | 0.0001<br>(0.0003)            | -0.0007<br>(0.0006)           | 0.0003<br>(0.0003)            | -0.0003<br>(0.0006)           | <b>0.0009***</b><br>(0.0004)  | -0.0004<br>(0.0006)           | 0.0004<br>(0.0003)            | -0.0004<br>(0.0006)           |
| lnAssets            | <b>-0.0020***</b><br>(0.0002) | <b>-0.0041***</b><br>(0.0008) | <b>-0.0008***</b><br>(0.0001) | <b>-0.0036***</b><br>(0.0009) | <b>-0.0014***</b><br>(0.0002) | <b>-0.0039***</b><br>(0.0009) | <b>-0.0019***</b><br>(0.0002) | <b>-0.0031***</b><br>(0.0007) | <b>-0.0006***</b><br>(0.0001) | <b>-0.0028***</b><br>(0.0008) | <b>-0.0015***</b><br>(0.0002) | <b>-0.0030***</b><br>(0.0008) |
| TobinsQ             | <b>-0.0008***</b><br>(0.0002) | <b>-0.0006**</b><br>(0.0003)  | <b>-0.0005***</b><br>(0.0001) | <b>-0.0009***</b><br>(0.0003) | <b>-0.0007***</b><br>(0.0002) | <b>-0.0009***</b><br>(0.0003) | <b>-0.0007***</b><br>(0.0002) | -0.0001<br>(0.0002)           | <b>-0.0003**</b><br>(0.0001)  | -0.0003<br>(0.0002)           | <b>-0.0007***</b><br>(0.0001) | -0.0003<br>(0.0002)           |
| ROA                 | <b>-0.0264***</b><br>(0.0044) | <b>-0.0349***</b><br>(0.0067) | <b>-0.0137***</b><br>(0.0043) | <b>-0.0227***</b><br>(0.0064) | <b>-0.0151***</b><br>(0.0044) | <b>-0.0237***</b><br>(0.0065) | <b>-0.0242***</b><br>(0.0041) | <b>-0.0338***</b><br>(0.0059) | <b>-0.0163***</b><br>(0.0043) | <b>-0.0261***</b><br>(0.0060) | <b>-0.0169***</b><br>(0.0045) | <b>-0.0263***</b><br>(0.0062) |
| Leverage            | 0.0003<br>(0.0009)            | <b>0.0028*</b><br>(0.0017)    | <b>-0.0021**</b><br>(0.0010)  | -0.0014<br>(0.0017)           | -0.0015<br>(0.0010)           | -0.0011<br>(0.0017)           | -0.0000<br>(0.0009)           | 0.0013<br>(0.0016)            | <b>-0.0015*</b><br>(0.0009)   | -0.0014<br>(0.0017)           | -0.0007<br>(0.0008)           | -0.0006<br>(0.0017)           |
| Capex               | <b>-0.0082**</b><br>(0.0033)  | 0.0004<br>(0.0085)            | <b>-0.0095**</b><br>(0.0037)  | -0.0026<br>(0.0089)           | <b>-0.0134***</b><br>(0.0036) | -0.0108<br>(0.0088)           | <b>-0.0131***</b><br>(0.0029) | <b>-0.0200***</b><br>(0.0067) | <b>-0.0128***</b><br>(0.0033) | <b>-0.0226***</b><br>(0.0071) | <b>-0.0138***</b><br>(0.0030) | <b>-0.0185**</b><br>(0.0073)  |
| DivDummy            | 0.0004<br>(0.0005)            | <b>-0.0018**</b><br>(0.0008)  | <b>0.0013**</b><br>(0.0005)   | <b>-0.0013*</b><br>(0.0008)   | <b>0.0011**</b><br>(0.0005)   | <b>-0.0015*</b><br>(0.0008)   | -0.0000<br>(0.0004)           | <b>-0.0019**</b><br>(0.0007)  | 0.0005<br>(0.0004)            | <b>-0.0016**</b><br>(0.0007)  | 0.0004<br>(0.0004)            | <b>-0.0016**</b><br>(0.0007)  |
| sCFO                | -0.0015<br>(0.0009)           | -0.0003<br>(0.0004)           | <b>-0.0019*</b><br>(0.0011)   | <b>-0.0007*</b><br>(0.0004)   | <b>-0.0019*</b><br>(0.0011)   | <b>-0.0006*</b><br>(0.0004)   | <b>-0.0014*</b><br>(0.0008)   | -0.0002<br>(0.0004)           | <b>-0.0015*</b><br>(0.0008)   | <b>-0.0006*</b><br>(0.0003)   | <b>-0.0018*</b><br>(0.0009)   | -0.0005<br>(0.0003)           |
| Lagged_DV           | <b>0.7077***</b><br>(0.0246)  | <b>0.6113***</b><br>(0.0286)  | <b>0.6899***</b><br>(0.0256)  | <b>0.5910***</b><br>(0.0301)  | <b>0.6920***</b><br>(0.0256)  | <b>0.5938***</b><br>(0.0300)  | <b>0.7422***</b><br>(0.0271)  | <b>0.6448***</b><br>(0.0298)  | <b>0.7351***</b><br>(0.0253)  | <b>0.6318***</b><br>(0.0295)  | <b>0.7358***</b><br>(0.0254)  | <b>0.6344***</b><br>(0.0295)  |
| DailyVola           |                               |                               | <b>0.0004***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0004***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0003***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0004***</b><br>(0.0001)  |                               |                               | <b>0.0003***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0003***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0002***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0002***</b><br>(0.0001)  |
| StockPrice          |                               |                               | <b>0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0000**</b><br>(0.0000)   | <b>0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0000**</b><br>(0.0000)   |                               |                               | <b>0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000)  |
| Turnover            |                               |                               | <b>-0.0668***</b><br>(0.0082) | <b>-0.0576***</b><br>(0.0069) | <b>-0.0617***</b><br>(0.0076) | <b>-0.0531***</b><br>(0.0067) |                               |                               | <b>-0.0334***</b><br>(0.0068) | <b>-0.0219***</b><br>(0.0040) | <b>-0.0306***</b><br>(0.0066) | <b>-0.0190***</b><br>(0.0039) |
| UncQue              |                               |                               | <b>-0.0009*</b><br>(0.0005)   | <b>-0.0013**</b><br>(0.0005)  | <b>-0.0014***</b><br>(0.0005) | <b>-0.0014***</b><br>(0.0005) |                               |                               | -0.0006<br>(0.0004)           | <b>-0.0013***</b><br>(0.0005) | <b>-0.0013***</b><br>(0.0004) | <b>-0.0013***</b><br>(0.0005) |
| Extended Controls   |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| Industry FE         | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               |
| Firm FE             |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |
| Year FE             | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               |
| Year-Quarter FE     |                               |                               |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| N                   | 59,870                        | 59,870                        | 56,737                        | 56,737                        | 56,737                        | 56,737                        | 59,444                        | 59,444                        | 57,537                        | 57,537                        | 57,537                        | 57,537                        |
| R <sup>2</sup>      | 0.543                         | 0.400                         | 0.548                         | 0.404                         | 0.548                         | 0.402                         | 0.554                         | 0.409                         | 0.558                         | 0.412                         | 0.557                         | 0.407                         |
| Adj. R <sup>2</sup> | 0.543                         | 0.382                         | 0.548                         | 0.386                         | 0.548                         | 0.383                         | 0.554                         | 0.391                         | 0.558                         | 0.394                         | 0.557                         | 0.388                         |

Notes: \*  $p < 0.10$ , \*\*  $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\*  $p < 0.01$  (one-tailed for IVs,  $\beta > 0$ ; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms).  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ).

Table 20: H7c: Speech Uncertainty and BGT (2018) 25-Day Post-Call Amihud Level ([0, +25], day 0 included)

|                     | (1)                           | (2)                           | (3)                           | (4)                           | (5)                           | (6)                           | (7)                           | (8)                           | (9)                           | (10)                          | (11)                          | (12)                          |
|---------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|
|                     |                               |                               | BGTLevel_Amihud               |                               |                               |                               |                               |                               | BGTLevel_Amihud_lead1         |                               |                               |                               |
| UncAnsCEO           | <b>0.0018**</b><br>(0.0010)   | <b>0.0019**</b><br>(0.0011)   | <b>0.0018**</b><br>(0.0011)   | <b>0.0020**</b><br>(0.0012)   | <b>0.0019**</b><br>(0.0011)   | <b>0.0020**</b><br>(0.0011)   | 0.0004<br>(0.0011)            | 0.0004<br>(0.0011)            | 0.0002<br>(0.0011)            | 0.0003<br>(0.0011)            | 0.0003<br>(0.0011)            | 0.0003<br>(0.0011)            |
| UncPreCEO           | -0.0002<br>(0.0008)           | -0.0001<br>(0.0010)           | -0.0008<br>(0.0008)           | -0.0000<br>(0.0011)           | -0.0008<br>(0.0008)           | -0.0002<br>(0.0011)           | -0.0009<br>(0.0010)           | -0.0010<br>(0.0012)           | -0.0012<br>(0.0011)           | -0.0011<br>(0.0012)           | -0.0011<br>(0.0011)           | -0.0012<br>(0.0013)           |
| UncAnsMgr           | -0.0025<br>(0.0013)           | -0.0031<br>(0.0014)           | -0.0023<br>(0.0013)           | -0.0032<br>(0.0015)           | -0.0029<br>(0.0013)           | -0.0035<br>(0.0015)           | -0.0005<br>(0.0014)           | -0.0007<br>(0.0015)           | 0.0014<br>(0.0015)            | -0.0005<br>(0.0014)           | -0.0002<br>(0.0016)           | -0.0006<br>(0.0016)           |
| UncPreMgr           | 0.0000<br>(0.0009)            | 0.0000<br>(0.0013)            | 0.0010<br>(0.0009)            | -0.0003<br>(0.0013)           | 0.0005<br>(0.0008)            | -0.0005<br>(0.0013)           | 0.0005<br>(0.0011)            | 0.0008<br>(0.0015)            | <b>0.0024**</b><br>(0.0011)   | 0.0005<br>(0.0016)            | 0.0006<br>(0.0011)            | 0.0006<br>(0.0016)            |
| lnAssets            | <b>-0.0021***</b><br>(0.0003) | <b>-0.0044***</b><br>(0.0010) | <b>-0.0009***</b><br>(0.0002) | <b>-0.0035***</b><br>(0.0011) | <b>-0.0014***</b><br>(0.0003) | <b>-0.0040***</b><br>(0.0011) | <b>-0.0022***</b><br>(0.0003) | <b>-0.0041***</b><br>(0.0010) | <b>-0.0008***</b><br>(0.0002) | <b>-0.0037***</b><br>(0.0011) | <b>-0.0019***</b><br>(0.0003) | <b>-0.0038***</b><br>(0.0011) |
| TobinsQ             | <b>-0.0008***</b><br>(0.0002) | -0.0002<br>(0.0003)           | <b>-0.0005***</b><br>(0.0002) | -0.0005<br>(0.0003)           | <b>-0.0006***</b><br>(0.0002) | -0.0005<br>(0.0003)           | <b>-0.0008***</b><br>(0.0002) | -0.0001<br>(0.0003)           | -0.0003<br>(0.0002)           | -0.0003<br>(0.0003)           | <b>-0.0008***</b><br>(0.0002) | -0.0003<br>(0.0003)           |
| ROA                 | <b>-0.0303***</b><br>(0.0048) | <b>-0.0414***</b><br>(0.0072) | <b>-0.0157***</b><br>(0.0044) | <b>-0.0276***</b><br>(0.0067) | <b>-0.0181***</b><br>(0.0045) | <b>-0.0297***</b><br>(0.0068) | <b>-0.0286***</b><br>(0.0052) | <b>-0.0396***</b><br>(0.0073) | <b>-0.0219***</b><br>(0.0055) | <b>-0.0325***</b><br>(0.0074) | <b>-0.0225***</b><br>(0.0055) | <b>-0.0324***</b><br>(0.0075) |
| Leverage            | 0.0004<br>(0.0011)            | 0.0022<br>(0.0022)            | <b>-0.0023*</b><br>(0.0012)   | -0.0037<br>(0.0023)           | -0.0016<br>(0.0011)           | -0.0030<br>(0.0023)           | 0.0000<br>(0.0012)            | -0.0016<br>(0.0022)           | -0.0016<br>(0.0013)           | <b>-0.0041*</b><br>(0.0022)   | -0.0005<br>(0.0012)           | -0.0028<br>(0.0022)           |
| Capex               | <b>-0.0109***</b><br>(0.0039) | -0.0086<br>(0.0094)           | <b>-0.0126***</b><br>(0.0042) | -0.0101<br>(0.0101)           | <b>-0.0152***</b><br>(0.0043) | <b>-0.0186***</b><br>(0.0102) | <b>-0.0167***</b><br>(0.0037) | <b>-0.0245***</b><br>(0.0081) | <b>-0.0144***</b><br>(0.0038) | <b>-0.0254***</b><br>(0.0085) | <b>-0.0156***</b><br>(0.0038) | <b>-0.0198***</b><br>(0.0085) |
| DivDummy            | 0.0005<br>(0.0006)            | <b>-0.0015*</b><br>(0.0009)   | <b>0.0015**</b><br>(0.0006)   | -0.0010<br>(0.0009)           | <b>0.0011*</b><br>(0.0006)    | -0.0013<br>(0.0009)           | 0.0002<br>(0.0006)            | <b>-0.0024**</b><br>(0.0006)  | 0.0006<br>(0.0009)            | <b>-0.0022**</b><br>(0.0009)  | 0.0005<br>(0.0006)            | <b>-0.0022**</b><br>(0.0009)  |
| sCFO                | -0.0023<br>(0.0015)           | -0.0009<br>(0.0007)           | -0.0031<br>(0.0019)           | <b>-0.0015*</b><br>(0.0008)   | -0.0029<br>(0.0018)           | <b>-0.0013*</b><br>(0.0007)   | -0.0019<br>(0.0012)           | -0.0005<br>(0.0005)           | -0.0019<br>(0.0012)           | -0.0008<br>(0.0005)           | -0.0022<br>(0.0013)           | -0.0007<br>(0.0006)           |
| Lagged_DV           | <b>0.7896***</b><br>(0.0242)  | <b>0.6805***</b><br>(0.0297)  | <b>0.7740***</b><br>(0.0258)  | <b>0.6612***</b><br>(0.0314)  | <b>0.7773***</b><br>(0.0261)  | <b>0.6649***</b><br>(0.0315)  | <b>0.7859***</b><br>(0.0246)  | <b>0.6782***</b><br>(0.0299)  | <b>0.7828***</b><br>(0.0257)  | <b>0.6679***</b><br>(0.0310)  | <b>0.7840***</b><br>(0.0259)  | <b>0.6721***</b><br>(0.0310)  |
| DailyVola           |                               |                               | <b>0.0004***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0005***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0003***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0004***</b><br>(0.0001)  |                               | <b>0.0002***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0002***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0002***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0002***</b><br>(0.0001)  |
| StockPrice          |                               |                               | <b>0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000)  |                               | <b>0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000)  |
| Turnover            |                               |                               | <b>-0.0787***</b><br>(0.0086) | <b>-0.0708***</b><br>(0.0087) | <b>-0.0707***</b><br>(0.0081) | <b>-0.0635***</b><br>(0.0088) |                               | <b>-0.0321***</b><br>(0.0075) | <b>-0.0229***</b><br>(0.0053) | <b>-0.0289***</b><br>(0.0075) | <b>-0.0198***</b><br>(0.0054) | <b>-0.0198***</b><br>(0.0054) |
| UncQue              |                               |                               | <b>-0.0011*</b><br>(0.0005)   | <b>-0.0012**</b><br>(0.0006)  | <b>-0.0014**</b><br>(0.0006)  | <b>-0.0014**</b><br>(0.0006)  |                               | 0.0005<br>(0.0005)            | -0.0004<br>(0.0005)           | -0.0003<br>(0.0005)           | -0.0003<br>(0.0005)           | -0.0003<br>(0.0005)           |
| Extended Controls   |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| Industry FE         | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               |
| Firm FE             |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |
| Year FE             | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               |
| Year-Quarter FE     |                               |                               |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| N                   | 63,806                        | 63,806                        | 60,256                        | 60,256                        | 60,256                        | 60,256                        | 63,351                        | 63,351                        | 61,099                        | 61,099                        | 61,099                        | 61,099                        |
| R <sup>2</sup>      | 0.621                         | 0.451                         | 0.621                         | 0.456                         | 0.622                         | 0.454                         | 0.623                         | 0.456                         | 0.618                         | 0.453                         | 0.619                         | 0.451                         |
| Adj. R <sup>2</sup> | 0.621                         | 0.435                         | 0.621                         | 0.440                         | 0.621                         | 0.437                         | 0.623                         | 0.441                         | 0.618                         | 0.437                         | 0.618                         | 0.434                         |

Notes: \*  $p < 0.10$ , \*\*  $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\*  $p < 0.01$  (one-tailed for IVs,  $\beta > 0$ ; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms).  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ).

Table 21: H7c Robustness: Orthogonal Speaker Partition

|                     | (1)                           | (2)                           | (3)                           | (4)                           | (5)                           | (6)                           | (7)                           | (8)                           | (9)                           | (10)                          | (11)                          | (12)                          |
|---------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|
|                     |                               |                               | BGTLevel_Amihud               |                               |                               |                               |                               |                               | BGTLevel_Amihud_lead1         |                               |                               |                               |
| UncAnsCEO           | 0.0005<br>(0.0007)            | 0.0005<br>(0.0008)            | 0.0002<br>(0.0007)            | 0.0002<br>(0.0008)            | 0.0000<br>(0.0007)            | -0.0001<br>(0.0008)           | -0.0001<br>(0.0006)           | -0.0003<br>(0.0006)           | 0.0005<br>(0.0006)            | -0.0003<br>(0.0007)           | -0.0002<br>(0.0006)           | -0.0003<br>(0.0007)           |
| UncAnsNoCEO         | -0.0006<br>(0.0004)           | -0.0007<br>(0.0005)           | -0.0007<br>(0.0005)           | -0.0008<br>(0.0005)           | -0.0008<br>(0.0004)           | -0.0008<br>(0.0005)           | 0.0004<br>(0.0004)            | 0.0005<br>(0.0005)            | <b>0.0010**</b><br>(0.0005)   | <b>0.0007*</b><br>(0.0005)    | 0.0005<br>(0.0004)            | <b>0.0007*</b><br>(0.0005)    |
| UncPreCEO           | -0.0002<br>(0.0007)           | -0.0001<br>(0.0009)           | -0.0003<br>(0.0007)           | -0.0001<br>(0.0009)           | -0.0005<br>(0.0007)           | -0.0004<br>(0.0009)           | -0.0007<br>(0.0007)           | -0.0008<br>(0.0009)           | -0.0002<br>(0.0007)           | -0.0010<br>(0.0010)           | -0.0008<br>(0.0007)           | -0.0010<br>(0.0010)           |
| UncPreNoCEO         | -0.0001<br>(0.0003)           | -0.0003<br>(0.0005)           | 0.0001<br>(0.0003)            | -0.0005<br>(0.0006)           | 0.0001<br>(0.0003)            | -0.0005<br>(0.0006)           | <b>0.0006*</b><br>(0.0004)    | -0.0003<br>(0.0007)           | <b>0.0013***</b><br>(0.0005)  | -0.0004<br>(0.0008)           | <b>0.0007*</b><br>(0.0005)    | -0.0003<br>(0.0008)           |
| lnAssets            | <b>-0.0017***</b><br>(0.0003) | <b>-0.0034***</b><br>(0.0010) | <b>-0.0008***</b><br>(0.0002) | <b>-0.0026**</b><br>(0.0011)  | <b>-0.0011***</b><br>(0.0003) | <b>-0.0031***</b><br>(0.0011) | <b>-0.0018***</b><br>(0.0003) | <b>-0.0036***</b><br>(0.0009) | <b>-0.0006***</b><br>(0.0002) | <b>-0.0033***</b><br>(0.0010) | <b>-0.0016***</b><br>(0.0003) | <b>-0.0034***</b><br>(0.0010) |
| TobinsQ             | <b>-0.0006***</b><br>(0.0002) | -0.0001<br>(0.0003)           | <b>-0.0004***</b><br>(0.0002) | -0.0003<br>(0.0003)           | <b>-0.0005***</b><br>(0.0002) | -0.0003<br>(0.0003)           | <b>-0.0006***</b><br>(0.0002) | 0.0000<br>(0.0003)            | -0.0002<br>(0.0002)           | -0.0002<br>(0.0003)           | <b>-0.0007***</b><br>(0.0002) | -0.0002<br>(0.0003)           |
| ROA                 | <b>-0.0281***</b><br>(0.0048) | <b>-0.0406***</b><br>(0.0073) | <b>-0.0148***</b><br>(0.0046) | <b>-0.0272***</b><br>(0.0068) | <b>-0.0171***</b><br>(0.0047) | <b>-0.0291***</b><br>(0.0069) | <b>-0.0280***</b><br>(0.0053) | <b>-0.0383***</b><br>(0.0073) | <b>-0.0220***</b><br>(0.0056) | <b>-0.0321***</b><br>(0.0074) | <b>-0.0224***</b><br>(0.0057) | <b>-0.0318***</b><br>(0.0075) |
| Leverage            | -0.0000<br>(0.0010)           | 0.0014<br>(0.0020)            | <b>-0.0023**</b><br>(0.0012)  | -0.0033<br>(0.0021)           | -0.0017<br>(0.0011)           | -0.0025<br>(0.0020)           | -0.0008<br>(0.0011)           | -0.0015<br>(0.0012)           | <b>-0.0022*</b><br>(0.0012)   | <b>-0.0038*</b><br>(0.0021)   | -0.0012<br>(0.0011)           | -0.0026<br>(0.0020)           |
| Capex               | <b>-0.0079**</b><br>(0.0038)  | -0.0003<br>(0.0102)           | <b>-0.0102**</b><br>(0.0043)  | -0.0023<br>(0.0110)           | <b>-0.0124***</b><br>(0.0043) | -0.0111<br>(0.0111)           | <b>-0.0145***</b><br>(0.0035) | <b>-0.0237***</b><br>(0.0083) | <b>-0.0130***</b><br>(0.0037) | <b>-0.0253***</b><br>(0.0087) | <b>-0.0136***</b><br>(0.0036) | <b>-0.0193**</b><br>(0.0088)  |
| DivDummy            | 0.0002<br>(0.0005)            | <b>-0.0017*</b><br>(0.0009)   | <b>0.0013*</b><br>(0.0006)    | -0.0010<br>(0.0009)           | <b>0.0010*</b><br>(0.0006)    | -0.0013<br>(0.0009)           | 0.0001<br>(0.0005)            | <b>-0.0024**</b><br>(0.0009)  | 0.0006<br>(0.0005)            | <b>-0.0021**</b><br>(0.0009)  | 0.0005<br>(0.0005)            | <b>-0.0021**</b><br>(0.0009)  |
| sCFO                | -0.0020<br>(0.0014)           | -0.0004<br>(0.0005)           | -0.0027<br>(0.0017)           | <b>-0.0009*</b><br>(0.0005)   | -0.0024<br>(0.0016)           | <b>-0.0008*</b><br>(0.0005)   | -0.0016<br>(0.0011)           | -0.0004<br>(0.0004)           | -0.0016<br>(0.0010)           | -0.0007<br>(0.0004)           | -0.0019<br>(0.0012)           | -0.0006<br>(0.0004)           |
| Lagged_DV           | <b>0.7940***</b><br>(0.0278)  | <b>0.6882***</b><br>(0.0338)  | <b>0.7812***</b><br>(0.0290)  | <b>0.6716***</b><br>(0.0351)  | <b>0.7849***</b><br>(0.0292)  | <b>0.6753***</b><br>(0.0353)  | <b>0.8071***</b><br>(0.0270)  | <b>0.7025***</b><br>(0.0338)  | <b>0.8015***</b><br>(0.0276)  | <b>0.6911***</b><br>(0.0343)  | <b>0.8034***</b><br>(0.0276)  | <b>0.6956***</b><br>(0.0343)  |
| DailyVola           |                               |                               | <b>0.0004***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0005***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0003***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0004***</b><br>(0.0001)  |                               |                               | <b>0.0002***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0002***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0002***</b><br>(0.0001)  |
| StockPrice          |                               |                               | <b>0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0000**</b><br>(0.0000)   | <b>0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0000**</b><br>(0.0000)   |                               |                               | <b>0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0000**</b><br>(0.0000)   | <b>0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0000**</b><br>(0.0000)   |
| Turnover            |                               |                               | <b>-0.0720***</b><br>(0.0080) | <b>-0.0666***</b><br>(0.0094) | <b>-0.0643***</b><br>(0.0076) | <b>-0.0596***</b><br>(0.0099) |                               |                               | <b>-0.0284***</b><br>(0.0072) | <b>-0.0212***</b><br>(0.0058) | <b>-0.0256***</b><br>(0.0073) | <b>-0.0184***</b><br>(0.0060) |
| UncQue              |                               |                               | <b>-0.0012**</b><br>(0.0005)  | <b>-0.0013**</b><br>(0.0005)  | <b>-0.0015***</b><br>(0.0005) | <b>-0.0015***</b><br>(0.0005) |                               |                               | 0.0000<br>(0.0004)            | -0.0007<br>(0.0004)           | -0.0007<br>(0.0004)           | -0.0006<br>(0.0004)           |
| Extended Controls   |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| Industry FE         | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               |
| Firm FE             |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |
| Year FE             | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               |
| Year-Quarter FE     |                               |                               |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| N                   | 59,935                        | 59,935                        | 56,802                        | 56,802                        | 56,802                        | 56,802                        | 59,481                        | 59,481                        | 57,576                        | 57,576                        | 57,576                        | 57,576                        |
| R <sup>2</sup>      | 0.631                         | 0.468                         | 0.638                         | 0.479                         | 0.639                         | 0.477                         | 0.641                         | 0.480                         | 0.640                         | 0.479                         | 0.641                         | 0.477                         |
| Adj. R <sup>2</sup> | 0.631                         | 0.453                         | 0.638                         | 0.463                         | 0.639                         | 0.460                         | 0.641                         | 0.464                         | 0.640                         | 0.463                         | 0.641                         | 0.460                         |

Notes: \*  $p < 0.10$ , \*\*  $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\*  $p < 0.01$  (one-tailed for IVs,  $\beta > 0$ ; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms).  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ).



Table 22: H7d: Speech Uncertainty and BGT-Window 25-Day Amihud Delta ( $[+1, +25] - [-25, -1]$ )

|                     | (1)                          | (2)                          | (3)                          | (4)                           | (5)                          | (6)                           | (7)                          | (8)                          | (9)                           | (10)                          | (11)                          | (12)                          |
|---------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------|-------------------------------|------------------------------|-------------------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|
|                     |                              |                              | BGTDelta_Amihud              |                               |                              |                               |                              |                              | BGTDelta_Amihud_lead1         |                               |                               |                               |
| UncAnsCEO           | 0.0001<br>(0.0005)           | 0.0003<br>(0.0006)           | 0.0000<br>(0.0006)           | 0.0002<br>(0.0006)            | 0.0001<br>(0.0006)           | 0.0003<br>(0.0006)            | 0.0000<br>(0.0005)           | 0.0001<br>(0.0005)           | 0.0002<br>(0.0005)            | 0.0002<br>(0.0006)            | 0.0002<br>(0.0005)            | 0.0002<br>(0.0005)            |
| UncPreCEO           | 0.0002<br>(0.0004)           | -0.0001<br>(0.0006)          | 0.0002<br>(0.0004)           | -0.0003<br>(0.0006)           | 0.0000<br>(0.0004)           | -0.0003<br>(0.0006)           | <b>0.0007**</b><br>(0.0003)  | 0.0006<br>(0.0005)           | <b>0.0009***</b><br>(0.0004)  | 0.0006<br>(0.0005)            | <b>0.0010***</b><br>(0.0004)  | <b>0.0007*</b><br>(0.0005)    |
| UncAnsMgr           | <b>0.0011*</b><br>(0.0007)   | 0.0009<br>(0.0008)           | -0.0005<br>(0.0007)          | 0.0006<br>(0.0008)            | 0.0007<br>(0.0007)           | 0.0005<br>(0.0008)            | -0.0003<br>(0.0006)          | -0.0006<br>(0.0008)          | 0.0000<br>(0.0006)            | -0.0003<br>(0.0008)           | -0.0000<br>(0.0006)           | -0.0001<br>(0.0008)           |
| UncPreMgr           | -0.0002<br>(0.0004)          | 0.0003<br>(0.0007)           | -0.0017<br>(0.0004)          | 0.0002<br>(0.0008)            | -0.0002<br>(0.0004)          | 0.0003<br>(0.0008)            | -0.0005<br>(0.0004)          | -0.0005<br>(0.0006)          | -0.0005<br>(0.0004)           | -0.0004<br>(0.0006)           | -0.0007<br>(0.0004)           | -0.0002<br>(0.0006)           |
| InAssets            | <b>0.0008***</b><br>(0.0001) | <b>0.0022***</b><br>(0.0004) | <b>0.0001*</b><br>(0.0001)   | <b>0.0029***</b><br>(0.0004)  | <b>0.0009***</b><br>(0.0001) | <b>0.0027***</b><br>(0.0004)  | <b>0.0007***</b><br>(0.0001) | <b>0.0017***</b><br>(0.0003) | <b>0.0004***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0016***</b><br>(0.0004)  | <b>0.0003***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0016***</b><br>(0.0004)  |
| TobinsQ             | <b>0.0005***</b><br>(0.0001) | <b>0.0009***</b><br>(0.0002) | <b>0.0002***</b><br>(0.0001) | <b>0.0010***</b><br>(0.0002)  | <b>0.0005***</b><br>(0.0001) | <b>0.0009***</b><br>(0.0002)  | <b>0.0004***</b><br>(0.0001) | <b>0.0006***</b><br>(0.0001) | <b>0.0003***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0007***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0003***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0006***</b><br>(0.0001)  |
| ROA                 | <b>-0.0029*</b><br>(0.0016)  | <b>-0.0059**</b><br>(0.0026) | -0.0010<br>(0.0016)          | -0.0035<br>(0.0027)           | -0.0018<br>(0.0018)          | -0.0040<br>(0.0028)           | 0.0022<br>(0.0018)           | 0.0028<br>(0.0026)           | <b>-0.0031*</b><br>(0.0017)   | -0.0020<br>(0.0026)           | -0.0024<br>(0.0018)           | -0.0012<br>(0.0027)           |
| Leverage            | <b>-0.0012**</b><br>(0.0005) | <b>-0.0037**</b><br>(0.0014) | <b>-0.0011*</b><br>(0.0006)  | <b>-0.0052***</b><br>(0.0015) | <b>-0.0013**</b><br>(0.0005) | <b>-0.0045***</b><br>(0.0015) | -0.0002<br>(0.0005)          | <b>-0.0027**</b><br>(0.0012) | 0.0007<br>(0.0005)            | -0.0006<br>(0.0013)           | 0.0008<br>(0.0005)            | -0.0003<br>(0.0013)           |
| Capex               | 0.0016<br>(0.0016)           | 0.0008<br>(0.0039)           | <b>-0.0027*</b><br>(0.0016)  | -0.0005<br>(0.0040)           | 0.0005<br>(0.0016)           | -0.0002<br>(0.0041)           | 0.0006<br>(0.0019)           | -0.0049<br>(0.0042)          | 0.0021<br>(0.0020)            | -0.0039<br>(0.0042)           | 0.0026<br>(0.0019)            | -0.0005<br>(0.0041)           |
| DivDummy            | -0.0002<br>(0.0002)          | 0.0005<br>(0.0004)           | 0.0001<br>(0.0002)           | 0.0007<br>(0.0005)            | 0.0000<br>(0.0002)           | 0.0006<br>(0.0005)            | -0.0003<br>(0.0002)          | 0.0003<br>(0.0004)           | <b>-0.0007***</b><br>(0.0002) | 0.0000<br>(0.0004)            | <b>-0.0007***</b><br>(0.0002) | 0.0001<br>(0.0004)            |
| sCFO                | -0.0003<br>(0.0002)          | -0.0002<br>(0.0002)          | <b>-0.0010*</b><br>(0.0006)  | -0.0003<br>(0.0002)           | -0.0005<br>(0.0003)          | -0.0002<br>(0.0002)           | -0.0002<br>(0.0002)          | -0.0002<br>(0.0002)          | 0.0002<br>(0.0003)            | 0.0000<br>(0.0002)            | 0.0001<br>(0.0003)            | 0.0000<br>(0.0002)            |
| Lagged_DV           | <b>0.1639***</b><br>(0.0361) | <b>0.1408***</b><br>(0.0377) | <b>0.1718***</b><br>(0.0376) | <b>0.1467***</b><br>(0.0390)  | <b>0.1700***</b><br>(0.0377) | <b>0.1486***</b><br>(0.0391)  | <b>0.1776***</b><br>(0.0340) | <b>0.1557***</b><br>(0.0353) | <b>0.1715***</b><br>(0.0343)  | <b>0.1530***</b><br>(0.0356)  | <b>0.1740***</b><br>(0.0346)  | <b>0.1547***</b><br>(0.0357)  |
| DailyVola           |                              |                              | 0.0000<br>(0.0000)           | <b>0.0001</b><br>(0.0000)     | 0.0000<br>(0.0000)           | <b>0.0001</b><br>(0.0000)     |                              |                              | <b>-0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0002***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0002***</b><br>(0.0000) |
| StockPrice          |                              |                              | 0.0000<br>(0.0000)           | <b>-0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0000*</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>-0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000) |                              |                              | <b>-0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0000**</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>-0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0000**</b><br>(0.0000)  |
| Turnover            |                              |                              | -0.0008<br>(0.0030)          | -0.0045<br>(0.0028)           | 0.0014<br>(0.0033)           | -0.0019<br>(0.0031)           |                              |                              | <b>0.0204***</b><br>(0.0031)  | <b>0.0180***</b><br>(0.0030)  | <b>0.0189***</b><br>(0.0031)  | <b>0.0166***</b><br>(0.0029)  |
| UncQue              |                              |                              | -0.0005<br>(0.0003)          | 0.0001<br>(0.0003)            | 0.0002<br>(0.0003)           | 0.0001<br>(0.0003)            |                              |                              | 0.0005<br>(0.0003)            | 0.0003<br>(0.0003)            | 0.0004<br>(0.0003)            | 0.0003<br>(0.0003)            |
| Extended Controls   |                              |                              | Yes                          | Yes                           | Yes                          | Yes                           |                              |                              | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| Industry FE         | Yes                          |                              | Yes                          |                               | Yes                          |                               | Yes                          |                              | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               |
| Firm FE             |                              | Yes                          |                              | Yes                           |                              | Yes                           |                              | Yes                          |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |
| Year FE             | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                           |                              |                               | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               |
| Year-Quarter FE     |                              |                              |                              |                               | Yes                          | Yes                           |                              |                              |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| N                   | 63,537                       | 63,537                       | 60,036                       | 60,036                        | 60,036                       | 60,036                        | 63,066                       | 63,066                       | 60,826                        | 60,826                        | 60,826                        | 60,826                        |
| R <sup>2</sup>      | 0.030                        | 0.022                        | 0.031                        | 0.028                         | 0.032                        | 0.025                         | 0.034                        | 0.026                        | 0.039                         | 0.032                         | 0.038                         | 0.031                         |
| Adj. R <sup>2</sup> | 0.030                        | -0.006                       | 0.031                        | -0.001                        | 0.031                        | -0.004                        | 0.033                        | -0.002                       | 0.038                         | 0.004                         | 0.036                         | 0.001                         |

Notes: \*  $p < 0.10$ , \*\*  $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\*  $p < 0.01$  (one-tailed for IVs,  $\beta > 0$ ; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms).  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ).

Table 23: H7d Robustness: Orthogonal Speaker Partition

|                     | (1)                          | (2)                           | (3)                          | (4)                           | (5)                          | (6)                           | (7)                          | (8)                          | (9)                           | (10)                          | (11)                          | (12)                          |
|---------------------|------------------------------|-------------------------------|------------------------------|-------------------------------|------------------------------|-------------------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|
|                     |                              |                               | BGTDelta_Amihud              |                               |                              |                               |                              |                              | BGTDelta_Amihud_lead1         |                               |                               |                               |
| UncAnsCEO           | <b>0.0006**</b><br>(0.0003)  | <b>0.0006*</b><br>(0.0004)    | -0.0002<br>(0.0003)          | 0.0005<br>(0.0004)            | <b>0.0004*</b><br>(0.0003)   | 0.0004<br>(0.0004)            | -0.0001<br>(0.0004)          | -0.0000<br>(0.0005)          | 0.0001<br>(0.0004)            | 0.0001<br>(0.0005)            | 0.0001<br>(0.0004)            | 0.0002<br>(0.0005)            |
| UncAnsNoCEO         | -0.0001<br>(0.0003)          | -0.0002<br>(0.0003)           | -0.0006<br>(0.0003)          | -0.0004<br>(0.0003)           | -0.0002<br>(0.0003)          | -0.0004<br>(0.0003)           | 0.0002<br>(0.0002)           | 0.0002<br>(0.0003)           | 0.0003<br>(0.0003)            | 0.0002<br>(0.0003)            | 0.0002<br>(0.0002)            | 0.0002<br>(0.0003)            |
| UncPreCEO           | 0.0000<br>(0.0003)           | -0.0001<br>(0.0005)           | -0.0006<br>(0.0004)          | -0.0002<br>(0.0005)           | -0.0001<br>(0.0004)          | -0.0003<br>(0.0005)           | <b>0.0004**</b><br>(0.0003)  | 0.0003<br>(0.0003)           | <b>0.0006**</b><br>(0.0003)   | 0.0003<br>(0.0003)            | <b>0.0006***</b><br>(0.0003)  | <b>0.0005*</b><br>(0.0003)    |
| UncPreNoCEO         | -0.0001<br>(0.0002)          | 0.0000<br>(0.0003)            | -0.0007<br>(0.0002)          | -0.0000<br>(0.0004)           | -0.0001<br>(0.0002)          | 0.0001<br>(0.0004)            | -0.0001<br>(0.0002)          | 0.0002<br>(0.0003)           | -0.0001<br>(0.0002)           | 0.0003<br>(0.0003)            | -0.0001<br>(0.0002)           | 0.0003<br>(0.0003)            |
| InAssets            | <b>0.0008***</b><br>(0.0001) | <b>0.0022***</b><br>(0.0004)  | <b>0.0001*</b><br>(0.0001)   | <b>0.0029***</b><br>(0.0005)  | <b>0.0008***</b><br>(0.0001) | <b>0.0026***</b><br>(0.0005)  | <b>0.0006***</b><br>(0.0001) | <b>0.0016***</b><br>(0.0004) | <b>0.0004***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0015***</b><br>(0.0004)  | <b>0.0003***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0015***</b><br>(0.0004)  |
| TobinsQ             | <b>0.0005***</b><br>(0.0001) | <b>0.0008***</b><br>(0.0002)  | <b>0.0002***</b><br>(0.0001) | <b>0.0010***</b><br>(0.0002)  | <b>0.0005***</b><br>(0.0001) | <b>0.0009***</b><br>(0.0002)  | <b>0.0003***</b><br>(0.0001) | <b>0.0005***</b><br>(0.0001) | <b>0.0003***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0006***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0002***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0005***</b><br>(0.0001)  |
| ROA                 | <b>-0.0033**</b><br>(0.0016) | <b>-0.0058**</b><br>(0.0028)  | -0.0014<br>(0.0017)          | -0.0032<br>(0.0028)           | -0.0022<br>(0.0019)          | -0.0038<br>(0.0030)           | 0.0019<br>(0.0017)           | 0.0033<br>(0.0026)           | <b>-0.0032*</b><br>(0.0017)   | -0.0018<br>(0.0025)           | -0.0025<br>(0.0018)           | -0.0009<br>(0.0026)           |
| Leverage            | <b>-0.0009*</b><br>(0.0005)  | <b>-0.0040***</b><br>(0.0015) | -0.0007<br>(0.0005)          | <b>-0.0052***</b><br>(0.0016) | <b>-0.0009*</b><br>(0.0005)  | <b>-0.0045***</b><br>(0.0015) | -0.0002<br>(0.0005)          | <b>-0.0022*</b><br>(0.0013)  | 0.0006<br>(0.0005)            | -0.0004<br>(0.0013)           | 0.0007<br>(0.0005)            | -0.0002<br>(0.0013)           |
| Capex               | 0.0010<br>(0.0016)           | 0.0007<br>(0.0039)            | <b>-0.0029*</b><br>(0.0016)  | 0.0001<br>(0.0041)            | 0.0003<br>(0.0016)           | -0.0001<br>(0.0041)           | -0.0004<br>(0.0019)          | -0.0056<br>(0.0042)          | 0.0013<br>(0.0021)            | -0.0045<br>(0.0042)           | 0.0017<br>(0.0019)            | -0.0013<br>(0.0041)           |
| DivDummy            | -0.0001<br>(0.0002)          | 0.0005<br>(0.0005)            | 0.0002<br>(0.0002)           | 0.0008<br>(0.0005)            | 0.0001<br>(0.0002)           | 0.0007<br>(0.0005)            | -0.0001<br>(0.0002)          | 0.0003<br>(0.0004)           | <b>-0.0006***</b><br>(0.0002) | 0.0001<br>(0.0004)            | <b>-0.0005***</b><br>(0.0002) | 0.0002<br>(0.0004)            |
| sCFO                | -0.0003<br>(0.0002)          | -0.0001<br>(0.0002)           | <b>-0.0009*</b><br>(0.0005)  | -0.0002<br>(0.0002)           | -0.0004<br>(0.0003)          | -0.0001<br>(0.0002)           | -0.0003<br>(0.0002)          | -0.0004<br>(0.0002)          | 0.0001<br>(0.0002)            | -0.0001<br>(0.0002)           | -0.0000<br>(0.0002)           | -0.0002<br>(0.0002)           |
| Lagged_DV           | <b>0.1749***</b><br>(0.0407) | <b>0.1543***</b><br>(0.0418)  | <b>0.1791***</b><br>(0.0415) | <b>0.1551***</b><br>(0.0427)  | <b>0.1766***</b><br>(0.0415) | <b>0.1562***</b><br>(0.0427)  | <b>0.1883***</b><br>(0.0375) | <b>0.1682***</b><br>(0.0389) | <b>0.1811***</b><br>(0.0366)  | <b>0.1641***</b><br>(0.0382)  | <b>0.1837***</b><br>(0.0369)  | <b>0.1658***</b><br>(0.0384)  |
| DailyVola           |                              |                               | 0.0000<br>(0.0000)           | <b>0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000)  | 0.0000<br>(0.0000)           | 0.0001<br>(0.0000)            |                              |                              | <b>-0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0002***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0002***</b><br>(0.0000) |
| StockPrice          |                              |                               | 0.0000<br>(0.0000)           | <b>-0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0000*</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>-0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000) |                              |                              | <b>-0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0000**</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>-0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0000**</b><br>(0.0000)  |
| Turnover            |                              |                               | -0.0008<br>(0.0032)          | <b>-0.0052*</b><br>(0.0029)   | 0.0018<br>(0.0035)           | -0.0025<br>(0.0033)           |                              |                              | <b>0.0196***</b><br>(0.0032)  | <b>0.0177***</b><br>(0.0031)  | <b>0.0182***</b><br>(0.0031)  | <b>0.0163***</b><br>(0.0031)  |
| UncQue              |                              |                               | -0.0004<br>(0.0003)          | 0.0002<br>(0.0003)            | 0.0003<br>(0.0003)           | 0.0001<br>(0.0003)            |                              |                              | 0.0004<br>(0.0003)            | 0.0001<br>(0.0003)            | 0.0003<br>(0.0003)            | 0.0002<br>(0.0003)            |
| Extended Controls   |                              |                               | Yes                          | Yes                           | Yes                          | Yes                           |                              |                              | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| Industry FE         | Yes                          |                               | Yes                          |                               | Yes                          |                               | Yes                          |                              | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               |
| Firm FE             |                              | Yes                           |                              | Yes                           |                              | Yes                           |                              | Yes                          |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |
| Year FE             | Yes                          | Yes                           | Yes                          | Yes                           |                              |                               | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               |
| Year-Quarter FE     |                              |                               |                              |                               | Yes                          | Yes                           |                              |                              |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| N                   | 59,692                       | 59,692                        | 56,602                       | 56,602                        | 56,602                       | 56,602                        | 59,228                       | 59,228                       | 57,334                        | 57,334                        | 57,334                        | 57,334                        |
| R <sup>2</sup>      | 0.034                        | 0.026                         | 0.034                        | 0.030                         | 0.035                        | 0.028                         | 0.037                        | 0.029                        | 0.042                         | 0.035                         | 0.041                         | 0.034                         |
| Adj. R <sup>2</sup> | 0.033                        | -0.003                        | 0.033                        | 0.001                         | 0.033                        | -0.003                        | 0.036                        | 0.000                        | 0.041                         | 0.006                         | 0.039                         | 0.003                         |

Notes: \*  $p < 0.10$ , \*\*  $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\*  $p < 0.01$  (one-tailed for IVs,  $\beta > 0$ ; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms).  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ).

Table 24: H7e: Speech Uncertainty and BGT-Window 25-Day Amihud Average ( $[-25, +25]$ , 51-day symmetric)

|                     | (1)                           | (2)                           | (3)                           | (4)                           | (5)                           | (6)                           | (7)                           | (8)                           | (9)                           | (10)                          | (11)                          | (12)                          |
|---------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|
|                     |                               |                               | BGTAvg_Amihud                 |                               |                               |                               |                               |                               | BGTAvg_Amihud_Lead1           |                               |                               |                               |
| UncAnsCEO           | 0.0009<br>(0.0011)            | 0.0008<br>(0.0011)            | 0.0010<br>(0.0011)            | 0.0010<br>(0.0011)            | 0.0009<br>(0.0011)            | 0.0009<br>(0.0011)            | 0.0002<br>(0.0013)            | 0.0003<br>(0.0014)            | 0.0000<br>(0.0013)            | 0.0002<br>(0.0014)            | 0.0001<br>(0.0013)            | 0.0002<br>(0.0014)            |
| UncPreCEO           | -0.0005<br>(0.0010)           | -0.0005<br>(0.0013)           | -0.0011<br>(0.0010)           | -0.0002<br>(0.0013)           | -0.0010<br>(0.0010)           | -0.0003<br>(0.0013)           | -0.0012<br>(0.0012)           | -0.0015<br>(0.0015)           | -0.0017<br>(0.0012)           | -0.0016<br>(0.0015)           | -0.0018<br>(0.0012)           | -0.0018<br>(0.0015)           |
| UncAnsMgr           | -0.0031<br>(0.0014)           | -0.0039<br>(0.0016)           | -0.0024<br>(0.0015)           | -0.0036<br>(0.0016)           | -0.0030<br>(0.0014)           | -0.0040<br>(0.0016)           | 0.0006<br>(0.0016)            | 0.0006<br>(0.0016)            | 0.0014<br>(0.0016)            | 0.0005<br>(0.0018)            | 0.0005<br>(0.0016)            | 0.0003<br>(0.0018)            |
| UncPreMgr           | 0.0006<br>(0.0010)            | 0.0005<br>(0.0015)            | <b>0.0016**</b><br>(0.0010)   | -0.0000<br>(0.0015)           | 0.0009<br>(0.0009)            | -0.0003<br>(0.0015)           | 0.0010<br>(0.0013)            | 0.0014<br>(0.0018)            | <b>0.0020*</b><br>(0.0013)    | 0.0009<br>(0.0018)            | 0.0012<br>(0.0012)            | 0.0010<br>(0.0018)            |
| lnAssets            | <b>-0.0022***</b><br>(0.0003) | <b>-0.0045***</b><br>(0.0010) | <b>-0.0010***</b><br>(0.0002) | <b>-0.0037***</b><br>(0.0012) | <b>-0.0015***</b><br>(0.0003) | <b>-0.0042***</b><br>(0.0012) | <b>-0.0021***</b><br>(0.0004) | <b>-0.0037***</b><br>(0.0010) | <b>-0.0009***</b><br>(0.0002) | <b>-0.0028***</b><br>(0.0011) | <b>-0.0016***</b><br>(0.0003) | <b>-0.0031***</b><br>(0.0011) |
| TobinsQ             | <b>-0.0010***</b><br>(0.0002) | <b>-0.0006*</b><br>(0.0003)   | <b>-0.0007***</b><br>(0.0002) | <b>-0.0009*</b><br>(0.0004)   | <b>-0.0009***</b><br>(0.0002) | <b>-0.0008**</b><br>(0.0004)  | <b>-0.0008***</b><br>(0.0002) | 0.0001<br>(0.0003)            | <b>-0.0005**</b><br>(0.0002)  | -0.0002<br>(0.0003)           | <b>-0.0007***</b><br>(0.0002) | -0.0001<br>(0.0004)           |
| ROA                 | <b>-0.0312***</b><br>(0.0054) | <b>-0.0422***</b><br>(0.0083) | <b>-0.0159***</b><br>(0.0051) | <b>-0.0280***</b><br>(0.0079) | <b>-0.0188***</b><br>(0.0052) | <b>-0.0306***</b><br>(0.0080) | <b>-0.0316***</b><br>(0.0058) | <b>-0.0438***</b><br>(0.0081) | <b>-0.0199***</b><br>(0.0059) | <b>-0.0321***</b><br>(0.0080) | <b>-0.0216***</b><br>(0.0060) | <b>-0.0331***</b><br>(0.0082) |
| Leverage            | 0.0001<br>(0.0012)            | 0.0032<br>(0.0022)            | <b>-0.0027**</b><br>(0.0013)  | -0.0029<br>(0.0023)           | -0.0020<br>(0.0012)           | -0.0024<br>(0.0023)           | -0.0007<br>(0.0014)           | -0.0016<br>(0.0023)           | <b>-0.0029**</b><br>(0.0015)  | <b>-0.0065***</b><br>(0.0024) | -0.0020<br>(0.0014)           | <b>-0.0050**</b><br>(0.0023)  |
| Capex               | <b>-0.0082*</b><br>(0.0047)   | 0.0002<br>(0.0115)            | <b>-0.0102**</b><br>(0.0049)  | -0.0021<br>(0.0119)           | <b>-0.0149***</b><br>(0.0049) | -0.0164<br>(0.0119)           | <b>-0.0171***</b><br>(0.0042) | <b>-0.0231**</b><br>(0.0091)  | <b>-0.0186***</b><br>(0.0046) | <b>-0.0251***</b><br>(0.0095) | <b>-0.0178***</b><br>(0.0044) | <b>-0.0210**</b><br>(0.0096)  |
| DivDummy            | 0.0007<br>(0.0006)            | -0.0014<br>(0.0009)           | <b>0.0018**</b><br>(0.0007)   | -0.0008<br>(0.0009)           | <b>0.0013*</b><br>(0.0007)    | -0.0013<br>(0.0009)           | 0.0003<br>(0.0006)            | <b>-0.0025**</b><br>(0.0010)  | <b>0.0011*</b><br>(0.0006)    | <b>-0.0021*</b><br>(0.0010)   | 0.0009<br>(0.0007)            | <b>-0.0022**</b><br>(0.0010)  |
| sCFO                | -0.0025<br>(0.0017)           | -0.0007<br>(0.0007)           | -0.0032<br>(0.0021)           | <b>-0.0013*</b><br>(0.0008)   | -0.0030<br>(0.0019)           | <b>-0.0012*</b><br>(0.0007)   | -0.0021<br>(0.0014)           | -0.0005<br>(0.0005)           | -0.0027<br>(0.0017)           | <b>-0.0011*</b><br>(0.0006)   | -0.0027<br>(0.0017)           | -0.0009<br>(0.0006)           |
| Lagged_DV           | <b>0.7988***</b><br>(0.0237)  | <b>0.7012***</b><br>(0.0290)  | <b>0.7871***</b><br>(0.0244)  | <b>0.6888***</b><br>(0.0301)  | <b>0.7902***</b><br>(0.0247)  | <b>0.6925***</b><br>(0.0303)  | <b>0.8046***</b><br>(0.0245)  | <b>0.7083***</b><br>(0.0300)  | <b>0.7974***</b><br>(0.0255)  | <b>0.6987***</b><br>(0.0310)  | <b>0.7985***</b><br>(0.0257)  | <b>0.7005***</b><br>(0.0309)  |
| DailyVola           |                               |                               | <b>0.0004***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0005***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0003***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0004***</b><br>(0.0001)  |                               |                               | <b>0.0003***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0004***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0003***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0003***</b><br>(0.0001)  |
| StockPrice          |                               |                               | <b>0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0000**</b><br>(0.0000)   | <b>0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0000**</b><br>(0.0000)   |                               |                               | <b>0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0000**</b><br>(0.0000)   | <b>0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0000**</b><br>(0.0000)   |
| Turnover            |                               |                               | <b>-0.0733***</b><br>(0.0121) | <b>-0.0591***</b><br>(0.0108) | <b>-0.0644***</b><br>(0.0110) | <b>-0.0516***</b><br>(0.0096) |                               |                               | <b>-0.0542***</b><br>(0.0070) | <b>-0.0455***</b><br>(0.0107) | <b>-0.0485***</b><br>(0.0070) | <b>-0.0403***</b><br>(0.0112) |
| UncQue              |                               |                               | -0.0009<br>(0.0007)           | -0.0011<br>(0.0007)           | <b>-0.0013**</b><br>(0.0007)  | <b>-0.0013*</b><br>(0.0007)   |                               |                               | -0.0002<br>(0.0006)           | -0.0006<br>(0.0006)           | -0.0006<br>(0.0006)           | -0.0006<br>(0.0006)           |
| Extended Controls   |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| Industry FE         | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               |
| Firm FE             |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |
| Year FE             | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               |
| Year-Quarter FE     |                               |                               |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| N                   | 63,816                        | 63,816                        | 60,256                        | 60,256                        | 60,256                        | 60,256                        | 63,397                        | 63,397                        | 61,136                        | 61,136                        | 61,136                        | 61,136                        |
| R <sup>2</sup>      | 0.647                         | 0.496                         | 0.647                         | 0.500                         | 0.649                         | 0.500                         | 0.644                         | 0.494                         | 0.643                         | 0.496                         | 0.642                         | 0.492                         |
| Adj. R <sup>2</sup> | 0.646                         | 0.482                         | 0.647                         | 0.485                         | 0.649                         | 0.485                         | 0.644                         | 0.479                         | 0.643                         | 0.482                         | 0.641                         | 0.476                         |

Notes: \*  $p < 0.10$ , \*\*  $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\*  $p < 0.01$  (one-tailed for IVs,  $\beta > 0$ ; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms).  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ).

Table 25: H7e Robustness: Orthogonal Speaker Partition

|                     | (1)                           | (2)                           | (3)                           | (4)                           | (5)                           | (6)                           | (7)                           | (8)                           | (9)                           | (10)                          | (11)                          | (12)                          |
|---------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|
|                     |                               |                               | BGTAvg_Amihud                 |                               |                               |                               |                               |                               | BGTAvg_Amihud_Lead1           |                               |                               |                               |
| UncAnsCEO           | -0.0005<br>(0.0007)           | -0.0010<br>(0.0009)           | -0.0007<br>(0.0008)           | -0.0012<br>(0.0009)           | -0.0010<br>(0.0008)           | -0.0015<br>(0.0009)           | 0.0004<br>(0.0007)            | 0.0002<br>(0.0008)            | 0.0006<br>(0.0007)            | 0.0002<br>(0.0009)            | 0.0002<br>(0.0008)            | 0.0001<br>(0.0009)            |
| UncAnsNoCEO         | -0.0007<br>(0.0005)           | -0.0008<br>(0.0005)           | -0.0007<br>(0.0005)           | -0.0008<br>(0.0005)           | -0.0008<br>(0.0005)           | -0.0008<br>(0.0005)           | 0.0001<br>(0.0005)            | 0.0001<br>(0.0006)            | 0.0005<br>(0.0005)            | 0.0003<br>(0.0006)            | 0.0002<br>(0.0005)            | 0.0003<br>(0.0006)            |
| UncPreCEO           | -0.0003<br>(0.0008)           | -0.0003<br>(0.0010)           | -0.0003<br>(0.0008)           | -0.0003<br>(0.0010)           | -0.0006<br>(0.0008)           | -0.0006<br>(0.0010)           | -0.0009<br>(0.0008)           | -0.0011<br>(0.0010)           | -0.0009<br>(0.0008)           | -0.0014<br>(0.0011)           | -0.0013<br>(0.0008)           | -0.0016<br>(0.0011)           |
| UncPreNoCEO         | -0.0000<br>(0.0003)           | -0.0005<br>(0.0007)           | 0.0003<br>(0.0004)            | -0.0007<br>(0.0007)           | 0.0001<br>(0.0004)            | -0.0008<br>(0.0007)           | 0.0005<br>(0.0005)            | -0.0007<br>(0.0008)           | <b>0.0009*</b><br>(0.0005)    | -0.0009<br>(0.0008)           | <b>0.0006*</b><br>(0.0005)    | -0.0008<br>(0.0008)           |
| InAssets            | <b>-0.0018**</b><br>(0.0003)  | <b>-0.0034***</b><br>(0.0011) | <b>-0.0008***</b><br>(0.0002) | <b>-0.0028**</b><br>(0.0012)  | <b>-0.0012***</b><br>(0.0003) | <b>-0.0033***</b><br>(0.0012) | <b>-0.0018***</b><br>(0.0003) | <b>-0.0033***</b><br>(0.0010) | <b>-0.0008***</b><br>(0.0002) | <b>-0.0026**</b><br>(0.0011)  | <b>-0.0014***</b><br>(0.0003) | <b>-0.0029***</b><br>(0.0011) |
| TobinsQ             | <b>-0.0008**</b><br>(0.0002)  | -0.0004<br>(0.0003)           | <b>-0.0006**</b><br>(0.0002)  | <b>-0.0007**</b><br>(0.0004)  | <b>-0.0007***</b><br>(0.0002) | <b>-0.0006*</b><br>(0.0004)   | <b>-0.0007***</b><br>(0.0002) | 0.0001<br>(0.0003)            | <b>-0.0004**</b><br>(0.0002)  | -0.0001<br>(0.0004)           | <b>-0.0007***</b><br>(0.0002) | -0.0001<br>(0.0004)           |
| ROA                 | <b>-0.0298***</b><br>(0.0056) | <b>-0.0428***</b><br>(0.0087) | <b>-0.0165***</b><br>(0.0054) | <b>-0.0296***</b><br>(0.0083) | <b>-0.0194***</b><br>(0.0056) | <b>-0.0321***</b><br>(0.0084) | <b>-0.0307***</b><br>(0.0059) | <b>-0.0435***</b><br>(0.0083) | <b>-0.0199***</b><br>(0.0060) | <b>-0.0323***</b><br>(0.0083) | <b>-0.0214***</b><br>(0.0062) | <b>-0.0332***</b><br>(0.0085) |
| Leverage            | -0.0005<br>(0.0012)           | 0.0024<br>(0.0020)            | <b>-0.0028**</b><br>(0.0013)  | -0.0025<br>(0.0021)           | <b>-0.0021*</b><br>(0.0012)   | -0.0019<br>(0.0021)           | -0.0014<br>(0.0013)           | -0.0021<br>(0.0020)           | <b>-0.0033**</b><br>(0.0014)  | <b>-0.0062***</b><br>(0.0022) | <b>-0.0025*</b><br>(0.0013)   | <b>-0.0048**</b><br>(0.0022)  |
| Capex               | -0.0047<br>(0.0047)           | 0.0089<br>(0.0123)            | -0.0070<br>(0.0049)           | 0.0061<br>(0.0128)            | <b>-0.0115**</b><br>(0.0049)  | -0.0080<br>(0.0127)           | <b>-0.0146***</b><br>(0.0041) | <b>-0.0216**</b><br>(0.0091)  | <b>-0.0166***</b><br>(0.0046) | <b>-0.0244**</b><br>(0.0098)  | <b>-0.0154***</b><br>(0.0044) | <b>-0.0193*</b><br>(0.0099)   |
| DivDummy            | 0.0004<br>(0.0006)            | <b>-0.0015*</b><br>(0.0009)   | <b>0.0016**</b><br>(0.0006)   | -0.0009<br>(0.0009)           | <b>0.0011*</b><br>(0.0006)    | -0.0014<br>(0.0009)           | 0.0000<br>(0.0006)            | <b>-0.0028***</b><br>(0.0010) | <b>0.0010*</b><br>(0.0006)    | <b>-0.0023**</b><br>(0.0010)  | 0.0007<br>(0.0006)            | <b>-0.0024**</b><br>(0.0010)  |
| sCFO                | -0.0023<br>(0.0016)           | -0.0004<br>(0.0005)           | -0.0029<br>(0.0019)           | -0.0009<br>(0.0006)           | -0.0027<br>(0.0018)           | -0.0008<br>(0.0005)           | -0.0017<br>(0.0012)           | -0.0002<br>(0.0004)           | -0.0023<br>(0.0014)           | <b>-0.0007*</b><br>(0.0004)   | -0.0022<br>(0.0014)           | -0.0006<br>(0.0004)           |
| Lagged_DV           | <b>0.8094***</b><br>(0.0280)  | <b>0.7140***</b><br>(0.0339)  | <b>0.7963***</b><br>(0.0283)  | <b>0.6989***</b><br>(0.0346)  | <b>0.7997***</b><br>(0.0285)  | <b>0.7027***</b><br>(0.0348)  | <b>0.8203***</b><br>(0.0292)  | <b>0.7252***</b><br>(0.0367)  | <b>0.8091***</b><br>(0.0299)  | <b>0.7119***</b><br>(0.0374)  | <b>0.8106***</b><br>(0.0301)  | <b>0.7141***</b><br>(0.0373)  |
| DailyVola           |                               |                               | <b>0.0004***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0005***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0003***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0004***</b><br>(0.0001)  |                               |                               | <b>0.0003***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0004***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0003***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0003***</b><br>(0.0001)  |
| StockPrice          |                               |                               | <b>0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0000**</b><br>(0.0000)   | <b>0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0000**</b><br>(0.0000)   |                               |                               | <b>0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0000**</b><br>(0.0000)   | <b>0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0000**</b><br>(0.0000)   |
| Turnover            |                               |                               | <b>-0.0651***</b><br>(0.0112) | <b>-0.0525***</b><br>(0.0085) | <b>-0.0564***</b><br>(0.0101) | <b>-0.0452***</b><br>(0.0075) |                               |                               | <b>-0.0519***</b><br>(0.0072) | <b>-0.0452***</b><br>(0.0120) | <b>-0.0468***</b><br>(0.0073) | <b>-0.0404***</b><br>(0.0125) |
| UncQue              |                               |                               | -0.0010<br>(0.0006)           | <b>-0.0012*</b><br>(0.0006)   | <b>-0.0013**</b><br>(0.0006)  | <b>-0.0014**</b><br>(0.0006)  |                               |                               | -0.0006<br>(0.0006)           | -0.0009<br>(0.0006)           | <b>-0.0010*</b><br>(0.0005)   | <b>-0.0009*</b><br>(0.0006)   |
| Extended Controls   |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| Industry FE         | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               |
| Firm FE             |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |
| Year FE             | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               |
| Year-Quarter FE     |                               |                               |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| N                   | 59,943                        | 59,943                        | 56,803                        | 56,803                        | 56,803                        | 56,803                        | 59,521                        | 59,521                        | 57,609                        | 57,609                        | 57,609                        | 57,609                        |
| R <sup>2</sup>      | 0.656                         | 0.513                         | 0.659                         | 0.517                         | 0.661                         | 0.518                         | 0.649                         | 0.501                         | 0.649                         | 0.503                         | 0.648                         | 0.499                         |
| Adj. R <sup>2</sup> | 0.656                         | 0.499                         | 0.659                         | 0.502                         | 0.661                         | 0.503                         | 0.649                         | 0.487                         | 0.649                         | 0.488                         | 0.648                         | 0.483                         |

Notes: \*  $p < 0.10$ , \*\*  $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\*  $p < 0.01$  (one-tailed for IVs,  $\beta > 0$ ; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms).  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ).

Table 26: H11: Political Risk and Language Uncertainty

|                             | (1)                            | (2)                            | (3)                            | (4)                            | (5)                            | (6)                            | (7)                           | (8)                           | (9)                           | (10)                          | (11)                          | (12)                          |
|-----------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|
|                             | Industry FE                    |                                |                                |                                |                                |                                | Firm FE                       |                               |                               |                               |                               |                               |
|                             | UncAnsMgr                      | UncAnsCEO                      | UncPreMgr                      | UncPreCEO                      | UncAnsNoCEO                    | UncPreNoCEO                    | UncAnsMgr                     | UncAnsCEO                     | UncPreMgr                     | UncPreCEO                     | UncAnsNoCEO                   | UncPreNoCEO                   |
| Political Risk <sub>t</sub> | <b>0.0002</b> ***<br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0001</b> ***<br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0002</b> ***<br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0003</b> ***<br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0001</b> ***<br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0001</b> ***<br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0001</b> ***<br>(0.0000) | <b>0.0001</b> ***<br>(0.0000) | <b>0.0001</b> ***<br>(0.0000) | <b>0.0002</b> ***<br>(0.0000) | <b>0.0001</b> ***<br>(0.0000) | <b>0.0001</b> ***<br>(0.0000) |
| UncQue                      | <b>0.0431</b> ***<br>(0.0035)  | <b>0.0452</b> ***<br>(0.0043)  | <b>0.0240</b> ***<br>(0.0041)  | <b>0.0204</b> ***<br>(0.0045)  | <b>0.0504</b> ***<br>(0.0057)  | <b>0.0270</b> ***<br>(0.0077)  | <b>0.0346</b> ***<br>(0.0026) | <b>0.0380</b> ***<br>(0.0033) | <b>0.0091</b> ***<br>(0.0024) | <b>0.0081</b> ***<br>(0.0029) | <b>0.0410</b> ***<br>(0.0051) | <b>0.0130</b> ***<br>(0.0044) |
| NegCall                     | <b>0.0890</b> ***<br>(0.0091)  | <b>0.0867</b> ***<br>(0.0107)  | <b>0.1248</b> ***<br>(0.0124)  | <b>0.1874</b> ***<br>(0.0141)  | <b>0.0652</b> ***<br>(0.0127)  | <b>0.0562</b> ***<br>(0.0242)  | <b>0.0618</b> ***<br>(0.0059) | <b>0.0672</b> ***<br>(0.0075) | <b>0.1093</b> ***<br>(0.0072) | <b>0.1477</b> ***<br>(0.0082) | <b>0.0372</b> ***<br>(0.0099) | <b>0.0761</b> ***<br>(0.0130) |
| InAssets                    | <b>-0.0218</b> ***<br>(0.0026) | <b>-0.0199</b> ***<br>(0.0031) | <b>-0.0333</b> ***<br>(0.0042) | <b>-0.0296</b> ***<br>(0.0039) | <b>-0.0347</b> ***<br>(0.0033) | <b>-0.0532</b> ***<br>(0.0073) | -0.0012<br>(0.0050)           | -0.0001<br>(0.0062)           | 0.0046<br>(0.0075)            | 0.0048<br>(0.0078)            | -0.0037<br>(0.0080)           | 0.0050<br>(0.0137)            |
| TobinsQ                     | <b>-0.0106</b> ***<br>(0.0024) | <b>-0.0115</b> ***<br>(0.0025) | 0.0002<br>(0.0034)             | -0.0007<br>(0.0036)            | <b>-0.0116</b> ***<br>(0.0029) | <b>-0.0091</b> *<br>(0.0055)   | 0.0022<br>(0.0019)            | 0.0025<br>(0.0026)            | 0.0012<br>(0.0022)            | 0.0001<br>(0.0023)            | -0.0011<br>(0.0027)           | -0.0037<br>(0.0037)           |
| ROA                         | <b>0.0763</b> ***<br>(0.0236)  | <b>0.1018</b> ***<br>(0.0281)  | <b>0.0720</b> **<br>(0.0333)   | 0.0477<br>(0.0318)             | <b>0.0805</b> ***<br>(0.0292)  | 0.0600<br>(0.0578)             | <b>0.0572</b> ***<br>(0.0164) | <b>0.0604</b> ***<br>(0.0207) | 0.0029<br>(0.0217)            | 0.0346<br>(0.0230)            | <b>0.0625</b> **<br>(0.0289)  | -0.0537<br>(0.0379)           |
| CashRatio                   | -0.0234<br>(0.0253)            | 0.0080<br>(0.0300)             | <b>0.0923</b> ***<br>(0.0344)  | -0.0354<br>(0.0357)            | <b>-0.0642</b> **<br>(0.0295)  | 0.0967<br>(0.0613)             | <b>0.0581</b> ***<br>(0.0189) | <b>0.0463</b> *<br>(0.0238)   | -0.0023<br>(0.0278)           | 0.0265<br>(0.0287)            | 0.0485<br>(0.0335)            | -0.0748<br>(0.0504)           |
| DivDummy                    | 0.0100<br>(0.0076)             | 0.0121<br>(0.0088)             | <b>-0.0481</b> ***<br>(0.0117) | -0.0139<br>(0.0118)            | 0.0016<br>(0.0099)             | <b>-0.0731</b> ***<br>(0.0220) | -0.0094<br>(0.0073)           | -0.0043<br>(0.0095)           | <b>-0.0185</b> **<br>(0.0092) | <b>-0.0229</b> **<br>(0.0103) | 0.0095<br>(0.0104)            | -0.0302<br>(0.0184)           |
| FirmMat                     | 0.0012<br>(0.0013)             | 0.0006<br>(0.0017)             | <b>0.0044</b> *<br>(0.0024)    | <b>0.0021</b> **<br>(0.0010)   | 0.0016<br>(0.0021)             | 0.0051<br>(0.0045)             | <b>0.0030</b> ***<br>(0.0006) | <b>0.0033</b> ***<br>(0.0009) | 0.0009<br>(0.0012)            | 0.0006<br>(0.0007)            | -0.0020<br>(0.0026)           | 0.0016<br>(0.0020)            |
| EarnVol                     | -0.0076<br>(0.0082)            | -0.0107<br>(0.0114)            | -0.0151<br>(0.0179)            | -0.0072<br>(0.0157)            | -0.0097<br>(0.0100)            | -0.0267<br>(0.0278)            | -0.0044<br>(0.0076)           | -0.0022<br>(0.0113)           | 0.0081<br>(0.0088)            | -0.0104<br>(0.0132)           | -0.0059<br>(0.0093)           | 0.0266<br>(0.0184)            |
| UncPreMgr                   | <b>0.1637</b> ***<br>(0.0097)  |                                |                                |                                |                                |                                | <b>0.1174</b> ***<br>(0.0065) |                               |                               |                               |                               |                               |
| UncPreCEO                   |                                | <b>0.1786</b> ***<br>(0.0089)  |                                |                                |                                |                                |                               | <b>0.1078</b> ***<br>(0.0056) |                               |                               |                               |                               |
| UncPreNoCEO                 |                                |                                |                                |                                | <b>0.0598</b> ***<br>(0.0091)  |                                |                               |                               |                               |                               | <b>0.0577</b> ***<br>(0.0077) |                               |
| Industry FE                 | Yes                            | Yes                            | Yes                            | Yes                            | Yes                            | Yes                            |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| Firm FE                     |                                |                                |                                |                                |                                |                                | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| Year FE                     | Yes                            | Yes                            | Yes                            | Yes                            | Yes                            | Yes                            | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| N                           | 77,658                         | 65,394                         | 77,758                         | 65,760                         | 73,816                         | 76,549                         | 77,658                        | 65,394                        | 77,758                        | 65,760                        | 73,816                        | 76,549                        |
| R <sup>2</sup>              | 0.066                          | 0.057                          | 0.053                          | 0.043                          | 0.018                          | 0.029                          | 0.026                         | 0.021                         | 0.018                         | 0.023                         | 0.005                         | 0.005                         |
| Adj. R <sup>2</sup>         | 0.065                          | 0.056                          | 0.052                          | 0.043                          | 0.018                          | 0.029                          | 0.002                         | -0.006                        | -0.005                        | -0.004                        | -0.020                        | -0.020                        |

Notes: \* $p < 0.10$ , \*\* $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\* $p < 0.01$  (one-tailed for IVs,  $\beta > 0$ ; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). Firms with fewer than 5 calls are excluded.  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ).

Table 27: H11-Lag1: Political Risk (1-Qtr Lag) and Language Uncertainty

|                      | (1)                           | (2)                           | (3)                           | (4)                           | (5)                           | (6)                           | (7)                          | (8)                          | (9)                          | (10)                         | (11)                         | (12)                         |
|----------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------|
|                      | Industry FE                   |                               |                               |                               |                               |                               | Firm FE                      |                              |                              |                              |                              |                              |
|                      | UncAnsMgr                     | UncAnsCEO                     | UncPreMgr                     | UncPreCEO                     | UncAnsNoCEO                   | UncPreNoCEO                   | UncAnsMgr                    | UncAnsCEO                    | UncPreMgr                    | UncPreCEO                    | UncAnsNoCEO                  | UncPreNoCEO                  |
| PRisk <sub>t-1</sub> | <b>0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0002***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000) |
| UncQue               | <b>0.0448***</b><br>(0.0036)  | <b>0.0462***</b><br>(0.0044)  | <b>0.0263***</b><br>(0.0042)  | <b>0.0247***</b><br>(0.0046)  | <b>0.0523***</b><br>(0.0057)  | <b>0.0265***</b><br>(0.0079)  | <b>0.0357***</b><br>(0.0026) | <b>0.0381***</b><br>(0.0034) | <b>0.0108***</b><br>(0.0025) | <b>0.0097***</b><br>(0.0030) | <b>0.0421***</b><br>(0.0051) | <b>0.0140***</b><br>(0.0044) |
| NegCall              | <b>0.0935***</b><br>(0.0092)  | <b>0.0919***</b><br>(0.0109)  | <b>0.1342***</b><br>(0.0126)  | <b>0.1981***</b><br>(0.0144)  | <b>0.0686***</b><br>(0.0128)  | <b>0.0634***</b><br>(0.0244)  | <b>0.0668***</b><br>(0.0060) | <b>0.0715***</b><br>(0.0077) | <b>0.1170***</b><br>(0.0073) | <b>0.1591***</b><br>(0.0084) | <b>0.0417***</b><br>(0.0101) | <b>0.0834***</b><br>(0.0131) |
| InAssets             | <b>-0.0217***</b><br>(0.0026) | <b>-0.0191***</b><br>(0.0031) | <b>-0.0335***</b><br>(0.0043) | <b>-0.0298***</b><br>(0.0040) | <b>-0.0352***</b><br>(0.0033) | <b>-0.0527***</b><br>(0.0074) | -0.0014<br>(0.0052)          | 0.0009<br>(0.0065)           | 0.0045<br>(0.0077)           | 0.0054<br>(0.0080)           | -0.0064<br>(0.0081)          | 0.0051<br>(0.0141)           |
| TobinsQ              | <b>-0.0108***</b><br>(0.0024) | <b>-0.0119***</b><br>(0.0025) | 0.0005<br>(0.0034)            | -0.0003<br>(0.0036)           | <b>-0.0115***</b><br>(0.0030) | -0.0085<br>(0.0055)           | 0.0020<br>(0.0020)           | 0.0021<br>(0.0027)           | 0.0014<br>(0.0023)           | 0.0001<br>(0.0023)           | -0.0008<br>(0.0028)          | -0.0038<br>(0.0037)          |
| ROA                  | <b>0.0885***</b><br>(0.0249)  | <b>0.1151***</b><br>(0.0295)  | <b>0.0718**</b><br>(0.0335)   | 0.0480<br>(0.0331)            | <b>0.0854***</b><br>(0.0303)  | 0.0442<br>(0.0589)            | <b>0.0610***</b><br>(0.0175) | <b>0.0633***</b><br>(0.0219) | 0.0029<br>(0.0229)           | <b>0.0455*</b><br>(0.0246)   | <b>0.0614**</b><br>(0.0294)  | -0.0592<br>(0.0395)          |
| CashRatio            | -0.0217<br>(0.0257)           | 0.0126<br>(0.0305)            | <b>0.0918***</b><br>(0.0352)  | -0.0347<br>(0.0365)           | <b>-0.0647**</b><br>(0.0301)  | 0.0958<br>(0.0620)            | <b>0.0598***</b><br>(0.0192) | <b>0.0534**</b><br>(0.0243)  | -0.0016<br>(0.0284)          | 0.0271<br>(0.0290)           | 0.0334<br>(0.0333)           | -0.0647<br>(0.0509)          |
| DivDummy             | 0.0102<br>(0.0077)            | 0.0117<br>(0.0088)            | <b>-0.0501***</b><br>(0.0119) | -0.0145<br>(0.0120)           | 0.0018<br>(0.0100)            | <b>-0.0725***</b><br>(0.0220) | -0.0097<br>(0.0074)          | -0.0061<br>(0.0097)          | <b>-0.0183**</b><br>(0.0093) | <b>-0.0242**</b><br>(0.0107) | 0.0113<br>(0.0107)           | -0.0288<br>(0.0183)          |
| FirmMat              | 0.0003<br>(0.0017)            | -0.0004<br>(0.0022)           | <b>0.0059***</b><br>(0.0023)  | 0.0021<br>(0.0014)            | 0.0014<br>(0.0021)            | <b>0.0090**</b><br>(0.0038)   | <b>0.0028*</b><br>(0.0015)   | <b>0.0039**</b><br>(0.0019)  | 0.0017<br>(0.0024)           | -0.0007<br>(0.0015)          | -0.0017<br>(0.0027)          | 0.0047<br>(0.0035)           |
| EarnVol              | -0.0065<br>(0.0106)           | -0.0074<br>(0.0125)           | -0.0174<br>(0.0201)           | -0.0070<br>(0.0158)           | -0.0077<br>(0.0137)           | -0.0283<br>(0.0325)           | -0.0039<br>(0.0082)          | 0.0035<br>(0.0115)           | 0.0082<br>(0.0107)           | -0.0131<br>(0.0146)          | -0.0047<br>(0.0118)          | 0.0341<br>(0.0230)           |
| UncPreMgr            | <b>0.1693***</b><br>(0.0099)  |                               |                               |                               |                               |                               | <b>0.1219***</b><br>(0.0066) |                              |                              |                              |                              |                              |
| UncPreCEO            |                               | <b>0.1821***</b><br>(0.0090)  |                               |                               |                               |                               |                              | <b>0.1122***</b><br>(0.0058) |                              |                              |                              |                              |
| UncPreNoCEO          |                               |                               |                               |                               | <b>0.0614***</b><br>(0.0092)  |                               |                              |                              |                              |                              | <b>0.0583***</b><br>(0.0078) |                              |
| Industry FE          | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                              |                              |                              |                              |                              |                              |
| Firm FE              |                               |                               |                               |                               |                               |                               | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                          |
| Year FE              | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                          |
| N                    | 74,918                        | 63,049                        | 75,014                        | 63,399                        | 71,264                        | 73,875                        | 74,918                       | 63,049                       | 75,014                       | 63,399                       | 71,264                       | 73,875                       |
| R <sup>2</sup>       | 0.063                         | 0.055                         | 0.049                         | 0.036                         | 0.018                         | 0.028                         | 0.022                        | 0.018                        | 0.014                        | 0.016                        | 0.005                        | 0.004                        |
| Adj. R <sup>2</sup>  | 0.063                         | 0.054                         | 0.049                         | 0.035                         | 0.018                         | 0.027                         | -0.002                       | -0.009                       | -0.011                       | -0.012                       | -0.021                       | -0.021                       |

Notes: \* $p < 0.10$ , \*\* $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\* $p < 0.01$  (one-tailed for IVs,  $\beta > 0$ ; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). Firms with fewer than 5 calls are excluded.  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ).

Table 28: H11-Lag2: Political Risk (2-Qtr Lag) and Language Uncertainty

|                      | (1)                           | (2)                           | (3)                           | (4)                           | (5)                           | (6)                           | (7)                          | (8)                          | (9)                          | (10)                         | (11)                         | (12)                         |
|----------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------|
|                      | Industry FE                   |                               |                               |                               |                               |                               | Firm FE                      |                              |                              |                              |                              |                              |
|                      | UncAnsMgr                     | UncAnsCEO                     | UncPreMgr                     | UncPreCEO                     | UncAnsNoCEO                   | UncPreNoCEO                   | UncAnsMgr                    | UncAnsCEO                    | UncPreMgr                    | UncPreCEO                    | UncAnsNoCEO                  | UncPreNoCEO                  |
| PRisk <sub>t-2</sub> | <b>0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0001**</b><br>(0.0000)   | <b>0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>0.0000**</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>0.0000**</b><br>(0.0000)  | 0.0000<br>(0.0000)           |
| UncQue               | <b>0.0447***</b><br>(0.0036)  | <b>0.0470***</b><br>(0.0044)  | <b>0.0265***</b><br>(0.0043)  | <b>0.0242***</b><br>(0.0047)  | <b>0.0519***</b><br>(0.0058)  | <b>0.0287***</b><br>(0.0080)  | <b>0.0358***</b><br>(0.0027) | <b>0.0395***</b><br>(0.0034) | <b>0.0108***</b><br>(0.0025) | <b>0.0099***</b><br>(0.0031) | <b>0.0419***</b><br>(0.0052) | <b>0.0146***</b><br>(0.0045) |
| NegCall              | <b>0.0937***</b><br>(0.0092)  | <b>0.0923***</b><br>(0.0109)  | <b>0.1365***</b><br>(0.0127)  | <b>0.2019***</b><br>(0.0145)  | <b>0.0688***</b><br>(0.0129)  | <b>0.0654***</b><br>(0.0244)  | <b>0.0657***</b><br>(0.0060) | <b>0.0719***</b><br>(0.0077) | <b>0.1180***</b><br>(0.0073) | <b>0.1609***</b><br>(0.0084) | <b>0.0400***</b><br>(0.0101) | <b>0.0826***</b><br>(0.0131) |
| InAssets             | <b>-0.0215***</b><br>(0.0026) | <b>-0.0194***</b><br>(0.0031) | <b>-0.0332***</b><br>(0.0043) | <b>-0.0298***</b><br>(0.0040) | <b>-0.0346***</b><br>(0.0034) | <b>-0.0529***</b><br>(0.0075) | -0.0010<br>(0.0052)          | 0.0016<br>(0.0066)           | 0.0045<br>(0.0076)           | 0.0047<br>(0.0078)           | -0.0050<br>(0.0082)          | 0.0032<br>(0.0143)           |
| TobinsQ              | <b>-0.0105***</b><br>(0.0024) | <b>-0.0115***</b><br>(0.0026) | 0.0004<br>(0.0035)            | -0.0002<br>(0.0037)           | <b>-0.0112***</b><br>(0.0030) | -0.0091<br>(0.0055)           | 0.0021<br>(0.0020)           | 0.0025<br>(0.0028)           | 0.0014<br>(0.0023)           | -0.0002<br>(0.0023)          | -0.0008<br>(0.0028)          | -0.0035<br>(0.0038)          |
| ROA                  | <b>0.0838***</b><br>(0.0247)  | <b>0.1100***</b><br>(0.0293)  | <b>0.0735**</b><br>(0.0335)   | 0.0518<br>(0.0331)            | <b>0.0810***</b><br>(0.0308)  | 0.0477<br>(0.0588)            | <b>0.0575***</b><br>(0.0176) | <b>0.0617***</b><br>(0.0219) | 0.0055<br>(0.0221)           | <b>0.0464*</b><br>(0.0247)   | <b>0.0599***</b><br>(0.0304) | -0.0559<br>(0.0383)          |
| CashRatio            | -0.0210<br>(0.0259)           | 0.0111<br>(0.0308)            | <b>0.0928***</b><br>(0.0353)  | -0.0400<br>(0.0368)           | <b>-0.0648**</b><br>(0.0304)  | <b>0.1037*</b><br>(0.0624)    | <b>0.0627***</b><br>(0.0193) | <b>0.0498**</b><br>(0.0244)  | -0.0033<br>(0.0281)          | 0.0233<br>(0.0292)           | 0.0498<br>(0.0342)           | -0.0683<br>(0.0515)          |
| DivDummy             | 0.0091<br>(0.0077)            | 0.0106<br>(0.0089)            | <b>-0.0497***</b><br>(0.0120) | -0.0142<br>(0.0121)           | 0.0013<br>(0.0101)            | <b>-0.0715***</b><br>(0.0221) | -0.0119<br>(0.0074)          | -0.0079<br>(0.0098)          | <b>-0.0169*</b><br>(0.0094)  | <b>-0.0207*</b><br>(0.0106)  | 0.0092<br>(0.0106)           | -0.0276<br>(0.0187)          |
| FirmMat              | 0.0002<br>(0.0017)            | -0.0005<br>(0.0021)           | <b>0.0059**</b><br>(0.0023)   | 0.0021<br>(0.0015)            | 0.0015<br>(0.0021)            | <b>0.0088**</b><br>(0.0039)   | <b>0.0029*</b><br>(0.0015)   | <b>0.0037**</b><br>(0.0018)  | 0.0017<br>(0.0023)           | -0.0007<br>(0.0016)          | -0.0014<br>(0.0028)          | 0.0050<br>(0.0033)           |
| EarnVol              | -0.0079<br>(0.0114)           | -0.0086<br>(0.0134)           | -0.0152<br>(0.0208)           | -0.0078<br>(0.0159)           | -0.0066<br>(0.0136)           | -0.0235<br>(0.0344)           | -0.0069<br>(0.0098)          | 0.0005<br>(0.0129)           | 0.0092<br>(0.0109)           | -0.0154<br>(0.0158)          | -0.0052<br>(0.0129)          | 0.0376<br>(0.0234)           |
| UncPreMgr            | <b>0.1707***</b><br>(0.0100)  |                               |                               |                               |                               |                               | <b>0.1247***</b><br>(0.0067) |                              |                              |                              |                              |                              |
| UncPreCEO            |                               | <b>0.1827***</b><br>(0.0091)  |                               |                               |                               |                               |                              | <b>0.1138***</b><br>(0.0058) |                              |                              |                              |                              |
| UncPreNoCEO          |                               |                               |                               |                               | <b>0.0608***</b><br>(0.0093)  |                               |                              |                              |                              |                              | <b>0.0567***</b><br>(0.0078) |                              |
| Industry FE          | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                              |                              |                              |                              |                              |                              |
| Firm FE              |                               |                               |                               |                               |                               |                               | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                          |
| Year FE              | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                          |
| N                    | 74,467                        | 62,674                        | 74,561                        | 63,022                        | 70,842                        | 73,432                        | 74,467                       | 62,674                       | 74,561                       | 63,022                       | 70,842                       | 73,432                       |
| R <sup>2</sup>       | 0.063                         | 0.055                         | 0.048                         | 0.035                         | 0.017                         | 0.028                         | 0.023                        | 0.019                        | 0.013                        | 0.015                        | 0.004                        | 0.004                        |
| Adj. R <sup>2</sup>  | 0.063                         | 0.054                         | 0.047                         | 0.034                         | 0.017                         | 0.027                         | -0.002                       | -0.009                       | -0.012                       | -0.013                       | -0.022                       | -0.022                       |

Notes: \* $p < 0.10$ , \*\* $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\* $p < 0.01$  (one-tailed for IVs,  $\beta > 0$ ; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). Firms with fewer than 5 calls are excluded.  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ).

Table 29: H12: Speech Uncertainty and Quarterly Payout Ratio

|                     | (1)                           | (2)                           | (3)                           | (4)                           | (5)                           | (6)                           | (7)                           | (8)                           | (9)                           | (10)                          | (11)                          | (12)                          |
|---------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|
|                     |                               |                               | PayoutRatio_q                 |                               |                               |                               |                               |                               | PayoutRatio_q_lead_qtr        |                               |                               |                               |
| UncAnsCEO           | 0.0067<br>(0.0135)            | 0.0068<br>(0.0119)            | 0.0073<br>(0.0138)            | 0.0063<br>(0.0123)            | 0.0088<br>(0.0139)            | 0.0070<br>(0.0123)            | -0.0092<br>(0.0136)           | -0.0070<br>(0.0134)           | -0.0126<br>(0.0137)           | -0.0107<br>(0.0134)           | -0.0114<br>(0.0136)           | -0.0106<br>(0.0134)           |
| UncPreCEO           | 0.0311<br>(0.0136)            | 0.0074<br>(0.0104)            | 0.0265<br>(0.0133)            | 0.0037<br>(0.0105)            | 0.0273<br>(0.0133)            | 0.0038<br>(0.0106)            | 0.0282<br>(0.0150)            | -0.0079<br>(0.0125)           | 0.0213<br>(0.0146)            | -0.0114<br>(0.0127)           | 0.0215<br>(0.0145)            | -0.0125<br>(0.0127)           |
| UncAnsMgr           | 0.0008<br>(0.0163)            | -0.0047<br>(0.0151)           | 0.0165<br>(0.0165)            | -0.0051<br>(0.0153)           | -0.0021<br>(0.0165)           | -0.0089<br>(0.0153)           | 0.0196<br>(0.0182)            | 0.0058<br>(0.0174)            | 0.0392<br>(0.0179)            | 0.0093<br>(0.0174)            | 0.0216<br>(0.0181)            | 0.0062<br>(0.0174)            |
| UncPreMgr           | <b>-0.0498***</b><br>(0.0173) | -0.0139<br>(0.0143)           | <b>-0.0299**</b><br>(0.0161)  | -0.0142<br>(0.0147)           | <b>-0.0439***</b><br>(0.0171) | -0.0151<br>(0.0147)           | <b>-0.0529***</b><br>(0.0186) | -0.0053<br>(0.0173)           | <b>-0.0312**</b><br>(0.0172)  | -0.0041<br>(0.0177)           | <b>-0.0436***</b><br>(0.0181) | -0.0032<br>(0.0177)           |
| lnAssets            | <b>0.0212***</b><br>(0.0042)  | <b>-0.0480***</b><br>(0.0142) | <b>0.0257***</b><br>(0.0024)  | <b>-0.0485***</b><br>(0.0145) | <b>0.0142***</b><br>(0.0045)  | <b>-0.0446***</b><br>(0.0146) | <b>0.0232***</b><br>(0.0046)  | -0.0102<br>(0.0145)           | <b>0.0287***</b><br>(0.0025)  | -0.0082<br>(0.0146)           | <b>0.0167***</b><br>(0.0049)  | -0.0092<br>(0.0148)           |
| TobinsQ             | <b>0.0188***</b><br>(0.0045)  | <b>0.0079*</b><br>(0.0044)    | <b>0.0215***</b><br>(0.0045)  | <b>0.0113**</b><br>(0.0045)   | <b>0.0202***</b><br>(0.0044)  | <b>0.0144***</b><br>(0.0046)  | <b>0.0154***</b><br>(0.0048)  | -0.0025<br>(0.0050)           | <b>0.0185***</b><br>(0.0045)  | 0.0009<br>(0.0050)            | <b>0.0165***</b><br>(0.0044)  | 0.0029<br>(0.0051)            |
| ROA                 | <b>-0.4909***</b><br>(0.0737) | <b>-0.9512***</b><br>(0.0959) | <b>-0.5694***</b><br>(0.0810) | <b>-0.8803***</b><br>(0.1025) | <b>-0.5859***</b><br>(0.0807) | <b>-0.8901***</b><br>(0.1026) | <b>-0.5769***</b><br>(0.0890) | <b>-1.0889***</b><br>(0.1126) | <b>-0.6496***</b><br>(0.0977) | <b>-0.9826***</b><br>(0.1162) | <b>-0.6714***</b><br>(0.0980) | <b>-1.0044***</b><br>(0.1171) |
| Leverage            | 0.0429<br>(0.0306)            | <b>0.1533***</b><br>(0.0406)  | 0.0533<br>(0.0328)            | <b>0.1682***</b><br>(0.0440)  | 0.0544<br>(0.0331)            | <b>0.1682***</b><br>(0.0440)  | 0.0085<br>(0.0289)            | -0.0327<br>(0.0455)           | 0.0163<br>(0.0297)            | -0.0421<br>(0.0466)           | 0.0168<br>(0.0298)            | -0.0460<br>(0.0467)           |
| CashRatio           | -0.0114<br>(0.0510)           | <b>-0.1152**</b><br>(0.0454)  | 0.0472<br>(0.0604)            | <b>-0.1300***</b><br>(0.0465) | 0.0323<br>(0.0598)            | <b>-0.1308***</b><br>(0.0464) | 0.0661<br>(0.0554)            | <b>0.1666***</b><br>(0.0531)  | <b>0.1289**</b><br>(0.0639)   | <b>0.1542***</b><br>(0.0543)  | <b>0.1166*</b><br>(0.0636)    | <b>0.1511***</b><br>(0.0545)  |
| Capex               | <b>-0.4504***</b><br>(0.0814) | <b>-0.2244*</b><br>(0.1231)   | <b>-0.4675***</b><br>(0.0795) | <b>-0.2234*</b><br>(0.1232)   | <b>-0.4724***</b><br>(0.0799) | <b>-0.2466**</b><br>(0.1246)  | <b>-0.4275***</b><br>(0.0963) | -0.1644<br>(0.0943)           | <b>-0.4400***</b><br>(0.1777) | -0.1381<br>(0.1769)           | <b>-0.4553***</b><br>(0.0944) | -0.1784<br>(0.1765)           |
| sCFO                | <b>-0.0491**</b><br>(0.0243)  | -0.0084<br>(0.0214)           | <b>-0.0182*</b><br>(0.0108)   | -0.0043<br>(0.0215)           | -0.0157<br>(0.0113)           | -0.0050<br>(0.0219)           | <b>-0.0584**</b><br>(0.0284)  | -0.0076<br>(0.0208)           | <b>-0.0241*</b><br>(0.0126)   | -0.0041<br>(0.0206)           | <b>-0.0205*</b><br>(0.0123)   | -0.0045<br>(0.0201)           |
| Lagged_DV           | <b>0.2574***</b><br>(0.0187)  | <b>0.0729***</b><br>(0.0137)  | <b>0.2522***</b><br>(0.0191)  | <b>0.0685***</b><br>(0.0139)  | <b>0.2529***</b><br>(0.0190)  | <b>0.0708***</b><br>(0.0139)  | <b>0.2400***</b><br>(0.0193)  | <b>0.0385***</b><br>(0.0139)  | <b>0.2339***</b><br>(0.0197)  | <b>0.0353**</b><br>(0.0140)   | <b>0.2336***</b><br>(0.0196)  | <b>0.0363***</b><br>(0.0140)  |
| SalesGrowth         |                               |                               | <b>-0.1573***</b><br>(0.0207) | <b>-0.0825***</b><br>(0.0180) | <b>-0.1582***</b><br>(0.0209) | <b>-0.0874***</b><br>(0.0180) |                               |                               | <b>-0.1907***</b><br>(0.0229) | <b>-0.0836***</b><br>(0.0227) | <b>-0.1940***</b><br>(0.0236) | <b>-0.0903***</b><br>(0.0232) |
| RDSales             |                               |                               | <b>-0.2557**</b><br>(0.1178)  | -0.1845<br>(0.1624)           | <b>-0.2495**</b><br>(0.1167)  | -0.1941<br>(0.1624)           |                               |                               | <b>-0.3090**</b><br>(0.1309)  | -0.2174<br>(0.1984)           | <b>-0.2999**</b><br>(0.1303)  | -0.2401<br>(0.1994)           |
| CashFlowAt          |                               |                               | <b>0.2095***</b><br>(0.0712)  | -0.0950<br>(0.0726)           | <b>0.1615**</b><br>(0.0709)   | -0.1102<br>(0.0726)           |                               |                               | <b>0.2051***</b><br>(0.0776)  | <b>-0.2064**</b><br>(0.0807)  | <b>0.1759**</b><br>(0.0775)   | <b>-0.2013**</b><br>(0.0808)  |
| DailyVola           |                               |                               | <b>-0.0008***</b><br>(0.0003) | 0.0003<br>(0.0003)            | <b>-0.0020***</b><br>(0.0004) | 0.0001<br>(0.0004)            |                               |                               | <b>-0.0005*</b><br>(0.0003)   | <b>0.0008***</b><br>(0.0003)  | <b>-0.0019***</b><br>(0.0004) | <b>0.0008**</b><br>(0.0004)   |
| Extended Controls   |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| Industry FE         | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               |
| Firm FE             |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |
| Year FE             | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               |
| Year-Quarter FE     |                               |                               |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| N                   | 47,651                        | 47,651                        | 45,779                        | 45,779                        | 45,779                        | 45,779                        | 45,466                        | 45,466                        | 44,624                        | 44,624                        | 44,624                        | 44,624                        |
| R <sup>2</sup>      | 0.079                         | 0.015                         | 0.083                         | 0.016                         | 0.086                         | 0.016                         | 0.064                         | 0.010                         | 0.068                         | 0.011                         | 0.070                         | 0.012                         |
| Adj. R <sup>2</sup> | 0.079                         | -0.019                        | 0.082                         | -0.019                        | 0.084                         | -0.020                        | 0.063                         | -0.024                        | 0.067                         | -0.024                        | 0.068                         | -0.025                        |

Notes: \*  $p < 0.10$ , \*\*  $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\*  $p < 0.01$  (one-tailed for IVs,  $\beta < 0$ ; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms).  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ).



Table 30: H12 Robustness: Orthogonal Speaker Partition

|                     | (1)                           | (2)                           | (3)                           | (4)                           | (5)                           | (6)                           | (7)                           | (8)                           | (9)                           | (10)                          | (11)                          | (12)                          |
|---------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|
|                     |                               |                               | PayoutRatio.q                 |                               |                               |                               |                               |                               | PayoutRatio.q_lead.qtr        |                               |                               |                               |
| UncAnsCEO           | 0.0071<br>(0.0106)            | 0.0065<br>(0.0091)            | 0.0158<br>(0.0104)            | 0.0054<br>(0.0094)            | 0.0081<br>(0.0108)            | 0.0042<br>(0.0094)            | 0.0001<br>(0.0108)            | -0.0065<br>(0.0100)           | 0.0075<br>(0.0108)            | -0.0083<br>(0.0101)           | -0.0004<br>(0.0108)           | -0.0099<br>(0.0101)           |
| UncAnsNoCEO         | 0.0000<br>(0.0058)            | -0.0018<br>(0.0056)           | 0.0050<br>(0.0057)            | -0.0012<br>(0.0056)           | -0.0003<br>(0.0057)           | -0.0022<br>(0.0056)           | 0.0059<br>(0.0062)            | 0.0017<br>(0.0056)            | 0.0115<br>(0.0062)            | 0.0034<br>(0.0055)            | 0.0068<br>(0.0061)            | 0.0028<br>(0.0055)            |
| UncPreCEO           | 0.0038<br>(0.0102)            | 0.0013<br>(0.0089)            | 0.0085<br>(0.0103)            | -0.0026<br>(0.0090)           | 0.0037<br>(0.0104)            | -0.0029<br>(0.0090)           | 0.0015<br>(0.0116)            | -0.0089<br>(0.0104)           | 0.0053<br>(0.0113)            | -0.0109<br>(0.0105)           | 0.0003<br>(0.0116)            | -0.0119<br>(0.0105)           |
| UncPreNoCEO         | <b>-0.0169**</b><br>(0.0078)  | -0.0022<br>(0.0069)           | <b>-0.0106*</b><br>(0.0075)   | -0.0031<br>(0.0071)           | <b>-0.0154**</b><br>(0.0077)  | -0.0033<br>(0.0071)           | <b>-0.0199***</b><br>(0.0082) | -0.0067<br>(0.0079)           | <b>-0.0127*</b><br>(0.0077)   | -0.0067<br>(0.0081)           | <b>-0.0167**</b><br>(0.0080)  | -0.0058<br>(0.0082)           |
| lnAssets            | <b>0.0232***</b><br>(0.0041)  | <b>-0.0462***</b><br>(0.0145) | <b>0.0260***</b><br>(0.0023)  | <b>-0.0463***</b><br>(0.0147) | <b>0.0166***</b><br>(0.0045)  | <b>-0.0425***</b><br>(0.0147) | <b>0.0250***</b><br>(0.0045)  | -0.0090<br>(0.0148)           | <b>0.0290***</b><br>(0.0024)  | -0.0071<br>(0.0149)           | <b>0.0190***</b><br>(0.0048)  | -0.0076<br>(0.0150)           |
| TobinsQ             | <b>0.0180***</b><br>(0.0039)  | <b>0.0081*</b><br>(0.0044)    | <b>0.0196***</b><br>(0.0041)  | <b>0.0115***</b><br>(0.0045)  | <b>0.0187***</b><br>(0.0040)  | <b>0.0142***</b><br>(0.0045)  | <b>0.0163***</b><br>(0.0044)  | -0.0009<br>(0.0049)           | <b>0.0186***</b><br>(0.0043)  | 0.0027<br>(0.0049)            | <b>0.0169***</b><br>(0.0043)  | 0.0044<br>(0.0050)            |
| ROA                 | <b>-0.5019***</b><br>(0.0712) | <b>-0.9539***</b><br>(0.0980) | <b>-0.5877***</b><br>(0.0804) | <b>-0.8989***</b><br>(0.1046) | <b>-0.6038***</b><br>(0.0804) | <b>-0.9062***</b><br>(0.1047) | <b>-0.6010***</b><br>(0.0877) | <b>-1.0798***</b><br>(0.1124) | <b>-0.6801***</b><br>(0.0987) | <b>-1.0006***</b><br>(0.1172) | <b>-0.6996***</b><br>(0.0992) | <b>-1.0178***</b><br>(0.1184) |
| Leverage            | 0.0414<br>(0.0283)            | <b>0.1384***</b><br>(0.0393)  | <b>0.0524*</b><br>(0.0311)    | <b>0.1525***</b><br>(0.0313)  | <b>0.0532*</b><br>(0.0425)    | <b>0.1518***</b><br>(0.0289)  | 0.0170<br>(0.0425)            | -0.0355<br>(0.0289)           | 0.0232<br>(0.0456)            | -0.0451<br>(0.0301)           | 0.0231<br>(0.0467)            | -0.0497<br>(0.0467)           |
| CashRatio           | -0.0285<br>(0.0425)           | <b>-0.1195***</b><br>(0.0448) | 0.0201<br>(0.0498)            | <b>-0.1330***</b><br>(0.0460) | 0.0079<br>(0.0493)            | <b>-0.1344***</b><br>(0.0459) | 0.0492<br>(0.0475)            | <b>0.1588***</b><br>(0.0537)  | <b>0.1044*</b><br>(0.0543)    | <b>0.1489***</b><br>(0.0551)  | <b>0.0948*</b><br>(0.0543)    | <b>0.1463***</b><br>(0.0552)  |
| Capex               | <b>-0.4588***</b><br>(0.0795) | <b>-0.2484***</b><br>(0.1194) | <b>-0.4964***</b><br>(0.0774) | <b>-0.2453**</b><br>(0.1196)  | <b>-0.5026***</b><br>(0.0780) | <b>-0.2679**</b><br>(0.1209)  | <b>-0.4352***</b><br>(0.0952) | -0.1654<br>(0.1762)           | <b>-0.4632***</b><br>(0.0934) | -0.1305<br>(0.1767)           | <b>-0.4797***</b><br>(0.0936) | -0.1724<br>(0.1764)           |
| sCFO                | <b>-0.0447**</b><br>(0.0220)  | -0.0117<br>(0.0219)           | -0.0172<br>(0.0106)           | -0.0082<br>(0.0217)           | -0.0146<br>(0.0111)           | -0.0088<br>(0.0222)           | <b>-0.0530**</b><br>(0.0252)  | -0.0096<br>(0.0210)           | <b>-0.0224*</b><br>(0.0120)   | -0.0070<br>(0.0206)           | -0.0189<br>(0.0119)           | -0.0076<br>(0.0200)           |
| Lagged_DV           | <b>0.2533***</b><br>(0.0196)  | <b>0.0707***</b><br>(0.0144)  | <b>0.2484***</b><br>(0.0201)  | <b>0.0665***</b><br>(0.0145)  | <b>0.2493***</b><br>(0.0201)  | <b>0.0686***</b><br>(0.0145)  | <b>0.2386***</b><br>(0.0203)  | <b>0.0364**</b><br>(0.0146)   | <b>0.2327***</b><br>(0.0208)  | <b>0.0334**</b><br>(0.0146)   | <b>0.2326***</b><br>(0.0207)  | <b>0.0342**</b><br>(0.0146)   |
| SalesGrowth         |                               |                               | <b>-0.1464***</b><br>(0.0194) | <b>-0.0742***</b><br>(0.0175) | <b>-0.1472***</b><br>(0.0196) | <b>-0.0783***</b><br>(0.0175) |                               |                               | <b>-0.1777***</b><br>(0.0221) | <b>-0.0738***</b><br>(0.0225) | <b>-0.1811***</b><br>(0.0227) | <b>-0.0800***</b><br>(0.0228) |
| RDSales             |                               |                               | <b>-0.1984*</b><br>(0.1054)   | -0.2458<br>(0.1529)           | <b>-0.1959*</b><br>(0.1044)   | <b>-0.2522*</b><br>(0.1529)   |                               |                               | <b>-0.2657**</b><br>(0.1213)  | <b>-0.3618**</b><br>(0.1832)  | <b>-0.2594**</b><br>(0.1208)  | <b>-0.3842**</b><br>(0.1838)  |
| CashFlowAt          |                               |                               | <b>0.2349***</b><br>(0.0689)  | -0.0849<br>(0.0730)           | <b>0.1934***</b><br>(0.0682)  | -0.0994<br>(0.0730)           |                               |                               | <b>0.2195***</b><br>(0.0759)  | <b>-0.1902**</b><br>(0.0807)  | <b>0.1959***</b><br>(0.0755)  | <b>-0.1854**</b><br>(0.0807)  |
| DailyVola           |                               |                               | <b>-0.0008***</b><br>(0.0003) | 0.0002<br>(0.0003)            | <b>-0.0019***</b><br>(0.0004) | 0.0001<br>(0.0004)            |                               |                               | <b>-0.0006*</b><br>(0.0003)   | <b>0.0007**</b><br>(0.0003)   | <b>-0.0017***</b><br>(0.0004) | <b>0.0007*</b><br>(0.0004)    |
| Extended Controls   |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| Industry FE         | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               |
| Firm FE             |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |
| Year FE             | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               |
| Year-Quarter FE     |                               |                               |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| N                   | 44,882                        | 44,882                        | 43,106                        | 43,106                        | 43,106                        | 43,106                        | 42,786                        | 42,786                        | 41,994                        | 41,994                        | 41,994                        | 41,994                        |
| R <sup>2</sup>      | 0.079                         | 0.015                         | 0.083                         | 0.015                         | 0.085                         | 0.016                         | 0.065                         | 0.010                         | 0.069                         | 0.011                         | 0.070                         | 0.011                         |
| Adj. R <sup>2</sup> | 0.078                         | -0.020                        | 0.082                         | -0.021                        | 0.083                         | -0.022                        | 0.064                         | -0.026                        | 0.068                         | -0.026                        | 0.068                         | -0.027                        |

Notes: \*  $p < 0.10$ , \*\*  $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\*  $p < 0.01$  (one-tailed for IVs,  $\beta < 0$ ; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms).  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ).

Table 31: H12b: Speech Uncertainty and Dividend Payer Indicator (Hoberg-Prabhala 2009 analog)

|                     | (1)                           | (2)                           | (3)                           | (4)                           | (5)                           | (6)                           | (7)                           | (8)                           | (9)                           | (10)                          | (11)                          | (12)                          |
|---------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|
|                     |                               |                               | DivPayerQ                     |                               |                               |                               |                               |                               | DivPayerQ_lead1               |                               |                               |                               |
| UncAnsCEO           | 0.0024<br>(0.0033)            | 0.0030<br>(0.0036)            | 0.0031<br>(0.0034)            | 0.0039<br>(0.0036)            | 0.0035<br>(0.0034)            | 0.0041<br>(0.0036)            | -0.0004<br>(0.0034)           | -0.0004<br>(0.0035)           | -0.0006<br>(0.0034)           | -0.0006<br>(0.0035)           | -0.0004<br>(0.0034)           | -0.0007<br>(0.0035)           |
| UncPreCEO           | 0.0078<br>(0.0028)            | 0.0027<br>(0.0032)            | 0.0083<br>(0.0028)            | 0.0025<br>(0.0032)            | 0.0079<br>(0.0027)            | 0.0017<br>(0.0032)            | 0.0053<br>(0.0028)            | -0.0015<br>(0.0035)           | 0.0053<br>(0.0028)            | -0.0019<br>(0.0036)           | 0.0055<br>(0.0028)            | -0.0020<br>(0.0036)           |
| UncAnsMgr           | 0.0001<br>(0.0041)            | -0.0041<br>(0.0046)           | 0.0014<br>(0.0041)            | -0.0050<br>(0.0047)           | -0.0016<br>(0.0042)           | <b>-0.0063*</b><br>(0.0047)   | 0.0031<br>(0.0040)            | -0.0028<br>(0.0043)           | 0.0067<br>(0.0040)            | -0.0023<br>(0.0044)           | 0.0031<br>(0.0041)            | -0.0024<br>(0.0044)           |
| UncPreMgr           | <b>-0.0113***</b><br>(0.0033) | -0.0059<br>(0.0047)           | <b>-0.0093***</b><br>(0.0032) | -0.0054<br>(0.0048)           | <b>-0.0102***</b><br>(0.0033) | -0.0043<br>(0.0047)           | <b>-0.0096***</b><br>(0.0033) | -0.0058<br>(0.0049)           | <b>-0.0055**</b><br>(0.0032)  | -0.0042<br>(0.0049)           | <b>-0.0086***</b><br>(0.0033) | -0.0037<br>(0.0049)           |
| InAssets            | <b>0.0097***</b><br>(0.0010)  | <b>0.0204***</b><br>(0.0038)  | <b>0.0089***</b><br>(0.0008)  | <b>0.0200***</b><br>(0.0040)  | <b>0.0073***</b><br>(0.0010)  | <b>0.0196***</b><br>(0.0040)  | <b>0.0092***</b><br>(0.0009)  | <b>0.0239***</b><br>(0.0038)  | <b>0.0091***</b><br>(0.0006)  | <b>0.0222***</b><br>(0.0039)  | <b>0.0065***</b><br>(0.0039)  | <b>0.0210***</b><br>(0.0039)  |
| TobinsQ             | <b>0.0023***</b><br>(0.0007)  | <b>0.0025*</b><br>(0.0013)    | <b>0.0024***</b><br>(0.0007)  | <b>0.0028**</b><br>(0.0013)   | <b>0.0021***</b><br>(0.0007)  | <b>0.0030**</b><br>(0.0014)   | <b>0.0015*</b><br>(0.0009)    | 0.0009<br>(0.0013)            | <b>0.0016*</b><br>(0.0008)    | 0.0013<br>(0.0014)            | 0.0009<br>(0.0008)            | 0.0012<br>(0.0014)            |
| ROA                 | <b>0.0501***</b><br>(0.0078)  | <b>0.0273***</b><br>(0.0079)  | <b>0.0326***</b><br>(0.0075)  | 0.0102<br>(0.0091)            | <b>0.0288***</b><br>(0.0074)  | 0.0066<br>(0.0092)            | <b>0.0811***</b><br>(0.0109)  | <b>0.0651***</b><br>(0.0110)  | <b>0.0535***</b><br>(0.0102)  | <b>0.0390***</b><br>(0.0116)  | <b>0.0517***</b><br>(0.0102)  | <b>0.0361***</b><br>(0.0116)  |
| Leverage            | <b>-0.0215***</b><br>(0.0054) | <b>-0.0550***</b><br>(0.0120) | <b>-0.0185***</b><br>(0.0051) | <b>-0.0511***</b><br>(0.0124) | <b>-0.0169***</b><br>(0.0049) | <b>-0.0481***</b><br>(0.0123) | <b>-0.0196***</b><br>(0.0059) | <b>-0.0747***</b><br>(0.0132) | <b>-0.0143***</b><br>(0.0054) | <b>-0.0660***</b><br>(0.0132) | <b>-0.0130**</b><br>(0.0052)  | <b>-0.0639***</b><br>(0.0132) |
| CashRatio           | <b>-0.0200***</b><br>(0.0066) | 0.0139<br>(0.0120)            | <b>-0.0171***</b><br>(0.0065) | 0.0110<br>(0.0122)            | <b>-0.0195***</b><br>(0.0067) | 0.0093<br>(0.0121)            | -0.0075<br>(0.0069)           | <b>0.0332***</b><br>(0.0127)  | 0.0003<br>(0.0068)            | <b>0.0306**</b><br>(0.0126)   | -0.0045<br>(0.0071)           | <b>0.0309**</b><br>(0.0126)   |
| Capex               | <b>-0.0673***</b><br>(0.0180) | <b>0.0736**</b><br>(0.0358)   | <b>-0.0549***</b><br>(0.0180) | <b>0.0715**</b><br>(0.0352)   | <b>-0.0579***</b><br>(0.0180) | <b>0.0602*</b><br>(0.0349)    | <b>-0.0646***</b><br>(0.0178) | 0.0408<br>(0.0385)            | <b>-0.0432**</b><br>(0.0186)  | 0.0435<br>(0.0378)            | <b>-0.0483***</b><br>(0.0185) | 0.0416<br>(0.0380)            |
| sCFO                | -0.0027<br>(0.0026)           | -0.0042<br>(0.0052)           | 0.0001<br>(0.0024)            | -0.0008<br>(0.0056)           | 0.0003<br>(0.0024)            | -0.0008<br>(0.0024)           | 0.0000<br>(0.0055)            | -0.0014<br>(0.0046)           | 0.0035<br>(0.0025)            | -0.0000<br>(0.0051)           | 0.0034<br>(0.0022)            | 0.0003<br>(0.0021)            |
| Lagged_DV           | <b>0.9062***</b><br>(0.0080)  | <b>0.6988***</b><br>(0.0232)  | <b>0.9024***</b><br>(0.0083)  | <b>0.6929***</b><br>(0.0238)  | <b>0.9019***</b><br>(0.0083)  | <b>0.6938***</b><br>(0.0236)  | <b>0.9147***</b><br>(0.0049)  | <b>0.7243***</b><br>(0.0135)  | <b>0.9101***</b><br>(0.0050)  | <b>0.7210***</b><br>(0.0137)  | <b>0.9095***</b><br>(0.0050)  | <b>0.7208***</b><br>(0.0137)  |
| SalesGrowth         |                               |                               | <b>-0.0068***</b><br>(0.0020) | -0.0034<br>(0.0024)           | <b>-0.0070***</b><br>(0.0020) | <b>-0.0042*</b><br>(0.0024)   |                               |                               | <b>-0.0039*</b><br>(0.0023)   | -0.0028<br>(0.0030)           | -0.0036<br>(0.0023)           | -0.0028<br>(0.0030)           |
| RDSales             |                               |                               | <b>0.0020***</b><br>(0.0006)  | -0.0001<br>(0.0008)           | <b>0.0020***</b><br>(0.0006)  | -0.0003<br>(0.0008)           |                               |                               | <b>0.0029***</b><br>(0.0008)  | 0.0009<br>(0.0011)            | <b>0.0029***</b><br>(0.0008)  | 0.0008<br>(0.0011)            |
| CashFlowAt          |                               |                               | 0.0028<br>(0.0102)            | 0.0159<br>(0.0128)            | -0.0010<br>(0.0100)           | 0.0151<br>(0.0127)            |                               |                               | 0.0036<br>(0.0132)            | 0.0135<br>(0.0155)            | -0.0012<br>(0.0130)           | 0.0136<br>(0.0154)            |
| DailyVola           |                               |                               | <b>-0.0005***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0004***</b><br>(0.0001) | <b>-0.0007***</b><br>(0.0001) | <b>-0.0006***</b><br>(0.0001) |                               |                               | <b>-0.0008***</b><br>(0.0001) | <b>-0.0007***</b><br>(0.0001) | <b>-0.0010***</b><br>(0.0001) | <b>-0.0009***</b><br>(0.0001) |
| Extended Controls   |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| Industry FE         | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               |
| Firm FE             |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |
| Year FE             | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               |
| Year-Quarter FE     |                               |                               |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| N                   | 64,145                        | 64,145                        | 61,535                        | 61,535                        | 61,535                        | 61,535                        | 61,359                        | 61,359                        | 60,175                        | 60,175                        | 60,175                        | 60,175                        |
| R <sup>2</sup>      | 0.846                         | 0.500                         | 0.845                         | 0.494                         | 0.846                         | 0.496                         | 0.859                         | 0.536                         | 0.859                         | 0.536                         | 0.860                         | 0.537                         |
| Adj. R <sup>2</sup> | 0.846                         | 0.486                         | 0.845                         | 0.479                         | 0.846                         | 0.480                         | 0.859                         | 0.523                         | 0.859                         | 0.522                         | 0.860                         | 0.523                         |

Notes: \*  $p < 0.10$ , \*\*  $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\*  $p < 0.01$  (one-tailed for IVs,  $\beta < 0$ ; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms).  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ).

Table 32: H12b Robustness: Orthogonal Speaker Partition

|                     | (1)                           | (2)                           | (3)                           | (4)                           | (5)                           | (6)                           | (7)                           | (8)                           | (9)                           | (10)                          | (11)                          | (12)                          |
|---------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|
|                     | DivPayerQ                     |                               |                               |                               |                               |                               | DivPayerQ_lead1               |                               |                               |                               |                               |                               |
| UncAnsCEO           | 0.0019<br>(0.0020)            | 0.0005<br>(0.0023)            | 0.0033<br>(0.0020)            | 0.0008<br>(0.0023)            | 0.0020<br>(0.0020)            | 0.0002<br>(0.0023)            | 0.0009<br>(0.0022)            | -0.0017<br>(0.0024)           | 0.0029<br>(0.0022)            | -0.0017<br>(0.0025)           | 0.0009<br>(0.0022)            | -0.0018<br>(0.0025)           |
| UncAnsNoCEO         | -0.0006<br>(0.0013)           | 0.0003<br>(0.0013)            | -0.0002<br>(0.0013)           | 0.0003<br>(0.0013)            | -0.0010<br>(0.0013)           | -0.0001<br>(0.0013)           | -0.0000<br>(0.0014)           | 0.0008<br>(0.0014)            | 0.0010<br>(0.0014)            | 0.0008<br>(0.0014)            | -0.0002<br>(0.0014)           | 0.0008<br>(0.0014)            |
| UncPreCEO           | 0.0010<br>(0.0022)            | -0.0009<br>(0.0026)           | 0.0025<br>(0.0022)            | -0.0009<br>(0.0026)           | 0.0018<br>(0.0022)            | -0.0012<br>(0.0026)           | 0.0002<br>(0.0023)            | <b>-0.0042*</b><br>(0.0027)   | 0.0021<br>(0.0023)            | <b>-0.0039*</b><br>(0.0023)   | 0.0009<br>(0.0028)            | <b>-0.0037*</b><br>(0.0028)   |
| UncPreNoCEO         | <b>-0.0026**</b><br>(0.0015)  | -0.0017<br>(0.0024)           | <b>-0.0022*</b><br>(0.0015)   | -0.0016<br>(0.0024)           | <b>-0.0024*</b><br>(0.0016)   | -0.0009<br>(0.0024)           | -0.0017<br>(0.0016)           | -0.0016<br>(0.0024)           | -0.0000<br>(0.0016)           | -0.0009<br>(0.0024)           | -0.0013<br>(0.0016)           | -0.0006<br>(0.0024)           |
| InAssets            | <b>0.0100***</b><br>(0.0011)  | <b>0.0192***</b><br>(0.0040)  | <b>0.0090***</b><br>(0.0008)  | <b>0.0186***</b><br>(0.0041)  | <b>0.0075***</b><br>(0.0010)  | <b>0.0181***</b><br>(0.0041)  | <b>0.0093***</b><br>(0.0009)  | <b>0.0224***</b><br>(0.0039)  | <b>0.0091***</b><br>(0.0006)  | <b>0.0205***</b><br>(0.0039)  | <b>0.0065***</b><br>(0.0009)  | <b>0.0193***</b><br>(0.0039)  |
| TobinsQ             | <b>0.0023***</b><br>(0.0008)  | <b>0.0023*</b><br>(0.0013)    | <b>0.0024***</b><br>(0.0008)  | <b>0.0025*</b><br>(0.0014)    | <b>0.0021***</b><br>(0.0008)  | <b>0.0028**</b><br>(0.0014)   | 0.0013<br>(0.0009)            | 0.0004<br>(0.0013)            | <b>0.0015*</b><br>(0.0009)    | 0.0008<br>(0.0014)            | 0.0007<br>(0.0009)            | 0.0008<br>(0.0014)            |
| ROA                 | <b>0.0504***</b><br>(0.0084)  | <b>0.0270***</b><br>(0.0080)  | <b>0.0280***</b><br>(0.0078)  | 0.0036<br>(0.0095)            | <b>0.0241***</b><br>(0.0077)  | -0.0001<br>(0.0095)           | <b>0.0807***</b><br>(0.0116)  | <b>0.0665***</b><br>(0.0111)  | <b>0.0521***</b><br>(0.0106)  | <b>0.0376***</b><br>(0.0119)  | <b>0.0502***</b><br>(0.0107)  | <b>0.0348***</b><br>(0.0119)  |
| Leverage            | <b>-0.0217***</b><br>(0.0057) | <b>-0.0554***</b><br>(0.0121) | <b>-0.0186***</b><br>(0.0053) | <b>-0.0505***</b><br>(0.0124) | <b>-0.0171***</b><br>(0.0051) | <b>-0.0474***</b><br>(0.0123) | <b>-0.0210***</b><br>(0.0063) | <b>-0.0761***</b><br>(0.0131) | <b>-0.0158***</b><br>(0.0056) | <b>-0.0666***</b><br>(0.0130) | <b>-0.0145***</b><br>(0.0055) | <b>-0.0644***</b><br>(0.0130) |
| CashRatio           | <b>-0.0221***</b><br>(0.0067) | 0.0164<br>(0.0129)            | <b>-0.0191***</b><br>(0.0066) | 0.0130<br>(0.0130)            | <b>-0.0211***</b><br>(0.0068) | 0.0114<br>(0.0129)            | -0.0100<br>(0.0071)           | <b>0.0303**</b><br>(0.0133)   | -0.0015<br>(0.0069)           | <b>0.0275**</b><br>(0.0132)   | -0.0062<br>(0.0072)           | <b>0.0277**</b><br>(0.0131)   |
| Capex               | <b>-0.0709***</b><br>(0.0175) | <b>0.0593*</b><br>(0.0356)    | <b>-0.0601***</b><br>(0.0178) | <b>0.0584*</b><br>(0.0354)    | <b>-0.0630***</b><br>(0.0178) | 0.0467<br>(0.0351)            | <b>-0.0673***</b><br>(0.0180) | 0.0347<br>(0.0395)            | <b>-0.0425**</b><br>(0.0188)  | 0.0405<br>(0.0389)            | <b>-0.0475**</b><br>(0.0187)  | 0.0386<br>(0.0390)            |
| sCFO                | -0.0026<br>(0.0026)           | -0.0035<br>(0.0045)           | 0.0002<br>(0.0024)            | -0.0001<br>(0.0049)           | 0.0004<br>(0.0024)            | -0.0002<br>(0.0049)           | 0.0003<br>(0.0048)            | -0.0006<br>(0.0019)           | 0.0037<br>(0.0054)            | 0.0007<br>(0.0017)            | 0.0036<br>(0.0052)            | 0.0010<br>(0.0017)            |
| Lagged_DV           | <b>0.9062***</b><br>(0.0081)  | <b>0.6999***</b><br>(0.0236)  | <b>0.9022***</b><br>(0.0085)  | <b>0.6941***</b><br>(0.0242)  | <b>0.9017***</b><br>(0.0084)  | <b>0.6949***</b><br>(0.0240)  | <b>0.9154***</b><br>(0.0049)  | <b>0.7272***</b><br>(0.0137)  | <b>0.9107***</b><br>(0.0051)  | <b>0.7237***</b><br>(0.0139)  | <b>0.9103***</b><br>(0.0051)  | <b>0.7235***</b><br>(0.0139)  |
| SalesGrowth         |                               |                               | <b>-0.0074***</b><br>(0.0022) | -0.0032<br>(0.0025)           | <b>-0.0077***</b><br>(0.0022) | -0.0041<br>(0.0026)           |                               |                               | <b>-0.0045*</b><br>(0.0026)   | -0.0025<br>(0.0030)           | -0.0042<br>(0.0026)           | -0.0025<br>(0.0030)           |
| RDSales             |                               |                               | <b>0.0019***</b><br>(0.0006)  | -0.0002<br>(0.0009)           | <b>0.0019***</b><br>(0.0006)  | -0.0006<br>(0.0009)           |                               |                               | <b>0.0027***</b><br>(0.0008)  | 0.0010<br>(0.0011)            | <b>0.0027***</b><br>(0.0008)  | 0.0009<br>(0.0011)            |
| CashFlowAt          |                               |                               | 0.0080<br>(0.0107)            | <b>0.0263*</b><br>(0.0137)    | 0.0043<br>(0.0106)            | <b>0.0253*</b><br>(0.0136)    |                               |                               | 0.0029<br>(0.0137)            | 0.0159<br>(0.0161)            | -0.0019<br>(0.0136)           | 0.0160<br>(0.0161)            |
| DailyVola           |                               |                               | <b>-0.0006***</b><br>(0.0001) | <b>-0.0004***</b><br>(0.0001) | <b>-0.0008***</b><br>(0.0001) | <b>-0.0006***</b><br>(0.0001) |                               |                               | <b>-0.0008***</b><br>(0.0001) | <b>-0.0008***</b><br>(0.0001) | <b>-0.0010***</b><br>(0.0001) | <b>-0.0009***</b><br>(0.0001) |
| Extended Controls   |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| Industry FE         | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               |
| Firm FE             |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |
| Year FE             | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               |
| Year-Quarter FE     |                               |                               |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| N                   | 60,224                        | 60,224                        | 57,777                        | 57,777                        | 57,777                        | 57,777                        | 57,627                        | 57,627                        | 56,535                        | 56,535                        | 56,535                        | 56,535                        |
| R <sup>2</sup>      | 0.846                         | 0.501                         | 0.845                         | 0.495                         | 0.846                         | 0.497                         | 0.860                         | 0.540                         | 0.860                         | 0.540                         | 0.861                         | 0.541                         |
| Adj. R <sup>2</sup> | 0.846                         | 0.486                         | 0.845                         | 0.480                         | 0.846                         | 0.481                         | 0.860                         | 0.526                         | 0.860                         | 0.526                         | 0.860                         | 0.526                         |

Notes: \*  $p < 0.10$ , \*\*  $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\*  $p < 0.01$  (one-tailed for IVs,  $\beta < 0$ ; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms).  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ).

Table 33: H13: Speech Uncertainty and Capital Expenditure

|                     | (1)                           | (2)                           | (3)                           | (4)                           | (5)                           | (6)                           | (7)                           | (8)                           | (9)                           | (10)                          | (11)                          | (12)                          |
|---------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|
|                     | Capex                         |                               |                               |                               |                               |                               | Capex_lead                    |                               |                               |                               |                               |                               |
| UncAnsCEO           | 0.0003<br>(0.0006)            | <b>0.0012**</b><br>(0.0006)   | 0.0003<br>(0.0006)            | <b>0.0011*</b><br>(0.0006)    | 0.0003<br>(0.0006)            | <b>0.0010*</b><br>(0.0006)    | -0.0003<br>(0.0007)           | 0.0005<br>(0.0006)            | -0.0003<br>(0.0007)           | 0.0005<br>(0.0006)            | -0.0003<br>(0.0007)           | 0.0005<br>(0.0006)            |
| UncPreCEO           | 0.0004<br>(0.0006)            | 0.0008<br>(0.0007)            | 0.0005<br>(0.0006)            | 0.0008<br>(0.0007)            | 0.0005<br>(0.0006)            | 0.0008<br>(0.0007)            | 0.0001<br>(0.0009)            | 0.0000<br>(0.0007)            | 0.0001<br>(0.0009)            | 0.0001<br>(0.0007)            | 0.0002<br>(0.0009)            | 0.0001<br>(0.0007)            |
| UncAnsMgr           | 0.0009<br>(0.0008)            | -0.0008<br>(0.0007)           | <b>0.0020**</b><br>(0.0008)   | -0.0007<br>(0.0007)           | 0.0012<br>(0.0008)            | -0.0009<br>(0.0007)           | <b>0.0024**</b><br>(0.0010)   | -0.0000<br>(0.0008)           | <b>0.0049***</b><br>(0.0010)  | 0.0001<br>(0.0008)            | <b>0.0028***</b><br>(0.0010)  | 0.0001<br>(0.0008)            |
| UncPreMgr           | -0.0003<br>(0.0008)           | -0.0011<br>(0.0009)           | -0.0002<br>(0.0008)           | -0.0013<br>(0.0010)           | -0.0010<br>(0.0008)           | -0.0014<br>(0.0009)           | -0.0015<br>(0.0011)           | -0.0017<br>(0.0011)           | 0.0001<br>(0.0011)            | -0.0017<br>(0.0011)           | <b>-0.0020*</b><br>(0.0011)   | -0.0017<br>(0.0011)           |
| lnAssets            | -0.0002<br>(0.0002)           | <b>-0.0014**</b><br>(0.0007)  | <b>0.0003***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>-0.0016**</b><br>(0.0007)  | -0.0003<br>(0.0002)           | <b>-0.0018**</b><br>(0.0007)  | -0.0004<br>(0.0003)           | <b>-0.0018*</b><br>(0.0009)   | <b>0.0007***</b><br>(0.0002)  | <b>-0.0025***</b><br>(0.0009) | <b>-0.0007**</b><br>(0.0003)  | <b>-0.0027***</b><br>(0.0009) |
| TobinsQ             | <b>0.0018***</b><br>(0.0002)  | <b>0.0032***</b><br>(0.0004)  | <b>0.0012***</b><br>(0.0003)  | <b>0.0028***</b><br>(0.0004)  | <b>0.0010***</b><br>(0.0003)  | <b>0.0029***</b><br>(0.0004)  | <b>0.0018***</b><br>(0.0003)  | <b>0.0036***</b><br>(0.0004)  | <b>0.0013***</b><br>(0.0004)  | <b>0.0033***</b><br>(0.0004)  | <b>0.0009***</b><br>(0.0004)  | <b>0.0033***</b><br>(0.0004)  |
| ROA                 | -0.0017<br>(0.0028)           | -0.0019<br>(0.0053)           | <b>-0.0348***</b><br>(0.0061) | <b>-0.0175***</b><br>(0.0065) | <b>-0.0358***</b><br>(0.0061) | <b>-0.0190***</b><br>(0.0065) | <b>0.0187***</b><br>(0.0033)  | <b>0.0332***</b><br>(0.0052)  | <b>-0.0153***</b><br>(0.0047) | <b>0.0189***</b><br>(0.0053)  | <b>-0.0162***</b><br>(0.0047) | <b>0.0164***</b><br>(0.0052)  |
| Leverage            | <b>-0.0045***</b><br>(0.0013) | <b>-0.0225***</b><br>(0.0033) | <b>-0.0037***</b><br>(0.0012) | <b>-0.0223***</b><br>(0.0033) | <b>-0.0033***</b><br>(0.0012) | <b>-0.0213***</b><br>(0.0033) | -0.0005<br>(0.0016)           | <b>-0.0203***</b><br>(0.0033) | 0.0012<br>(0.0016)            | <b>-0.0181***</b><br>(0.0033) | 0.0014<br>(0.0016)            | <b>-0.0177***</b><br>(0.0033) |
| CashRatio           | <b>-0.0095***</b><br>(0.0016) | <b>-0.0156***</b><br>(0.0031) | <b>-0.0088***</b><br>(0.0016) | <b>-0.0149***</b><br>(0.0031) | <b>-0.0095***</b><br>(0.0017) | <b>-0.0140***</b><br>(0.0031) | -0.0033<br>(0.0022)           | 0.0050<br>(0.0038)            | -0.0004<br>(0.0023)           | 0.0056<br>(0.0038)            | <b>-0.0039*</b><br>(0.0024)   | 0.0055<br>(0.0038)            |
| DivDummy            | <b>-0.0013*</b><br>(0.0005)   | <b>0.0021**</b><br>(0.0009)   | -0.0008<br>(0.0005)           | <b>0.0021**</b><br>(0.0010)   | <b>-0.0011**</b><br>(0.0005)  | <b>0.0017*</b><br>(0.0009)    | <b>-0.0025***</b><br>(0.0008) | 0.0002<br>(0.0011)            | <b>-0.0025***</b><br>(0.0008) | -0.0001<br>(0.0011)           | <b>-0.0027***</b><br>(0.0008) | -0.0002<br>(0.0011)           |
| sCFO                | <b>-0.0039**</b><br>(0.0020)  | <b>-0.0069**</b><br>(0.0025)  | <b>-0.0043**</b><br>(0.0018)  | <b>-0.0073***</b><br>(0.0023) | <b>-0.0042**</b><br>(0.0018)  | <b>-0.0071***</b><br>(0.0023) | -0.0016<br>(0.0012)           | <b>-0.0057***</b><br>(0.0017) | -0.0012<br>(0.0014)           | <b>-0.0058***</b><br>(0.0016) | -0.0015<br>(0.0012)           | <b>-0.0057***</b><br>(0.0016) |
| Lagged_DV           | <b>0.7612***</b><br>(0.0150)  | <b>0.3241***</b><br>(0.0224)  | <b>0.7383***</b><br>(0.0152)  | <b>0.3184***</b><br>(0.0225)  | <b>0.7394***</b><br>(0.0155)  | <b>0.3213***</b><br>(0.0225)  | <b>0.6545***</b><br>(0.0198)  | <b>0.0857***</b><br>(0.0193)  | <b>0.6398***</b><br>(0.0194)  | <b>0.0868***</b><br>(0.0196)  | <b>0.6364***</b><br>(0.0199)  | <b>0.0883***</b><br>(0.0196)  |
| SalesGrowth         |                               |                               | <b>0.0092***</b><br>(0.0019)  | <b>0.0067***</b><br>(0.0016)  | <b>0.0083***</b><br>(0.0018)  | <b>0.0059***</b><br>(0.0015)  |                               |                               | <b>0.0096***</b><br>(0.0017)  | <b>0.0058***</b><br>(0.0014)  | <b>0.0089***</b><br>(0.0017)  | <b>0.0054***</b><br>(0.0014)  |
| RDSales             |                               |                               | <b>0.0008***</b><br>(0.0002)  | <b>0.0010***</b><br>(0.0003)  | <b>0.0008***</b><br>(0.0002)  | <b>0.0009***</b><br>(0.0003)  |                               |                               | <b>0.0016***</b><br>(0.0003)  | <b>0.0019***</b><br>(0.0004)  | <b>0.0016***</b><br>(0.0002)  | <b>0.0018***</b><br>(0.0004)  |
| CashFlowAt          |                               |                               | <b>0.0588***</b><br>(0.0065)  | <b>0.0328***</b><br>(0.0064)  | <b>0.0582***</b><br>(0.0065)  | <b>0.0333***</b><br>(0.0064)  |                               |                               | <b>0.0549***</b><br>(0.0062)  | <b>0.0184***</b><br>(0.0066)  | <b>0.0546***</b><br>(0.0062)  | <b>0.0195***</b><br>(0.0066)  |
| DailyVola           |                               |                               | <b>0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0000**</b><br>(0.0000)   | 0.0000<br>(0.0000)            | <b>-0.0000*</b><br>(0.0000)   |                               |                               | <b>-0.0000*</b><br>(0.0000)   | <b>-0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0002***</b><br>(0.0000) |
| Extended Controls   |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| Industry FE         | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               |
| Firm FE             |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |
| Year FE             | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               |
| Year-Quarter FE     |                               |                               |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| N                   | 65,105                        | 65,105                        | 62,482                        | 62,482                        | 62,482                        | 62,482                        | 60,090                        | 60,090                        | 58,897                        | 58,897                        | 58,897                        | 58,897                        |
| R <sup>2</sup>      | 0.617                         | 0.144                         | 0.622                         | 0.148                         | 0.626                         | 0.150                         | 0.490                         | 0.058                         | 0.496                         | 0.070                         | 0.501                         | 0.068                         |
| Adj. R <sup>2</sup> | 0.617                         | 0.120                         | 0.622                         | 0.124                         | 0.625                         | 0.125                         | 0.490                         | 0.031                         | 0.495                         | 0.043                         | 0.500                         | 0.040                         |

Notes: \*  $p < 0.10$ , \*\*  $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\*  $p < 0.01$  (two-tailed). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms).  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ).

Table 34: H13 Robustness: Orthogonal Speaker Partition

|                     | (1)                           | (2)                           | (3)                           | (4)                           | (5)                           | (6)                           | (7)                          | (8)                           | (9)                           | (10)                          | (11)                          | (12)                          |
|---------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|
|                     | Capex                         |                               |                               |                               |                               | Capex_lead                    |                              |                               |                               |                               |                               |                               |
| UncAnsCEO           | <b>0.0008*</b><br>(0.0004)    | <b>0.0007*</b><br>(0.0004)    | <b>0.0014***</b><br>(0.0004)  | 0.0006<br>(0.0004)            | <b>0.0009**</b><br>(0.0004)   | 0.0004<br>(0.0004)            | <b>0.0013**</b><br>(0.0006)  | 0.0007<br>(0.0004)            | <b>0.0028***</b><br>(0.0006)  | 0.0007<br>(0.0004)            | <b>0.0015***</b><br>(0.0006)  | 0.0007<br>(0.0004)            |
| UncAnsNoCEO         | 0.0002<br>(0.0002)            | -0.0001<br>(0.0002)           | <b>0.0005**</b><br>(0.0002)   | -0.0001<br>(0.0002)           | 0.0002<br>(0.0002)            | -0.0001<br>(0.0002)           | <b>0.0007**</b><br>(0.0003)  | 0.0002<br>(0.0003)            | <b>0.0014***</b><br>(0.0003)  | 0.0002<br>(0.0003)            | <b>0.0007**</b><br>(0.0003)   | 0.0002<br>(0.0003)            |
| UncPreCEO           | 0.0002<br>(0.0005)            | 0.0002<br>(0.0005)            | 0.0003<br>(0.0005)            | 0.0002<br>(0.0005)            | -0.0000<br>(0.0005)           | 0.0001<br>(0.0005)            | -0.0005<br>(0.0008)          | -0.0007<br>(0.0006)           | 0.0003<br>(0.0007)            | -0.0006<br>(0.0006)           | -0.0005<br>(0.0008)           | -0.0006<br>(0.0006)           |
| UncPreNoCEO         | -0.0002<br>(0.0004)           | -0.0007<br>(0.0005)           | -0.0000<br>(0.0004)           | <b>-0.0008*</b><br>(0.0005)   | -0.0004<br>(0.0004)           | <b>-0.0008*</b><br>(0.0005)   | -0.0008<br>(0.0005)          | <b>-0.0011**</b><br>(0.0005)  | -0.0001<br>(0.0005)           | <b>-0.0011**</b><br>(0.0006)  | <b>-0.0010*</b><br>(0.0005)   | <b>-0.0011*</b><br>(0.0006)   |
| lnAssets            | -0.0003<br>(0.0002)           | <b>-0.0017**</b><br>(0.0007)  | <b>0.0003***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>-0.0018**</b><br>(0.0008)  | -0.0003<br>(0.0002)           | <b>-0.0020***</b><br>(0.0008) | <b>-0.0005*</b><br>(0.0003)  | -0.0015<br>(0.0009)           | <b>0.0007***</b><br>(0.0002)  | <b>-0.0022**</b><br>(0.0009)  | <b>-0.0007**</b><br>(0.0003)  | <b>-0.0023**</b><br>(0.0009)  |
| TobinsQ             | <b>0.0017***</b><br>(0.0002)  | <b>0.0031***</b><br>(0.0004)  | <b>0.0012***</b><br>(0.0003)  | <b>0.0027***</b><br>(0.0004)  | <b>0.0010***</b><br>(0.0003)  | <b>0.0028***</b><br>(0.0004)  | <b>0.0018***</b><br>(0.0003) | <b>0.0035***</b><br>(0.0004)  | <b>0.0014***</b><br>(0.0004)  | <b>0.0032***</b><br>(0.0004)  | <b>0.0010***</b><br>(0.0004)  | <b>0.0033***</b><br>(0.0004)  |
| ROA                 | -0.0012<br>(0.0028)           | -0.0022<br>(0.0053)           | <b>-0.0330***</b><br>(0.0058) | <b>-0.0171***</b><br>(0.0064) | <b>-0.0341***</b><br>(0.0058) | <b>-0.0186***</b><br>(0.0064) | <b>0.0193***</b><br>(0.0034) | <b>0.0332***</b><br>(0.0052)  | <b>-0.0130***</b><br>(0.0047) | <b>0.0194***</b><br>(0.0052)  | <b>-0.0141***</b><br>(0.0047) | <b>0.0170***</b><br>(0.0052)  |
| Leverage            | <b>-0.0042***</b><br>(0.0013) | <b>-0.0218***</b><br>(0.0032) | <b>-0.0035***</b><br>(0.0012) | <b>-0.0218***</b><br>(0.0032) | <b>-0.0031***</b><br>(0.0011) | <b>-0.0208***</b><br>(0.0032) | -0.0000<br>(0.0016)          | <b>-0.0200***</b><br>(0.0034) | 0.0015<br>(0.0016)            | <b>-0.0179***</b><br>(0.0034) | 0.0017<br>(0.0016)            | <b>-0.0175***</b><br>(0.0034) |
| CashRatio           | <b>-0.0093***</b><br>(0.0016) | <b>-0.0163***</b><br>(0.0030) | <b>-0.0088***</b><br>(0.0016) | <b>-0.0154***</b><br>(0.0031) | <b>-0.0095***</b><br>(0.0017) | <b>-0.0146***</b><br>(0.0031) | -0.0037<br>(0.0023)          | 0.0041<br>(0.0038)            | -0.0009<br>(0.0023)           | 0.0048<br>(0.0038)            | <b>-0.0045*</b><br>(0.0024)   | 0.0047<br>(0.0038)            |
| DivDummy            | <b>-0.0013*</b><br>(0.0005)   | <b>0.0020**</b><br>(0.0009)   | -0.0008<br>(0.0006)           | <b>0.0020**</b><br>(0.0010)   | <b>-0.0011**</b><br>(0.0006)  | <b>0.0016*</b><br>(0.0010)    | <b>-0.0024**</b><br>(0.0008) | -0.0000<br>(0.0011)           | <b>-0.0024***</b><br>(0.0008) | -0.0003<br>(0.0011)           | <b>-0.0025***</b><br>(0.0008) | -0.0004<br>(0.0011)           |
| sCFO                | <b>-0.0040**</b><br>(0.0020)  | <b>-0.0067**</b><br>(0.0026)  | <b>-0.0041**</b><br>(0.0020)  | <b>-0.0071***</b><br>(0.0023) | <b>-0.0041**</b><br>(0.0020)  | <b>-0.0070***</b><br>(0.0024) | -0.0016<br>(0.0012)          | <b>-0.0054***</b><br>(0.0017) | -0.0012<br>(0.0014)           | <b>-0.0055***</b><br>(0.0016) | -0.0015<br>(0.0012)           | <b>-0.0054***</b><br>(0.0016) |
| Lagged_DV           | <b>0.7638***</b><br>(0.0149)  | <b>0.3251***</b><br>(0.0231)  | <b>0.7405***</b><br>(0.0152)  | <b>0.3160***</b><br>(0.0235)  | <b>0.7416***</b><br>(0.0154)  | <b>0.3191***</b><br>(0.0234)  | <b>0.6601***</b><br>(0.0199) | <b>0.0909***</b><br>(0.0195)  | <b>0.6463***</b><br>(0.0196)  | <b>0.0908***</b><br>(0.0197)  | <b>0.6425***</b><br>(0.0201)  | <b>0.0921***</b><br>(0.0197)  |
| SalesGrowth         |                               |                               | <b>0.0082***</b><br>(0.0017)  | <b>0.0059***</b><br>(0.0015)  | <b>0.0074***</b><br>(0.0016)  | <b>0.0051***</b><br>(0.0015)  |                              |                               | <b>0.0090***</b><br>(0.0017)  | <b>0.0057***</b><br>(0.0014)  | <b>0.0083***</b><br>(0.0016)  | <b>0.0053***</b><br>(0.0013)  |
| RDSales             |                               |                               | <b>0.0008***</b><br>(0.0003)  | <b>0.0010***</b><br>(0.0004)  | <b>0.0008***</b><br>(0.0003)  | <b>0.0008***</b><br>(0.0004)  |                              |                               | <b>0.0018***</b><br>(0.0003)  | <b>0.0022***</b><br>(0.0005)  | <b>0.0018***</b><br>(0.0003)  | <b>0.0020***</b><br>(0.0005)  |
| CashFlowAt          |                               |                               | <b>0.0574***</b><br>(0.0062)  | <b>0.0322***</b><br>(0.0065)  | <b>0.0567***</b><br>(0.0062)  | <b>0.0327***</b><br>(0.0064)  |                              |                               | <b>0.0527***</b><br>(0.0062)  | <b>0.0173***</b><br>(0.0065)  | <b>0.0523***</b><br>(0.0062)  | <b>0.0184***</b><br>(0.0065)  |
| DailyVola           |                               |                               | <b>0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0000**</b><br>(0.0000)   | 0.0000<br>(0.0000)            | -0.0000<br>(0.0000)           |                              |                               | -0.0000<br>(0.0000)           | <b>-0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0002***</b><br>(0.0000) |
| Extended Controls   |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                              |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| Industry FE         | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                          |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               |
| Firm FE             |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                              | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |
| Year FE             | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                          | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               |
| Year-Quarter FE     |                               |                               |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |                              |                               |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| N                   | 61,097                        | 61,097                        | 58,659                        | 58,659                        | 58,659                        | 58,659                        | 56,394                       | 56,394                        | 55,299                        | 55,299                        | 55,299                        | 55,299                        |
| R <sup>2</sup>      | 0.618                         | 0.143                         | 0.622                         | 0.145                         | 0.626                         | 0.147                         | 0.494                        | 0.059                         | 0.498                         | 0.070                         | 0.503                         | 0.069                         |
| Adj. R <sup>2</sup> | 0.618                         | 0.118                         | 0.622                         | 0.119                         | 0.625                         | 0.121                         | 0.494                        | 0.031                         | 0.498                         | 0.042                         | 0.502                         | 0.039                         |

Notes: \*  $p < 0.10$ , \*\*  $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\*  $p < 0.01$  (two-tailed). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms).  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ).

Table 35: H13.1: Product Similarity–Moderated Speech Uncertainty and Capital Expenditure

|                         | (1)                           | (2)                           | (3)                           | (4)                           | (5)                           | (6)                           | (7)                           | (8)                           |
|-------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|
|                         | Capex                         |                               |                               |                               | Capex_lead                    |                               |                               |                               |
| UncAnsMgr_c             | <b>0.0010**</b><br>(0.0005)   | 0.0002<br>(0.0004)            | <b>0.0010**</b><br>(0.0005)   | -0.0000<br>(0.0004)           | <b>0.0017***</b><br>(0.0007)  | 0.0005<br>(0.0006)            | <b>0.0017***</b><br>(0.0007)  | 0.0004<br>(0.0006)            |
| z_log_TotalSimilarity   | <b>0.0020***</b><br>(0.0004)  | 0.0010<br>(0.0010)            | <b>0.0021***</b><br>(0.0004)  | 0.0010<br>(0.0010)            | <b>0.0027***</b><br>(0.0006)  | <b>0.0024**</b><br>(0.0012)   | <b>0.0027***</b><br>(0.0006)  | <b>0.0024**</b><br>(0.0012)   |
| UncAnsMgr_c_x_zlogTSIMM | <b>0.0012**</b><br>(0.0006)   | <b>0.0013**</b><br>(0.0006)   | <b>0.0011**</b><br>(0.0006)   | <b>0.0013**</b><br>(0.0006)   | <b>0.0024***</b><br>(0.0009)  | <b>0.0025***</b><br>(0.0009)  | <b>0.0023***</b><br>(0.0009)  | <b>0.0024***</b><br>(0.0009)  |
| InAssets                | <b>-0.0004*</b><br>(0.0002)   | <b>-0.0019**</b><br>(0.0007)  | <b>-0.0005**</b><br>(0.0002)  | <b>-0.0021***</b><br>(0.0007) | <b>-0.0009***</b><br>(0.0003) | <b>-0.0028***</b><br>(0.0009) | <b>-0.0009***</b><br>(0.0003) | <b>-0.0029***</b><br>(0.0009) |
| TobinsQ                 | <b>0.0010***</b><br>(0.0002)  | <b>0.0026***</b><br>(0.0004)  | <b>0.0010***</b><br>(0.0002)  | <b>0.0027***</b><br>(0.0004)  | <b>0.0008*</b><br>(0.0003)    | <b>0.0031***</b><br>(0.0004)  | <b>0.0008***</b><br>(0.0003)  | <b>0.0031***</b><br>(0.0004)  |
| ROA                     | <b>-0.0300***</b><br>(0.0054) | <b>-0.0152***</b><br>(0.0058) | <b>-0.0315***</b><br>(0.0054) | <b>-0.0168***</b><br>(0.0058) | <b>-0.0122***</b><br>(0.0042) | <b>0.0177***</b><br>(0.0048)  | <b>-0.0142***</b><br>(0.0042) | <b>0.0152***</b><br>(0.0048)  |
| Leverage                | <b>-0.0034***</b><br>(0.0011) | <b>-0.0205***</b><br>(0.0028) | <b>-0.0031***</b><br>(0.0011) | <b>-0.0196***</b><br>(0.0027) | 0.0013<br>(0.0017)            | <b>-0.0170***</b><br>(0.0029) | 0.0013<br>(0.0016)            | <b>-0.0166***</b><br>(0.0029) |
| CashRatio               | <b>-0.0126***</b><br>(0.0018) | <b>-0.0122***</b><br>(0.0032) | <b>-0.0121***</b><br>(0.0018) | <b>-0.0114***</b><br>(0.0032) | <b>-0.0081***</b><br>(0.0023) | 0.0059<br>(0.0037)            | <b>-0.0080***</b><br>(0.0023) | 0.0059<br>(0.0037)            |
| DivDummy                | -0.0002<br>(0.0005)           | 0.0014<br>(0.0009)            | -0.0004<br>(0.0005)           | 0.0011<br>(0.0009)            | <b>-0.0017**</b><br>(0.0007)  | -0.0003<br>(0.0011)           | <b>-0.0016**</b><br>(0.0007)  | -0.0004<br>(0.0010)           |
| sCFO                    | <b>-0.0040**</b><br>(0.0018)  | <b>-0.0058**</b><br>(0.0027)  | <b>-0.0039**</b><br>(0.0017)  | <b>-0.0058**</b><br>(0.0026)  | <b>-0.0017*</b><br>(0.0010)   | <b>-0.0043**</b><br>(0.0021)  | -0.0016<br>(0.0010)           | <b>-0.0042**</b><br>(0.0021)  |
| SalesGrowth             | <b>0.0065***</b><br>(0.0013)  | <b>0.0051***</b><br>(0.0013)  | <b>0.0059***</b><br>(0.0012)  | <b>0.0045***</b><br>(0.0013)  | <b>0.0067***</b><br>(0.0012)  | <b>0.0046***</b><br>(0.0011)  | <b>0.0062***</b><br>(0.0011)  | <b>0.0043***</b><br>(0.0011)  |
| RDSales                 | <b>0.0005**</b><br>(0.0003)   | <b>0.0008***</b><br>(0.0004)  | <b>0.0005*</b><br>(0.0002)    | <b>0.0007*</b><br>(0.0004)    | <b>0.0012***</b><br>(0.0004)  | <b>0.0017***</b><br>(0.0006)  | <b>0.0012***</b><br>(0.0004)  | <b>0.0016**</b><br>(0.0006)   |
| CashFlowAt              | <b>0.0520***</b><br>(0.0060)  | <b>0.0320***</b><br>(0.0064)  | <b>0.0531***</b><br>(0.0059)  | <b>0.0326***</b><br>(0.0064)  | <b>0.0500***</b><br>(0.0054)  | <b>0.0193***</b><br>(0.0063)  | <b>0.0517***</b><br>(0.0054)  | <b>0.0205***</b><br>(0.0063)  |
| DailyVola               | <b>0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000)  | 0.0000<br>(0.0000)            | <b>-0.0000**</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>-0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0002***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0002***</b><br>(0.0000) |
| Lagged_DV               | <b>0.7311***</b><br>(0.0150)  | <b>0.3325***</b><br>(0.0221)  | <b>0.7337***</b><br>(0.0150)  | <b>0.3354***</b><br>(0.0221)  | <b>0.6234***</b><br>(0.0192)  | <b>0.0949***</b><br>(0.0187)  | <b>0.6251***</b><br>(0.0192)  | <b>0.0969***</b><br>(0.0187)  |
| Industry FE             | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               |
| Firm FE                 |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |
| Year FE                 | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               |
| Year-Quarter FE         |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| N                       | 73,673                        | 73,673                        | 73,673                        | 73,673                        | 69,580                        | 69,580                        | 69,580                        | 69,580                        |
| R <sup>2</sup>          | 0.620                         | 0.156                         | 0.623                         | 0.159                         | 0.494                         | 0.071                         | 0.497                         | 0.070                         |
| Adj. R <sup>2</sup>     | 0.620                         | 0.135                         | 0.623                         | 0.137                         | 0.494                         | 0.047                         | 0.496                         | 0.045                         |

Notes: \*  $p < 0.10$ , \*\*  $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\*  $p < 0.01$  (one-tailed for IVs,  $\beta > 0$ ; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms).  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ).

Table 36: H13.1.r: Product Similarity–Moderated Speech Uncertainty and Capital Expenditure (Robustness: CEO Q&amp;A Speaker Partition)

|                         | (1)                           | (2)                           | (3)                           | (4)                           | (5)                           | (6)                           | (7)                           | (8)                           |
|-------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|
|                         | Capex                         |                               |                               |                               | Capex_lead                    |                               |                               |                               |
| UncAnsCEO_c             | <b>0.0010**</b><br>(0.0004)   | <b>0.0006*</b><br>(0.0004)    | <b>0.0010**</b><br>(0.0004)   | 0.0005<br>(0.0004)            | <b>0.0012**</b><br>(0.0006)   | 0.0004<br>(0.0005)            | <b>0.0013**</b><br>(0.0006)   | 0.0004<br>(0.0005)            |
| z_log_TotalSimilarity   | <b>0.0022***</b><br>(0.0004)  | 0.0010<br>(0.0011)            | <b>0.0022***</b><br>(0.0004)  | 0.0010<br>(0.0011)            | <b>0.0030***</b><br>(0.0006)  | <b>0.0024**</b><br>(0.0013)   | <b>0.0030***</b><br>(0.0006)  | <b>0.0024**</b><br>(0.0013)   |
| UncAnsCEO_c.x_zlogTSIMM | 0.0006<br>(0.0006)            | 0.0006<br>(0.0005)            | 0.0006<br>(0.0006)            | 0.0006<br>(0.0005)            | <b>0.0014**</b><br>(0.0009)   | <b>0.0015**</b><br>(0.0008)   | <b>0.0014*</b><br>(0.0009)    | <b>0.0014**</b><br>(0.0008)   |
| lnAssets                | -0.0003<br>(0.0002)           | <b>-0.0021**</b><br>(0.0009)  | <b>-0.0004**</b><br>(0.0002)  | <b>-0.0022***</b><br>(0.0009) | <b>-0.0009***</b><br>(0.0003) | <b>-0.0032***</b><br>(0.0010) | <b>-0.0009***</b><br>(0.0003) | <b>-0.0033***</b><br>(0.0010) |
| TobinsQ                 | <b>0.0010***</b><br>(0.0003)  | <b>0.0027***</b><br>(0.0004)  | <b>0.0010***</b><br>(0.0003)  | <b>0.0028***</b><br>(0.0004)  | <b>0.0009**</b><br>(0.0004)   | <b>0.0032***</b><br>(0.0004)  | <b>0.0009**</b><br>(0.0004)   | <b>0.0032***</b><br>(0.0004)  |
| ROA                     | <b>-0.0324***</b><br>(0.0061) | <b>-0.0173***</b><br>(0.0067) | <b>-0.0338***</b><br>(0.0060) | <b>-0.0188***</b><br>(0.0067) | <b>-0.0122***</b><br>(0.0047) | <b>0.0192***</b><br>(0.0055)  | <b>-0.0142***</b><br>(0.0047) | <b>0.0167***</b><br>(0.0054)  |
| Leverage                | <b>-0.0040***</b><br>(0.0011) | <b>-0.0214***</b><br>(0.0032) | <b>-0.0037***</b><br>(0.0011) | <b>-0.0204***</b><br>(0.0032) | 0.0010<br>(0.0018)            | <b>-0.0173***</b><br>(0.0032) | 0.0010<br>(0.0018)            | <b>-0.0169***</b><br>(0.0032) |
| CashRatio               | <b>-0.0133***</b><br>(0.0019) | <b>-0.0144***</b><br>(0.0037) | <b>-0.0128***</b><br>(0.0019) | <b>-0.0135***</b><br>(0.0036) | <b>-0.0082***</b><br>(0.0025) | 0.0062<br>(0.0043)            | <b>-0.0082***</b><br>(0.0025) | 0.0061<br>(0.0043)            |
| DivDummy                | -0.0004<br>(0.0005)           | <b>0.0017*</b><br>(0.0010)    | -0.0007<br>(0.0005)           | 0.0014<br>(0.0010)            | <b>-0.0020**</b><br>(0.0008)  | -0.0002<br>(0.0011)           | <b>-0.0019**</b><br>(0.0008)  | -0.0002<br>(0.0011)           |
| sCFO                    | <b>-0.0047***</b><br>(0.0016) | <b>-0.0074***</b><br>(0.0022) | <b>-0.0045***</b><br>(0.0017) | <b>-0.0073***</b><br>(0.0023) | <b>-0.0020*</b><br>(0.0010)   | <b>-0.0058***</b><br>(0.0016) | <b>-0.0019*</b><br>(0.0011)   | <b>-0.0057***</b><br>(0.0016) |
| SalesGrowth             | <b>0.0086***</b><br>(0.0018)  | <b>0.0066***</b><br>(0.0016)  | <b>0.0078***</b><br>(0.0017)  | <b>0.0058***</b><br>(0.0015)  | <b>0.0091***</b><br>(0.0017)  | <b>0.0061***</b><br>(0.0014)  | <b>0.0085***</b><br>(0.0016)  | <b>0.0057***</b><br>(0.0014)  |
| RDSales                 | <b>0.0006**</b><br>(0.0002)   | <b>0.0010***</b><br>(0.0003)  | <b>0.0005**</b><br>(0.0002)   | <b>0.0009***</b><br>(0.0003)  | <b>0.0014***</b><br>(0.0003)  | <b>0.0019***</b><br>(0.0004)  | <b>0.0013***</b><br>(0.0003)  | <b>0.0018***</b><br>(0.0004)  |
| CashFlowAt              | <b>0.0562***</b><br>(0.0064)  | <b>0.0345***</b><br>(0.0073)  | <b>0.0563***</b><br>(0.0064)  | <b>0.0350***</b><br>(0.0072)  | <b>0.0509***</b><br>(0.0061)  | <b>0.0203***</b><br>(0.0074)  | <b>0.0526***</b><br>(0.0061)  | <b>0.0214***</b><br>(0.0074)  |
| DailyVola               | <b>0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0000**</b><br>(0.0000)   | 0.0000<br>(0.0000)            | <b>-0.0000*</b><br>(0.0000)   | <b>-0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0002***</b><br>(0.0000) |
| Lagged_DV               | <b>0.7326***</b><br>(0.0157)  | <b>0.3280***</b><br>(0.0242)  | <b>0.7354***</b><br>(0.0156)  | <b>0.3310***</b><br>(0.0242)  | <b>0.6278***</b><br>(0.0199)  | <b>0.0933***</b><br>(0.0208)  | <b>0.6293***</b><br>(0.0199)  | <b>0.0948***</b><br>(0.0208)  |
| Industry FE             | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               |
| Firm FE                 |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |
| Year FE                 | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               |
| Year-Quarter FE         |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| N                       | 63,716                        | 63,716                        | 63,716                        | 63,716                        | 60,094                        | 60,094                        | 60,094                        | 60,094                        |
| R <sup>2</sup>          | 0.625                         | 0.154                         | 0.629                         | 0.157                         | 0.501                         | 0.074                         | 0.503                         | 0.072                         |
| Adj. R <sup>2</sup>     | 0.625                         | 0.130                         | 0.628                         | 0.132                         | 0.501                         | 0.047                         | 0.503                         | 0.044                         |

Notes: \*  $p < 0.10$ , \*\*  $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\*  $p < 0.01$  (one-tailed for IVs,  $\beta > 0$ ; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms).  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ).

Table 37: H13.2: Speech Uncertainty and Capital Expenditure — Lead Horizons

|                     | (1)                           | (2)                           | (3)                           | (4)                           | (5)                           | (6)                           | (7)                           | (8)                           | (9)                           | (10)                          | (11)                          | (12)                          | (13)                          | (14)                          | (15)                          | (16)                          |
|---------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|
|                     |                               | Capex_lead                    |                               |                               |                               | Capex_lead2                   |                               |                               |                               | Capex_lead3                   |                               |                               |                               | Capex_lead4                   |                               |                               |
| UncAnsCEO           | -0.0003<br>(0.0007)           | 0.0005<br>(0.0006)            | -0.0003<br>(0.0007)           | 0.0005<br>(0.0006)            | -0.0010<br>(0.0008)           | -0.0002<br>(0.0007)           | -0.0010<br>(0.0008)           | -0.0002<br>(0.0007)           | -0.0013<br>(0.0010)           | -0.0008<br>(0.0008)           | -0.0012<br>(0.0010)           | -0.0008<br>(0.0008)           | -0.0011<br>(0.0010)           | -0.0008<br>(0.0006)           | -0.0011<br>(0.0010)           | -0.0009<br>(0.0006)           |
| UncPreCEO           | 0.0001<br>(0.0009)            | 0.0001<br>(0.0007)            | 0.0002<br>(0.0009)            | 0.0001<br>(0.0007)            | -0.0005<br>(0.0010)           | -0.0006<br>(0.0008)           | -0.0006<br>(0.0010)           | -0.0007<br>(0.0008)           | -0.0016<br>(0.0012)           | -0.0012<br>(0.0008)           | -0.0015<br>(0.0012)           | -0.0012<br>(0.0008)           | -0.0013<br>(0.0013)           | -0.0004<br>(0.0008)           | -0.0012<br>(0.0013)           | -0.0004<br>(0.0008)           |
| UncAnsMgr           | <b>0.0049***</b><br>(0.0010)  | 0.0001<br>(0.0008)            | <b>0.0028***</b><br>(0.0010)  | 0.0001<br>(0.0008)            | <b>0.0036***</b><br>(0.0011)  | 0.0004<br>(0.0009)            | <b>0.0035***</b><br>(0.0011)  | 0.0003<br>(0.0009)            | <b>0.0070***</b><br>(0.0014)  | <b>0.0019*</b><br>(0.0010)    | <b>0.0049***</b><br>(0.0013)  | <b>0.0018*</b><br>(0.0010)    | <b>0.0071***</b><br>(0.0014)  | 0.0016<br>(0.0010)            | <b>0.0048***</b><br>(0.0014)  | 0.0015<br>(0.0010)            |
| UncPreMgr           | 0.0001<br>(0.0011)            | -0.0017<br>(0.0011)           | <b>-0.0020*</b><br>(0.0011)   | -0.0017<br>(0.0011)           | -0.0010<br>(0.0014)           | 0.0005<br>(0.0012)            | -0.0009<br>(0.0014)           | 0.0005<br>(0.0012)            | 0.0022<br>(0.0015)            | 0.0016<br>(0.0011)            | 0.0002<br>(0.0016)            | 0.0016<br>(0.0011)            | 0.0023<br>(0.0017)            | 0.0010<br>(0.0012)            | 0.0001<br>(0.0018)            | 0.0010<br>(0.0012)            |
| InAssets            | <b>0.0007***</b><br>(0.0002)  | <b>-0.0025***</b><br>(0.0003) | <b>-0.0007**</b><br>(0.0003)  | <b>-0.0027***</b><br>(0.0003) | <b>-0.0009**</b><br>(0.0003)  | <b>-0.0052***</b><br>(0.0011) | <b>-0.0009**</b><br>(0.0003)  | <b>-0.0052***</b><br>(0.0011) | <b>0.0006**</b><br>(0.0002)   | <b>-0.0065***</b><br>(0.0013) | <b>-0.0008**</b><br>(0.0004)  | <b>-0.0065***</b><br>(0.0013) | <b>0.0005**</b><br>(0.0003)   | <b>-0.0061***</b><br>(0.0013) | <b>-0.0010**</b><br>(0.0005)  | <b>-0.0062***</b><br>(0.0013) |
| TobinsQ             | <b>0.0013***</b><br>(0.0004)  | <b>0.0033***</b><br>(0.0004)  | <b>0.0009***</b><br>(0.0004)  | <b>0.0033***</b><br>(0.0004)  | 0.0005<br>(0.0004)            | <b>0.0018***</b><br>(0.0004)  | 0.0005<br>(0.0004)            | <b>0.0020***</b><br>(0.0004)  | 0.0003<br>(0.0004)            | 0.0004<br>(0.0004)            | -0.0001<br>(0.0004)           | 0.0005<br>(0.0004)            | -0.0002<br>(0.0004)           | -0.0002<br>(0.0003)           | -0.0006<br>(0.0004)           | -0.0002<br>(0.0004)           |
| ROA                 | <b>-0.0153***</b><br>(0.0047) | <b>0.0189***</b><br>(0.0053)  | <b>-0.0162***</b><br>(0.0047) | <b>0.0164***</b><br>(0.0052)  | <b>-0.0289***</b><br>(0.0052) | 0.0074<br>(0.0046)            | <b>-0.0293***</b><br>(0.0052) | 0.0070<br>(0.0046)            | <b>-0.0376***</b><br>(0.0057) | -0.0013<br>(0.0045)           | <b>-0.0370***</b><br>(0.0057) | -0.0011<br>(0.0045)           | <b>-0.0364***</b><br>(0.0063) | -0.0019<br>(0.0042)           | <b>-0.0364***</b><br>(0.0063) | -0.0024<br>(0.0042)           |
| Leverage            | 0.0012<br>(0.0016)            | <b>-0.0181***</b><br>(0.0033) | 0.0014<br>(0.0016)            | <b>-0.0177***</b><br>(0.0033) | <b>0.0052***</b><br>(0.0020)  | <b>-0.0126***</b><br>(0.0034) | <b>0.0053***</b><br>(0.0020)  | <b>-0.0121***</b><br>(0.0034) | <b>0.0069***</b><br>(0.0024)  | <b>-0.0074**</b><br>(0.0033)  | <b>0.0070***</b><br>(0.0024)  | <b>-0.0070**</b><br>(0.0033)  | <b>0.0091***</b><br>(0.0026)  | -0.0027<br>(0.0035)           | <b>0.0093***</b><br>(0.0026)  | -0.0026<br>(0.0035)           |
| CashRatio           | -0.0004<br>(0.0023)           | 0.0056<br>(0.0038)            | <b>-0.0039*</b><br>(0.0024)   | 0.0055<br>(0.0038)            | -0.0022<br>(0.0028)           | <b>0.0082**</b><br>(0.0039)   | -0.0022<br>(0.0028)           | <b>0.0083**</b><br>(0.0039)   | 0.0004<br>(0.0031)            | 0.0054<br>(0.0035)            | -0.0032<br>(0.0032)           | 0.0050<br>(0.0035)            | -0.0005<br>(0.0035)           | 0.0034<br>(0.0035)            | -0.0041<br>(0.0036)           | 0.0038<br>(0.0036)            |
| DivDummy            | <b>-0.0025***</b><br>(0.0008) | -0.0001<br>(0.0011)           | <b>-0.0027***</b><br>(0.0008) | -0.0002<br>(0.0011)           | <b>-0.0023**</b><br>(0.0010)  | 0.0005<br>(0.0013)            | <b>-0.0023**</b><br>(0.0009)  | 0.0004<br>(0.0013)            | -0.0017<br>(0.0011)           | -0.0010<br>(0.0012)           | <b>-0.0020*</b><br>(0.0011)   | -0.0010<br>(0.0012)           | -0.0015<br>(0.0012)           | -0.0018<br>(0.0012)           | -0.0017<br>(0.0012)           | -0.0017<br>(0.0012)           |
| sCFO                | -0.0012<br>(0.0014)           | <b>-0.0058***</b><br>(0.0016) | -0.0015<br>(0.0012)           | <b>-0.0057***</b><br>(0.0016) | <b>0.0021**</b><br>(0.0010)   | -0.0014<br>(0.0010)           | <b>0.0022**</b><br>(0.0010)   | -0.0013<br>(0.0010)           | <b>0.0054***</b><br>(0.0019)  | <b>0.0028**</b><br>(0.0013)   | <b>0.0051**</b><br>(0.0020)   | <b>0.0027**</b><br>(0.0013)   | <b>0.0068***</b><br>(0.0020)  | <b>0.0049***</b><br>(0.0013)  | <b>0.0064***</b><br>(0.0021)  | <b>0.0049***</b><br>(0.0013)  |
| Lagged_DV           | <b>0.6398***</b><br>(0.0194)  | <b>0.0868***</b><br>(0.0196)  | <b>0.6364***</b><br>(0.0199)  | <b>0.0883***</b><br>(0.0196)  | <b>0.5626***</b><br>(0.0215)  | <b>-0.0351*</b><br>(0.0184)   | <b>0.5645***</b><br>(0.0216)  | <b>-0.0343*</b><br>(0.0184)   | <b>0.5206***</b><br>(0.0248)  | <b>-0.0774***</b><br>(0.0180) | <b>0.5175***</b><br>(0.0253)  | <b>-0.0782***</b><br>(0.0180) | <b>0.4968***</b><br>(0.0252)  | <b>-0.0641***</b><br>(0.0201) | <b>0.4939***</b><br>(0.0256)  | <b>-0.0625***</b><br>(0.0203) |
| SalesGrowth         | <b>0.0096***</b><br>(0.0017)  | <b>0.0058***</b><br>(0.0014)  | <b>0.0089***</b><br>(0.0017)  | <b>0.0054***</b><br>(0.0014)  | <b>0.0061***</b><br>(0.0016)  | <b>0.0023*</b><br>(0.0012)    | <b>0.0057***</b><br>(0.0016)  | <b>0.0023*</b><br>(0.0012)    | <b>0.0054***</b><br>(0.0020)  | 0.0011<br>(0.0010)            | <b>0.0050**</b><br>(0.0020)   | 0.0013<br>(0.0011)            | <b>0.0044**</b><br>(0.0019)   | -0.0000<br>(0.0010)           | <b>0.0037**</b><br>(0.0018)   | -0.0001<br>(0.0010)           |
| RDSales             | <b>0.0016***</b><br>(0.0003)  | <b>0.0019***</b><br>(0.0004)  | <b>0.0016***</b><br>(0.0002)  | <b>0.0018***</b><br>(0.0004)  | <b>0.0017**</b><br>(0.0007)   | <b>0.0020*</b><br>(0.0011)    | <b>0.0017**</b><br>(0.0007)   | <b>0.0021*</b><br>(0.0011)    | <b>0.0007**</b><br>(0.0003)   | -0.0001<br>(0.0007)           | <b>0.0007**</b><br>(0.0003)   | -0.0000<br>(0.0007)           | 0.0010<br>(0.0007)            | <b>0.0010*</b><br>(0.0005)    | 0.0010<br>(0.0007)            | <b>0.0009*</b><br>(0.0005)    |
| CashFlowAt          | <b>0.0549***</b><br>(0.0062)  | <b>0.0184***</b><br>(0.0066)  | <b>0.0546***</b><br>(0.0062)  | <b>0.0195***</b><br>(0.0066)  | <b>0.0687***</b><br>(0.0067)  | <b>0.0226***</b><br>(0.0058)  | <b>0.0689***</b><br>(0.0067)  | <b>0.0220***</b><br>(0.0057)  | <b>0.0769***</b><br>(0.0075)  | <b>0.0167***</b><br>(0.0056)  | <b>0.0743***</b><br>(0.0074)  | <b>0.0154***</b><br>(0.0056)  | <b>0.0725***</b><br>(0.0089)  | <b>0.0102*</b><br>(0.0060)    | <b>0.0707***</b><br>(0.0089)  | <b>0.0101*</b><br>(0.0060)    |
| Daily Vola          | <b>-0.0000*</b><br>(0.0000)   | <b>-0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0002***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000)  | -0.0000<br>(0.0000)           | -0.0000<br>(0.0000)           | <b>-0.0000**</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000)  | 0.0000<br>(0.0000)            | 0.0000<br>(0.0000)            | -0.0000<br>(0.0000)           |
| Industry FE         | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               |
| Firm FE             |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |
| Year FE             | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               |
| Year-Quarter FE     |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| N                   | 58,897                        | 58,897                        | 58,897                        | 58,897                        | 52,648                        | 52,648                        | 52,648                        | 52,648                        | 46,679                        | 46,679                        | 46,679                        | 46,679                        | 41,091                        | 41,091                        | 41,091                        | 41,091                        |
| R <sup>2</sup>      | 0.496                         | 0.070                         | 0.501                         | 0.068                         | 0.426                         | 0.034                         | 0.428                         | 0.035                         | 0.381                         | 0.022                         | 0.386                         | 0.023                         | 0.361                         | 0.016                         | 0.366                         | 0.016                         |
| Adj. R <sup>2</sup> | 0.495                         | 0.043                         | 0.500                         | 0.040                         | 0.425                         | 0.005                         | 0.427                         | 0.004                         | 0.381                         | -0.009                        | 0.384                         | -0.010                        | 0.360                         | -0.019                        | 0.365                         | -0.020                        |

Notes: \*  $p < 0.10$ , \*\*  $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\*  $p < 0.01$  (two-tailed). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms).  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ).



Table 38: H13.2 Robustness: Orthogonal Speaker Partition

|                     | (1)                           | (2)                           | (3)                           | (4)                           | (5)                           | (6)                           | (7)                           | (8)                           | (9)                           | (10)                          | (11)                          | (12)                          | (13)                          | (14)                          | (15)                          | (16)                          |
|---------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|
|                     |                               | Capex_lead                    |                               |                               |                               | Capex_lead2                   |                               |                               |                               | Capex_lead3                   |                               |                               |                               | Capex_lead4                   |                               |                               |
| UncAnsCEO           | <b>0.0028***</b><br>(0.0006)  | 0.0007<br>(0.0004)            | <b>0.0015***</b><br>(0.0006)  | 0.0007<br>(0.0004)            | 0.0010<br>(0.0007)            | -0.0001<br>(0.0005)           | 0.0010<br>(0.0007)            | -0.0002<br>(0.0005)           | <b>0.0029***</b><br>(0.0008)  | 0.0003<br>(0.0006)            | <b>0.0017**</b><br>(0.0008)   | 0.0003<br>(0.0006)            | <b>0.0032***</b><br>(0.0009)  | 0.0002<br>(0.0005)            | <b>0.0018**</b><br>(0.0009)   | 0.0001<br>(0.0005)            |
| UncAnsNoCEO         | <b>0.0014***</b><br>(0.0003)  | 0.0002<br>(0.0003)            | <b>0.0007**</b><br>(0.0003)   | 0.0002<br>(0.0003)            | 0.0005<br>(0.0004)            | -0.0001<br>(0.0003)           | 0.0005<br>(0.0004)            | -0.0001<br>(0.0003)           | <b>0.0019***</b><br>(0.0004)  | 0.0005<br>(0.0003)            | <b>0.0011***</b><br>(0.0004)  | 0.0005<br>(0.0003)            | <b>0.0016***</b><br>(0.0005)  | 0.0001<br>(0.0003)            | <b>0.0008*</b><br>(0.0005)    | 0.0001<br>(0.0003)            |
| UncPreCEO           | 0.0003<br>(0.0007)            | -0.0006<br>(0.0006)           | -0.0005<br>(0.0008)           | -0.0006<br>(0.0006)           | -0.0009<br>(0.0009)           | -0.0005<br>(0.0006)           | -0.0009<br>(0.0009)           | -0.0006<br>(0.0006)           | -0.0004<br>(0.0010)           | -0.0004<br>(0.0006)           | -0.0013<br>(0.0011)           | -0.0004<br>(0.0006)           | -0.0002<br>(0.0011)           | -0.0001<br>(0.0006)           | -0.0011<br>(0.0011)           | -0.0000<br>(0.0006)           |
| UncPreNoCEO         | -0.0001<br>(0.0005)           | <b>-0.0011**</b><br>(0.0006)  | <b>-0.0010*</b><br>(0.0005)   | <b>-0.0011*</b><br>(0.0006)   | -0.0008<br>(0.0007)           | -0.0006<br>(0.0006)           | -0.0008<br>(0.0007)           | -0.0005<br>(0.0006)           | 0.0007<br>(0.0008)            | 0.0005<br>(0.0006)            | -0.0002<br>(0.0008)           | 0.0006<br>(0.0006)            | 0.0011<br>(0.0008)            | 0.0009<br>(0.0006)            | 0.0001<br>(0.0009)            | 0.0009<br>(0.0006)            |
| InAssets            | <b>0.0007***</b><br>(0.0002)  | <b>-0.0022**</b><br>(0.0009)  | <b>-0.0007***</b><br>(0.0003) | <b>-0.0023**</b><br>(0.0009)  | <b>-0.0009**</b><br>(0.0003)  | <b>-0.0049***</b><br>(0.0011) | <b>-0.0009**</b><br>(0.0004)  | <b>-0.0049***</b><br>(0.0011) | <b>0.0006***</b><br>(0.0002)  | <b>-0.0059***</b><br>(0.0012) | <b>-0.0008*</b><br>(0.0004)   | <b>-0.0059***</b><br>(0.0012) | <b>0.0006**</b><br>(0.0003)   | <b>-0.0057***</b><br>(0.0013) | <b>-0.0010**</b><br>(0.0005)  | <b>-0.0058***</b><br>(0.0013) |
| TobinsQ             | <b>0.0014***</b><br>(0.0004)  | <b>0.0032***</b><br>(0.0004)  | <b>0.0010***</b><br>(0.0004)  | <b>0.0033***</b><br>(0.0004)  | 0.0006<br>(0.0004)            | <b>0.0018***</b><br>(0.0004)  | 0.0006<br>(0.0004)            | <b>0.0019***</b><br>(0.0004)  | 0.0003<br>(0.0004)            | 0.0004<br>(0.0004)            | -0.0000<br>(0.0004)           | 0.0005<br>(0.0004)            | -0.0000<br>(0.0004)           | -0.0002<br>(0.0004)           | -0.0005<br>(0.0004)           | -0.0002<br>(0.0004)           |
| ROA                 | <b>-0.0130***</b><br>(0.0047) | <b>0.0194***</b><br>(0.0052)  | <b>-0.0141***</b><br>(0.0047) | <b>0.0170***</b><br>(0.0052)  | <b>-0.0258***</b><br>(0.0052) | <b>0.0090**</b><br>(0.0046)   | <b>-0.0261***</b><br>(0.0052) | <b>0.0087*</b><br>(0.0046)    | <b>-0.0367***</b><br>(0.0057) | -0.0030<br>(0.0045)           | <b>-0.0362***</b><br>(0.0057) | -0.0027<br>(0.0045)           | <b>-0.0349***</b><br>(0.0064) | -0.0025<br>(0.0042)           | <b>-0.0350***</b><br>(0.0064) | -0.0029<br>(0.0042)           |
| Leverage            | 0.0015<br>(0.0016)            | <b>-0.0179***</b><br>(0.0034) | 0.0017<br>(0.0016)            | <b>-0.0175***</b><br>(0.0034) | <b>0.0056***</b><br>(0.0020)  | <b>-0.0120***</b><br>(0.0034) | <b>0.0056***</b><br>(0.0020)  | <b>-0.0115***</b><br>(0.0034) | <b>0.0070***</b><br>(0.0024)  | <b>-0.0077***</b><br>(0.0024) | <b>0.0072***</b><br>(0.0024)  | <b>-0.0073***</b><br>(0.0024) | <b>0.0092***</b><br>(0.0026)  | -0.0031<br>(0.0034)           | <b>0.0094***</b><br>(0.0026)  | -0.0030<br>(0.0034)           |
| CashRatio           | -0.0009<br>(0.0023)           | 0.0048<br>(0.0038)            | <b>-0.0045*</b><br>(0.0024)   | 0.0047<br>(0.0038)            | -0.0027<br>(0.0028)           | <b>0.0077**</b><br>(0.0038)   | -0.0027<br>(0.0028)           | <b>0.0078**</b><br>(0.0038)   | -0.0002<br>(0.0032)           | <b>0.0056*</b><br>(0.0034)    | -0.0041<br>(0.0033)           | 0.0053<br>(0.0034)            | -0.0014<br>(0.0036)           | 0.0033<br>(0.0034)            | -0.0051<br>(0.0037)           | 0.0037<br>(0.0034)            |
| DivDummy            | <b>-0.0024***</b><br>(0.0008) | -0.0003<br>(0.0011)           | <b>-0.0025***</b><br>(0.0008) | -0.0004<br>(0.0011)           | <b>-0.0021**</b><br>(0.0010)  | 0.0006<br>(0.0013)            | <b>-0.0021**</b><br>(0.0009)  | 0.0004<br>(0.0012)            | <b>-0.0018*</b><br>(0.0011)   | -0.0013<br>(0.0011)           | <b>-0.0020*</b><br>(0.0011)   | -0.0014<br>(0.0011)           | -0.0013<br>(0.0012)           | -0.0016<br>(0.0011)           | -0.0014<br>(0.0012)           | -0.0015<br>(0.0011)           |
| sCFO                | -0.0012<br>(0.0014)           | <b>-0.0055***</b><br>(0.0016) | -0.0015<br>(0.0012)           | <b>-0.0054***</b><br>(0.0016) | <b>0.0021**</b><br>(0.0010)   | -0.0016<br>(0.0010)           | <b>0.0022**</b><br>(0.0010)   | -0.0015<br>(0.0010)           | <b>0.0061***</b><br>(0.0017)  | <b>0.0027**</b><br>(0.0012)   | <b>0.0057***</b><br>(0.0018)  | <b>0.0027**</b><br>(0.0012)   | <b>0.0069***</b><br>(0.0019)  | <b>0.0051***</b><br>(0.0013)  | <b>0.0066***</b><br>(0.0020)  | <b>0.0050***</b><br>(0.0013)  |
| Lagged_DV           | <b>0.6463***</b><br>(0.0196)  | <b>0.0908***</b><br>(0.0197)  | <b>0.6425***</b><br>(0.0201)  | <b>0.0921***</b><br>(0.0197)  | <b>0.5643***</b><br>(0.0219)  | -0.0269<br>(0.0194)           | <b>0.5663***</b><br>(0.0220)  | -0.0260<br>(0.0194)           | <b>0.5231***</b><br>(0.0261)  | <b>-0.0743***</b><br>(0.0181) | <b>0.5195***</b><br>(0.0266)  | <b>-0.0752***</b><br>(0.0181) | <b>0.4977***</b><br>(0.0260)  | <b>-0.0588***</b><br>(0.0197) | <b>0.4946***</b><br>(0.0265)  | <b>-0.0571***</b><br>(0.0198) |
| SalesGrowth         | <b>0.0090***</b><br>(0.0017)  | <b>0.0057***</b><br>(0.0014)  | <b>0.0083***</b><br>(0.0016)  | <b>0.0053***</b><br>(0.0013)  | <b>0.0056***</b><br>(0.0016)  | <b>0.0022**</b><br>(0.0012)   | <b>0.0052***</b><br>(0.0016)  | <b>0.0023*</b><br>(0.0012)    | <b>0.0052**</b><br>(0.0020)   | 0.0012<br>(0.0010)            | <b>0.0048**</b><br>(0.0020)   | 0.0014<br>(0.0010)            | <b>0.0043**</b><br>(0.0019)   | 0.0006<br>(0.0010)            | <b>0.0036**</b><br>(0.0018)   | 0.0004<br>(0.0010)            |
| RDSales             | <b>0.0018***</b><br>(0.0003)  | <b>0.0022***</b><br>(0.0005)  | <b>0.0018***</b><br>(0.0003)  | <b>0.0020***</b><br>(0.0005)  | <b>0.0016**</b><br>(0.0006)   | <b>0.0022**</b><br>(0.0011)   | <b>0.0016**</b><br>(0.0006)   | <b>0.0022**</b><br>(0.0011)   | <b>0.0011**</b><br>(0.0004)   | 0.0000<br>(0.0010)            | <b>0.0011***</b><br>(0.0004)  | 0.0002<br>(0.0010)            | 0.0012<br>(0.0007)            | <b>0.0014**</b><br>(0.0007)   | <b>0.0012*</b><br>(0.0007)    | <b>0.0013*</b><br>(0.0007)    |
| CashFlowAt          | <b>0.0527***</b><br>(0.0062)  | <b>0.0173***</b><br>(0.0065)  | <b>0.0523***</b><br>(0.0062)  | <b>0.0184***</b><br>(0.0065)  | <b>0.0658***</b><br>(0.0067)  | <b>0.0211***</b><br>(0.0059)  | <b>0.0659***</b><br>(0.0067)  | <b>0.0205***</b><br>(0.0058)  | <b>0.0777***</b><br>(0.0076)  | <b>0.0194***</b><br>(0.0057)  | <b>0.0752***</b><br>(0.0075)  | <b>0.0182***</b><br>(0.0056)  | <b>0.0727***</b><br>(0.0089)  | <b>0.0130**</b><br>(0.0061)   | <b>0.0708***</b><br>(0.0089)  | <b>0.0129**</b><br>(0.0061)   |
| Daily Vola          | -0.0000<br>(0.0000)           | <b>-0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0002***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000)  | -0.0000<br>(0.0000)           | -0.0000<br>(0.0000)           | <b>-0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000)  | 0.0000<br>(0.0000)            | 0.0000<br>(0.0000)            | -0.0000<br>(0.0000)           |
| Industry FE         | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               |
| Firm FE             |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |
| Year FE             | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               |
| Year-Quarter FE     |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| N                   | 55,299                        | 55,299                        | 55,299                        | 55,299                        | 49,446                        | 49,446                        | 49,446                        | 49,446                        | 43,847                        | 43,847                        | 43,847                        | 43,847                        | 38,613                        | 38,613                        | 38,613                        | 38,613                        |
| R <sup>2</sup>      | 0.498                         | 0.070                         | 0.503                         | 0.069                         | 0.428                         | 0.034                         | 0.431                         | 0.034                         | 0.384                         | 0.022                         | 0.388                         | 0.022                         | 0.363                         | 0.015                         | 0.368                         | 0.015                         |
| Adj. R <sup>2</sup> | 0.498                         | 0.042                         | 0.502                         | 0.039                         | 0.427                         | 0.003                         | 0.430                         | 0.002                         | 0.383                         | -0.012                        | 0.387                         | -0.012                        | 0.362                         | -0.021                        | 0.367                         | -0.022                        |

Notes: \*  $p < 0.10$ , \*\*  $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\*  $p < 0.01$  (two-tailed). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms).  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ).

Table 39: H13.3: Financial Constraint–Moderated Speech Uncertainty and Capital Expenditure (Three-Category, CEO Q&amp;A)

|                       | (1)                           | (2)                           | (3)                           | (4)                           | (5)                           | (6)                           | (7)                           | (8)                           |
|-----------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|
|                       | Capex                         |                               |                               |                               | Capex_lead                    |                               |                               |                               |
| UncAnsCEO_c           | <b>0.0013***</b><br>(0.0005)  | <b>0.0008**</b><br>(0.0004)   | <b>0.0012***</b><br>(0.0005)  | <b>0.0006*</b><br>(0.0004)    | <b>0.0015***</b><br>(0.0006)  | 0.0005<br>(0.0005)            | <b>0.0014***</b><br>(0.0006)  | 0.0005<br>(0.0005)            |
| Unrated               | <b>0.0016***</b><br>(0.0006)  | -0.0037<br>(0.0016)           | 0.0000<br>(0.0008)            | -0.0035<br>(0.0016)           | <b>0.0045***</b><br>(0.0009)  | -0.0044<br>(0.0021)           | -0.0003<br>(0.0011)           | -0.0043<br>(0.0020)           |
| UncAnsCEO_c.x.Unrated | -0.0004<br>(0.0012)           | 0.0001<br>(0.0009)            | -0.0005<br>(0.0012)           | -0.0000<br>(0.0009)           | -0.0010<br>(0.0017)           | 0.0002<br>(0.0011)            | -0.0008<br>(0.0017)           | 0.0003<br>(0.0011)            |
| InAssets              | <b>0.0004***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>-0.0022**</b><br>(0.0009)  | -0.0003<br>(0.0002)           | <b>-0.0024***</b><br>(0.0009) | <b>0.0009***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>-0.0033***</b><br>(0.0011) | <b>-0.0008**</b><br>(0.0003)  | <b>-0.0034***</b><br>(0.0011) |
| TobinsQ               | <b>0.0015***</b><br>(0.0003)  | <b>0.0030***</b><br>(0.0005)  | <b>0.0014***</b><br>(0.0003)  | <b>0.0031***</b><br>(0.0005)  | <b>0.0016***</b><br>(0.0004)  | <b>0.0034***</b><br>(0.0005)  | <b>0.0013***</b><br>(0.0004)  | <b>0.0034***</b><br>(0.0005)  |
| ROA                   | <b>-0.0369***</b><br>(0.0065) | <b>-0.0190***</b><br>(0.0072) | <b>-0.0381***</b><br>(0.0064) | <b>-0.0205***</b><br>(0.0071) | <b>-0.0167***</b><br>(0.0047) | <b>0.0191***</b><br>(0.0057)  | <b>-0.0180***</b><br>(0.0047) | <b>0.0166***</b><br>(0.0057)  |
| Leverage              | <b>-0.0046***</b><br>(0.0013) | <b>-0.0225***</b><br>(0.0036) | <b>-0.0046***</b><br>(0.0013) | <b>-0.0215***</b><br>(0.0036) | -0.0007<br>(0.0018)           | <b>-0.0195***</b><br>(0.0035) | -0.0013<br>(0.0017)           | <b>-0.0191***</b><br>(0.0035) |
| CashRatio             | <b>-0.0097***</b><br>(0.0017) | <b>-0.0156***</b><br>(0.0039) | <b>-0.0102***</b><br>(0.0018) | <b>-0.0147***</b><br>(0.0039) | -0.0018<br>(0.0023)           | 0.0060<br>(0.0045)            | <b>-0.0046*</b><br>(0.0024)   | 0.0059<br>(0.0045)            |
| DivDummy              | -0.0005<br>(0.0006)           | <b>0.0018*</b><br>(0.0010)    | -0.0008<br>(0.0006)           | 0.0014<br>(0.0010)            | <b>-0.0017**</b><br>(0.0008)  | -0.0002<br>(0.0011)           | <b>-0.0022***</b><br>(0.0008) | -0.0003<br>(0.0011)           |
| sCFO                  | <b>-0.0042**</b><br>(0.0018)  | <b>-0.0076***</b><br>(0.0021) | <b>-0.0041**</b><br>(0.0018)  | <b>-0.0075***</b><br>(0.0021) | -0.0014<br>(0.0012)           | <b>-0.0059***</b><br>(0.0015) | -0.0016<br>(0.0010)           | <b>-0.0059***</b><br>(0.0015) |
| SalesGrowth           | <b>0.0091***</b><br>(0.0018)  | <b>0.0071***</b><br>(0.0017)  | <b>0.0082***</b><br>(0.0017)  | <b>0.0062***</b><br>(0.0016)  | <b>0.0102***</b><br>(0.0017)  | <b>0.0069***</b><br>(0.0015)  | <b>0.0096***</b><br>(0.0017)  | <b>0.0065***</b><br>(0.0015)  |
| RDSales               | <b>0.0008***</b><br>(0.0002)  | <b>0.0010**</b><br>(0.0004)   | <b>0.0007***</b><br>(0.0002)  | <b>0.0009**</b><br>(0.0004)   | <b>0.0018***</b><br>(0.0003)  | <b>0.0019***</b><br>(0.0005)  | <b>0.0017***</b><br>(0.0003)  | <b>0.0018***</b><br>(0.0005)  |
| CashFlowAt            | <b>0.0603***</b><br>(0.0069)  | <b>0.0344***</b><br>(0.0076)  | <b>0.0599***</b><br>(0.0068)  | <b>0.0350***</b><br>(0.0075)  | <b>0.0543***</b><br>(0.0063)  | <b>0.0185***</b><br>(0.0076)  | <b>0.0546***</b><br>(0.0062)  | <b>0.0196***</b><br>(0.0075)  |
| DailyVola             | <b>0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000)  | 0.0000<br>(0.0000)            | -0.0000<br>(0.0000)           | <b>-0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0002***</b><br>(0.0000) |
| Lagged_DV             | <b>0.7346***</b><br>(0.0155)  | <b>0.3090***</b><br>(0.0253)  | <b>0.7362***</b><br>(0.0157)  | <b>0.3122***</b><br>(0.0253)  | <b>0.6361***</b><br>(0.0191)  | <b>0.0769***</b><br>(0.0226)  | <b>0.6340***</b><br>(0.0195)  | <b>0.0781***</b><br>(0.0226)  |
| Industry FE           | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               |
| Firm FE               |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |
| Year FE               | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               |
| Year-Quarter FE       |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| N                     | 58,134                        | 58,134                        | 58,134                        | 58,134                        | 56,546                        | 56,546                        | 56,546                        | 56,546                        |
| R <sup>2</sup>        | 0.621                         | 0.140                         | 0.624                         | 0.142                         | 0.496                         | 0.070                         | 0.500                         | 0.068                         |
| Adj. R <sup>2</sup>   | 0.620                         | 0.115                         | 0.623                         | 0.116                         | 0.495                         | 0.042                         | 0.499                         | 0.039                         |

Notes: \*  $p < 0.10$ , \*\*  $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\*  $p < 0.01$  (one-tailed for IVs,  $\beta > 0$ ; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). Fiscal years 2002-2016.  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ).

Table 40: H14: Speech Uncertainty and Lee (2016) 3-Day Bid-Ask Spread Change ( $\Delta$ DSPREAD,  $[+1, +3] - [-3, -1]$ )

|                     | (1)                           | (2)                          | (3)                           | (4)                          | (5)                           | (6)                          | (7)                          | (8)                          | (9)                           | (10)                          | (11)                          | (12)                          |
|---------------------|-------------------------------|------------------------------|-------------------------------|------------------------------|-------------------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|
|                     | DSPREAD                       |                              |                               |                              |                               | DSPREAD_lead1                |                              |                              |                               |                               |                               |                               |
| UncAnsCEO           | 0.0721<br>(0.2738)            | 0.2457<br>(0.2983)           | 0.1653<br>(0.2777)            | 0.2254<br>(0.3033)           | 0.1684<br>(0.2794)            | 0.2395<br>(0.3039)           | 0.1112<br>(0.2690)           | 0.2853<br>(0.2840)           | 0.1363<br>(0.2430)            | 0.3082<br>(0.2709)            | 0.1506<br>(0.2439)            | 0.3201<br>(0.2708)            |
| UncPreCEO           | 0.0185<br>(0.2398)            | -0.0765<br>(0.2600)          | -0.1418<br>(0.2046)           | -0.3875<br>(0.2629)          | -0.1715<br>(0.2024)           | -0.3536<br>(0.2631)          | -0.3044<br>(0.2320)          | -0.5044<br>(0.2733)          | -0.2891<br>(0.2003)           | -0.4453<br>(0.2576)           | -0.3379<br>(0.2000)           | -0.4565<br>(0.2579)           |
| UncAnsMgr           | -0.0315<br>(0.3374)           | -0.1868<br>(0.3822)          | -0.7957<br>(0.3329)           | -0.3429<br>(0.3865)          | 0.0273<br>(0.3386)            | -0.2787<br>(0.3856)          | -0.1289<br>(0.3325)          | -0.3308<br>(0.3615)          | -0.5742<br>(0.3035)           | -0.4183<br>(0.3547)           | -0.0418<br>(0.3095)           | -0.4509<br>(0.3549)           |
| UncPreMgr           | 0.0214<br>(0.3028)            | 0.2118<br>(0.3634)           | -0.5961<br>(0.2278)           | 0.4146<br>(0.3357)           | 0.2046<br>(0.2359)            | <b>0.4657*</b><br>(0.3358)   | 0.0893<br>(0.2705)           | 0.2456<br>(0.3503)           | -0.3615<br>(0.2121)           | 0.0130<br>(0.3271)            | 0.2221<br>(0.2232)            | 0.0099<br>(0.3303)            |
| InAssets            | <b>0.7344***</b><br>(0.0590)  | <b>0.7552***</b><br>(0.2258) | <b>0.1646***</b><br>(0.0324)  | <b>0.5619**</b><br>(0.2762)  | <b>0.7274***</b><br>(0.0623)  | <b>0.5960**</b><br>(0.2776)  | <b>0.7361***</b><br>(0.0615) | <b>0.7467***</b><br>(0.2184) | <b>0.2366***</b><br>(0.0313)  | 0.3760<br>(0.2641)            | <b>0.6435***</b><br>(0.0609)  | 0.4207<br>(0.2668)            |
| TobinsQ             | <b>0.3066***</b><br>(0.0506)  | <b>0.1395**</b><br>(0.0663)  | -0.0558<br>(0.0488)           | 0.0560<br>(0.1016)           | <b>0.2158***</b><br>(0.0517)  | 0.0427<br>(0.1024)           | <b>0.2820***</b><br>(0.0479) | <b>0.1348*</b><br>(0.0693)   | 0.0180<br>(0.0459)            | 0.1266<br>(0.0983)            | <b>0.2023***</b><br>(0.0484)  | 0.0962<br>(0.0989)            |
| ROA                 | <b>-1.8575***</b><br>(0.7026) | -1.1000<br>(1.0527)          | -1.0631<br>(1.1363)           | -0.7649<br>(1.3640)          | -0.7092<br>(1.1426)           | -0.4102<br>(1.3826)          | <b>-1.6177**</b><br>(0.8161) | -1.0204<br>(1.1724)          | -1.4546<br>(1.1036)           | -1.7546<br>(1.2815)           | -1.0991<br>(1.1014)           | -1.5553<br>(1.2937)           |
| Leverage            | <b>-0.5893*</b><br>(0.3221)   | -0.4334<br>(0.6995)          | -0.3255<br>(0.3282)           | -0.9628<br>(0.6904)          | <b>-0.6732*</b><br>(0.3472)   | -0.8884<br>(0.6937)          | <b>-0.6776**</b><br>(0.3353) | -0.8467<br>(0.7292)          | -0.1184<br>(0.3221)           | -0.4588<br>(0.7764)           | -0.3854<br>(0.3304)           | -0.4953<br>(0.7783)           |
| Capex               | 2.1288<br>(1.3649)            | 1.6389<br>(2.3213)           | 1.1760<br>(1.3274)            | 3.3313<br>(2.7262)           | <b>3.5965***</b><br>(1.3301)  | 3.7776<br>(2.7238)           | 2.4026<br>(1.5009)           | 2.3216<br>(2.5284)           | 1.6629<br>(1.3692)            | 2.0620<br>(2.9078)            | <b>3.2983**</b><br>(1.3879)   | 2.0994<br>(2.9161)            |
| DivDummy            | -0.0010<br>(0.1380)           | 0.1017<br>(0.2946)           | 0.0674<br>(0.1447)            | 0.0959<br>(0.3130)           | 0.0894<br>(0.1404)            | 0.1453<br>(0.3133)           | 0.0031<br>(0.1400)           | 0.3251<br>(0.2896)           | -0.0453<br>(0.1395)           | 0.1584<br>(0.2924)            | -0.0110<br>(0.1377)           | 0.1826<br>(0.2929)            |
| sCFO                | <b>0.3380**</b><br>(0.1684)   | 0.1634<br>(0.1081)           | 0.3689<br>(0.2270)            | <b>0.5873***</b><br>(0.1493) | <b>0.4803**</b><br>(0.1888)   | <b>0.5840***</b><br>(0.1492) | <b>0.2978*</b><br>(0.1658)   | 0.1483<br>(0.1036)           | <b>0.2073*</b><br>(0.1172)    | <b>0.2858***</b><br>(0.0998)  | <b>0.2659**</b><br>(0.1185)   | <b>0.2699***</b><br>(0.0992)  |
| Lagged_DV           | 0.0138<br>(0.0097)            | <b>-0.0170*</b><br>(0.0097)  | 0.0167<br>(0.0113)            | <b>-0.0226**</b><br>(0.0112) | 0.0128<br>(0.0113)            | <b>-0.0226**</b><br>(0.0112) | 0.0133<br>(0.0103)           | <b>-0.0185*</b><br>(0.0103)  | <b>0.0221*</b><br>(0.0118)    | -0.0156<br>(0.0115)           | 0.0193<br>(0.0119)            | -0.0155<br>(0.0116)           |
| StockPrice          |                               |                              | <b>-0.0050***</b><br>(0.0016) | -0.0048<br>(0.0034)          | <b>-0.0108***</b><br>(0.0016) | <b>-0.0069**</b><br>(0.0034) |                              |                              | <b>-0.0091***</b><br>(0.0017) | -0.0040<br>(0.0034)           | <b>-0.0123***</b><br>(0.0017) | -0.0038<br>(0.0034)           |
| Turnover            |                               |                              | <b>12.2966***</b><br>(2.1559) | <b>9.4258***</b><br>(2.7872) | <b>11.4327***</b><br>(2.1590) | <b>8.2241***</b><br>(2.8270) |                              |                              | <b>13.0113***</b><br>(2.0881) | <b>7.4111***</b><br>(2.5671)  | <b>12.3677***</b><br>(2.1074) | <b>7.1405***</b><br>(2.5740)  |
| DailyVola           |                               |                              | <b>-0.0325***</b><br>(0.0066) | -0.0094<br>(0.0084)          | -0.0068<br>(0.0085)           | -0.0031<br>(0.0110)          |                              |                              | <b>-0.0614***</b><br>(0.0068) | <b>-0.0524***</b><br>(0.0085) | <b>-0.0379***</b><br>(0.0084) | <b>-0.0461***</b><br>(0.0107) |
| AbsSurpDec          |                               |                              | <b>-0.2203***</b><br>(0.0441) | -0.0171<br>(0.0493)          | <b>-0.1023**</b><br>(0.0427)  | -0.0182<br>(0.0492)          |                              |                              | <b>-0.1480***</b><br>(0.0434) | -0.0339<br>(0.0488)           | <b>-0.0724*</b><br>(0.0418)   | -0.0399<br>(0.0487)           |
| Extended Controls   |                               |                              | Yes                           | Yes                          | Yes                           | Yes                          |                              |                              | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| Industry FE         | Yes                           |                              | Yes                           |                              | Yes                           |                              | Yes                          |                              | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               |
| Firm FE             |                               | Yes                          |                               | Yes                          |                               | Yes                          |                              | Yes                          |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |
| Year FE             | Yes                           | Yes                          | Yes                           | Yes                          |                               |                              | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               |
| Year-Quarter FE     |                               |                              |                               |                              | Yes                           | Yes                          |                              |                              |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| N                   | 63,972                        | 63,972                       | 44,132                        | 44,132                       | 44,132                        | 44,132                       | 63,554                       | 63,554                       | 44,640                        | 44,640                        | 44,640                        | 44,640                        |
| R <sup>2</sup>      | 0.005                         | 0.001                        | 0.003                         | 0.001                        | 0.007                         | 0.001                        | 0.006                        | 0.001                        | 0.008                         | 0.004                         | 0.009                         | 0.002                         |
| Adj. R <sup>2</sup> | 0.005                         | -0.027                       | 0.002                         | -0.032                       | 0.005                         | -0.034                       | 0.005                        | -0.027                       | 0.007                         | -0.029                        | 0.007                         | -0.032                        |

Notes: \*  $p < 0.10$ , \*\*  $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\*  $p < 0.01$  (one-tailed for IVs,  $\beta > 0$ ; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms).  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ). DSPREAD values rescaled by  $10^4$  for readability; multiply coefficients by  $10^{-4}$  to recover raw units.

Table 41: H14 Robustness: Orthogonal Speaker Partition

|                     | (1)                           | (2)                          | (3)                           | (4)                           | (5)                           | (6)                          | (7)                          | (8)                          | (9)                           | (10)                          | (11)                          | (12)                          |
|---------------------|-------------------------------|------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|
|                     | DSPREAD                       |                              |                               |                               |                               | DSPREAD_lead1                |                              |                              |                               |                               |                               |                               |
| UncAnsCEO           | 0.0026<br>(0.1719)            | 0.1218<br>(0.1996)           | -0.3174<br>(0.1656)           | -0.0088<br>(0.2015)           | 0.1603<br>(0.1698)            | 0.0330<br>(0.2018)           | -0.0090<br>(0.1775)          | 0.0622<br>(0.1949)           | -0.1079<br>(0.1647)           | 0.1328<br>(0.1950)            | 0.1989<br>(0.1656)            | 0.1246<br>(0.1956)            |
| UncAnsNoCEO         | <b>0.2320**</b><br>(0.1138)   | <b>0.1691*</b><br>(0.1235)   | -0.1918<br>(0.1173)           | 0.0145<br>(0.1295)            | 0.0790<br>(0.1181)            | 0.0241<br>(0.1291)           | -0.0800<br>(0.1192)          | -0.1820<br>(0.1274)          | -0.2268<br>(0.1099)           | -0.1691<br>(0.1255)           | -0.0486<br>(0.1101)           | -0.1755<br>(0.1257)           |
| UncPreCEO           | 0.1636<br>(0.1687)            | 0.0717<br>(0.2089)           | -0.3160<br>(0.1635)           | -0.1484<br>(0.2153)           | 0.0339<br>(0.1637)            | -0.0949<br>(0.2153)          | -0.1523<br>(0.1788)          | -0.4084<br>(0.2201)          | -0.3865<br>(0.1623)           | -0.4276<br>(0.2023)           | -0.1734<br>(0.1620)           | -0.4424<br>(0.2019)           |
| UncPreNoCEO         | -0.1356<br>(0.1265)           | -0.0761<br>(0.1733)          | -0.3681<br>(0.1033)           | 0.0439<br>(0.1755)            | -0.0305<br>(0.1073)           | 0.0619<br>(0.1757)           | -0.0010<br>(0.1232)          | 0.1155<br>(0.1803)           | -0.2805<br>(0.1069)           | -0.2018<br>(0.1744)           | -0.0442<br>(0.1080)           | -0.1960<br>(0.1742)           |
| lnAssets            | <b>0.7054***</b><br>(0.0555)  | <b>0.7328***</b><br>(0.2285) | <b>0.1382***</b><br>(0.0311)  | <b>0.5337*</b><br>(0.2821)    | <b>0.6865***</b><br>(0.0627)  | <b>0.5605**</b><br>(0.2826)  | <b>0.7000***</b><br>(0.0616) | <b>0.6423***</b><br>(0.2299) | <b>0.2207***</b><br>(0.0304)  | 0.3804<br>(0.2720)            | <b>0.6060***</b><br>(0.0613)  | 0.4349<br>(0.2753)            |
| TobinsQ             | <b>0.3108***</b><br>(0.0484)  | <b>0.1780***</b><br>(0.0654) | -0.0589<br>(0.0497)           | 0.0692<br>(0.1013)            | <b>0.2114***</b><br>(0.0526)  | 0.0556<br>(0.1020)           | <b>0.2509***</b><br>(0.0461) | <b>0.1475**</b><br>(0.0739)  | 0.0115<br>(0.0455)            | 0.1372<br>(0.1004)            | <b>0.1896***</b><br>(0.0479)  | 0.1083<br>(0.1010)            |
| ROA                 | <b>-1.9421***</b><br>(0.7530) | -1.1921<br>(1.1118)          | -1.2887<br>(1.2230)           | -0.8390<br>(1.3595)           | -0.9952<br>(1.2285)           | -0.5161<br>(1.3801)          | -1.1165<br>(0.9081)          | -0.5780<br>(1.2908)          | -1.4995<br>(1.2550)           | -1.7977<br>(1.3959)           | -1.1579<br>(1.2614)           | -1.6102<br>(1.4158)           |
| Leverage            | <b>-0.5636*</b><br>(0.3165)   | -0.4383<br>(0.7108)          | -0.2681<br>(0.3245)           | -1.0213<br>(0.7219)           | <b>-0.6165*</b><br>(0.3394)   | -0.9221<br>(0.7257)          | -0.5010<br>(0.3309)          | -0.6213<br>(0.7151)          | -0.0485<br>(0.3214)           | -0.6030<br>(0.7945)           | -0.3150<br>(0.3258)           | -0.6443<br>(0.7970)           |
| Capex               | 1.8980<br>(1.4356)            | 2.1716<br>(2.4814)           | 1.1888<br>(1.4049)            | 4.2046<br>(2.8613)            | <b>3.5514**</b><br>(1.4100)   | 4.6214<br>(2.8620)           | 2.0217<br>(1.5527)           | 2.3992<br>(2.4809)           | 1.7765<br>(1.4539)            | 2.7398<br>(3.0130)            | <b>3.3055**</b><br>(1.4657)   | 2.8279<br>(3.0042)            |
| DivDummy            | 0.0352<br>(0.1359)            | 0.1742<br>(0.2951)           | 0.1834<br>(0.1412)            | 0.2095<br>(0.3180)            | 0.1796<br>(0.3172)            | 0.2603<br>(0.3184)           | 0.0006<br>(0.1486)           | 0.2216<br>(0.3059)           | 0.0377<br>(0.1415)            | 0.1162<br>(0.3070)            | 0.0585<br>(0.1397)            | 0.1399<br>(0.3077)            |
| sCFO                | <b>0.3010*</b><br>(0.1631)    | 0.1212<br>(0.1228)           | 0.3811<br>(0.2318)            | <b>0.5695***</b><br>(0.1869)  | <b>0.4984**</b><br>(0.1941)   | <b>0.5630***</b><br>(0.1910) | <b>0.3577*</b><br>(0.1897)   | <b>0.1900*</b><br>(0.1131)   | <b>0.2623***</b><br>(0.1017)  | <b>0.2886***</b><br>(0.0975)  | <b>0.3224***</b><br>(0.1193)  | <b>0.2748***</b><br>(0.0965)  |
| Lagged_DV           | 0.0122<br>(0.0098)            | <b>-0.0170*</b><br>(0.0098)  | 0.0138<br>(0.0112)            | <b>-0.0244**</b><br>(0.0111)  | 0.0100<br>(0.0112)            | <b>-0.0243**</b><br>(0.0112) | 0.0053<br>(0.0102)           | <b>-0.0246**</b><br>(0.0102) | 0.0157<br>(0.0115)            | <b>-0.0210*</b><br>(0.0113)   | 0.0134<br>(0.0116)            | <b>-0.0205*</b><br>(0.0114)   |
| StockPrice          |                               |                              | <b>-0.0041*</b><br>(0.0016)   | -0.0044<br>(0.0035)           | <b>-0.0099***</b><br>(0.0016) | <b>-0.0064*</b><br>(0.0035)  |                              |                              | <b>-0.0085***</b><br>(0.0017) | -0.0048<br>(0.0035)           | <b>-0.0115***</b><br>(0.0017) | -0.0047<br>(0.0035)           |
| Turnover            |                               |                              | <b>12.6927***</b><br>(2.1465) | <b>10.2015***</b><br>(2.7887) | <b>12.1176***</b><br>(2.1384) | <b>9.1792***</b><br>(2.8167) |                              |                              | <b>12.7779***</b><br>(2.1172) | <b>7.0613***</b><br>(2.6130)  | <b>12.1657***</b><br>(2.1312) | <b>6.7178**</b><br>(2.6149)   |
| DailyVola           |                               |                              | <b>-0.0323***</b><br>(0.0069) | -0.0090<br>(0.0087)           | -0.0087<br>(0.0087)           | -0.0049<br>(0.0111)          |                              |                              | <b>-0.0612***</b><br>(0.0070) | <b>-0.0524***</b><br>(0.0087) | <b>-0.0383***</b><br>(0.0086) | <b>-0.0456***</b><br>(0.0108) |
| AbsSurpDec          |                               |                              | <b>-0.2115***</b><br>(0.0450) | -0.0201<br>(0.0508)           | <b>-0.0901**</b><br>(0.0432)  | -0.0204<br>(0.0508)          |                              |                              | <b>-0.1312***</b><br>(0.0440) | -0.0373<br>(0.0501)           | -0.0566<br>(0.0423)           | -0.0422<br>(0.0500)           |
| Extended Controls   |                               |                              | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                          |                              |                              | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| Industry FE         | Yes                           |                              | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                              | Yes                          |                              | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               |
| Firm FE             |                               | Yes                          |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                          |                              | Yes                          |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |
| Year FE             | Yes                           | Yes                          | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                              | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                           |                               |                               |                               |
| Year-Quarter FE     |                               |                              |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                          |                              |                              |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| N                   | 60,073                        | 60,073                       | 41,604                        | 41,604                        | 41,604                        | 41,604                       | 59,652                       | 59,652                       | 42,079                        | 42,079                        | 42,079                        | 42,079                        |
| R <sup>2</sup>      | 0.005                         | 0.001                        | 0.003                         | 0.001                         | 0.007                         | 0.001                        | 0.005                        | 0.001                        | 0.008                         | 0.004                         | 0.009                         | 0.003                         |
| Adj. R <sup>2</sup> | 0.005                         | -0.029                       | 0.002                         | -0.034                        | 0.005                         | -0.035                       | 0.005                        | -0.028                       | 0.007                         | -0.030                        | 0.006                         | -0.033                        |

Notes: \*  $p < 0.10$ , \*\*  $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\*  $p < 0.01$  (one-tailed for IVs,  $\beta > 0$ ; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms).  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ). DSPREAD values rescaled by  $10^4$  for readability; multiply coefficients by  $10^{-4}$  to recover raw units.

Table 42: H14b: Speech Uncertainty and Lee (2016) 3-Day Post-Call Bid-Ask Spread Level ([+1, +3])

|                     | (1)                            | (2)                            | (3)                            | (4)                            | (5)                            | (6)                            | (7)                            | (8)                            | (9)                            | (10)                           | (11)                           | (12)                           |
|---------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|
|                     |                                |                                | PostCallSpread                 |                                |                                |                                |                                |                                | PostCallSpread_lead1           |                                |                                |                                |
| UncAnsCEO           | 0.3079<br>(0.3119)             | 0.3472<br>(0.3161)             | 0.1388<br>(0.3049)             | 0.2889<br>(0.3138)             | 0.1819<br>(0.2991)             | 0.3226<br>(0.3069)             | 0.3095<br>(0.2729)             | <b>0.3918*</b><br>(0.2912)     | 0.2882<br>(0.2784)             | <b>0.4555*</b><br>(0.2985)     | 0.2577<br>(0.2750)             | <b>0.4227*</b><br>(0.2961)     |
| UncPreCEO           | -0.0462<br>(0.2582)            | -0.1350<br>(0.3123)            | -0.3205<br>(0.2502)            | 0.0272<br>(0.3061)             | -0.2701<br>(0.2565)            | -0.0882<br>(0.3069)            | -0.1692<br>(0.2685)            | -0.2959<br>(0.2743)            | -0.4984<br>(0.2615)            | -0.2957<br>(0.2738)            | -0.2886<br>(0.2643)            | -0.1984<br>(0.2696)            |
| UncAnsMgr           | -0.6930<br>(0.4162)            | -0.6583<br>(0.4219)            | <b>0.9758***</b><br>(0.3966)   | -0.6171<br>(0.4014)            | -0.7201<br>(0.3978)            | -0.7251<br>(0.3937)            | -0.5963<br>(0.3590)            | -0.6496<br>(0.3590)            | <b>1.2029***</b><br>(0.3642)   | -0.8783<br>(0.3776)            | -0.5739<br>(0.3596)            | -0.7621<br>(0.3748)            |
| UncPreMgr           | -0.2043<br>(0.3243)            | <b>0.5918*</b><br>(0.4084)     | <b>1.8059***</b><br>(0.2927)   | 0.3764<br>(0.3916)             | -0.0108<br>(0.3111)            | 0.3317<br>(0.3912)             | -0.3807<br>(0.3634)            | 0.3017<br>(0.4006)             | <b>1.8837***</b><br>(0.3251)   | 0.2146<br>(0.3951)             | -0.1308<br>(0.3493)            | 0.2570<br>(0.3922)             |
| lnAssets            | <b>-2.2449***</b><br>(0.1008)  | <b>-5.6123***</b><br>(0.4016)  | <b>-0.5519***</b><br>(0.0438)  | <b>-5.2908***</b><br>(0.4557)  | <b>-1.8081***</b><br>(0.0958)  | <b>-5.4885***</b><br>(0.4618)  | <b>-2.1586***</b><br>(0.0948)  | <b>-4.8212***</b><br>(0.3852)  | <b>-0.4556***</b><br>(0.0491)  | <b>-4.8193***</b><br>(0.4406)  | <b>-1.7785***</b><br>(0.0952)  | <b>-4.6667***</b><br>(0.4366)  |
| TobinsQ             | <b>-0.9005***</b><br>(0.0770)  | <b>-1.4164***</b><br>(0.1886)  | <b>-0.1767**</b><br>(0.0697)   | <b>-1.5253***</b><br>(0.2102)  | <b>-0.7275***</b><br>(0.0715)  | <b>-1.5319***</b><br>(0.2099)  | <b>-0.7758***</b><br>(0.0836)  | <b>-0.9581***</b><br>(0.1570)  | -0.0410<br>(0.0811)            | <b>-1.1163***</b><br>(0.1773)  | <b>-0.6528***</b><br>(0.0749)  | <b>-1.0908***</b><br>(0.1759)  |
| ROA                 | <b>-19.6307***</b><br>(1.3717) | <b>-19.5171***</b><br>(1.6754) | <b>-11.4686***</b><br>(1.3235) | <b>-12.7195***</b><br>(1.6609) | <b>-12.5378***</b><br>(1.3434) | <b>-13.2437***</b><br>(1.7004) | <b>-20.6243***</b><br>(1.6285) | <b>-23.1154***</b><br>(1.9547) | <b>-15.0302***</b><br>(1.6196) | <b>-18.9815***</b><br>(1.9422) | <b>-15.2633***</b><br>(1.5608) | <b>-18.3149***</b><br>(1.9477) |
| Leverage            | <b>2.7808***</b><br>(0.5171)   | <b>7.5040***</b><br>(1.0851)   | 0.5029<br>(0.4471)             | <b>5.0850***</b><br>(1.0451)   | <b>1.4582***</b><br>(0.4688)   | <b>5.2325***</b><br>(1.0607)   | <b>2.0013***</b><br>(0.4799)   | <b>5.2610***</b><br>(1.0171)   | 0.3341<br>(0.4332)             | <b>4.1282***</b><br>(1.0268)   | <b>1.2640***</b><br>(0.4244)   | <b>4.1818***</b><br>(1.0112)   |
| Capex               | <b>-4.7750***</b><br>(1.7723)  | <b>-6.0196***</b><br>(2.9167)  | -1.5721<br>(1.6394)            | <b>-8.2452***</b><br>(2.8183)  | <b>-6.0395***</b><br>(1.7033)  | <b>-9.0720***</b><br>(2.8204)  | <b>-5.8414***</b><br>(1.7853)  | <b>-7.8678***</b><br>(3.1849)  | -1.6370<br>(1.6288)            | <b>-9.3587***</b><br>(3.1556)  | <b>-5.9424***</b><br>(1.6540)  | <b>-8.0232***</b><br>(3.1313)  |
| DivDummy            | 0.0569<br>(0.2104)             | <b>-0.8433**</b><br>(0.3670)   | <b>0.3302*</b><br>(0.1786)     | <b>-0.6241*</b><br>(0.3569)    | 0.2743<br>(0.1867)             | <b>-0.6348*</b><br>(0.3554)    | -0.1545<br>(0.2072)            | <b>-0.9509**</b><br>(0.3706)   | 0.1248<br>(0.1836)             | <b>-0.7079**</b><br>(0.3599)   | 0.1010<br>(0.1871)             | <b>-0.6227*</b><br>(0.3545)    |
| sCFO                | 0.1535<br>(0.3535)             | <b>0.6136*</b><br>(0.3573)     | 0.2303<br>(0.3439)             | 0.3486<br>(0.3408)             | -0.1314<br>(0.4116)            | 0.3672<br>(0.3280)             | 0.0646<br>(0.2892)             | <b>0.7209**</b><br>(0.3186)    | 0.2766<br>(0.2640)             | <b>0.5339*</b><br>(0.2944)     | -0.1852<br>(0.3561)            | <b>0.5205*</b><br>(0.2919)     |
| Lagged_DV           | <b>0.6150***</b><br>(0.0113)   | <b>0.4535***</b><br>(0.0124)   | <b>0.5912***</b><br>(0.0120)   | <b>0.4132***</b><br>(0.0129)   | <b>0.5630***</b><br>(0.0125)   | <b>0.4092***</b><br>(0.0135)   | <b>0.6131***</b><br>(0.0116)   | <b>0.4473***</b><br>(0.0130)   | <b>0.6116***</b><br>(0.0132)   | <b>0.4156***</b><br>(0.0147)   | <b>0.5900***</b><br>(0.0131)   | <b>0.4252***</b><br>(0.0149)   |
| DailyVola           |                                |                                | <b>0.2463***</b><br>(0.0083)   | <b>0.2226***</b><br>(0.0097)   | <b>0.2124***</b><br>(0.0105)   | <b>0.2237***</b><br>(0.0122)   |                                |                                | <b>0.1786***</b><br>(0.0079)   | <b>0.1571***</b><br>(0.0093)   | <b>0.1430***</b><br>(0.0105)   | <b>0.1515***</b><br>(0.0121)   |
| StockPrice          |                                |                                | <b>-0.0081***</b><br>(0.0026)  | <b>0.0111*</b><br>(0.0058)     | 0.0039<br>(0.0029)             | <b>0.0176***</b><br>(0.0059)   |                                |                                | <b>-0.0082***</b><br>(0.0025)  | <b>0.0194***</b><br>(0.0057)   | 0.0007<br>(0.0029)             | <b>0.0138**</b><br>(0.0057)    |
| Turnover            |                                |                                | <b>-58.2412***</b><br>(2.9710) | <b>-55.8152***</b><br>(3.6440) | <b>-58.8217***</b><br>(3.0241) | <b>-53.0175***</b><br>(3.6546) |                                |                                | <b>-37.7213***</b><br>(2.5472) | <b>-34.1353***</b><br>(3.0256) | <b>-40.8038***</b><br>(2.6341) | <b>-34.1169***</b><br>(3.0173) |
| UncQue              |                                |                                | <b>0.5015***</b><br>(0.1564)   | <b>-0.4223***</b><br>(0.1613)  | <b>-0.4708***</b><br>(0.1568)  | <b>-0.4552***</b><br>(0.1592)  |                                |                                | <b>0.8859***</b><br>(0.2010)   | -0.1749<br>(0.1883)            | -0.1494<br>(0.2030)            | -0.1318<br>(0.1863)            |
| Extended Controls   |                                |                                | Yes                            | Yes                            | Yes                            | Yes                            |                                |                                | Yes                            | Yes                            | Yes                            | Yes                            |
| Industry FE         | Yes                            |                                | Yes                            |                                | Yes                            |                                | Yes                            |                                | Yes                            |                                | Yes                            |                                |
| Firm FE             |                                | Yes                            |                                | Yes                            |                                | Yes                            |                                | Yes                            |                                | Yes                            |                                | Yes                            |
| Year FE             | Yes                            | Yes                            | Yes                            | Yes                            |                                |                                | Yes                            | Yes                            | Yes                            | Yes                            |                                |                                |
| Year-Quarter FE     |                                |                                |                                |                                | Yes                            | Yes                            |                                |                                |                                |                                | Yes                            | Yes                            |
| N                   | 63,972                         | 63,972                         | 60,368                         | 60,368                         | 60,368                         | 60,368                         | 63,554                         | 63,554                         | 61,257                         | 61,257                         | 61,257                         | 61,257                         |
| R <sup>2</sup>      | 0.539                          | 0.294                          | 0.549                          | 0.326                          | 0.554                          | 0.313                          | 0.547                          | 0.292                          | 0.545                          | 0.311                          | 0.555                          | 0.303                          |
| Adj. R <sup>2</sup> | 0.539                          | 0.274                          | 0.549                          | 0.306                          | 0.553                          | 0.292                          | 0.546                          | 0.272                          | 0.544                          | 0.291                          | 0.555                          | 0.282                          |

Notes: \*  $p < 0.10$ , \*\*  $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\*  $p < 0.01$  (one-tailed for IVs,  $\beta > 0$ ; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms).  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ). PostCallSpread values rescaled by  $10^4$  for readability; multiply coefficients by  $10^{-4}$  to recover raw units.

Table 43: H14b Robustness: Orthogonal Speaker Partition

|                     | (1)                            | (2)                            | (3)                            | (4)                            | (5)                            | (6)                            | (7)                            | (8)                            | (9)                            | (10)                           | (11)                           | (12)                           |
|---------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|
|                     |                                |                                | PostCallSpread                 |                                |                                |                                |                                |                                | PostCallSpread_lead1           |                                |                                |                                |
| UncAnsCEO           | 0.0118<br>(0.2060)             | 0.0160<br>(0.2120)             | <b>0.6556***</b><br>(0.1937)   | -0.1124<br>(0.2081)            | -0.2747<br>(0.1934)            | -0.1339<br>(0.2060)            | -0.0577<br>(0.2045)            | -0.0371<br>(0.2217)            | <b>0.8765***</b><br>(0.1960)   | -0.1142<br>(0.2168)            | -0.1581<br>(0.1956)            | -0.0794<br>(0.2141)            |
| UncAnsNoCEO         | -0.2855<br>(0.1421)            | -0.2528<br>(0.1425)            | <b>0.1912*</b><br>(0.1349)     | -0.2727<br>(0.1377)            | -0.3321<br>(0.1378)            | -0.2726<br>(0.1369)            | -0.2800<br>(0.1302)            | -0.2521<br>(0.1304)            | <b>0.3358***</b><br>(0.1336)   | -0.2383<br>(0.1333)            | -0.2442<br>(0.1314)            | -0.2120<br>(0.1314)            |
| UncPreCEO           | -0.1018<br>(0.2025)            | 0.1782<br>(0.2416)             | <b>0.5904***</b><br>(0.2010)   | 0.2957<br>(0.2382)             | -0.1977<br>(0.2048)            | 0.1634<br>(0.2372)             | -0.3161<br>(0.1932)            | -0.1266<br>(0.2162)            | <b>0.4156**</b><br>(0.1973)    | -0.1275<br>(0.2201)            | -0.2993<br>(0.1908)            | -0.0151<br>(0.2165)            |
| UncPreNoCEO         | -0.0097<br>(0.1538)            | 0.2235<br>(0.1962)             | <b>0.7797***</b><br>(0.1460)   | 0.1434<br>(0.1931)             | 0.0375<br>(0.1510)             | 0.1483<br>(0.1945)             | 0.1397<br>(0.1629)             | <b>0.4572**</b><br>(0.1998)    | <b>1.0624***</b><br>(0.1574)   | <b>0.4797***</b><br>(0.1998)   | <b>0.2224*</b><br>(0.1590)     | <b>0.4875***</b><br>(0.1970)   |
| lnAssets            | <b>-2.1057***</b><br>(0.0906)  | <b>-5.3720***</b><br>(0.3992)  | <b>-0.5231***</b><br>(0.0432)  | <b>-5.1024***</b><br>(0.4526)  | <b>-1.7276***</b><br>(0.0915)  | <b>-5.3041***</b><br>(0.4580)  | <b>-2.0320***</b><br>(0.0873)  | <b>-4.6718***</b><br>(0.3959)  | <b>-0.4202***</b><br>(0.0447)  | <b>-4.7195***</b><br>(0.4521)  | <b>-1.6713***</b><br>(0.0891)  | <b>-4.5461***</b><br>(0.4476)  |
| TobinsQ             | <b>-0.8267***</b><br>(0.0707)  | <b>-1.3460***</b><br>(0.1819)  | <b>-0.1525**</b><br>(0.0713)   | <b>-1.5030***</b><br>(0.2079)  | <b>-0.6887***</b><br>(0.0710)  | <b>-1.5139***</b><br>(0.2085)  | <b>-0.7561***</b><br>(0.0829)  | <b>-0.9101***</b><br>(0.1544)  | -0.0472<br>(0.0826)            | <b>-1.0946***</b><br>(0.1777)  | <b>-0.6334***</b><br>(0.0742)  | <b>-1.0702***</b><br>(0.1752)  |
| ROA                 | <b>-19.5372***</b><br>(1.2527) | <b>-19.0975***</b><br>(1.7255) | <b>-11.6122***</b><br>(1.2851) | <b>-12.1161***</b><br>(1.7137) | <b>-12.7071***</b><br>(1.3060) | <b>-12.6354***</b><br>(1.7537) | <b>-20.1463***</b><br>(1.5555) | <b>-22.6970***</b><br>(1.9696) | <b>-14.8325***</b><br>(1.5687) | <b>-18.7190***</b><br>(1.9546) | <b>-15.0107***</b><br>(1.4942) | <b>-17.9279***</b><br>(1.9566) |
| Leverage            | <b>2.5754***</b><br>(0.5039)   | <b>6.9911***</b><br>(1.0572)   | 0.3410<br>(0.4496)             | <b>4.7200***</b><br>(1.0295)   | <b>1.2742***</b><br>(0.4637)   | <b>4.8943***</b><br>(1.0460)   | <b>1.9618***</b><br>(0.4683)   | <b>5.3313***</b><br>(1.0300)   | 0.3163<br>(0.4248)             | <b>4.1979***</b><br>(1.0408)   | <b>1.2192***</b><br>(0.4116)   | <b>4.2159***</b><br>(1.0209)   |
| Capex               | <b>-4.0856**</b><br>(1.7804)   | -4.0266<br>(3.0797)            | -1.1654<br>(1.6644)            | <b>-6.9322**</b><br>(2.9467)   | <b>-5.6326***</b><br>(1.7209)  | <b>-7.7819***</b><br>(2.9462)  | <b>-5.4724***</b><br>(1.7876)  | <b>-7.2793**</b><br>(3.0489)   | -1.3083<br>(1.6597)            | <b>-8.7564***</b><br>(2.9976)  | <b>-5.5113***</b><br>(1.6644)  | <b>-7.2474**</b><br>(2.9645)   |
| DivDummy            | 0.0483<br>(0.1895)             | <b>-0.6939*</b><br>(0.3743)    | <b>0.3443*</b><br>(0.1781)     | -0.5000<br>(0.3639)            | <b>0.3304*</b><br>(0.1844)     | -0.5055<br>(0.3620)            | -0.2535<br>(0.1855)            | <b>-0.9980***</b><br>(0.3861)  | 0.0209<br>(0.1726)             | <b>-0.7672**</b><br>(0.3777)   | 0.0386<br>(0.1761)             | <b>-0.6906*</b><br>(0.3713)    |
| sCFO                | 0.2526<br>(0.3609)             | <b>0.6148*</b><br>(0.3639)     | 0.3458<br>(0.3347)             | 0.3803<br>(0.3331)             | 0.0115<br>(0.3512)             | 0.4096<br>(0.3110)             | 0.2511<br>(0.2392)             | <b>0.7815**</b><br>(0.3128)    | <b>0.4440*</b><br>(0.2565)     | <b>0.6146**</b><br>(0.2848)    | -0.0024<br>(0.2705)            | <b>0.5968**</b><br>(0.2853)    |
| Lagged_DV           | <b>0.6104***</b><br>(0.0120)   | <b>0.4618***</b><br>(0.0127)   | <b>0.5877***</b><br>(0.0125)   | <b>0.4166***</b><br>(0.0136)   | <b>0.5606***</b><br>(0.0132)   | <b>0.4128***</b><br>(0.0142)   | <b>0.6063***</b><br>(0.0127)   | <b>0.4496***</b><br>(0.0136)   | <b>0.6036***</b><br>(0.0140)   | <b>0.4140***</b><br>(0.0154)   | <b>0.5839***</b><br>(0.0141)   | <b>0.4243***</b><br>(0.0156)   |
| DailyVola           |                                |                                | <b>0.2482***</b><br>(0.0085)   | <b>0.2256***</b><br>(0.0099)   | <b>0.2141***</b><br>(0.0108)   | <b>0.2260***</b><br>(0.0126)   |                                |                                | <b>0.1791***</b><br>(0.0082)   | <b>0.1581***</b><br>(0.0096)   | <b>0.1464***</b><br>(0.0108)   | <b>0.1543***</b><br>(0.0124)   |
| StockPrice          |                                |                                | <b>-0.0083***</b><br>(0.0026)  | 0.0090<br>(0.0058)             | 0.0033<br>(0.0029)             | <b>0.0155***</b><br>(0.0059)   |                                |                                | <b>-0.0091***</b><br>(0.0025)  | <b>0.0178***</b><br>(0.0057)   | -0.0006<br>(0.0029)            | <b>0.0121**</b><br>(0.0056)    |
| Turnover            |                                |                                | <b>-56.6870***</b><br>(2.9266) | <b>-54.1555***</b><br>(3.6074) | <b>-57.3868***</b><br>(2.9842) | <b>-51.3262***</b><br>(3.6182) |                                |                                | <b>-36.8840***</b><br>(2.5240) | <b>-32.3719***</b><br>(3.0400) | <b>-40.3397***</b><br>(2.6272) | <b>-32.5773***</b><br>(3.0346) |
| UncQue              |                                |                                | <b>0.5159***</b><br>(0.1562)   | <b>-0.4290***</b><br>(0.1639)  | <b>-0.4562***</b><br>(0.1557)  | <b>-0.4572***</b><br>(0.1618)  |                                |                                | <b>0.8341***</b><br>(0.1891)   | -0.1901<br>(0.1879)            | -0.1958<br>(0.1930)            | -0.1505<br>(0.1863)            |
| Extended Controls   |                                |                                | Yes                            | Yes                            | Yes                            | Yes                            |                                |                                | Yes                            | Yes                            | Yes                            | Yes                            |
| Industry FE         | Yes                            |                                | Yes                            |                                | Yes                            |                                | Yes                            |                                | Yes                            |                                | Yes                            |                                |
| Firm FE             |                                | Yes                            |                                | Yes                            |                                | Yes                            |                                | Yes                            |                                | Yes                            |                                | Yes                            |
| Year FE             | Yes                            | Yes                            | Yes                            | Yes                            |                                |                                | Yes                            | Yes                            | Yes                            | Yes                            |                                |                                |
| Year-Quarter FE     |                                |                                |                                |                                | Yes                            | Yes                            |                                |                                |                                |                                | Yes                            | Yes                            |
| N                   | 60,073                         | 60,073                         | 56,894                         | 56,894                         | 56,894                         | 56,894                         | 59,652                         | 59,652                         | 57,708                         | 57,708                         | 57,708                         | 57,708                         |
| R <sup>2</sup>      | 0.531                          | 0.300                          | 0.546                          | 0.330                          | 0.550                          | 0.316                          | 0.537                          | 0.296                          | 0.541                          | 0.313                          | 0.551                          | 0.304                          |
| Adj. R <sup>2</sup> | 0.530                          | 0.280                          | 0.546                          | 0.310                          | 0.549                          | 0.295                          | 0.537                          | 0.275                          | 0.541                          | 0.292                          | 0.551                          | 0.283                          |

Notes: \*  $p < 0.10$ , \*\*  $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\*  $p < 0.01$  (one-tailed for IVs,  $\beta > 0$ ; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms).  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ). PostCallSpread values rescaled by  $10^4$  for readability; multiply coefficients by  $10^{-4}$  to recover raw units.

Table 44: H14c: Speech Uncertainty and BGT-Window 25-Day Bid-Ask Spread Level ([0, +25], day 0 included)

|                     | (1)                            | (2)                            | (3)                            | (4)                            | (5)                            | (6)                            | (7)                            | (8)                            | (9)                           | (10)                           | (11)                          | (12)                           |
|---------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|-------------------------------|--------------------------------|-------------------------------|--------------------------------|
|                     |                                |                                | BGTLevel_Spread                |                                |                                |                                |                                |                                | BGTLevel_Spread_lead1         |                                |                               |                                |
| UncAnsCEO           | 0.0607<br>(0.1731)             | 0.0708<br>(0.1812)             | -0.0853<br>(0.1469)            | -0.1041<br>(0.1586)            | -0.0234<br>(0.1424)            | -0.0318<br>(0.1538)            | <b>0.4110**</b><br>(0.1890)    | <b>0.4414**</b><br>(0.2027)    | <b>0.2477*</b><br>(0.1511)    | <b>0.2353*</b><br>(0.1646)     | 0.1808<br>(0.1412)            | <b>0.2111*</b><br>(0.1561)     |
| UncPreCEO           | <b>0.2994**</b><br>(0.1468)    | <b>0.4255***</b><br>(0.1805)   | 0.0809<br>(0.1259)             | <b>0.2626*</b><br>(0.1668)     | 0.0409<br>(0.1237)             | 0.1282<br>(0.1622)             | -0.1097<br>(0.1785)            | -0.1067<br>(0.1856)            | -0.2037<br>(0.1347)           | -0.2426<br>(0.1678)            | -0.0340<br>(0.1278)           | -0.0930<br>(0.1606)            |
| UncAnsMgr           | -0.3223<br>(0.2454)            | -0.2516<br>(0.2610)            | <b>0.3616*</b><br>(0.2202)     | -0.2453<br>(0.2380)            | -0.2257<br>(0.2121)            | -0.3266<br>(0.2294)            | -0.5609<br>(0.2351)            | -0.6551<br>(0.2465)            | <b>0.5780***</b><br>(0.1819)  | -0.4518<br>(0.1953)            | -0.2466<br>(0.1683)           | -0.3593<br>(0.1824)            |
| UncPreMgr           | -0.0123<br>(0.1939)            | 0.1870<br>(0.2529)             | <b>0.5508***</b><br>(0.1452)   | 0.1023<br>(0.2181)             | -0.0070<br>(0.1438)            | 0.0686<br>(0.2112)             | 0.0435<br>(0.2308)             | 0.2640<br>(0.2562)             | <b>0.9476***</b><br>(0.1605)  | <b>0.2786*</b><br>(0.2124)     | 0.0401<br>(0.1543)            | <b>0.2893*</b><br>(0.2060)     |
| InAssets            | <b>-0.9594***</b><br>(0.0499)  | <b>-2.5455***</b><br>(0.2089)  | <b>-0.2252***</b><br>(0.0241)  | <b>-1.7035***</b><br>(0.2173)  | <b>-0.6564***</b><br>(0.0469)  | <b>-1.8416***</b><br>(0.2171)  | <b>-0.9824***</b><br>(0.0506)  | <b>-2.2880***</b><br>(0.2052)  | <b>-0.1237***</b><br>(0.0209) | <b>-1.9742***</b><br>(0.2200)  | <b>-0.7042***</b><br>(0.0472) | <b>-1.6746***</b><br>(0.2073)  |
| TobinsQ             | <b>-0.3685***</b><br>(0.0444)  | <b>-0.5237***</b><br>(0.0960)  | <b>-0.0744*</b><br>(0.0438)    | <b>-0.5635***</b><br>(0.0928)  | <b>-0.2873***</b><br>(0.0449)  | <b>-0.6012***</b><br>(0.0929)  | <b>-0.3229***</b><br>(0.0477)  | <b>-0.3226***</b><br>(0.0813)  | <b>0.1008**</b><br>(0.0449)   | <b>-0.4965***</b><br>(0.0991)  | <b>-0.2262***</b><br>(0.0437) | <b>-0.4499***</b><br>(0.0927)  |
| ROA                 | <b>-11.6319***</b><br>(0.9450) | <b>-14.5821***</b><br>(1.2001) | <b>-5.5265***</b><br>(0.9644)  | <b>-7.6522***</b><br>(1.2206)  | <b>-6.0851***</b><br>(0.9579)  | <b>-7.9264***</b><br>(1.2085)  | <b>-12.0880***</b><br>(1.0613) | <b>-16.1297***</b><br>(1.3354) | <b>-8.6103***</b><br>(1.0478) | <b>-12.1990***</b><br>(1.2320) | <b>-7.9920***</b><br>(0.9826) | <b>-10.8672***</b><br>(1.1553) |
| Leverage            | <b>0.7509***</b><br>(0.2517)   | <b>3.0868***</b><br>(0.6504)   | -0.4576<br>(0.2811)            | 0.5512<br>(0.5467)             | -0.0774<br>(0.2374)            | 0.7327<br>(0.5374)             | <b>0.4738*</b><br>(0.2731)     | <b>1.6062***</b><br>(0.6180)   | <b>-0.4303*</b><br>(0.2546)   | 0.3486<br>(0.5592)             | -0.0481<br>(0.2245)           | 0.3114<br>(0.5251)             |
| Capex               | -1.0022<br>(0.9913)            | 0.4156<br>(2.0398)             | -0.1040<br>(1.0079)            | -0.0825<br>(2.3713)            | -1.5745<br>(0.9891)            | -0.0027<br>(2.3137)            | <b>-3.0126***</b><br>(1.0066)  | <b>-5.7827***</b><br>(2.0725)  | 0.7643<br>(0.9699)            | <b>-5.1554**</b><br>(2.4258)   | -1.5022<br>(0.9306)           | -3.3424<br>(2.3625)            |
| DivDummy            | 0.0510<br>(0.1125)             | -0.3279<br>(0.2223)            | <b>0.3469***</b><br>(0.0906)   | 0.2128<br>(0.1853)             | <b>0.3181**</b><br>(0.0879)    | 0.2635<br>(0.1845)             | -0.1062<br>(0.1162)            | <b>-0.5052*</b><br>(0.2397)    | 0.1127<br>(0.0903)            | 0.0979<br>(0.2099)             | 0.1152<br>(0.0851)            | 0.1096<br>(0.2000)             |
| sCFO                | -0.1729<br>(0.2676)            | <b>0.4766**</b><br>(0.2071)    | 0.4348<br>(0.4177)             | <b>0.6670*</b><br>(0.3679)     | 0.3905<br>(0.4107)             | <b>0.6844**</b><br>(0.3253)    | -0.1719<br>(0.2596)            | <b>0.5206***</b><br>(0.1847)   | 0.0969<br>(0.1734)            | 0.2838<br>(0.2091)             | -0.0954<br>(0.2117)           | 0.2223<br>(0.1810)             |
| Lagged_DV           | <b>0.8143***</b><br>(0.0085)   | <b>0.7030***</b><br>(0.0089)   | <b>0.7331***</b><br>(0.0140)   | <b>0.6306***</b><br>(0.0171)   | <b>0.7328***</b><br>(0.0152)   | <b>0.6416***</b><br>(0.0181)   | <b>0.8053***</b><br>(0.0095)   | <b>0.6810***</b><br>(0.0099)   | <b>0.7543***</b><br>(0.0149)  | <b>0.6111***</b><br>(0.0186)   | <b>0.7596***</b><br>(0.0150)  | <b>0.6476***</b><br>(0.0181)   |
| StockPrice          |                                |                                | <b>-0.0042***</b><br>(0.0015)  | -0.0035<br>(0.0024)            | 0.0006<br>(0.0014)             | 0.0016<br>(0.0024)             |                                | <b>-0.0062***</b><br>(0.0013)  | <b>0.0099***</b><br>(0.0025)  | -0.0019<br>(0.0013)            | <b>0.0045***</b><br>(0.0022)  |                                |
| Turnover            |                                |                                | <b>-24.6047***</b><br>(1.7426) | <b>-24.3939***</b><br>(2.1413) | <b>-21.9680***</b><br>(1.7020) | <b>-20.4118***</b><br>(2.0935) |                                | <b>-7.4275***</b><br>(1.5223)  | <b>-5.8266***</b><br>(2.0556) | <b>-8.5559***</b><br>(1.4983)  | <b>-5.1441***</b><br>(1.9559) |                                |
| DailyVola           |                                |                                | <b>0.1386***</b><br>(0.0068)   | <b>0.1436***</b><br>(0.0079)   | <b>0.1106***</b><br>(0.0080)   | <b>0.1291***</b><br>(0.0097)   |                                | <b>0.0610***</b><br>(0.0060)   | <b>0.0536***</b><br>(0.0066)  | <b>0.0429***</b><br>(0.0068)   | <b>0.0466***</b><br>(0.0080)  |                                |
| AbsSurpDec          |                                |                                | -0.0120<br>(0.0277)            | -0.0235<br>(0.0316)            | <b>-0.0778***</b><br>(0.0272)  | -0.0106<br>(0.0304)            |                                | <b>0.1462***</b><br>(0.0300)   | 0.0222<br>(0.0315)            | -0.0099<br>(0.0279)            | 0.0087<br>(0.0298)            |                                |
| Extended Controls   |                                |                                | Yes                            | Yes                            | Yes                            | Yes                            |                                | Yes                            | Yes                           | Yes                            | Yes                           | Yes                            |
| Industry FE         | Yes                            |                                | Yes                            |                                | Yes                            |                                | Yes                            |                                | Yes                           |                                | Yes                           |                                |
| Firm FE             |                                | Yes                            |                                | Yes                            |                                | Yes                            |                                | Yes                            |                               | Yes                            |                               | Yes                            |
| Year FE             | Yes                            | Yes                            | Yes                            | Yes                            |                                |                                | Yes                            | Yes                            | Yes                           | Yes                            |                               |                                |
| Year-Quarter FE     |                                |                                |                                |                                | Yes                            | Yes                            |                                |                                |                               |                                | Yes                           | Yes                            |
| N                   | 63,899                         | 63,899                         | 44,092                         | 44,092                         | 44,092                         | 44,092                         | 63,443                         | 63,443                         | 44,569                        | 44,569                         | 44,569                        | 44,569                         |
| R <sup>2</sup>      | 0.778                          | 0.585                          | 0.721                          | 0.563                          | 0.730                          | 0.557                          | 0.774                          | 0.567                          | 0.699                         | 0.514                          | 0.723                         | 0.530                          |
| Adj. R <sup>2</sup> | 0.778                          | 0.573                          | 0.720                          | 0.548                          | 0.730                          | 0.542                          | 0.774                          | 0.555                          | 0.699                         | 0.498                          | 0.723                         | 0.514                          |

Notes: \*  $p < 0.10$ , \*\*  $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\*  $p < 0.01$  (one-tailed for IVs,  $\beta > 0$ ; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms).  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ). BGTLevel\_Spread values rescaled by  $10^4$  for readability; multiply coefficients by  $10^{-4}$  to recover raw units.

Table 45: H14c Robustness: Orthogonal Speaker Partition

|                     | (1)                            | (2)                            | (3)                            | (4)                            | (5)                            | (6)                            | (7)                            | (8)                            | (9)                           | (10)                           | (11)                          | (12)                           |
|---------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|-------------------------------|--------------------------------|-------------------------------|--------------------------------|
|                     |                                |                                | BGTLevel_Spread                |                                |                                |                                |                                |                                | BGTLevel_Spread_lead1         |                                |                               |                                |
| UncAnsCEO           | -0.0536<br>(0.1181)            | -0.0022<br>(0.1332)            | <b>0.1530*</b><br>(0.1049)     | -0.2225<br>(0.1097)            | -0.1533<br>(0.0968)            | -0.2013<br>(0.1063)            | 0.1171<br>(0.1319)             | 0.1222<br>(0.1567)             | <b>0.5631***</b><br>(0.1206)  | -0.0338<br>(0.1411)            | 0.0113<br>(0.1146)            | -0.0090<br>(0.1350)            |
| UncAnsNoCEO         | -0.0992<br>(0.0891)            | -0.0618<br>(0.0931)            | <b>0.1090*</b><br>(0.0787)     | -0.1069<br>(0.0858)            | -0.0816<br>(0.0771)            | -0.0981<br>(0.0827)            | -0.1109<br>(0.0813)            | -0.0862<br>(0.0861)            | <b>0.2994***</b><br>(0.0735)  | -0.0066<br>(0.0803)            | -0.0165<br>(0.0705)           | 0.0025<br>(0.0765)             |
| UncPreCEO           | <b>0.2306**</b><br>(0.1117)    | <b>0.4663***</b><br>(0.1375)   | <b>0.3183***</b><br>(0.1077)   | <b>0.2826**</b><br>(0.1316)    | 0.0012<br>(0.1044)             | 0.1397<br>(0.1277)             | -0.1248<br>(0.1198)            | -0.0079<br>(0.1414)            | <b>0.2353**</b><br>(0.1038)   | -0.1307<br>(0.1343)            | -0.0294<br>(0.0972)           | 0.0293<br>(0.1290)             |
| UncPreNoCEO         | -0.0116<br>(0.0933)            | 0.0493<br>(0.1247)             | <b>0.2019***</b><br>(0.0654)   | 0.0047<br>(0.1031)             | -0.0223<br>(0.0644)            | 0.0246<br>(0.1007)             | 0.1007<br>(0.0944)             | <b>0.2068*</b><br>(0.1300)     | <b>0.3711***</b><br>(0.0710)  | 0.0706<br>(0.1084)             | -0.0387<br>(0.0644)           | 0.0560<br>(0.1036)             |
| InAssets            | <b>-0.9264***</b><br>(0.0501)  | <b>-2.4784***</b><br>(0.2156)  | <b>-0.2065***</b><br>(0.0242)  | <b>-1.7495***</b><br>(0.2244)  | <b>-0.6584***</b><br>(0.0491)  | <b>-1.8843***</b><br>(0.2249)  | <b>-0.9414***</b><br>(0.0502)  | <b>-2.2520***</b><br>(0.2081)  | <b>-0.1125***</b><br>(0.0210) | <b>-2.0044***</b><br>(0.2308)  | <b>-0.7064***</b><br>(0.0480) | <b>-1.7142***</b><br>(0.2177)  |
| TobinsQ             | <b>-0.3411***</b><br>(0.0424)  | <b>-0.4989***</b><br>(0.0961)  | -0.0518<br>(0.0452)            | <b>-0.5866***</b><br>(0.0973)  | <b>-0.2791***</b><br>(0.0460)  | <b>-0.6246***</b><br>(0.0975)  | <b>-0.3094***</b><br>(0.0520)  | <b>-0.3042***</b><br>(0.0820)  | <b>0.1209**</b><br>(0.0472)   | <b>-0.5182***</b><br>(0.1026)  | <b>-0.2177***</b><br>(0.0455) | <b>-0.4684***</b><br>(0.0952)  |
| ROA                 | <b>-11.9168***</b><br>(0.9227) | <b>-14.6359***</b><br>(1.2565) | <b>-6.0142***</b><br>(1.0180)  | <b>-8.0326***</b><br>(1.2841)  | <b>-6.5826***</b><br>(1.0130)  | <b>-8.2914***</b><br>(1.2641)  | <b>-12.2366***</b><br>(1.0892) | <b>-16.2875***</b><br>(1.3653) | <b>-9.0499***</b><br>(1.0958) | <b>-12.4130***</b><br>(1.2803) | <b>-8.4034***</b><br>(1.0357) | <b>-10.9936***</b><br>(1.2042) |
| Leverage            | <b>0.7118***</b><br>(0.2585)   | <b>2.9709***</b><br>(0.6566)   | <b>-0.5126*</b><br>(0.2920)    | 0.6011<br>(0.5530)             | -0.1071<br>(0.2481)            | 0.7421<br>(0.5548)             | 0.4070<br>(0.2792)             | <b>1.5519**</b><br>(0.6210)    | <b>-0.5051*</b><br>(0.2615)   | 0.3897<br>(0.5683)             | -0.0762<br>(0.2291)           | 0.3902<br>(0.5333)             |
| Capex               | -0.9383<br>(1.0544)            | 1.5238<br>(2.2405)             | -0.0298<br>(1.0679)            | 0.3240<br>(2.5487)             | -1.6043<br>(1.0368)            | 0.3999<br>(2.4886)             | <b>-2.7165***</b><br>(1.0329)  | <b>-4.9035**</b><br>(2.1117)   | 1.1317<br>(0.9887)            | <b>-5.2605***</b><br>(2.5587)  | -1.1251<br>(0.9287)           | -3.3188<br>(2.4779)            |
| DivDummy            | -0.0087<br>(0.1058)            | <b>-0.3900*</b><br>(0.2329)    | <b>0.3390***</b><br>(0.0937)   | 0.1695<br>(0.1952)             | <b>0.3300***</b><br>(0.0903)   | 0.2123<br>(0.1941)             | -0.1160<br>(0.1108)            | <b>-0.4521*</b><br>(0.2484)    | 0.1321<br>(0.0935)            | 0.1371<br>(0.2204)             | <b>0.1520*</b><br>(0.0878)    | 0.1392<br>(0.2103)             |
| sCFO                | -0.0748<br>(0.2538)            | <b>0.4965**</b><br>(0.2098)    | 0.5818<br>(0.3565)             | <b>0.6926*</b><br>(0.3647)     | 0.5519<br>(0.3359)             | <b>0.7275**</b><br>(0.3024)    | -0.1033<br>(0.2387)            | <b>0.5157***</b><br>(0.1775)   | 0.1934<br>(0.1427)            | 0.3010<br>(0.2074)             | -0.0143<br>(0.1853)           | 0.2307<br>(0.1861)             |
| Lagged_DV           | <b>0.8046***</b><br>(0.0089)   | <b>0.6990***</b><br>(0.0096)   | <b>0.7233***</b><br>(0.0145)   | <b>0.6227***</b><br>(0.0178)   | <b>0.7225***</b><br>(0.0159)   | <b>0.6341***</b><br>(0.0189)   | <b>0.8017***</b><br>(0.0097)   | <b>0.6818***</b><br>(0.0104)   | <b>0.7496***</b><br>(0.0161)  | <b>0.6054***</b><br>(0.0195)   | <b>0.7546***</b><br>(0.0162)  | <b>0.6427***</b><br>(0.0189)   |
| StockPrice          |                                |                                | <b>-0.0045***</b><br>(0.0015)  | -0.0028<br>(0.0025)            | 0.0005<br>(0.0015)             | 0.0023<br>(0.0025)             |                                |                                | <b>-0.0065***</b><br>(0.0013) | <b>0.0101***</b><br>(0.0025)   | <b>-0.0022*</b><br>(0.0013)   | <b>0.0046**</b><br>(0.0023)    |
| Turnover            |                                |                                | <b>-24.2920***</b><br>(1.7648) | <b>-24.4940***</b><br>(2.1608) | <b>-21.7210***</b><br>(1.7327) | <b>-20.3661***</b><br>(2.1179) |                                |                                | <b>-6.9017***</b><br>(1.5482) | <b>-5.4612***</b><br>(2.0959)  | <b>-8.1633***</b><br>(1.5274) | <b>-4.7962**</b><br>(1.9941)   |
| DailyVola           |                                |                                | <b>0.1418***</b><br>(0.0071)   | <b>0.1455***</b><br>(0.0084)   | <b>0.1130***</b><br>(0.0085)   | <b>0.1311***</b><br>(0.0103)   |                                |                                | <b>0.0616***</b><br>(0.0063)  | <b>0.0542***</b><br>(0.0068)   | <b>0.0428***</b><br>(0.0071)  | <b>0.0467***</b><br>(0.0082)   |
| AbsSurpDec          |                                |                                | -0.0295<br>(0.0283)            | -0.0473<br>(0.0324)            | <b>-0.1015***</b><br>(0.0275)  | -0.0336<br>(0.0312)            |                                |                                | <b>0.1458***</b><br>(0.0305)  | 0.0170<br>(0.0325)             | -0.0165<br>(0.0284)           | 0.0036<br>(0.0306)             |
| Extended Controls   |                                |                                | Yes                            | Yes                            | Yes                            | Yes                            |                                |                                | Yes                           | Yes                            | Yes                           | Yes                            |
| Industry FE         | Yes                            |                                | Yes                            |                                | Yes                            |                                | Yes                            |                                | Yes                           |                                | Yes                           |                                |
| Firm FE             |                                | Yes                            |                                | Yes                            |                                | Yes                            |                                | Yes                            |                               | Yes                            |                               | Yes                            |
| Year FE             | Yes                            | Yes                            | Yes                            | Yes                            |                                |                                | Yes                            | Yes                            | Yes                           | Yes                            |                               |                                |
| Year-Quarter FE     |                                |                                |                                |                                | Yes                            | Yes                            |                                |                                |                               |                                | Yes                           | Yes                            |
| N                   | 60,002                         | 60,002                         | 41,563                         | 41,563                         | 41,563                         | 41,563                         | 59,548                         | 59,548                         | 42,009                        | 42,009                         | 42,009                        | 42,009                         |
| R <sup>2</sup>      | 0.768                          | 0.583                          | 0.717                          | 0.559                          | 0.726                          | 0.553                          | 0.765                          | 0.566                          | 0.694                         | 0.510                          | 0.719                         | 0.525                          |
| Adj. R <sup>2</sup> | 0.768                          | 0.571                          | 0.716                          | 0.544                          | 0.726                          | 0.537                          | 0.765                          | 0.553                          | 0.694                         | 0.493                          | 0.718                         | 0.508                          |

Notes: \*  $p < 0.10$ , \*\*  $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\*  $p < 0.01$  (one-tailed for IVs,  $\beta > 0$ ; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms).  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ). BGTLevel\_Spread values rescaled by  $10^4$  for readability; multiply coefficients by  $10^{-4}$  to recover raw units.



Table 46: H14d: Speech Uncertainty and BGT-Window 25-Day Bid-Ask Spread Delta ( $[+1, +25] - [-25, -1]$ )

|                     | (1)                           | (2)                           | (3)<br>BGTDelta_Spread        |                               | (5)                           | (6)                           | (7)                           | (8)                           | (9)<br>BGTDelta_Spread_lead1  |                               | (11)                          | (12)                          |
|---------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|
| UncAnsCEO           | 0.0033<br>(0.1409)            | 0.0628<br>(0.1548)            | 0.0413<br>(0.1287)            | 0.0703<br>(0.1444)            | 0.0482<br>(0.1265)            | 0.0950<br>(0.1421)            | 0.1323<br>(0.1262)            | <b>0.1830*</b><br>(0.1319)    | 0.1294<br>(0.1280)            | 0.1490<br>(0.1418)            | 0.1190<br>(0.1237)            | 0.1454<br>(0.1375)            |
| UncPreCEO           | 0.0420<br>(0.1093)            | 0.0618<br>(0.1379)            | -0.0527<br>(0.0922)           | -0.0421<br>(0.1245)           | -0.0482<br>(0.0898)           | -0.0029<br>(0.1217)           | -0.0911<br>(0.1013)           | -0.1049<br>(0.1311)           | -0.0536<br>(0.0911)           | -0.0709<br>(0.1145)           | -0.0559<br>(0.0897)           | -0.0469<br>(0.1138)           |
| UncAnsMgr           | 0.0051<br>(0.1708)            | -0.1221<br>(0.1967)           | -0.3530<br>(0.1600)           | -0.2365<br>(0.1886)           | 0.0177<br>(0.1610)            | -0.1870<br>(0.1865)           | -0.1212<br>(0.1477)           | -0.2639<br>(0.1648)           | -0.2532<br>(0.1434)           | -0.3746<br>(0.1660)           | -0.2203<br>(0.1405)           | -0.4045<br>(0.1623)           |
| UncPreMgr           | 0.1251<br>(0.1195)            | 0.0931<br>(0.1767)            | -0.2611<br>(0.1007)           | -0.0456<br>(0.1576)           | 0.1059<br>(0.1005)            | 0.0252<br>(0.1545)            | 0.1294<br>(0.1120)            | 0.0598<br>(0.1629)            | 0.0726<br>(0.1015)            | 0.0830<br>(0.1445)            | 0.1164<br>(0.1026)            | 0.0273<br>(0.1438)            |
| lnAssets            | <b>0.3082***</b><br>(0.0293)  | <b>0.6417***</b><br>(0.1124)  | 0.0157<br>(0.0150)            | <b>0.5822***</b><br>(0.1365)  | <b>0.2602***</b><br>(0.0274)  | <b>0.5347***</b><br>(0.1365)  | <b>0.2920***</b><br>(0.0278)  | <b>0.6610***</b><br>(0.1111)  | <b>0.0953***</b><br>(0.0140)  | <b>0.3272***</b><br>(0.1123)  | <b>0.1487***</b><br>(0.0254)  | <b>0.3829***</b><br>(0.1139)  |
| TobinsQ             | <b>0.1991***</b><br>(0.0251)  | <b>0.2965***</b><br>(0.0476)  | -0.0137<br>(0.0226)           | <b>0.2217***</b><br>(0.0452)  | <b>0.0941***</b><br>(0.0233)  | <b>0.1572***</b><br>(0.0435)  | <b>0.1386***</b><br>(0.0225)  | <b>0.1891***</b><br>(0.0401)  | <b>0.0687***</b><br>(0.0200)  | <b>0.1730***</b><br>(0.0397)  | <b>0.0700***</b><br>(0.0212)  | <b>0.1249***</b><br>(0.0389)  |
| ROA                 | <b>-1.9859***</b><br>(0.4388) | <b>-3.2837***</b><br>(0.7130) | -0.7765<br>(0.5578)           | <b>-1.2591*</b><br>(0.7153)   | -0.5896<br>(0.5498)           | -0.9897<br>(0.6974)           | -0.4808<br>(0.4238)           | -0.7793<br>(0.6721)           | <b>-1.5432***</b><br>(0.4639) | <b>-1.7847***</b><br>(0.6470) | <b>-1.1306**</b><br>(0.4662)  | <b>-1.3676**</b><br>(0.6519)  |
| Leverage            | <b>-0.4547***</b><br>(0.1737) | <b>-1.0995***</b><br>(0.4209) | -0.1425<br>(0.1552)           | <b>-0.8998**</b><br>(0.3837)  | <b>-0.2961*</b><br>(0.1625)   | <b>-0.8747**</b><br>(0.3777)  | <b>-0.4361***</b><br>(0.1638) | <b>-1.7838***</b><br>(0.4324) | -0.0022<br>(0.1322)           | -0.4553<br>(0.4008)           | -0.0561<br>(0.1316)           | -0.5173<br>(0.3979)           |
| Capex               | <b>2.4808***</b><br>(0.6280)  | <b>4.5739***</b><br>(1.4754)  | 0.0029<br>(0.5573)            | <b>4.0794***</b><br>(1.2948)  | <b>0.9174*</b><br>(0.5428)    | <b>4.1364***</b><br>(1.2383)  | <b>1.2728**</b><br>(0.5790)   | 0.2977<br>(1.2999)            | 0.6336<br>(0.5358)            | 0.0826<br>(1.1331)            | 0.8721<br>(0.5373)            | 0.7056<br>(1.1266)            |
| DivDummy            | 0.0862<br>(0.0658)            | 0.2179<br>(0.1402)            | 0.0927<br>(0.0613)            | <b>0.2536*</b><br>(0.1415)    | 0.0968<br>(0.0602)            | <b>0.2729*</b><br>(0.1398)    | -0.0217<br>(0.0624)           | 0.1632<br>(0.1391)            | -0.0924<br>(0.0570)           | -0.0098<br>(0.1343)           | -0.0689<br>(0.0571)           | 0.0052<br>(0.1339)            |
| sCFO                | 0.1792<br>(0.2230)            | <b>0.3020*</b><br>(0.1724)    | 0.4893<br>(0.3602)            | <b>0.7107**</b><br>(0.3048)   | 0.5269<br>(0.3350)            | <b>0.6947**</b><br>(0.2931)   | 0.2170<br>(0.1538)            | 0.2461<br>(0.1581)            | <b>0.3427**</b><br>(0.1734)   | <b>0.3899**</b><br>(0.1910)   | <b>0.3123*</b><br>(0.1695)    | <b>0.3727**</b><br>(0.1832)   |
| Lagged_DV           | -0.0056<br>(0.0099)           | <b>-0.0325***</b><br>(0.0103) | 0.0104<br>(0.0131)            | <b>-0.0232*</b><br>(0.0134)   | 0.0191<br>(0.0133)            | -0.0132<br>(0.0136)           | -0.0022<br>(0.0104)           | <b>-0.0277**</b><br>(0.0108)  | 0.0180<br>(0.0141)            | -0.0105<br>(0.0141)           | 0.0193<br>(0.0141)            | -0.0096<br>(0.0141)           |
| StockPrice          |                               |                               | <b>0.0027***</b><br>(0.0008)  | -0.0024<br>(0.0015)           | 0.0001<br>(0.0008)            | <b>-0.0036**</b><br>(0.0015)  |                               |                               | <b>-0.0035***</b><br>(0.0007) | <b>-0.0025*</b><br>(0.0014)   | <b>-0.0033***</b><br>(0.0007) | <b>-0.0023*</b><br>(0.0014)   |
| Turnover            |                               |                               | <b>3.3270***</b><br>(1.0552)  | <b>3.2232**</b><br>(1.3946)   | <b>2.4221**</b><br>(1.0737)   | 1.7001<br>(1.3984)            |                               |                               | <b>8.3582***</b><br>(1.0491)  | <b>8.8869***</b><br>(1.3434)  | <b>7.6445***</b><br>(1.0537)  | <b>8.4446***</b><br>(1.3394)  |
| DailyVola           |                               |                               | 0.0053<br>(0.0040)            | <b>0.0200***</b><br>(0.0048)  | <b>0.0181***</b><br>(0.0050)  | <b>0.0292***</b><br>(0.0061)  |                               |                               | <b>-0.0366***</b><br>(0.0034) | <b>-0.0411***</b><br>(0.0042) | <b>-0.0255***</b><br>(0.0043) | <b>-0.0315***</b><br>(0.0053) |
| AbsSurpDec          |                               |                               | <b>-0.1624***</b><br>(0.0204) | <b>-0.1094***</b><br>(0.0233) | <b>-0.1129***</b><br>(0.0187) | <b>-0.1072***</b><br>(0.0229) |                               |                               | -0.0102<br>(0.0196)           | -0.0197<br>(0.0237)           | -0.0169<br>(0.0193)           | -0.0279<br>(0.0232)           |
| Extended Controls   |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| Industry FE         | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               |
| Firm FE             |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |
| Year FE             | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               |
| Year-Quarter FE     |                               |                               |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| N                   | 62,480                        | 62,480                        | 43,282                        | 43,282                        | 43,282                        | 43,282                        | 62,029                        | 62,029                        | 43,750                        | 43,750                        | 43,750                        | 43,750                        |
| R <sup>2</sup>      | 0.005                         | 0.004                         | 0.002                         | 0.006                         | 0.006                         | 0.006                         | 0.003                         | 0.003                         | 0.012                         | 0.012                         | 0.007                         | 0.006                         |
| Adj. R <sup>2</sup> | 0.004                         | -0.024                        | 0.001                         | -0.028                        | 0.004                         | -0.029                        | 0.003                         | -0.026                        | 0.011                         | -0.022                        | 0.005                         | -0.029                        |

Notes: \*  $p < 0.10$ , \*\*  $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\*  $p < 0.01$  (one-tailed for IVs,  $\beta > 0$ ; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms).  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ). BGTDelta\_Spread values rescaled by  $10^4$  for readability; multiply coefficients by  $10^{-4}$  to recover raw units.

Table 47: H14d Robustness: Orthogonal Speaker Partition

|                     | (1)                           | (2)                           | (3)<br>BGTDelta_Spread        |                               | (5)                           | (6)                           | (7)                          | (8)                           | (9)<br>BGTDelta_Spread_lead1  |                               | (11)                          | (12)                          |
|---------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|
| UncAnsCEO           | 0.0272<br>(0.0845)            | 0.0422<br>(0.1015)            | -0.1609<br>(0.0787)           | -0.0414<br>(0.0983)           | 0.0645<br>(0.0779)            | 0.0059<br>(0.0961)            | 0.0685<br>(0.0863)           | 0.0754<br>(0.0979)            | -0.0369<br>(0.0807)           | -0.0765<br>(0.1008)           | -0.0281<br>(0.0834)           | -0.0987<br>(0.0991)           |
| UncAnsNoCEO         | 0.0622<br>(0.0595)            | 0.0361<br>(0.0658)            | -0.0984<br>(0.0566)           | -0.0293<br>(0.0613)           | 0.0220<br>(0.0549)            | -0.0206<br>(0.0606)           | 0.0255<br>(0.0543)           | 0.0012<br>(0.0600)            | 0.0241<br>(0.0493)            | 0.0173<br>(0.0554)            | 0.0293<br>(0.0494)            | 0.0018<br>(0.0546)            |
| UncPreCEO           | 0.0607<br>(0.0842)            | 0.0400<br>(0.1046)            | -0.1963<br>(0.0749)           | -0.0727<br>(0.0975)           | -0.0137<br>(0.0729)           | -0.0035<br>(0.0965)           | -0.0093<br>(0.0797)          | -0.0821<br>(0.1005)           | -0.0124<br>(0.0702)           | -0.0339<br>(0.0913)           | 0.0068<br>(0.0685)            | -0.0329<br>(0.0910)           |
| UncPreNoCEO         | 0.0079<br>(0.0570)            | -0.0176<br>(0.0855)           | -0.1372<br>(0.0484)           | -0.0560<br>(0.0796)           | 0.0223<br>(0.0481)            | -0.0311<br>(0.0788)           | 0.0406<br>(0.0526)           | 0.0266<br>(0.0813)            | -0.0245<br>(0.0464)           | -0.0326<br>(0.0791)           | -0.0073<br>(0.0472)           | -0.0545<br>(0.0778)           |
| InAssets            | <b>0.2951***</b><br>(0.0291)  | <b>0.5948***</b><br>(0.1127)  | 0.0167<br>(0.0152)            | <b>0.5975***</b><br>(0.1426)  | <b>0.2584***</b><br>(0.0281)  | <b>0.5448***</b><br>(0.1413)  | <b>0.2726***</b><br>(0.0283) | <b>0.6113***</b><br>(0.1100)  | <b>0.0895***</b><br>(0.0142)  | <b>0.3499***</b><br>(0.1129)  | <b>0.1419***</b><br>(0.0262)  | <b>0.4015***</b><br>(0.1149)  |
| TobinsQ             | <b>0.1991***</b><br>(0.0256)  | <b>0.3044***</b><br>(0.0492)  | -0.0153<br>(0.0219)           | <b>0.2214***</b><br>(0.0448)  | <b>0.0956***</b><br>(0.0228)  | <b>0.1596***</b><br>(0.0434)  | <b>0.1196***</b><br>(0.0213) | <b>0.1733***</b><br>(0.0403)  | <b>0.0566***</b><br>(0.0193)  | <b>0.1676***</b><br>(0.0401)  | <b>0.0586***</b><br>(0.0208)  | <b>0.1189***</b><br>(0.0392)  |
| ROA                 | <b>-2.1145***</b><br>(0.4617) | <b>-3.4336***</b><br>(0.7415) | -0.8698<br>(0.5799)           | <b>-1.5261**</b><br>(0.7316)  | -0.7249<br>(0.5691)           | <b>-1.2786*</b><br>(0.7134)   | -0.2503<br>(0.4622)          | -0.6192<br>(0.6988)           | <b>-1.3445***</b><br>(0.4771) | <b>-1.6766**</b><br>(0.6663)  | <b>-0.9297*</b><br>(0.4830)   | <b>-1.2287*</b><br>(0.6727)   |
| Leverage            | <b>-0.4280**</b><br>(0.1714)  | <b>-1.1227***</b><br>(0.4346) | -0.1571<br>(0.1631)           | <b>-1.0590*</b><br>(0.4126)   | <b>-0.3169*</b><br>(0.1710)   | <b>-1.0427**</b><br>(0.4095)  | <b>-0.3467**</b><br>(0.1590) | <b>-1.5924***</b><br>(0.4327) | 0.0351<br>(0.1324)            | -0.4319<br>(0.4129)           | -0.0103<br>(0.1309)           | -0.4849<br>(0.4115)           |
| Capex               | <b>2.2278***</b><br>(0.6845)  | <b>4.6026***</b><br>(1.6429)  | -0.0912<br>(0.6088)           | <b>4.6647***</b><br>(1.3982)  | 0.8018<br>(0.5964)            | <b>4.7414***</b><br>(1.3464)  | 0.9783<br>(0.6137)           | 0.3321<br>(1.3577)            | 0.5252<br>(0.5590)            | 0.3533<br>(1.2004)            | 0.7693<br>(0.5675)            | 1.0090<br>(1.1969)            |
| DivDummy            | 0.0820<br>(0.0656)            | 0.2110<br>(0.1443)            | <b>0.1156*</b><br>(0.0627)    | <b>0.2634*</b><br>(0.1489)    | <b>0.1073*</b><br>(0.0619)    | <b>0.2753*</b><br>(0.1474)    | -0.0259<br>(0.0648)          | 0.1614<br>(0.1415)            | -0.0718<br>(0.0564)           | 0.0134<br>(0.1347)            | -0.0502<br>(0.0565)           | 0.0326<br>(0.1346)            |
| sCFO                | 0.2277<br>(0.1935)            | <b>0.3221**</b><br>(0.1498)   | <b>0.5605*</b><br>(0.3288)    | <b>0.7328**</b><br>(0.2878)   | <b>0.6015**</b><br>(0.2990)   | <b>0.7136**</b><br>(0.2801)   | 0.2042<br>(0.1672)           | 0.1930<br>(0.1909)            | <b>0.3377*</b><br>(0.1908)    | <b>0.3683*</b><br>(0.2103)    | <b>0.3147*</b><br>(0.1796)    | <b>0.3560*</b><br>(0.1975)    |
| Lagged_DV           | -0.0053<br>(0.0108)           | <b>-0.0318***</b><br>(0.0112) | 0.0050<br>(0.0144)            | <b>-0.0285*</b><br>(0.0148)   | 0.0142<br>(0.0146)            | -0.0180<br>(0.0150)           | 0.0048<br>(0.0105)           | <b>-0.0215*</b><br>(0.0111)   | 0.0206<br>(0.0150)            | -0.0080<br>(0.0149)           | 0.0215<br>(0.0150)            | -0.0076<br>(0.0150)           |
| StockPrice          |                               |                               | <b>0.0027***</b><br>(0.0008)  | <b>-0.0025*</b><br>(0.0015)   | 0.0000<br>(0.0008)            | <b>-0.0037**</b><br>(0.0015)  |                              |                               | <b>-0.0034***</b><br>(0.0008) | <b>-0.0028**</b><br>(0.0014)  | <b>-0.0032***</b><br>(0.0007) | <b>-0.0028**</b><br>(0.0014)  |
| Turnover            |                               |                               | <b>3.6228***</b><br>(1.0688)  | <b>3.3493**</b><br>(1.4181)   | <b>2.8989***</b><br>(1.0875)  | 1.9686<br>(1.4205)            |                              |                               | <b>8.1654***</b><br>(1.0573)  | <b>8.6794***</b><br>(1.3697)  | <b>7.4333***</b><br>(1.0666)  | <b>8.1456***</b><br>(1.3685)  |
| DailyVola           |                               |                               | 0.0050<br>(0.0040)            | <b>0.0204***</b><br>(0.0050)  | <b>0.0169***</b><br>(0.0051)  | <b>0.0289***</b><br>(0.0062)  |                              |                               | <b>-0.0357***</b><br>(0.0035) | <b>-0.0399***</b><br>(0.0042) | <b>-0.0247***</b><br>(0.0043) | <b>-0.0300***</b><br>(0.0053) |
| AbsSurpDec          |                               |                               | <b>-0.1736***</b><br>(0.0211) | <b>-0.1221***</b><br>(0.0242) | <b>-0.1203***</b><br>(0.0194) | <b>-0.1182***</b><br>(0.0238) |                              |                               | -0.0137<br>(0.0196)           | -0.0263<br>(0.0240)           | -0.0190<br>(0.0192)           | -0.0338<br>(0.0235)           |
| Extended Controls   |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                              |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| Industry FE         | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                          |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               |
| Firm FE             |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                              | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |
| Year FE             | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                          | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               |                               |
| Year-Quarter FE     |                               |                               |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |                              |                               |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| N                   | 58,647                        | 58,647                        | 40,785                        | 40,785                        | 40,785                        | 40,785                        | 58,200                       | 58,200                        | 41,231                        | 41,231                        | 41,231                        | 41,231                        |
| R <sup>2</sup>      | 0.005                         | 0.005                         | 0.002                         | 0.007                         | 0.006                         | 0.006                         | 0.003                        | 0.002                         | 0.011                         | 0.011                         | 0.007                         | 0.005                         |
| Adj. R <sup>2</sup> | 0.004                         | -0.025                        | 0.001                         | -0.028                        | 0.004                         | -0.030                        | 0.003                        | -0.028                        | 0.011                         | -0.024                        | 0.005                         | -0.031                        |

Notes: \*  $p < 0.10$ , \*\*  $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\*  $p < 0.01$  (one-tailed for IVs,  $\beta > 0$ ; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms).  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ). BGTDelta\_Spread values rescaled by  $10^4$  for readability; multiply coefficients by  $10^{-4}$  to recover raw units.

Table 48: H14e: Speech Uncertainty and BGT-Window 25-Day Bid-Ask Spread Average ( $[-25, +25]$ , 51-day symmetric)

|                     | (1)                           | (2)                            | (3)                            | (4)                            | (5)                            | (6)                            | (7)                            | (8)                            | (9)                           | (10)                           | (11)                          | (12)                          |
|---------------------|-------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|-------------------------------|--------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|
|                     |                               |                                | BGTAvg_Spread                  |                                |                                |                                |                                |                                | BGTAvg_Spread_lead1           |                                |                               |                               |
| UncAnsCEO           | 0.1354<br>(0.1647)            | 0.1566<br>(0.1736)             | -0.0536<br>(0.1358)            | -0.0459<br>(0.1462)            | 0.0072<br>(0.1323)             | 0.0159<br>(0.1421)             | <b>0.2878**</b><br>(0.1747)    | <b>0.3317**</b><br>(0.1879)    | 0.1521<br>(0.1374)            | 0.1354<br>(0.1491)             | 0.1034<br>(0.1282)            | 0.1289<br>(0.1415)            |
| UncPreCEO           | <b>0.2071*</b><br>(0.1352)    | <b>0.3705**</b><br>(0.1633)    | 0.1114<br>(0.1128)             | <b>0.2982**</b><br>(0.1455)    | 0.0386<br>(0.1113)             | 0.1313<br>(0.1423)             | 0.0022<br>(0.1577)             | 0.0617<br>(0.1759)             | -0.1434<br>(0.1178)           | -0.1698<br>(0.1534)            | 0.0248<br>(0.1106)            | -0.0009<br>(0.1437)           |
| UncAnsMgr           | -0.3037<br>(0.2243)           | -0.2103<br>(0.2407)            | 0.1897<br>(0.2058)             | -0.2336<br>(0.2218)            | -0.2979<br>(0.1981)            | -0.3408<br>(0.2129)            | -0.4073<br>(0.2188)            | -0.4894<br>(0.2325)            | <b>0.4651***</b><br>(0.1752)  | -0.3026<br>(0.1884)            | -0.1191<br>(0.1569)           | -0.1745<br>(0.1731)           |
| UncPreMgr           | 0.0803<br>(0.1686)            | 0.2279<br>(0.2265)             | <b>0.4347***</b><br>(0.1309)   | 0.1031<br>(0.1943)             | -0.0148<br>(0.1301)            | 0.0467<br>(0.1884)             | -0.0020<br>(0.2022)            | 0.1060<br>(0.2319)             | <b>0.6979***</b><br>(0.1369)  | 0.1930<br>(0.1932)             | 0.0368<br>(0.1320)            | <b>0.2599*</b><br>(0.1845)    |
| lnAssets            | <b>-0.7474***</b><br>(0.0422) | <b>-2.0513***</b><br>(0.1837)  | <b>-0.2071***</b><br>(0.0229)  | <b>-1.4110***</b><br>(0.2040)  | <b>-0.5722***</b><br>(0.0447)  | <b>-1.5815***</b><br>(0.2054)  | <b>-0.7857***</b><br>(0.0437)  | <b>-1.8059***</b><br>(0.1825)  | <b>-0.1437***</b><br>(0.0194) | <b>-1.5334***</b><br>(0.2018)  | <b>-0.5484***</b><br>(0.0432) | <b>-1.2237***</b><br>(0.1884) |
| TobinsQ             | <b>-0.3771***</b><br>(0.0421) | <b>-0.6016***</b><br>(0.0936)  | <b>-0.1277***</b><br>(0.0389)  | <b>-0.6175***</b><br>(0.0901)  | <b>-0.2877***</b><br>(0.0413)  | <b>-0.6244***</b><br>(0.0896)  | <b>-0.2187***</b><br>(0.0441)  | <b>-0.1493**</b><br>(0.0645)   | 0.0532<br>(0.0418)            | <b>-0.4117***</b><br>(0.0890)  | <b>-0.1829***</b><br>(0.0403) | <b>-0.3500***</b><br>(0.0818) |
| ROA                 | <b>-9.9380***</b><br>(0.8194) | <b>-12.6747***</b><br>(1.0064) | <b>-4.3688***</b><br>(0.8425)  | <b>-6.2204***</b><br>(1.0597)  | <b>-5.1122***</b><br>(0.8505)  | <b>-6.7600***</b><br>(1.0649)  | <b>-11.2007***</b><br>(1.0012) | <b>-15.4200***</b><br>(1.1944) | <b>-7.4140***</b><br>(0.9755) | <b>-10.6907***</b><br>(1.1206) | <b>-6.7481***</b><br>(0.9069) | <b>-9.3817***</b><br>(1.0392) |
| Leverage            | <b>0.5849**</b><br>(0.2271)   | <b>2.8393***</b><br>(0.6103)   | -0.4101<br>(0.2604)            | 0.4769<br>(0.4917)             | -0.0782<br>(0.2146)            | 0.7121<br>(0.4867)             | 0.1702<br>(0.2488)             | <b>1.3597**</b><br>(0.5578)    | <b>-0.5081**</b><br>(0.2397)  | -0.1210<br>(0.4894)            | -0.2247<br>(0.2112)           | -0.1657<br>(0.4559)           |
| Capex               | -0.4168<br>(0.8706)           | 1.6157<br>(1.7827)             | -0.0197<br>(0.9317)            | 0.5126<br>(2.1846)             | -1.0097<br>(0.9219)            | 0.8917<br>(2.1523)             | <b>-2.0113**</b><br>(0.9168)   | <b>-3.4057*</b><br>(1.9593)    | 0.2696<br>(0.8883)            | -3.3575<br>(2.4109)            | -1.3267<br>(0.8421)           | -1.5965<br>(2.3457)           |
| DivDummy            | 0.1142<br>(0.0966)            | -0.1822<br>(0.1974)            | <b>0.3404***</b><br>(0.0824)   | 0.2063<br>(0.1689)             | <b>0.3107***</b><br>(0.0807)   | 0.2409<br>(0.1689)             | -0.0156<br>(0.1048)            | <b>-0.4271**</b><br>(0.2169)   | <b>0.1937**</b><br>(0.0798)   | 0.1525<br>(0.1816)             | <b>0.1829**</b><br>(0.0751)   | 0.1615<br>(0.1715)            |
| sCFO                | -0.2827<br>(0.2671)           | 0.2897<br>(0.2022)             | -0.0006<br>(0.3070)            | 0.1812<br>(0.2536)             | -0.0080<br>(0.2988)            | 0.2201<br>(0.2247)             | -0.2655<br>(0.2685)            | <b>0.4092**</b><br>(0.1772)    | 0.0061<br>(0.1823)            | 0.1965<br>(0.1547)             | -0.1436<br>(0.2154)           | 0.1512<br>(0.1327)            |
| Lagged_DV           | <b>0.8559***</b><br>(0.0074)  | <b>0.7647***</b><br>(0.0077)   | <b>0.7817***</b><br>(0.0125)   | <b>0.6943***</b><br>(0.0157)   | <b>0.7789***</b><br>(0.0137)   | <b>0.6994***</b><br>(0.0167)   | <b>0.8406***</b><br>(0.0085)   | <b>0.7344***</b><br>(0.0091)   | <b>0.7886***</b><br>(0.0141)  | <b>0.6670***</b><br>(0.0179)   | <b>0.8020***</b><br>(0.0142)  | <b>0.7080***</b><br>(0.0171)  |
| StockPrice          |                               |                                | <b>-0.0026*</b><br>(0.0013)    | <b>-0.0039*</b><br>(0.0023)    | 0.0016<br>(0.0013)             | 0.0023<br>(0.0023)             |                                |                                | -0.0018<br>(0.0011)           | <b>0.0103***</b><br>(0.0022)   | 0.0005<br>(0.0011)            | <b>0.0037*</b><br>(0.0019)    |
| Turnover            |                               |                                | <b>-23.1346***</b><br>(1.6492) | <b>-23.7444***</b><br>(2.0032) | <b>-20.1206***</b><br>(1.6117) | <b>-19.2191***</b><br>(1.9702) |                                |                                | <b>-8.0598***</b><br>(1.3957) | <b>-6.6693***</b><br>(1.8563)  | <b>-8.5505***</b><br>(1.3726) | <b>-6.2162***</b><br>(1.7616) |
| DailyVola           |                               |                                | <b>0.1239***</b><br>(0.0067)   | <b>0.1307***</b><br>(0.0078)   | <b>0.0965***</b><br>(0.0078)   | <b>0.1129***</b><br>(0.0095)   |                                |                                | <b>0.0704***</b><br>(0.0061)  | <b>0.0700***</b><br>(0.0070)   | <b>0.0525***</b><br>(0.0070)  | <b>0.0614***</b><br>(0.0086)  |
| AbsSurpDec          |                               |                                | -0.0084<br>(0.0266)            | 0.0008<br>(0.0305)             | <b>-0.0510**</b><br>(0.0259)   | 0.0148<br>(0.0291)             |                                |                                | <b>0.0526**</b><br>(0.0259)   | -0.0268<br>(0.0273)            | <b>-0.0649***</b><br>(0.0240) | -0.0404<br>(0.0255)           |
| Extended Controls   |                               |                                | Yes                            | Yes                            | Yes                            | Yes                            |                                |                                | Yes                           | Yes                            | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| Industry FE         | Yes                           |                                | Yes                            |                                | Yes                            |                                | Yes                            |                                | Yes                           |                                | Yes                           |                               |
| Firm FE             |                               | Yes                            |                                | Yes                            |                                | Yes                            |                                | Yes                            |                               | Yes                            |                               | Yes                           |
| Year FE             | Yes                           | Yes                            | Yes                            | Yes                            |                                |                                | Yes                            | Yes                            | Yes                           | Yes                            |                               |                               |
| Year-Quarter FE     |                               |                                |                                |                                | Yes                            | Yes                            |                                |                                |                               |                                | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| N                   | 63,936                        | 63,936                         | 44,100                         | 44,100                         | 44,100                         | 44,100                         | 63,509                         | 63,509                         | 44,600                        | 44,600                         | 44,600                        | 44,600                        |
| R <sup>2</sup>      | 0.826                         | 0.663                          | 0.776                          | 0.638                          | 0.786                          | 0.638                          | 0.818                          | 0.641                          | 0.762                         | 0.604                          | 0.787                         | 0.625                         |
| Adj. R <sup>2</sup> | 0.826                         | 0.654                          | 0.775                          | 0.626                          | 0.786                          | 0.625                          | 0.818                          | 0.631                          | 0.762                         | 0.591                          | 0.786                         | 0.612                         |

Notes: \*  $p < 0.10$ , \*\*  $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\*  $p < 0.01$  (one-tailed for IVs,  $\beta > 0$ ; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms).  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ). BGTAvg\_Spread values rescaled by  $10^4$  for readability; multiply coefficients by  $10^{-4}$  to recover raw units.

Table 49: H14e Robustness: Orthogonal Speaker Partition

|                     | (1)                            | (2)                            | (3)                            | (4)                            | (5)                            | (6)                            | (7)                            | (8)                            | (9)                           | (10)                           | (11)                          | (12)                          |
|---------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|-------------------------------|--------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|
|                     |                                |                                | BGTAvg_Spread                  |                                |                                |                                |                                |                                | BGTAvg_Spread_lead1           |                                |                               |                               |
| UncAnsCEO           | -0.0148<br>(0.1119)            | 0.0447<br>(0.1259)             | 0.0676<br>(0.0998)             | -0.1845<br>(0.1046)            | -0.1780<br>(0.0933)            | -0.1839<br>(0.1013)            | 0.0869<br>(0.1221)             | 0.1085<br>(0.1446)             | <b>0.4166***</b><br>(0.1076)  | -0.0378<br>(0.1214)            | 0.0206<br>(0.1011)            | 0.0238<br>(0.1164)            |
| UncAnsNoCEO         | -0.1277<br>(0.0769)            | -0.1018<br>(0.0809)            | 0.0307<br>(0.0690)             | -0.1240<br>(0.0749)            | -0.1164<br>(0.0673)            | -0.1167<br>(0.0719)            | -0.0936<br>(0.0760)            | -0.0774<br>(0.0818)            | <b>0.2219***</b><br>(0.0647)  | -0.0105<br>(0.0726)            | -0.0111<br>(0.0606)           | 0.0089<br>(0.0680)            |
| UncPreCEO           | <b>0.2279**</b><br>(0.1041)    | <b>0.4759***</b><br>(0.1258)   | <b>0.3197***</b><br>(0.0956)   | <b>0.3458***</b><br>(0.1160)   | 0.0207<br>(0.0929)             | <b>0.1603*</b><br>(0.1126)     | -0.0451<br>(0.1105)            | 0.0809<br>(0.1357)             | <b>0.1664**</b><br>(0.0919)   | -0.1024<br>(0.1198)            | 0.0177<br>(0.0837)            | 0.1013<br>(0.1127)            |
| UncPreNoCEO         | 0.0045<br>(0.0782)             | 0.0384<br>(0.1129)             | <b>0.1486***</b><br>(0.0577)   | 0.0050<br>(0.0962)             | -0.0281<br>(0.0559)            | 0.0165<br>(0.0938)             | 0.0600<br>(0.0870)             | 0.1125<br>(0.1191)             | <b>0.2746***</b><br>(0.0610)  | 0.0653<br>(0.0950)             | -0.0336<br>(0.0570)           | 0.0692<br>(0.0900)            |
| lnAssets            | <b>-0.7357***</b><br>(0.0428)  | <b>-1.9950***</b><br>(0.1890)  | <b>-0.1943***</b><br>(0.0225)  | <b>-1.4821***</b><br>(0.2061)  | <b>-0.5770***</b><br>(0.0463)  | <b>-1.6488***</b><br>(0.2083)  | <b>-0.7620***</b><br>(0.0439)  | <b>-1.7865***</b><br>(0.1877)  | <b>-0.1323***</b><br>(0.0195) | <b>-1.5806***</b><br>(0.2131)  | <b>-0.5545***</b><br>(0.0443) | <b>-1.2776***</b><br>(0.1988) |
| TobinsQ             | <b>-0.3506***</b><br>(0.0392)  | <b>-0.5790***</b><br>(0.0935)  | <b>-0.1001**</b><br>(0.0399)   | <b>-0.6347***</b><br>(0.0931)  | <b>-0.2743***</b><br>(0.0420)  | <b>-0.6441***</b><br>(0.0927)  | <b>-0.2052***</b><br>(0.0486)  | <b>-0.1313**</b><br>(0.0658)   | <b>0.0788*</b><br>(0.0447)    | <b>-0.4350***</b><br>(0.0925)  | <b>-0.1697***</b><br>(0.0428) | <b>-0.3686***</b><br>(0.0845) |
| ROA                 | <b>-10.1876***</b><br>(0.8001) | <b>-12.6668***</b><br>(1.0496) | <b>-4.9018***</b><br>(0.9007)  | <b>-6.6188***</b><br>(1.1098)  | <b>-5.6381***</b><br>(0.9089)  | <b>-7.1343***</b><br>(1.1018)  | <b>-11.4667***</b><br>(1.0389) | <b>-15.6598***</b><br>(1.2166) | <b>-7.9293***</b><br>(1.0194) | <b>-10.9551***</b><br>(1.1521) | <b>-7.2350***</b><br>(0.9545) | <b>-9.5761***</b><br>(1.0755) |
| Leverage            | <b>0.5637**</b><br>(0.2304)    | <b>2.8324***</b><br>(0.6036)   | <b>-0.4732*</b><br>(0.2682)    | 0.6239<br>(0.4658)             | -0.1198<br>(0.2223)            | <b>0.8159*</b><br>(0.4707)     | 0.1034<br>(0.2555)             | <b>1.3075**</b><br>(0.5591)    | <b>-0.5862**</b><br>(0.2482)  | -0.0924<br>(0.4905)            | -0.2647<br>(0.2164)           | -0.1095<br>(0.4570)           |
| Capex               | -0.2857<br>(0.9249)            | 2.7254<br>(1.9677)             | 0.0729<br>(0.9809)             | 1.0394<br>(2.3760)             | -1.0142<br>(0.9633)            | 1.3670<br>(2.3393)             | <b>-1.8248*</b><br>(0.9649)    | -2.8813<br>(2.0304)            | 0.5871<br>(0.9274)            | -3.5536<br>(2.5633)            | -1.0100<br>(0.8588)           | -1.6360<br>(2.4835)           |
| DivDummy            | 0.0713<br>(0.0927)             | -0.2143<br>(0.2046)            | <b>0.3416***</b><br>(0.0838)   | 0.1912<br>(0.1779)             | <b>0.3280***</b><br>(0.0813)   | 0.2224<br>(0.1777)             | -0.0280<br>(0.1028)            | <b>-0.3777*</b><br>(0.2264)    | <b>0.2076**</b><br>(0.0835)   | 0.1885<br>(0.1898)             | <b>0.2087***</b><br>(0.0784)  | 0.1848<br>(0.1793)            |
| sCFO                | -0.2147<br>(0.2654)            | 0.2998<br>(0.2095)             | 0.0862<br>(0.2780)             | 0.1814<br>(0.2655)             | 0.0985<br>(0.2507)             | 0.2420<br>(0.2122)             | -0.1822<br>(0.2394)            | <b>0.4238**</b><br>(0.1693)    | 0.1212<br>(0.1271)            | 0.2239<br>(0.1430)             | -0.0515<br>(0.1764)           | 0.1652<br>(0.1309)            |
| Lagged_DV           | <b>0.8471***</b><br>(0.0077)   | <b>0.7600***</b><br>(0.0083)   | <b>0.7748***</b><br>(0.0130)   | <b>0.6879***</b><br>(0.0164)   | <b>0.7713***</b><br>(0.0143)   | <b>0.6932***</b><br>(0.0174)   | <b>0.8349***</b><br>(0.0089)   | <b>0.7322***</b><br>(0.0098)   | <b>0.7824***</b><br>(0.0150)  | <b>0.6589***</b><br>(0.0186)   | <b>0.7957***</b><br>(0.0150)  | <b>0.7009***</b><br>(0.0177)  |
| StockPrice          |                                |                                | <b>-0.0027**</b><br>(0.0014)   | -0.0033<br>(0.0023)            | 0.0016<br>(0.0013)             | 0.0028<br>(0.0023)             |                                | <b>-0.0024**</b><br>(0.0011)   | <b>0.0105***</b><br>(0.0023)  | 0.0001<br>(0.0011)             | <b>0.0040**</b><br>(0.0020)   |                               |
| Turnover            |                                |                                | <b>-23.0471***</b><br>(1.6602) | <b>-24.0079***</b><br>(1.9906) | <b>-20.0854***</b><br>(1.6258) | <b>-19.3555***</b><br>(1.9546) |                                | <b>-7.5017***</b><br>(1.4427)  | <b>-6.3587***</b><br>(1.9079) | <b>-8.0995***</b><br>(1.4285)  | <b>-5.8752***</b><br>(1.8091) |                               |
| DailyVola           |                                |                                | <b>0.1270***</b><br>(0.0070)   | <b>0.1326***</b><br>(0.0082)   | <b>0.0989***</b><br>(0.0082)   | <b>0.1150***</b><br>(0.0100)   |                                | <b>0.0711***</b><br>(0.0064)   | <b>0.0708***</b><br>(0.0073)  | <b>0.0524***</b><br>(0.0075)   | <b>0.0617***</b><br>(0.0089)  |                               |
| AbsSurpDec          |                                |                                | -0.0192<br>(0.0269)            | -0.0159<br>(0.0314)            | <b>-0.0686***</b><br>(0.0261)  | -0.0023<br>(0.0299)            |                                | <b>0.0528**</b><br>(0.0266)    | -0.0297<br>(0.0282)           | <b>-0.0705***</b><br>(0.0245)  | <b>-0.0435*</b><br>(0.0261)   |                               |
| Extended Controls   |                                |                                | Yes                            | Yes                            | Yes                            | Yes                            |                                | Yes                            | Yes                           | Yes                            | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| Industry FE         | Yes                            |                                | Yes                            |                                | Yes                            |                                | Yes                            |                                | Yes                           |                                | Yes                           |                               |
| Firm FE             |                                | Yes                            |                                | Yes                            |                                | Yes                            |                                | Yes                            |                               | Yes                            |                               | Yes                           |
| Year FE             | Yes                            | Yes                            | Yes                            | Yes                            |                                |                                | Yes                            | Yes                            | Yes                           |                                |                               |                               |
| Year-Quarter FE     |                                |                                |                                |                                | Yes                            | Yes                            |                                |                                |                               |                                | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| N                   | 60,035                         | 60,035                         | 41,570                         | 41,570                         | 41,570                         | 41,570                         | 59,608                         | 59,608                         | 42,039                        | 42,039                         | 42,039                        | 42,039                        |
| R <sup>2</sup>      | 0.817                          | 0.661                          | 0.772                          | 0.634                          | 0.783                          | 0.634                          | 0.810                          | 0.638                          | 0.758                         | 0.598                          | 0.782                         | 0.619                         |
| Adj. R <sup>2</sup> | 0.816                          | 0.651                          | 0.772                          | 0.622                          | 0.783                          | 0.620                          | 0.809                          | 0.627                          | 0.758                         | 0.584                          | 0.782                         | 0.605                         |

Notes: \*  $p < 0.10$ , \*\*  $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\*  $p < 0.01$  (one-tailed for IVs,  $\beta > 0$ ; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms).  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ). BGTAvg\_Spread values rescaled by  $10^4$  for readability; multiply coefficients by  $10^{-4}$  to recover raw units.

Table 50: H16: Speech Uncertainty and R&amp;D Investment Intensity

|                     | (1)                           | (2)                           | (3)                           | (4)                           | (5)                           | (6)                           | (7)                          | (8)                         | (9)                          | (10)                | (11)                         | (12)                |
|---------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|------------------------------|-----------------------------|------------------------------|---------------------|------------------------------|---------------------|
|                     |                               |                               | RDSales                       |                               |                               |                               |                              |                             | RDSales.Lead                 |                     |                              |                     |
| UncAnsCEO           | -0.0048<br>(0.0214)           | -0.0205<br>(0.0166)           | -0.0006<br>(0.0213)           | -0.0196<br>(0.0163)           | -0.0009<br>(0.0212)           | -0.0197<br>(0.0164)           | 0.0108<br>(0.0243)           | -0.0200<br>(0.0198)         | 0.0126<br>(0.0255)           | -0.0195<br>(0.0204) | 0.0125<br>(0.0255)           | -0.0194<br>(0.0204) |
| UncPreCEO           | 0.0138<br>(0.0110)            | 0.0022<br>(0.0103)            | 0.0063<br>(0.0097)            | -0.0137<br>(0.0090)           | 0.0062<br>(0.0098)            | -0.0138<br>(0.0089)           | 0.0181<br>(0.0136)           | 0.0049<br>(0.0140)          | 0.0150<br>(0.0139)           | 0.0026<br>(0.0175)  | 0.0146<br>(0.0138)           | 0.0023<br>(0.0176)  |
| UncAnsMgr           | 0.0255<br>(0.0264)            | 0.0170<br>(0.0158)            | 0.0090<br>(0.0291)            | 0.0077<br>(0.0156)            | 0.0168<br>(0.0263)            | 0.0067<br>(0.0158)            | 0.0176<br>(0.0361)           | 0.0181<br>(0.0281)          | 0.0010<br>(0.0399)           | 0.0174<br>(0.0290)  | 0.0103<br>(0.0374)           | 0.0165<br>(0.0290)  |
| UncPreMgr           | 0.0020<br>(0.0114)            | 0.0085<br>(0.0163)            | 0.0106<br>(0.0095)            | 0.0196<br>(0.0153)            | 0.0185<br>(0.0116)            | 0.0192<br>(0.0153)            | -0.0107<br>(0.0156)          | 0.0152<br>(0.0163)          | -0.0119<br>(0.0184)          | 0.0183<br>(0.0186)  | -0.0025<br>(0.0180)          | 0.0180<br>(0.0183)  |
| InAssets            | <b>0.0103***</b><br>(0.0036)  | 0.0253<br>(0.0240)            | <b>0.0043***</b><br>(0.0015)  | <b>0.0428*</b><br>(0.0250)    | <b>0.0088**</b><br>(0.0037)   | <b>0.0411*</b><br>(0.0247)    | <b>0.0074*</b><br>(0.0039)   | 0.0720<br>(0.0484)          | 0.0035<br>(0.0022)           | 0.0789<br>(0.0517)  | <b>0.0097**</b><br>(0.0047)  | 0.0784<br>(0.0515)  |
| TobinsQ             | <b>0.0158*</b><br>(0.0094)    | 0.0118<br>(0.0142)            | <b>0.0380***</b><br>(0.0142)  | <b>0.0383**</b><br>(0.0170)   | <b>0.0396***</b><br>(0.0147)  | <b>0.0393**</b><br>(0.0173)   | 0.0064<br>(0.0107)           | -0.0015<br>(0.0285)         | 0.0160<br>(0.0154)           | 0.0053<br>(0.0318)  | 0.0179<br>(0.0162)           | 0.0057<br>(0.0323)  |
| ROA                 | <b>-0.7946***</b><br>(0.2690) | <b>-0.6379***</b><br>(0.1764) | -0.1769<br>(0.1683)           | -0.0567<br>(0.1521)           | -0.1948<br>(0.1703)           | -0.0768<br>(0.1500)           | <b>-0.4412**</b><br>(0.1990) | 0.1815<br>(0.1960)          | 0.1252<br>(0.1911)           | 0.3848<br>(0.2706)  | 0.1188<br>(0.1891)           | 0.3790<br>(0.2690)  |
| Leverage            | <b>-0.0647**</b><br>(0.0295)  | <b>-0.0685**</b><br>(0.0319)  | <b>-0.0580**</b><br>(0.0276)  | 0.0020<br>(0.0401)            | <b>-0.0567**</b><br>(0.0276)  | 0.0085<br>(0.0410)            | -0.0154<br>(0.0289)          | 0.0730<br>(0.0660)          | -0.0429<br>(0.0350)          | 0.0736<br>(0.0560)  | -0.0441<br>(0.0353)          | 0.0762<br>(0.0564)  |
| CashRatio           | <b>0.2919***</b><br>(0.1027)  | <b>0.1755**</b><br>(0.0708)   | <b>0.2724***</b><br>(0.0971)  | 0.0777<br>(0.0610)            | <b>0.2869***</b><br>(0.1016)  | 0.0796<br>(0.0618)            | <b>0.4871***</b><br>(0.1392) | <b>0.1941**</b><br>(0.0984) | <b>0.4711***</b><br>(0.1327) | 0.1841<br>(0.1136)  | <b>0.4865***</b><br>(0.1378) | 0.1841<br>(0.1131)  |
| Capex               | <b>-0.1390**</b><br>(0.0671)  | -0.1341<br>(0.1383)           | <b>0.3351***</b><br>(0.1243)  | <b>0.2092*</b><br>(0.1193)    | <b>0.3382***</b><br>(0.1280)  | 0.1567<br>(0.1218)            | -0.1309<br>(0.1151)          | 0.0394<br>(0.2539)          | 0.2668<br>(0.1678)           | 0.1542<br>(0.2428)  | 0.2825<br>(0.1733)           | 0.1363<br>(0.2488)  |
| DivDummy            | 0.0101<br>(0.0075)            | -0.0046<br>(0.0073)           | <b>-0.0182*</b><br>(0.0095)   | -0.0103<br>(0.0092)           | <b>-0.0192**</b><br>(0.0096)  | -0.0123<br>(0.0096)           | 0.0009<br>(0.0057)           | -0.0143<br>(0.0147)         | -0.0026<br>(0.0108)          | -0.0146<br>(0.0158) | -0.0020<br>(0.0108)          | -0.0152<br>(0.0164) |
| sCFO                | 0.0012<br>(0.0368)            | -0.0053<br>(0.0090)           | 0.0547<br>(0.0500)            | 0.0265<br>(0.0233)            | 0.0586<br>(0.0518)            | 0.0280<br>(0.0241)            | 0.0130<br>(0.0380)           | 0.0034<br>(0.0106)          | 0.0084<br>(0.0291)           | 0.0080<br>(0.0152)  | 0.0110<br>(0.0288)           | 0.0084<br>(0.0155)  |
| Lagged_DV           | <b>0.6564***</b><br>(0.0687)  | <b>0.2772**</b><br>(0.1166)   | <b>0.7354***</b><br>(0.0711)  | <b>0.3889***</b><br>(0.1296)  | <b>0.7367***</b><br>(0.0711)  | <b>0.3911***</b><br>(0.1298)  | <b>0.5155***</b><br>(0.1287) | 0.0404<br>(0.1800)          | <b>0.5132***</b><br>(0.1355) | 0.0568<br>(0.1930)  | <b>0.5132***</b><br>(0.1355) | 0.0570<br>(0.1934)  |
| SalesGrowth         |                               |                               | <b>-0.6094***</b><br>(0.1736) | <b>-0.6535***</b><br>(0.1954) | <b>-0.6163***</b><br>(0.1751) | <b>-0.6626***</b><br>(0.1976) |                              |                             | -0.0925<br>(0.1648)          | -0.0959<br>(0.1768) | -0.0940<br>(0.1671)          | -0.0974<br>(0.1797) |
| CashFlowAt          |                               |                               | <b>-0.7053***</b><br>(0.2435) | <b>-0.3184**</b><br>(0.1567)  | <b>-0.6851***</b><br>(0.2382) | <b>-0.2995*</b><br>(0.1574)   |                              |                             | <b>-0.9530**</b><br>(0.4444) | -0.3752<br>(0.3748) | <b>-0.9404**</b><br>(0.4430) | -0.3738<br>(0.3771) |
| DailyVola           |                               |                               | -0.0002<br>(0.0004)           | -0.0003<br>(0.0003)           | -0.0002<br>(0.0005)           | <b>-0.0007**</b><br>(0.0004)  |                              |                             | -0.0002<br>(0.0003)          | -0.0004<br>(0.0002) | 0.0001<br>(0.0004)           | -0.0006<br>(0.0004) |
| Extended Controls   |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                              |                             | Yes                          | Yes                 | Yes                          | Yes                 |
| Industry FE         | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                          |                             | Yes                          |                     | Yes                          |                     |
| Firm FE             |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                              | Yes                         |                              | Yes                 |                              | Yes                 |
| Year FE             | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                          | Yes                         | Yes                          | Yes                 |                              |                     |
| Year-Quarter FE     |                               |                               |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |                              |                             |                              |                     | Yes                          | Yes                 |
| N                   | 65,086                        | 65,086                        | 62,517                        | 62,517                        | 62,517                        | 62,517                        | 60,105                       | 60,105                      | 58,970                       | 58,970              | 58,970                       | 58,970              |
| R <sup>2</sup>      | 0.448                         | 0.072                         | 0.504                         | 0.183                         | 0.505                         | 0.185                         | 0.252                        | 0.004                       | 0.259                        | 0.007               | 0.259                        | 0.007               |
| Adj. R <sup>2</sup> | 0.447                         | 0.047                         | 0.504                         | 0.159                         | 0.504                         | 0.161                         | 0.252                        | -0.025                      | 0.258                        | -0.022              | 0.258                        | -0.023              |

Notes: \*  $p < 0.10$ , \*\*  $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\*  $p < 0.01$  (two-tailed). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms).  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ).

Table 51: H16 Robustness: Orthogonal Speaker Partition

|                     | (1)                          | (2)                           | (3)                           | (4)                           | (5)                           | (6)                           | (7)                          | (8)                        | (9)                          | (10)                | (11)                         | (12)                |
|---------------------|------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|------------------------------|----------------------------|------------------------------|---------------------|------------------------------|---------------------|
|                     | RDSales                      |                               |                               |                               |                               |                               | RDSales.Lead                 |                            |                              |                     |                              |                     |
| UncAnsCEO           | 0.0053<br>(0.0074)           | -0.0109<br>(0.0082)           | 0.0010<br>(0.0067)            | -0.0141<br>(0.0088)           | 0.0049<br>(0.0076)            | <b>-0.0148*</b><br>(0.0088)   | <b>0.0200**</b><br>(0.0099)  | -0.0030<br>(0.0050)        | <b>0.0135*</b><br>(0.0079)   | -0.0038<br>(0.0050) | <b>0.0188*</b><br>(0.0097)   | -0.0041<br>(0.0051) |
| UncAnsNoCEO         | 0.0040<br>(0.0044)           | -0.0009<br>(0.0041)           | 0.0023<br>(0.0051)            | 0.0000<br>(0.0039)            | 0.0049<br>(0.0045)            | 0.0001<br>(0.0039)            | 0.0009<br>(0.0042)           | 0.0000<br>(0.0056)         | -0.0026<br>(0.0048)          | -0.0000<br>(0.0058) | 0.0005<br>(0.0042)           | -0.0001<br>(0.0057) |
| UncPreCEO           | <b>0.0150*</b><br>(0.0089)   | 0.0075<br>(0.0074)            | 0.0121<br>(0.0080)            | -0.0026<br>(0.0088)           | <b>0.0152*</b><br>(0.0065)    | -0.0032<br>(0.0088)           | 0.0090<br>(0.0065)           | 0.0070<br>(0.0081)         | 0.0053<br>(0.0109)           | 0.0047<br>(0.0069)  | 0.0090<br>(0.0124)           | 0.0043<br>(0.0081)  |
| UncPreNoCEO         | -0.0034<br>(0.0038)          | -0.0029<br>(0.0066)           | -0.0011<br>(0.0034)           | 0.0026<br>(0.0062)            | 0.0021<br>(0.0037)            | 0.0028<br>(0.0061)            | -0.0056<br>(0.0060)          | -0.0032<br>(0.0080)        | -0.0072<br>(0.0071)          | -0.0015<br>(0.0091) | -0.0034<br>(0.0067)          | -0.0014<br>(0.0090) |
| InAssets            | <b>0.0086***</b><br>(0.0028) | 0.0228<br>(0.0237)            | <b>0.0036***</b><br>(0.0012)  | <b>0.0437*</b><br>(0.0251)    | <b>0.0077**</b><br>(0.0030)   | <b>0.0421*</b><br>(0.0248)    | 0.0058<br>(0.0038)           | 0.0731<br>(0.0526)         | 0.0017<br>(0.0018)           | 0.0800<br>(0.0563)  | <b>0.0077*</b><br>(0.0045)   | 0.0792<br>(0.0561)  |
| TobinsQ             | 0.0112<br>(0.0074)           | 0.0136<br>(0.0144)            | <b>0.0311***</b><br>(0.0112)  | <b>0.0381**</b><br>(0.0173)   | <b>0.0325***</b><br>(0.0118)  | <b>0.0391**</b><br>(0.0176)   | 0.0019<br>(0.0094)           | 0.0016<br>(0.0290)         | 0.0101<br>(0.0131)           | 0.0077<br>(0.0321)  | 0.0119<br>(0.0140)           | 0.0081<br>(0.0327)  |
| ROA                 | <b>-0.5923**</b><br>(0.1857) | <b>-0.5866***</b><br>(0.1584) | -0.0710<br>(0.1232)           | -0.0616<br>(0.1277)           | -0.0853<br>(0.1223)           | -0.0799<br>(0.1249)           | <b>-0.3455**</b><br>(0.1662) | 0.1118<br>(0.1763)         | 0.0442<br>(0.1764)           | 0.2442<br>(0.2265)  | 0.0382<br>(0.1727)           | 0.2372<br>(0.2231)  |
| Leverage            | <b>-0.0564**</b><br>(0.0240) | <b>-0.0779**</b><br>(0.0318)  | <b>-0.0515**</b><br>(0.0222)  | -0.0241<br>(0.0330)           | <b>-0.0502**</b><br>(0.0223)  | -0.0170<br>(0.0337)           | -0.0181<br>(0.0268)          | 0.0212<br>(0.0364)         | -0.0309<br>(0.0299)          | 0.0434<br>(0.0439)  | -0.0320<br>(0.0303)          | 0.0467<br>(0.0448)  |
| CashRatio           | <b>0.2552***</b><br>(0.0898) | <b>0.1558***</b><br>(0.0578)  | <b>0.2414***</b><br>(0.0845)  | 0.0719<br>(0.0514)            | <b>0.2549***</b><br>(0.0896)  | 0.0738<br>(0.0522)            | <b>0.4637***</b><br>(0.1313) | <b>0.1694*</b><br>(0.0915) | <b>0.4513***</b><br>(0.1286) | 0.1452<br>(0.1044)  | <b>0.4661***</b><br>(0.1334) | 0.1458<br>(0.1040)  |
| Capex               | <b>-0.1119**</b><br>(0.0561) | -0.1240<br>(0.1201)           | <b>0.2573***</b><br>(0.0936)  | 0.1659<br>(0.1082)            | <b>0.2609***</b><br>(0.0970)  | 0.1118<br>(0.1122)            | -0.1127<br>(0.1107)          | 0.0336<br>(0.2616)         | 0.1390<br>(0.1233)           | 0.1214<br>(0.2596)  | 0.1500<br>(0.1277)           | 0.0923<br>(0.2639)  |
| DivDummy            | 0.0063<br>(0.0055)           | -0.0056<br>(0.0065)           | <b>-0.0177**</b><br>(0.0080)  | -0.0111<br>(0.0084)           | <b>-0.0187**</b><br>(0.0081)  | -0.0133<br>(0.0088)           | -0.0000<br>(0.0052)          | -0.0156<br>(0.0146)        | -0.0059<br>(0.0093)          | -0.0178<br>(0.0161) | -0.0053<br>(0.0092)          | -0.0189<br>(0.0167) |
| sCFO                | 0.0098<br>(0.0194)           | -0.0052<br>(0.0084)           | 0.0510<br>(0.0408)            | 0.0241<br>(0.0217)            | 0.0548<br>(0.0427)            | 0.0255<br>(0.0225)            | -0.0103<br>(0.0190)          | -0.0006<br>(0.0125)        | -0.0053<br>(0.0195)          | 0.0081<br>(0.0180)  | -0.0027<br>(0.0188)          | 0.0087<br>(0.0184)  |
| Lagged_DV           | <b>0.6868***</b><br>(0.0744) | <b>0.3034***</b><br>(0.1151)  | <b>0.7573***</b><br>(0.0722)  | <b>0.4057***</b><br>(0.1225)  | <b>0.7588***</b><br>(0.0721)  | <b>0.4078***</b><br>(0.1225)  | <b>0.4881***</b><br>(0.1307) | -0.0142<br>(0.1946)        | <b>0.5008***</b><br>(0.1434) | 0.0167<br>(0.2161)  | <b>0.5011***</b><br>(0.1435) | 0.0172<br>(0.2166)  |
| SalesGrowth         |                              |                               | <b>-0.5579***</b><br>(0.1540) | <b>-0.5959***</b><br>(0.1723) | <b>-0.5644***</b><br>(0.1554) | <b>-0.6048***</b><br>(0.1743) |                              |                            | -0.1627<br>(0.1386)          | -0.1669<br>(0.1720) | -0.1653<br>(0.1407)          | -0.1699<br>(0.1748) |
| CashFlowAt          |                              |                               | <b>-0.5685***</b><br>(0.1900) | <b>-0.3355**</b><br>(0.1579)  | <b>-0.5509***</b><br>(0.1845) | <b>-0.3185**</b><br>(0.1582)  |                              |                            | <b>-0.5702**</b><br>(0.2480) | -0.0591<br>(0.2098) | <b>-0.5538**</b><br>(0.2395) | -0.0536<br>(0.2088) |
| Daily Vola          |                              |                               | 0.0001<br>(0.0003)            | -0.0002<br>(0.0002)           | 0.0001<br>(0.0004)            | <b>-0.0006**</b><br>(0.0003)  |                              |                            | 0.0001<br>(0.0002)           | -0.0004<br>(0.0003) | 0.0004<br>(0.0004)           | -0.0006<br>(0.0004) |
| Extended Controls   |                              |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                              |                            | Yes                          | Yes                 | Yes                          | Yes                 |
| Industry FE         | Yes                          |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                          |                            | Yes                          |                     | Yes                          |                     |
| Firm FE             |                              | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                              | Yes                        |                              | Yes                 |                              | Yes                 |
| Year FE             | Yes                          | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                          | Yes                        | Yes                          | Yes                 |                              |                     |
| Year-Quarter FE     |                              |                               |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |                              |                            |                              |                     | Yes                          | Yes                 |
| N                   | 61,096                       | 61,096                        | 58,693                        | 58,693                        | 58,693                        | 58,693                        | 56,422                       | 56,422                     | 55,367                       | 55,367              | 55,367                       | 55,367              |
| R <sup>2</sup>      | 0.487                        | 0.087                         | 0.540                         | 0.198                         | 0.541                         | 0.200                         | 0.240                        | 0.003                      | 0.246                        | 0.010               | 0.246                        | 0.010               |
| Adj. R <sup>2</sup> | 0.486                        | 0.061                         | 0.540                         | 0.174                         | 0.540                         | 0.175                         | 0.240                        | -0.027                     | 0.246                        | -0.021              | 0.245                        | -0.021              |

Notes: \*  $p < 0.10$ , \*\*  $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\*  $p < 0.01$  (two-tailed). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms).  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ).

Table 52: H17: Speech Uncertainty and Repurchase Intensity

|                     | (1)                           | (2)                           | (3)                           | (4)                           | (5)                           | (6)                           | (7)                           | (8)                           | (9)                           | (10)                          | (11)                          | (12)                          |
|---------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|
|                     |                               |                               | RepurchaseIntensity           |                               |                               |                               |                               |                               | RepurchaseIntensity_lead_qtr  |                               |                               |                               |
| UncAnsCEO           | 0.0001<br>(0.0002)            | 0.0001<br>(0.0002)            | 0.0001<br>(0.0003)            | 0.0001<br>(0.0002)            | 0.0000<br>(0.0002)            | 0.0000<br>(0.0002)            | 0.0000<br>(0.0003)            | 0.0000<br>(0.0002)            | -0.0001<br>(0.0003)           | -0.0001<br>(0.0002)           | -0.0001<br>(0.0003)           | -0.0001<br>(0.0002)           |
| UncPreCEO           | -0.0001<br>(0.0003)           | 0.0002<br>(0.0002)            | -0.0001<br>(0.0003)           | 0.0002<br>(0.0002)            | -0.0001<br>(0.0003)           | 0.0002<br>(0.0002)            | 0.0001<br>(0.0003)            | <b>0.0004*</b><br>(0.0003)    | 0.0001<br>(0.0003)            | 0.0004<br>(0.0003)            | 0.0001<br>(0.0003)            | 0.0004<br>(0.0003)            |
| UncAnsMgr           | <b>-0.0008***</b><br>(0.0003) | -0.0003<br>(0.0003)           | <b>-0.0007**</b><br>(0.0003)  | -0.0002<br>(0.0003)           | <b>-0.0007**</b><br>(0.0003)  | -0.0001<br>(0.0003)           | <b>-0.0007**</b><br>(0.0003)  | -0.0001<br>(0.0003)           | -0.0005<br>(0.0003)           | 0.0000<br>(0.0003)            | -0.0005<br>(0.0003)           | 0.0001<br>(0.0003)            |
| UncPreMgr           | <b>0.0007**</b><br>(0.0003)   | <b>0.0007**</b><br>(0.0003)   | <b>0.0006**</b><br>(0.0003)   | <b>0.0006**</b><br>(0.0003)   | <b>0.0005*</b><br>(0.0003)    | <b>0.0006*</b><br>(0.0003)    | <b>0.0006*</b><br>(0.0003)    | 0.0004<br>(0.0003)            | 0.0005<br>(0.0003)            | 0.0005<br>(0.0003)            | 0.0005<br>(0.0003)            | 0.0004<br>(0.0003)            |
| lnAssets            | <b>0.0006***</b><br>(0.0001)  | 0.0001<br>(0.0002)            | <b>0.0005***</b><br>(0.0001)  | -0.0000<br>(0.0002)           | <b>0.0005***</b><br>(0.0001)  | -0.0001<br>(0.0002)           | <b>0.0010***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0017***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0009***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0016***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0009***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0015***</b><br>(0.0001)  |
| TobinsQ             | <b>0.0011***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0004***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0010***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0003**</b><br>(0.0001)   | <b>0.0010***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0004***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0015***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0009***</b><br>(0.0002)  | <b>0.0014***</b><br>(0.0002)  | <b>0.0009***</b><br>(0.0002)  | <b>0.0014***</b><br>(0.0002)  | <b>0.0008***</b><br>(0.0002)  |
| ROA                 | <b>0.0117***</b><br>(0.0008)  | <b>0.0094***</b><br>(0.0009)  | <b>0.0040***</b><br>(0.0009)  | <b>0.0064***</b><br>(0.0009)  | <b>0.0035***</b><br>(0.0009)  | <b>0.0059***</b><br>(0.0009)  | <b>0.0137***</b><br>(0.0010)  | <b>0.0091***</b><br>(0.0011)  | <b>0.0047***</b><br>(0.0012)  | <b>0.0063***</b><br>(0.0011)  | <b>0.0042***</b><br>(0.0012)  | <b>0.0059***</b><br>(0.0011)  |
| Leverage            | -0.0009<br>(0.0006)           | <b>-0.0024***</b><br>(0.0008) | -0.0003<br>(0.0005)           | <b>-0.0016*</b><br>(0.0008)   | -0.0002<br>(0.0005)           | <b>-0.0015*</b><br>(0.0008)   | <b>-0.0030***</b><br>(0.0009) | <b>-0.0108***</b><br>(0.0011) | <b>-0.0022***</b><br>(0.0008) | <b>-0.0100***</b><br>(0.0011) | <b>-0.0021***</b><br>(0.0007) | <b>-0.0099***</b><br>(0.0011) |
| Capex               | -0.0003<br>(0.0016)           | <b>0.0069**</b><br>(0.0027)   | <b>-0.0052***</b><br>(0.0018) | <b>0.0060**</b><br>(0.0028)   | <b>-0.0056***</b><br>(0.0018) | 0.0041<br>(0.0028)            | -0.0015<br>(0.0020)           | 0.0006<br>(0.0034)            | <b>-0.0075***</b><br>(0.0021) | -0.0003<br>(0.0035)           | <b>-0.0075***</b><br>(0.0021) | -0.0006<br>(0.0035)           |
| CashRatio           | <b>0.0025***</b><br>(0.0006)  | <b>-0.0021**</b><br>(0.0010)  | <b>0.0028***</b><br>(0.0007)  | <b>-0.0024**</b><br>(0.0010)  | <b>0.0029***</b><br>(0.0007)  | <b>-0.0022**</b><br>(0.0010)  | <b>0.0052***</b><br>(0.0009)  | <b>0.0073***</b><br>(0.0013)  | <b>0.0057***</b><br>(0.0009)  | <b>0.0071***</b><br>(0.0013)  | <b>0.0058***</b><br>(0.0009)  | <b>0.0071***</b><br>(0.0013)  |
| DivDummy            | 0.0002<br>(0.0002)            | <b>0.0006*</b><br>(0.0003)    | -0.0001<br>(0.0002)           | 0.0005<br>(0.0003)            | -0.0002<br>(0.0002)           | 0.0004<br>(0.0003)            | -0.0000<br>(0.0002)           | 0.0002<br>(0.0004)            | -0.0003<br>(0.0002)           | 0.0001<br>(0.0004)            | -0.0004<br>(0.0002)           | 0.0000<br>(0.0004)            |
| sCFO                | <b>-0.0010*</b><br>(0.0005)   | -0.0008<br>(0.0006)           | <b>-0.0006**</b><br>(0.0003)  | -0.0006<br>(0.0005)           | <b>-0.0005**</b><br>(0.0003)  | -0.0006<br>(0.0005)           | <b>-0.0013*</b><br>(0.0007)   | -0.0009<br>(0.0007)           | <b>-0.0008*</b><br>(0.0004)   | -0.0008<br>(0.0007)           | <b>-0.0008*</b><br>(0.0004)   | -0.0008<br>(0.0006)           |
| Lagged_DV           | <b>0.4701***</b><br>(0.0105)  | <b>0.3216***</b><br>(0.0100)  | <b>0.4573***</b><br>(0.0106)  | <b>0.3169***</b><br>(0.0101)  | <b>0.4546***</b><br>(0.0107)  | <b>0.3135***</b><br>(0.0102)  | <b>0.3623***</b><br>(0.0112)  | <b>0.1910***</b><br>(0.0099)  | <b>0.3483***</b><br>(0.0112)  | <b>0.1879***</b><br>(0.0100)  | <b>0.3489***</b><br>(0.0112)  | <b>0.1878***</b><br>(0.0101)  |
| SalesGrowth         |                               |                               | <b>-0.0018***</b><br>(0.0003) | <b>-0.0014***</b><br>(0.0002) | <b>-0.0019***</b><br>(0.0003) | <b>-0.0015***</b><br>(0.0003) |                               |                               | <b>-0.0021***</b><br>(0.0003) | <b>-0.0014***</b><br>(0.0003) | <b>-0.0021***</b><br>(0.0003) | <b>-0.0014***</b><br>(0.0003) |
| RDSales             |                               |                               | <b>0.0004***</b><br>(0.0001)  | 0.0000<br>(0.0001)            | <b>0.0004***</b><br>(0.0001)  | 0.0000<br>(0.0001)            |                               |                               | <b>0.0003**</b><br>(0.0001)   | 0.0000<br>(0.0001)            | <b>0.0003**</b><br>(0.0001)   | -0.0000<br>(0.0001)           |
| CashFlowAt          |                               |                               | <b>0.0145***</b><br>(0.0014)  | <b>0.0105***</b><br>(0.0014)  | <b>0.0145***</b><br>(0.0014)  | <b>0.0107***</b><br>(0.0014)  |                               |                               | <b>0.0173***</b><br>(0.0018)  | <b>0.0108***</b><br>(0.0016)  | <b>0.0174***</b><br>(0.0018)  | <b>0.0112***</b><br>(0.0016)  |
| DailyVola           |                               |                               | <b>-0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000) |                               |                               | <b>-0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0000**</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>-0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000) |
| Extended Controls   |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| Industry FE         | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               |
| Firm FE             |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |
| Year FE             | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               |
| Year-Quarter FE     |                               |                               |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| N                   | 61,030                        | 61,030                        | 58,550                        | 58,550                        | 58,550                        | 58,550                        | 58,610                        | 58,610                        | 57,529                        | 57,529                        | 57,529                        | 57,529                        |
| R <sup>2</sup>      | 0.300                         | 0.117                         | 0.308                         | 0.120                         | 0.309                         | 0.119                         | 0.233                         | 0.064                         | 0.244                         | 0.067                         | 0.245                         | 0.067                         |
| Adj. R <sup>2</sup> | 0.299                         | 0.091                         | 0.307                         | 0.093                         | 0.308                         | 0.091                         | 0.232                         | 0.036                         | 0.244                         | 0.039                         | 0.244                         | 0.037                         |

Notes: \*  $p < 0.10$ , \*\*  $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\*  $p < 0.01$  (two-tailed). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms).  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ).

Table 53: H17 Robustness: Orthogonal Speaker Partition

|                     | (1)                          | (2)                           | (3)                           | (4)                           | (5)                           | (6)                           | (7)                           | (8)                           | (9)                           | (10)                          | (11)                          | (12)                          |
|---------------------|------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|
|                     |                              |                               | Repurchase                    | Intensity                     |                               |                               |                               |                               | Repurchase                    | Intensity                     | lead_qtr                      |                               |
| UncAnsCEO           | <b>-0.0003**</b><br>(0.0002) | 0.0000<br>(0.0002)            | <b>-0.0003*</b><br>(0.0002)   | -0.0000<br>(0.0002)           | <b>-0.0003*</b><br>(0.0002)   | -0.0000<br>(0.0002)           | <b>-0.0004**</b><br>(0.0002)  | -0.0000<br>(0.0002)           | <b>-0.0004**</b><br>(0.0002)  | -0.0001<br>(0.0002)           | <b>-0.0004*</b><br>(0.0002)   | -0.0000<br>(0.0002)           |
| UncAnsNoCEO         | <b>-0.0002*</b><br>(0.0001)  | -0.0001<br>(0.0001)           | <b>-0.0002*</b><br>(0.0001)   | -0.0000<br>(0.0001)           | -0.0000<br>(0.0001)           | -0.0000<br>(0.0001)           | <b>-0.0002**</b><br>(0.0001)  | -0.0001<br>(0.0001)           | -0.0002<br>(0.0001)           | -0.0000<br>(0.0001)           | -0.0002<br>(0.0001)           | -0.0000<br>(0.0001)           |
| UncPreCEO           | 0.0002<br>(0.0002)           | <b>0.0005***</b><br>(0.0002)  | 0.0002<br>(0.0002)            | <b>0.0004**</b><br>(0.0002)   | 0.0002<br>(0.0002)            | <b>0.0004**</b><br>(0.0002)   | 0.0004<br>(0.0003)            | <b>0.0007***</b><br>(0.0002)  | 0.0004<br>(0.0003)            | <b>0.0006***</b><br>(0.0002)  | 0.0004<br>(0.0003)            | <b>0.0006***</b><br>(0.0002)  |
| UncPreNoCEO         | 0.0001<br>(0.0001)           | 0.0002<br>(0.0001)            | 0.0001<br>(0.0001)            | 0.0001<br>(0.0002)            | 0.0001<br>(0.0001)            | 0.0001<br>(0.0002)            | 0.0001<br>(0.0002)            | 0.0001<br>(0.0002)            | 0.0001<br>(0.0001)            | 0.0001<br>(0.0002)            | 0.0001<br>(0.0001)            | 0.0001<br>(0.0002)            |
| InAssets            | <b>0.0006***</b><br>(0.0001) | 0.0000<br>(0.0002)            | <b>0.0005***</b><br>(0.0001)  | -0.0001<br>(0.0002)           | <b>0.0005***</b><br>(0.0001)  | -0.0002<br>(0.0002)           | <b>0.0010***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0017***</b><br>(0.0003)  | <b>0.0009***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0016***</b><br>(0.0003)  | <b>0.0009***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0015***</b><br>(0.0003)  |
| TobinsQ             | <b>0.0011***</b><br>(0.0001) | <b>0.0004***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0010***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0004***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0011***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0004***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0015***</b><br>(0.0001)  | <b>0.0010***</b><br>(0.0002)  | <b>0.0014***</b><br>(0.0002)  | <b>0.0009***</b><br>(0.0002)  | <b>0.0014***</b><br>(0.0002)  | <b>0.0009***</b><br>(0.0002)  |
| ROA                 | <b>0.0120***</b><br>(0.0008) | <b>0.0092***</b><br>(0.0009)  | <b>0.0037***</b><br>(0.0010)  | <b>0.0059***</b><br>(0.0010)  | <b>0.0033***</b><br>(0.0010)  | <b>0.0054***</b><br>(0.0010)  | <b>0.0140***</b><br>(0.0011)  | <b>0.0087***</b><br>(0.0010)  | <b>0.0044***</b><br>(0.0012)  | <b>0.0057***</b><br>(0.0011)  | <b>0.0040***</b><br>(0.0012)  | <b>0.0053***</b><br>(0.0011)  |
| Leverage            | -0.0009<br>(0.0006)          | <b>-0.0025***</b><br>(0.0009) | -0.0004<br>(0.0005)           | <b>-0.0016*</b><br>(0.0005)   | -0.0003<br>(0.0005)           | <b>-0.0016*</b><br>(0.0005)   | <b>-0.0031***</b><br>(0.0009) | <b>-0.0109***</b><br>(0.0011) | <b>-0.0023***</b><br>(0.0008) | <b>-0.0101***</b><br>(0.0011) | <b>-0.0022***</b><br>(0.0008) | <b>-0.0100***</b><br>(0.0011) |
| Capex               | -0.0000<br>(0.0017)          | <b>0.0069**</b><br>(0.0029)   | <b>-0.0053***</b><br>(0.0019) | <b>0.0060**</b><br>(0.0030)   | <b>-0.0057***</b><br>(0.0019) | 0.0041<br>(0.0030)            | -0.0014<br>(0.0021)           | 0.0005<br>(0.0037)            | <b>-0.0077***</b><br>(0.0022) | -0.0005<br>(0.0038)           | <b>-0.0077***</b><br>(0.0022) | -0.0008<br>(0.0038)           |
| CashRatio           | <b>0.0026***</b><br>(0.0007) | <b>-0.0022**</b><br>(0.0010)  | <b>0.0028***</b><br>(0.0007)  | <b>-0.0026**</b><br>(0.0010)  | <b>0.0029***</b><br>(0.0007)  | <b>-0.0024**</b><br>(0.0010)  | <b>0.0053***</b><br>(0.0009)  | <b>0.0073***</b><br>(0.0013)  | <b>0.0058***</b><br>(0.0009)  | <b>0.0072***</b><br>(0.0013)  | <b>0.0059***</b><br>(0.0009)  | <b>0.0071***</b><br>(0.0013)  |
| DivDummy            | 0.0002<br>(0.0002)           | <b>0.0007**</b><br>(0.0003)   | -0.0001<br>(0.0002)           | 0.0005<br>(0.0003)            | -0.0002<br>(0.0003)           | 0.0005<br>(0.0003)            | 0.0000<br>(0.0002)            | 0.0003<br>(0.0004)            | -0.0003<br>(0.0002)           | 0.0002<br>(0.0004)            | -0.0003<br>(0.0002)           | 0.0001<br>(0.0004)            |
| sCFO                | <b>-0.0010*</b><br>(0.0006)  | -0.0008<br>(0.0006)           | <b>-0.0006**</b><br>(0.0003)  | -0.0006<br>(0.0005)           | <b>-0.0006*</b><br>(0.0003)   | -0.0006<br>(0.0005)           | -0.0012<br>(0.0008)           | -0.0009<br>(0.0007)           | <b>-0.0008*</b><br>(0.0005)   | -0.0008<br>(0.0006)           | <b>-0.0008*</b><br>(0.0004)   | -0.0008<br>(0.0006)           |
| Lagged_DV           | <b>0.4711***</b><br>(0.0108) | <b>0.3215***</b><br>(0.0102)  | <b>0.4578***</b><br>(0.0109)  | <b>0.3168***</b><br>(0.0104)  | <b>0.4551***</b><br>(0.0109)  | <b>0.3135***</b><br>(0.0104)  | <b>0.3630***</b><br>(0.0116)  | <b>0.1914***</b><br>(0.0102)  | <b>0.3484***</b><br>(0.0115)  | <b>0.1883***</b><br>(0.0103)  | <b>0.3492***</b><br>(0.0115)  | <b>0.1885***</b><br>(0.0104)  |
| SalesGrowth         |                              |                               | <b>-0.0019***</b><br>(0.0003) | <b>-0.0014***</b><br>(0.0003) | <b>-0.0020***</b><br>(0.0003) | <b>-0.0015***</b><br>(0.0003) |                               |                               | <b>-0.0023***</b><br>(0.0003) | <b>-0.0015***</b><br>(0.0003) | <b>-0.0023***</b><br>(0.0003) | <b>-0.0015***</b><br>(0.0003) |
| RDSales             |                              |                               | <b>0.0004***</b><br>(0.0001)  | 0.0000<br>(0.0001)            | <b>0.0004***</b><br>(0.0001)  | 0.0000<br>(0.0001)            |                               |                               | <b>0.0003**</b><br>(0.0001)   | -0.0000<br>(0.0002)           | <b>0.0003**</b><br>(0.0001)   | -0.0000<br>(0.0002)           |
| CashFlowAt          |                              |                               | <b>0.0150***</b><br>(0.0015)  | <b>0.0109***</b><br>(0.0015)  | <b>0.0150***</b><br>(0.0015)  | <b>0.0111***</b><br>(0.0015)  |                               |                               | <b>0.0179***</b><br>(0.0019)  | <b>0.0112***</b><br>(0.0016)  | <b>0.0180***</b><br>(0.0019)  | <b>0.0115***</b><br>(0.0016)  |
| DailyVola           |                              |                               | <b>-0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000) |                               |                               | <b>-0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>-0.0000***</b><br>(0.0000) |
| Extended Controls   |                              |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| Industry FE         | Yes                          |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               |
| Firm FE             |                              | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |
| Year FE             | Yes                          | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               |
| Year-Quarter FE     |                              |                               |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| N                   | 57,334                       | 57,334                        | 54,977                        | 54,977                        | 54,977                        | 54,977                        | 55,039                        | 55,039                        | 54,033                        | 54,033                        | 54,033                        | 54,033                        |
| R <sup>2</sup>      | 0.302                        | 0.117                         | 0.310                         | 0.119                         | 0.311                         | 0.119                         | 0.236                         | 0.064                         | 0.248                         | 0.067                         | 0.249                         | 0.067                         |
| Adj. R <sup>2</sup> | 0.301                        | 0.090                         | 0.309                         | 0.092                         | 0.310                         | 0.090                         | 0.235                         | 0.035                         | 0.247                         | 0.038                         | 0.248                         | 0.037                         |

Notes: \*  $p < 0.10$ , \*\*  $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\*  $p < 0.01$  (two-tailed). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms).  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ).



Table 54: H18: Speech Uncertainty and SEC Comment Letters

|                     | (1)                         | (2)                           | (3)                          | (4)                           | (5)                          | (6)                           |
|---------------------|-----------------------------|-------------------------------|------------------------------|-------------------------------|------------------------------|-------------------------------|
|                     | CCCL                        |                               |                              |                               |                              |                               |
| UncAnsCEO           | -0.0012<br>(0.0009)         | -0.0007<br>(0.0009)           | -0.0014<br>(0.0009)          | -0.0008<br>(0.0009)           | -0.0014<br>(0.0009)          | -0.0009<br>(0.0009)           |
| UncPreCEO           | -0.0004<br>(0.0008)         | -0.0002<br>(0.0010)           | 0.0000<br>(0.0007)           | 0.0003<br>(0.0009)            | 0.0000<br>(0.0007)           | 0.0003<br>(0.0009)            |
| UncAnsMgr           | -0.0003<br>(0.0011)         | 0.0003<br>(0.0011)            | -0.0000<br>(0.0011)          | 0.0006<br>(0.0012)            | -0.0001<br>(0.0011)          | 0.0005<br>(0.0012)            |
| UncPreMgr           | <b>0.0017*</b><br>(0.0011)  | <b>0.0020*</b><br>(0.0014)    | 0.0013<br>(0.0010)           | 0.0016<br>(0.0013)            | 0.0013<br>(0.0010)           | 0.0016<br>(0.0013)            |
| lnAssets            | <b>-0.0003*</b><br>(0.0002) | 0.0012<br>(0.0007)            | <b>-0.0004**</b><br>(0.0002) | <b>0.0014*</b><br>(0.0007)    | <b>-0.0004**</b><br>(0.0002) | <b>0.0014*</b><br>(0.0007)    |
| TobinsQ             | -0.0001<br>(0.0002)         | 0.0002<br>(0.0002)            | -0.0001<br>(0.0002)          | 0.0001<br>(0.0003)            | -0.0001<br>(0.0002)          | 0.0002<br>(0.0002)            |
| ROA                 | -0.0012<br>(0.0021)         | -0.0009<br>(0.0032)           | -0.0024<br>(0.0034)          | -0.0008<br>(0.0040)           | -0.0020<br>(0.0034)          | -0.0005<br>(0.0040)           |
| Leverage            | -0.0013<br>(0.0010)         | -0.0006<br>(0.0021)           | -0.0011<br>(0.0010)          | -0.0002<br>(0.0023)           | -0.0011<br>(0.0010)          | -0.0002<br>(0.0024)           |
| Capex               | 0.0030<br>(0.0045)          | 0.0109<br>(0.0084)            | 0.0032<br>(0.0047)           | 0.0120<br>(0.0086)            | 0.0033<br>(0.0047)           | 0.0119<br>(0.0086)            |
| CashRatio           | -0.0010<br>(0.0018)         | <b>-0.0065**</b><br>(0.0032)  | -0.0007<br>(0.0019)          | <b>-0.0053*</b><br>(0.0031)   | -0.0008<br>(0.0019)          | <b>-0.0054*</b><br>(0.0031)   |
| DivDummy            | -0.0004<br>(0.0005)         | -0.0001<br>(0.0010)           | -0.0004<br>(0.0006)          | 0.0000<br>(0.0010)            | -0.0004<br>(0.0006)          | 0.0001<br>(0.0010)            |
| sCFO                | -0.0002<br>(0.0007)         | -0.0014<br>(0.0019)           | -0.0001<br>(0.0007)          | -0.0015<br>(0.0020)           | -0.0001<br>(0.0007)          | -0.0015<br>(0.0020)           |
| Lagged_DV           | -0.0030<br>(0.0043)         | <b>-0.0297***</b><br>(0.0047) | -0.0030<br>(0.0044)          | <b>-0.0306***</b><br>(0.0048) | -0.0029<br>(0.0044)          | <b>-0.0306***</b><br>(0.0048) |
| SalesGrowth         |                             |                               | -0.0001<br>(0.0005)          | -0.0005<br>(0.0006)           | -0.0000<br>(0.0005)          | -0.0004<br>(0.0006)           |
| RDSales             |                             |                               | <b>-0.0003**</b><br>(0.0001) | -0.0001<br>(0.0001)           | <b>-0.0003**</b><br>(0.0001) | -0.0000<br>(0.0001)           |
| CashFlowAt          |                             |                               | 0.0007<br>(0.0033)           | -0.0006<br>(0.0040)           | 0.0004<br>(0.0033)           | -0.0011<br>(0.0040)           |
| DailyVola           |                             |                               | -0.0000<br>(0.0000)          | <b>-0.0000**</b><br>(0.0000)  | -0.0000<br>(0.0000)          | <b>-0.0000*</b><br>(0.0000)   |
| Extended Controls   |                             |                               | Yes                          | Yes                           | Yes                          | Yes                           |
| Industry FE         | Yes                         |                               | Yes                          |                               | Yes                          |                               |
| Firm FE             |                             | Yes                           |                              | Yes                           |                              | Yes                           |
| Year FE             | Yes                         | Yes                           | Yes                          | Yes                           |                              |                               |
| Year-Quarter FE     |                             |                               |                              |                               | Yes                          | Yes                           |
| N                   | 66,886                      | 66,886                        | 64,172                       | 64,172                        | 64,172                       | 64,172                        |
| R <sup>2</sup>      | 0.000                       | 0.001                         | 0.000                        | 0.001                         | 0.000                        | 0.001                         |
| Adj. R <sup>2</sup> | -0.000                      | -0.026                        | -0.000                       | -0.027                        | -0.001                       | -0.028                        |

Notes: \* $p < 0.10$ , \*\* $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\* $p < 0.01$  (one-tailed for IVs,  $\beta > 0$ ; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms).  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ).

Table 55: H18 Robustness: Orthogonal Speaker Partition

|                     | (1)                          | (2)                           | (3)                          | (4)                          | (5)                          | (6)                           |
|---------------------|------------------------------|-------------------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------|-------------------------------|
|                     | CCCL                         |                               |                              |                              |                              |                               |
| UncAnsCEO           | -0.0015<br>(0.0006)          | -0.0006<br>(0.0007)           | -0.0015<br>(0.0007)          | -0.0005<br>(0.0007)          | -0.0015<br>(0.0007)          | -0.0006<br>(0.0007)           |
| UncAnsNoCEO         | -0.0003<br>(0.0004)          | -0.0003<br>(0.0004)           | -0.0003<br>(0.0005)          | -0.0002<br>(0.0005)          | -0.0003<br>(0.0004)          | -0.0002<br>(0.0005)           |
| UncPreCEO           | 0.0005<br>(0.0006)           | 0.0009<br>(0.0007)            | 0.0007<br>(0.0006)           | <b>0.0012**</b><br>(0.0007)  | 0.0007<br>(0.0006)           | <b>0.0012**</b><br>(0.0007)   |
| UncPreNoCEO         | <b>0.0006*</b><br>(0.0004)   | 0.0007<br>(0.0006)            | 0.0005<br>(0.0005)           | 0.0007<br>(0.0006)           | 0.0005<br>(0.0005)           | 0.0008<br>(0.0006)            |
| lnAssets            | <b>-0.0004**</b><br>(0.0002) | 0.0012<br>(0.0008)            | <b>-0.0005**</b><br>(0.0002) | <b>0.0015*</b><br>(0.0008)   | <b>-0.0005**</b><br>(0.0002) | <b>0.0016**</b><br>(0.0008)   |
| TobinsQ             | -0.0001<br>(0.0002)          | 0.0002<br>(0.0003)            | -0.0001<br>(0.0002)          | 0.0002<br>(0.0003)           | -0.0001<br>(0.0002)          | 0.0002<br>(0.0003)            |
| ROA                 | -0.0011<br>(0.0023)          | -0.0005<br>(0.0034)           | -0.0026<br>(0.0035)          | -0.0005<br>(0.0042)          | -0.0022<br>(0.0035)          | -0.0002<br>(0.0042)           |
| Leverage            | -0.0013<br>(0.0010)          | -0.0008<br>(0.0022)           | -0.0011<br>(0.0011)          | -0.0004<br>(0.0024)          | -0.0010<br>(0.0011)          | -0.0003<br>(0.0024)           |
| Capex               | 0.0036<br>(0.0047)           | 0.0118<br>(0.0087)            | 0.0036<br>(0.0049)           | 0.0131<br>(0.0090)           | 0.0038<br>(0.0049)           | 0.0131<br>(0.0089)            |
| CashRatio           | -0.0010<br>(0.0019)          | <b>-0.0062*</b><br>(0.0033)   | -0.0007<br>(0.0021)          | -0.0049<br>(0.0032)          | -0.0008<br>(0.0021)          | -0.0050<br>(0.0032)           |
| DivDummy            | -0.0002<br>(0.0006)          | -0.0001<br>(0.0011)           | -0.0003<br>(0.0006)          | 0.0000<br>(0.0011)           | -0.0003<br>(0.0006)          | 0.0001<br>(0.0011)            |
| sCFO                | -0.0001<br>(0.0007)          | -0.0014<br>(0.0019)           | -0.0000<br>(0.0007)          | -0.0014<br>(0.0020)          | -0.0001<br>(0.0007)          | -0.0014<br>(0.0020)           |
| Lagged_DV           | -0.0028<br>(0.0046)          | <b>-0.0304***</b><br>(0.0051) | -0.0028<br>(0.0047)          | <b>-0.0314**</b><br>(0.0052) | -0.0027<br>(0.0047)          | <b>-0.0314***</b><br>(0.0052) |
| SalesGrowth         |                              |                               | -0.0004<br>(0.0005)          | -0.0009<br>(0.0007)          | -0.0003<br>(0.0005)          | -0.0008<br>(0.0006)           |
| RDSales             |                              |                               | <b>-0.0003**</b><br>(0.0001) | -0.0001<br>(0.0001)          | <b>-0.0003**</b><br>(0.0001) | -0.0001<br>(0.0001)           |
| CashFlowAt          |                              |                               | 0.0016<br>(0.0034)           | 0.0006<br>(0.0042)           | 0.0013<br>(0.0034)           | 0.0001<br>(0.0042)            |
| DailyVola           |                              |                               | -0.0000<br>(0.0000)          | <b>-0.0000**</b><br>(0.0000) | -0.0000<br>(0.0000)          | <b>-0.0000*</b><br>(0.0000)   |
| Extended Controls   |                              |                               | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                           |
| Industry FE         | Yes                          |                               | Yes                          |                              | Yes                          |                               |
| Firm FE             |                              | Yes                           |                              | Yes                          |                              | Yes                           |
| Year FE             | Yes                          | Yes                           | Yes                          | Yes                          |                              |                               |
| Year-Quarter FE     |                              |                               |                              |                              | Yes                          | Yes                           |
| N                   | 62,704                       | 62,704                        | 60,199                       | 60,199                       | 60,199                       | 60,199                        |
| R <sup>2</sup>      | 0.000                        | 0.001                         | 0.000                        | 0.001                        | 0.000                        | 0.001                         |
| Adj. R <sup>2</sup> | -0.000                       | -0.027                        | -0.000                       | -0.028                       | -0.001                       | -0.029                        |

Notes: \*  $p < 0.10$ , \*\*  $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\*  $p < 0.01$  (one-tailed for IVs,  $\beta > 0$ ; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms).  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ).

Table 56: H18b: Logit Robustness — Speech Uncertainty and SEC Comment Letters

|                   | (1)                         | (2)                         |
|-------------------|-----------------------------|-----------------------------|
|                   | CCCL                        |                             |
| UncAnsCEO         | -0.0012<br>(0.0009)         | -0.0016<br>(0.0010)         |
| UncPreCEO         | -0.0005<br>(0.0008)         | 0.0001<br>(0.0007)          |
| UncAnsMgr         | -0.0004<br>(0.0011)         | 0.0001<br>(0.0011)          |
| UncPreMgr         | <b>0.0018**</b><br>(0.0010) | <b>0.0012*</b><br>(0.0009)  |
| InAssets          | -0.0003<br>(0.0002)         | <b>-0.0003*</b><br>(0.0002) |
| TobinsQ           | -0.0001<br>(0.0002)         | -0.0001<br>(0.0002)         |
| ROA               | -0.0018<br>(0.0019)         | -0.0030<br>(0.0030)         |
| Leverage          | -0.0015<br>(0.0013)         | -0.0008<br>(0.0013)         |
| Capex             | 0.0011<br>(0.0053)          | 0.0022<br>(0.0054)          |
| CashRatio         | -0.0006<br>(0.0018)         | 0.0007<br>(0.0020)          |
| DivDummy          | -0.0004<br>(0.0006)         | -0.0005<br>(0.0006)         |
| sCFO              | -0.0004<br>(0.0023)         | 0.0001<br>(0.0014)          |
| Lagged_DV         | -0.0022<br>(0.0037)         | -0.0026<br>(0.0041)         |
| SalesGrowth       |                             | -0.0003<br>(0.0008)         |
| RDSales           |                             | -0.0026<br>(0.0023)         |
| CashFlowAt        |                             | 0.0003<br>(0.0037)          |
| DailyVola         |                             | -0.0000<br>(0.0000)         |
| Extended Controls |                             | Yes                         |
| Industry FE       | Yes                         | Yes                         |
| Year FE           | Yes                         | Yes                         |
| N                 | 66,886                      | 64,172                      |
| Pseudo $R^2$      | 0.089                       | 0.090                       |

Notes: \* $p < 0.10$ , \*\* $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\* $p < 0.01$  (one-tailed for IVs,  $\beta > 0$ ; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms).  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ).

Table 57: H18b.r: Logit + Orthogonal Speaker Partition — SEC Comment Letters

|                   | (1)                         | (2)                          |
|-------------------|-----------------------------|------------------------------|
|                   | CCCL                        |                              |
| UncAnsCEO         | -0.0016<br>(0.0007)         | -0.0016<br>(0.0008)          |
| UncAnsNoCEO       | -0.0003<br>(0.0004)         | -0.0002<br>(0.0005)          |
| UncPreCEO         | 0.0006<br>(0.0006)          | 0.0008<br>(0.0006)           |
| UncPreNoCEO       | <b>0.0006*</b><br>(0.0004)  | <b>0.0006*</b><br>(0.0004)   |
| lnAssets          | <b>-0.0004*</b><br>(0.0002) | <b>-0.0004**</b><br>(0.0002) |
| TobinsQ           | -0.0000<br>(0.0002)         | -0.0001<br>(0.0002)          |
| ROA               | -0.0017<br>(0.0020)         | -0.0031<br>(0.0031)          |
| Leverage          | -0.0010<br>(0.0013)         | -0.0008<br>(0.0013)          |
| Capex             | 0.0003<br>(0.0058)          | 0.0031<br>(0.0059)           |
| CashRatio         | -0.0001<br>(0.0019)         | 0.0004<br>(0.0022)           |
| DivDummy          | -0.0002<br>(0.0006)         | -0.0004<br>(0.0006)          |
| sCFO              | -0.0007<br>(0.0034)         | -0.0000<br>(0.0019)          |
| Lagged_DV         | -0.0016<br>(0.0033)         | -0.0026<br>(0.0043)          |
| SalesGrowth       |                             | -0.0008<br>(0.0010)          |
| RDSales           |                             | -0.0022<br>(0.0023)          |
| CashFlowAt        |                             | 0.0019<br>(0.0040)           |
| DailyVola         |                             | -0.0000<br>(0.0000)          |
| Extended Controls |                             | Yes                          |
| Industry FE       | Yes                         | Yes                          |
| Year FE           | Yes                         | Yes                          |
| N                 | 62,704                      | 60,199                       |
| Pseudo $R^2$      | 0.091                       | 0.092                        |

Notes: \* $p < 0.10$ , \*\* $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\* $p < 0.01$  (one-tailed for IVs,  $\beta > 0$ ; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms).  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ).

Table 58: H19b: Speech Uncertainty and External vs Internal Financing (Chang et al. 2006)

|                     | (1)                           | (2)                           | (3)                           | (4)                           | (5)                           | (6)                           | (7)                           | (8)                           | (9)                           | (10)                          | (11)                          | (12)                          |
|---------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|
|                     |                               |                               | Chang                         | External                      | Funding                       |                               |                               |                               | Chang                         | External                      | Funding                       | lead                          |
| UncAnsCEO           | 0.0093<br>(0.0083)            | 0.0073<br>(0.0077)            | 0.0096<br>(0.0083)            | 0.0081<br>(0.0077)            | 0.0096<br>(0.0082)            | 0.0081<br>(0.0077)            | 0.0140<br>(0.0090)            | 0.0088<br>(0.0079)            | 0.0145<br>(0.0090)            | 0.0084<br>(0.0079)            | 0.0144<br>(0.0090)            | 0.0082<br>(0.0079)            |
| UncPreCEO           | -0.0039<br>(0.0093)           | -0.0115<br>(0.0092)           | -0.0045<br>(0.0092)           | -0.0053<br>(0.0093)           | -0.0045<br>(0.0092)           | -0.0054<br>(0.0093)           | 0.0051<br>(0.0102)            | -0.0070<br>(0.0093)           | 0.0033<br>(0.0101)            | -0.0075<br>(0.0094)           | 0.0032<br>(0.0101)            | -0.0074<br>(0.0094)           |
| UncAnsMgr           | -0.0049<br>(0.0105)           | -0.0038<br>(0.0100)           | -0.0083<br>(0.0105)           | 0.0015<br>(0.0100)            | -0.0085<br>(0.0100)           | 0.0010<br>(0.0100)            | -0.0133<br>(0.0114)           | -0.0096<br>(0.0106)           | <b>-0.0160*</b><br>(0.0114)   | -0.0092<br>(0.0107)           | <b>-0.0155*</b><br>(0.0115)   | -0.0084<br>(0.0107)           |
| UncPreMgr           | 0.0257<br>(0.0114)            | 0.0176<br>(0.0130)            | 0.0290<br>(0.0112)            | 0.0143<br>(0.0132)            | 0.0292<br>(0.0113)            | 0.0143<br>(0.0132)            | -0.0037<br>(0.0124)           | -0.0104<br>(0.0135)           | 0.0001<br>(0.0123)            | -0.0091<br>(0.0137)           | 0.0003<br>(0.0123)            | -0.0090<br>(0.0137)           |
| lnAssets            | <b>-0.0080**</b><br>(0.0034)  | 0.0074<br>(0.0102)            | <b>-0.0058*</b><br>(0.0035)   | 0.0146<br>(0.0107)            | -0.0056<br>(0.0036)           | 0.0148<br>(0.0107)            | <b>-0.0148***</b><br>(0.0031) | <b>-0.1222***</b><br>(0.0106) | <b>-0.0153***</b><br>(0.0032) | <b>-0.1207***</b><br>(0.0108) | <b>-0.0145***</b><br>(0.0032) | <b>-0.1196***</b><br>(0.0108) |
| TobinsQ             | <b>0.0229***</b><br>(0.0039)  | <b>0.0293***</b><br>(0.0048)  | <b>0.0237***</b><br>(0.0056)  | <b>0.0334***</b><br>(0.0061)  | <b>0.0238***</b><br>(0.0056)  | <b>0.0337***</b><br>(0.0062)  | <b>0.0223***</b><br>(0.0033)  | <b>0.0109**</b><br>(0.0049)   | <b>0.0240***</b><br>(0.0038)  | <b>0.0140***</b><br>(0.0048)  | <b>0.0241***</b><br>(0.0038)  | <b>0.0135***</b><br>(0.0049)  |
| ROA                 | <b>-0.2348***</b><br>(0.0504) | -0.0686<br>(0.0461)           | <b>0.1241**</b><br>(0.0534)   | <b>0.1169**</b><br>(0.0531)   | <b>0.1234**</b><br>(0.0539)   | <b>0.1148**</b><br>(0.0536)   | <b>-0.1917***</b><br>(0.0411) | 0.0251<br>(0.0517)            | <b>0.0757*</b><br>(0.0460)    | <b>0.1061**</b><br>(0.0518)   | <b>0.0779*</b><br>(0.0463)    | <b>0.1051**</b><br>(0.0520)   |
| Leverage            | <b>0.2928***</b><br>(0.0553)  | <b>0.4679***</b><br>(0.0413)  | <b>0.2745***</b><br>(0.0521)  | <b>0.4318***</b><br>(0.0431)  | <b>0.2737***</b><br>(0.0522)  | <b>0.4304***</b><br>(0.0433)  | <b>0.0945***</b><br>(0.0253)  | <b>-0.2967***</b><br>(0.0402) | <b>0.0886***</b><br>(0.0242)  | <b>-0.3010***</b><br>(0.0406) | <b>0.0868***</b><br>(0.0239)  | <b>-0.3041***</b><br>(0.0408) |
| Capex               | <b>0.6445***</b><br>(0.1001)  | <b>0.9281***</b><br>(0.1461)  | <b>0.8643***</b><br>(0.1116)  | <b>0.9986***</b><br>(0.1529)  | <b>0.8593***</b><br>(0.1119)  | <b>0.9841***</b><br>(0.1537)  | <b>0.6948***</b><br>(0.0946)  | <b>0.8689***</b><br>(0.1481)  | <b>0.8668***</b><br>(0.0995)  | <b>0.9102***</b><br>(0.1484)  | <b>0.8694***</b><br>(0.0998)  | <b>0.9330***</b><br>(0.1498)  |
| CashRatio           | -0.0484<br>(0.0332)           | 0.0258<br>(0.0401)            | <b>-0.0923***</b><br>(0.0319) | 0.0319<br>(0.0404)            | <b>-0.0929***</b><br>(0.0319) | 0.0319<br>(0.0405)            | <b>-0.1565***</b><br>(0.0329) | <b>-0.2364***</b><br>(0.0407) | <b>-0.1824***</b><br>(0.0312) | <b>-0.2382***</b><br>(0.0409) | <b>-0.1849***</b><br>(0.0311) | <b>-0.2395***</b><br>(0.0409) |
| DivDummy            | -0.0047<br>(0.0081)           | <b>0.0547***</b><br>(0.0132)  | 0.0023<br>(0.0083)            | <b>0.0581***</b><br>(0.0139)  | 0.0026<br>(0.0083)            | <b>0.0579***</b><br>(0.0139)  | 0.0006<br>(0.0085)            | <b>0.0502***</b><br>(0.0139)  | 0.0002<br>(0.0085)            | <b>0.0486***</b><br>(0.0140)  | 0.0017<br>(0.0085)            | <b>0.0495***</b><br>(0.0141)  |
| sCFO                | 0.0390<br>(0.0421)            | -0.0151<br>(0.0210)           | 0.0077<br>(0.0214)            | <b>-0.0265*</b><br>(0.0152)   | 0.0077<br>(0.0215)            | <b>-0.0266*</b><br>(0.0153)   | 0.0379<br>(0.0396)            | <b>-0.0362***</b><br>(0.0120) | 0.0297<br>(0.0335)            | <b>-0.0365***</b><br>(0.0118) | 0.0293<br>(0.0330)            | <b>-0.0360***</b><br>(0.0116) |
| Lagged_DV           | <b>0.0814***</b><br>(0.0100)  | <b>-0.0711***</b><br>(0.0090) | <b>0.0575***</b><br>(0.0100)  | <b>-0.0851***</b><br>(0.0092) | <b>0.0574***</b><br>(0.0100)  | <b>-0.0854***</b><br>(0.0092) | <b>0.0827***</b><br>(0.0090)  | <b>-0.0347***</b><br>(0.0088) | <b>0.0720***</b><br>(0.0090)  | <b>-0.0360***</b><br>(0.0089) | <b>0.0722***</b><br>(0.0090)  | <b>-0.0358***</b><br>(0.0088) |
| SalesGrowth         |                               |                               | <b>0.1731***</b><br>(0.0199)  | <b>0.1597***</b><br>(0.0196)  | <b>0.1724***</b><br>(0.0200)  | <b>0.1591***</b><br>(0.0198)  |                               |                               | <b>0.0411***</b><br>(0.0123)  | -0.0078<br>(0.0134)           | <b>0.0418***</b><br>(0.0123)  | -0.0069<br>(0.0134)           |
| RDSales             |                               |                               | 0.0089<br>(0.0058)            | <b>0.0147**</b><br>(0.0070)   | 0.0088<br>(0.0058)            | <b>0.0147**</b><br>(0.0070)   |                               |                               | <b>0.0186***</b><br>(0.0055)  | 0.0012<br>(0.0066)            | <b>0.0186***</b><br>(0.0056)  | 0.0016<br>(0.0066)            |
| CashFlowAt          |                               |                               | <b>-0.6527***</b><br>(0.0894) | <b>-0.7543***</b><br>(0.0976) | <b>-0.6486***</b><br>(0.0896) | <b>-0.7507***</b><br>(0.0979) |                               |                               | <b>-0.4337***</b><br>(0.0623) | <b>-0.2165***</b><br>(0.0674) | <b>-0.4280***</b><br>(0.0624) | <b>-0.2112***</b><br>(0.0676) |
| DailyVola           |                               |                               | 0.0000<br>(0.0002)            | -0.0000<br>(0.0002)           | 0.0001<br>(0.0002)            | 0.0000<br>(0.0002)            |                               |                               | <b>-0.0003*</b><br>(0.0002)   | -0.0002<br>(0.0002)           | -0.0000<br>(0.0002)           | 0.0001<br>(0.0002)            |
| Extended Controls   |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| Industry FE         | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| Firm FE             |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |
| Year FE             | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               |
| Year-Quarter FE     |                               |                               |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| N                   | 65,069                        | 65,069                        | 62,450                        | 62,450                        | 62,450                        | 62,450                        | 60,052                        | 60,052                        | 58,871                        | 58,871                        | 58,871                        | 58,871                        |
| R <sup>2</sup>      | 0.054                         | 0.025                         | 0.083                         | 0.049                         | 0.082                         | 0.048                         | 0.033                         | 0.031                         | 0.040                         | 0.032                         | 0.040                         | 0.031                         |
| Adj. R <sup>2</sup> | 0.054                         | -0.002                        | 0.082                         | 0.022                         | 0.081                         | 0.020                         | 0.032                         | 0.003                         | 0.040                         | 0.003                         | 0.039                         | 0.002                         |

Notes: \*  $p < 0.10$ , \*\*  $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\*  $p < 0.01$  (one-tailed for IVs,  $\beta < 0$ ; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms).  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ).

Table 59: H19b Robustness: Orthogonal Speaker Partition

|                     | (1)                           | (2)                           | (3)                           | (4)                           | (5)                           | (6)                           | (7)                           | (8)                           | (9)                           | (10)                          | (11)                          | (12)                          |
|---------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|
|                     |                               |                               | Chang                         | External                      | Funding                       |                               |                               |                               | Chang                         | External                      | Funding_lead                  |                               |
| UncAnsCEO           | 0.0060<br>(0.0065)            | 0.0039<br>(0.0058)            | 0.0043<br>(0.0064)            | 0.0082<br>(0.0057)            | 0.0043<br>(0.0064)            | 0.0080<br>(0.0057)            | 0.0063<br>(0.0072)            | 0.0012<br>(0.0060)            | 0.0054<br>(0.0071)            | 0.0011<br>(0.0060)            | 0.0056<br>(0.0071)            | 0.0015<br>(0.0060)            |
| UncAnsNoCEO         | 0.0074<br>(0.0036)            | 0.0062<br>(0.0034)            | 0.0061<br>(0.0036)            | 0.0067<br>(0.0034)            | 0.0061<br>(0.0036)            | 0.0067<br>(0.0034)            | -0.0035<br>(0.0038)           | -0.0043<br>(0.0035)           | -0.0045<br>(0.0039)           | -0.0045<br>(0.0036)           | -0.0044<br>(0.0039)           | -0.0043<br>(0.0036)           |
| UncPreCEO           | 0.0095<br>(0.0077)            | -0.0032<br>(0.0074)           | 0.0110<br>(0.0076)            | 0.0023<br>(0.0075)            | 0.0111<br>(0.0076)            | 0.0023<br>(0.0075)            | 0.0049<br>(0.0083)            | <b>-0.0118*</b><br>(0.0075)   | 0.0055<br>(0.0083)            | <b>-0.0119*</b><br>(0.0075)   | 0.0054<br>(0.0083)            | <b>-0.0117*</b><br>(0.0075)   |
| UncPreNoCEO         | 0.0116<br>(0.0057)            | 0.0053<br>(0.0068)            | 0.0122<br>(0.0055)            | 0.0029<br>(0.0069)            | 0.0123<br>(0.0056)            | 0.0029<br>(0.0069)            | -0.0015<br>(0.0059)           | <b>-0.0108*</b><br>(0.0072)   | -0.0007<br>(0.0058)           | <b>-0.0109*</b><br>(0.0073)   | -0.0007<br>(0.0058)           | <b>-0.0110*</b><br>(0.0073)   |
| lnAssets            | <b>-0.0088**</b><br>(0.0035)  | 0.0073<br>(0.0107)            | <b>-0.0065*</b><br>(0.0036)   | 0.0137<br>(0.0112)            | <b>-0.0062*</b><br>(0.0036)   | 0.0141<br>(0.0112)            | <b>-0.0156***</b><br>(0.0032) | <b>-0.1245***</b><br>(0.0109) | <b>-0.0160***</b><br>(0.0033) | <b>-0.1228***</b><br>(0.0111) | <b>-0.0151***</b><br>(0.0033) | <b>-0.1216***</b><br>(0.0112) |
| TobinsQ             | <b>0.0227***</b><br>(0.0039)  | <b>0.0296***</b><br>(0.0050)  | <b>0.0236***</b><br>(0.0057)  | <b>0.0332***</b><br>(0.0063)  | <b>0.0237***</b><br>(0.0057)  | <b>0.0334***</b><br>(0.0064)  | <b>0.0225***</b><br>(0.0033)  | <b>0.0102**</b><br>(0.0050)   | <b>0.0245***</b><br>(0.0039)  | <b>0.0135***</b><br>(0.0049)  | <b>0.0246***</b><br>(0.0039)  | <b>0.0130***</b><br>(0.0050)  |
| ROA                 | <b>-0.2187***</b><br>(0.0522) | -0.0558<br>(0.0473)           | <b>0.1498***</b><br>(0.0551)  | <b>0.1413***</b><br>(0.0548)  | <b>0.1495***</b><br>(0.0556)  | <b>0.1398***</b><br>(0.0554)  | <b>-0.1787***</b><br>(0.0420) | 0.0353<br>(0.0500)            | <b>0.0959**</b><br>(0.0476)   | <b>0.1220**</b><br>(0.0522)   | <b>0.0989**</b><br>(0.0479)   | <b>0.1216**</b><br>(0.0524)   |
| Leverage            | <b>0.2916***</b><br>(0.0579)  | <b>0.4797***</b><br>(0.0429)  | <b>0.2711***</b><br>(0.0540)  | <b>0.4430***</b><br>(0.0447)  | <b>0.2702***</b><br>(0.0540)  | <b>0.4411***</b><br>(0.0448)  | <b>0.0954***</b><br>(0.0263)  | <b>-0.2953***</b><br>(0.0409) | <b>0.0882***</b><br>(0.0250)  | <b>-0.2994***</b><br>(0.0413) | <b>0.0862***</b><br>(0.0246)  | <b>-0.3027***</b><br>(0.0415) |
| Capex               | <b>0.6169***</b><br>(0.1011)  | <b>0.9680***</b><br>(0.1515)  | <b>0.8576***</b><br>(0.1143)  | <b>1.0408***</b><br>(0.1600)  | <b>0.8524***</b><br>(0.1146)  | <b>1.0282***</b><br>(0.1607)  | <b>0.6617***</b><br>(0.0971)  | <b>0.8526***</b><br>(0.1520)  | <b>0.8485***</b><br>(0.1027)  | <b>0.9075***</b><br>(0.1524)  | <b>0.8515***</b><br>(0.1029)  | <b>0.9335***</b><br>(0.1539)  |
| CashRatio           | -0.0437<br>(0.0340)           | 0.0268<br>(0.0411)            | <b>-0.0839**</b><br>(0.0327)  | 0.0375<br>(0.0414)            | <b>-0.0845**</b><br>(0.0327)  | 0.0374<br>(0.0415)            | <b>-0.1574***</b><br>(0.0336) | <b>-0.2496***</b><br>(0.0416) | <b>-0.1797***</b><br>(0.0317) | <b>-0.2520***</b><br>(0.0418) | <b>-0.1826***</b><br>(0.0317) | <b>-0.2532***</b><br>(0.0419) |
| DivDummy            | -0.0025<br>(0.0083)           | <b>0.0568***</b><br>(0.0137)  | 0.0056<br>(0.0085)            | <b>0.0602***</b><br>(0.0143)  | 0.0060<br>(0.0084)            | <b>0.0601***</b><br>(0.0143)  | 0.0038<br>(0.0087)            | <b>0.0526***</b><br>(0.0143)  | 0.0036<br>(0.0087)            | <b>0.0511***</b><br>(0.0144)  | 0.0053<br>(0.0087)            | <b>0.0522***</b><br>(0.0145)  |
| sCFO                | 0.0317<br>(0.0391)            | -0.0145<br>(0.0209)           | 0.0053<br>(0.0209)            | <b>-0.0256*</b><br>(0.0154)   | 0.0052<br>(0.0209)            | <b>-0.0258*</b><br>(0.0154)   | 0.0377<br>(0.0407)            | <b>-0.0352***</b><br>(0.0124) | 0.0306<br>(0.0350)            | <b>-0.0350***</b><br>(0.0124) | 0.0301<br>(0.0345)            | <b>-0.0346***</b><br>(0.0122) |
| Lagged_DV           | <b>0.0792***</b><br>(0.0101)  | <b>-0.0714***</b><br>(0.0091) | <b>0.0560***</b><br>(0.0101)  | <b>-0.0853***</b><br>(0.0093) | <b>0.0559***</b><br>(0.0101)  | <b>-0.0857***</b><br>(0.0094) | <b>0.0806***</b><br>(0.0092)  | <b>-0.0345***</b><br>(0.0089) | <b>0.0708***</b><br>(0.0092)  | <b>-0.0360***</b><br>(0.0090) | <b>0.0708***</b><br>(0.0092)  | <b>-0.0358***</b><br>(0.0090) |
| SalesGrowth         |                               |                               | <b>0.1766***</b><br>(0.0208)  | <b>0.1692***</b><br>(0.0205)  | <b>0.1759***</b><br>(0.0210)  | <b>0.1685***</b><br>(0.0207)  |                               |                               | <b>0.0359***</b><br>(0.0128)  | -0.0096<br>(0.0137)           | <b>0.0367***</b><br>(0.0128)  | -0.0084<br>(0.0138)           |
| RDSales             |                               |                               | 0.0093<br>(0.0061)            | <b>0.0182**</b><br>(0.0079)   | 0.0093<br>(0.0061)            | <b>0.0182**</b><br>(0.0079)   |                               |                               | <b>0.0198***</b><br>(0.0063)  | 0.0026<br>(0.0082)            | <b>0.0198***</b><br>(0.0064)  | 0.0032<br>(0.0082)            |
| CashFlowAt          |                               |                               | <b>-0.6696***</b><br>(0.0915) | <b>-0.7697***</b><br>(0.1013) | <b>-0.6651***</b><br>(0.0917) | <b>-0.7658***</b><br>(0.1017) |                               |                               | <b>-0.4496***</b><br>(0.0650) | <b>-0.2286***</b><br>(0.0684) | <b>-0.4434***</b><br>(0.0651) | <b>-0.2231***</b><br>(0.0686) |
| DailyVola           |                               |                               | 0.0001<br>(0.0002)            | 0.0000<br>(0.0002)            | 0.0002<br>(0.0002)            | 0.0001<br>(0.0002)            |                               |                               | <b>-0.0003*</b><br>(0.0002)   | -0.0002<br>(0.0002)           | 0.0000<br>(0.0002)            | 0.0002<br>(0.0002)            |
| Extended Controls   |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| Industry FE         | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               |
| Firm FE             |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |
| Year FE             | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               |
| Year-Quarter FE     |                               |                               |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| N                   | 61,063                        | 61,063                        | 58,629                        | 58,629                        | 58,629                        | 58,629                        | 56,359                        | 56,359                        | 55,275                        | 55,275                        | 55,275                        | 55,275                        |
| R <sup>2</sup>      | 0.052                         | 0.026                         | 0.081                         | 0.050                         | 0.081                         | 0.050                         | 0.032                         | 0.031                         | 0.039                         | 0.032                         | 0.039                         | 0.032                         |
| Adj. R <sup>2</sup> | 0.052                         | -0.002                        | 0.080                         | 0.022                         | 0.079                         | 0.021                         | 0.031                         | 0.002                         | 0.038                         | 0.002                         | 0.038                         | 0.001                         |

Notes: \*  $p < 0.10$ , \*\*  $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\*  $p < 0.01$  (one-tailed for IVs,  $\beta < 0$ ; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms).  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ).

Table 60: H20b: Speech Uncertainty and Debt vs Equity Choice (Chang et al. 2006)

|                     | (1)                           | (2)                           | (3)                           | (4)                           | (5)                           | (6)                           | (7)                           | (8)                          | (9)                           | (10)                          | (11)                          | (12)                         |
|---------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|------------------------------|
|                     |                               |                               | ChangDebtChoice               |                               |                               |                               |                               |                              | ChangDebtChoice_lead          |                               |                               |                              |
| UncAnsCEO           | -0.0144<br>(0.0143)           | -0.0102<br>(0.0134)           | -0.0153<br>(0.0144)           | -0.0086<br>(0.0137)           | -0.0162<br>(0.0141)           | -0.0101<br>(0.0135)           | -0.0234<br>(0.0299)           | 0.0034<br>(0.0265)           | -0.0272<br>(0.0288)           | 0.0012<br>(0.0264)            | -0.0301<br>(0.0286)           | 0.0002<br>(0.0263)           |
| UncPreCEO           | <b>-0.0320**</b><br>(0.0162)  | -0.0079<br>(0.0149)           | <b>-0.0269*</b><br>(0.0162)   | -0.0049<br>(0.0150)           | -0.0259<br>(0.0161)           | -0.0031<br>(0.0150)           | -0.0382<br>(0.0328)           | -0.0169<br>(0.0309)          | -0.0324<br>(0.0322)           | -0.0272<br>(0.0326)           | -0.0295<br>(0.0326)           | -0.0242<br>(0.0338)          |
| UncAnsMgr           | 0.0240<br>(0.0184)            | 0.0118<br>(0.0163)            | 0.0273<br>(0.0185)            | 0.0127<br>(0.0170)            | 0.0264<br>(0.0184)            | 0.0132<br>(0.0169)            | 0.0444<br>(0.0437)            | -0.0217<br>(0.0348)          | 0.0554<br>(0.0424)            | -0.0208<br>(0.0350)           | 0.0583<br>(0.0421)            | -0.0207<br>(0.0344)          |
| UncPreMgr           | <b>0.0389*</b><br>(0.0201)    | 0.0128<br>(0.0225)            | <b>0.0362*</b><br>(0.0202)    | 0.0130<br>(0.0228)            | <b>0.0333*</b><br>(0.0201)    | 0.0065<br>(0.0230)            | 0.0073<br>(0.0446)            | 0.0539<br>(0.0561)           | 0.0035<br>(0.0440)            | 0.0627<br>(0.0583)            | 0.0018<br>(0.0443)            | 0.0584<br>(0.0595)           |
| lnAssets            | <b>0.0523***</b><br>(0.0051)  | <b>0.0932***</b><br>(0.0172)  | <b>0.0487***</b><br>(0.0052)  | <b>0.0996***</b><br>(0.0181)  | <b>0.0443***</b><br>(0.0051)  | <b>0.0955***</b><br>(0.0180)  | <b>0.0636***</b><br>(0.0106)  | 0.0472<br>(0.0408)           | <b>0.0511***</b><br>(0.0106)  | 0.0551<br>(0.0425)            | <b>0.0500***</b><br>(0.0108)  | 0.0542<br>(0.0438)           |
| TobinsQ             | <b>-0.0248***</b><br>(0.0043) | <b>-0.0271***</b><br>(0.0060) | <b>-0.0252***</b><br>(0.0043) | <b>-0.0271***</b><br>(0.0059) | <b>-0.0261***</b><br>(0.0043) | <b>-0.0267***</b><br>(0.0061) | <b>-0.0116*</b><br>(0.0060)   | -0.0112<br>(0.0135)          | <b>-0.0115*</b><br>(0.0062)   | -0.0069<br>(0.0125)           | <b>-0.0120*</b><br>(0.0063)   | -0.0071<br>(0.0123)          |
| ROA                 | <b>0.2663***</b><br>(0.0479)  | <b>0.1211*</b><br>(0.0673)    | <b>0.2829***</b><br>(0.0715)  | <b>0.1639*</b><br>(0.0839)    | <b>0.2509***</b><br>(0.0713)  | <b>0.1411*</b><br>(0.0835)    | <b>0.3790***</b><br>(0.0838)  | <b>0.3614***</b><br>(0.1384) | <b>0.5384***</b><br>(0.1268)  | <b>0.3817**</b><br>(0.1757)   | <b>0.5364***</b><br>(0.1283)  | <b>0.3842**</b><br>(0.1791)  |
| Leverage            | <b>0.1617***</b><br>(0.0294)  | <b>0.1198***</b><br>(0.0455)  | <b>0.1727***</b><br>(0.0297)  | <b>0.1208***</b><br>(0.0461)  | <b>0.1808***</b><br>(0.0302)  | <b>0.1320***</b><br>(0.0458)  | 0.0221<br>(0.0594)            | <b>-0.2478**</b><br>(0.1105) | 0.0166<br>(0.0526)            | <b>-0.2279**</b><br>(0.1058)  | 0.0166<br>(0.0526)            | <b>-0.2313**</b><br>(0.1046) |
| Capex               | 0.1538<br>(0.1298)            | <b>1.0006***</b><br>(0.2856)  | <b>0.2759**</b><br>(0.1323)   | <b>1.0307***</b><br>(0.2875)  | <b>0.2553*</b><br>(0.1308)    | <b>0.9389***</b><br>(0.2830)  | 0.1418<br>(0.2231)            | 0.1569<br>(0.4918)           | 0.3236<br>(0.2311)            | 0.2549<br>(0.4784)            | 0.3383<br>(0.2323)            | 0.3605<br>(0.4833)           |
| CashRatio           | <b>-0.4541***</b><br>(0.0498) | <b>-0.3466***</b><br>(0.0704) | <b>-0.4531***</b><br>(0.0527) | <b>-0.3413***</b><br>(0.0726) | <b>-0.4280***</b><br>(0.0525) | <b>-0.3318***</b><br>(0.0721) | <b>-0.3771***</b><br>(0.0916) | -0.0174<br>(0.1617)          | <b>-0.3433***</b><br>(0.0940) | -0.0535<br>(0.1535)           | <b>-0.3343***</b><br>(0.0944) | -0.0326<br>(0.1539)          |
| DivDummy            | <b>0.0630**</b><br>(0.0134)   | <b>0.0450*</b><br>(0.0273)    | <b>0.0562***</b><br>(0.0134)  | 0.0413<br>(0.0274)            | <b>0.0494***</b><br>(0.0133)  | 0.0379<br>(0.0273)            | <b>0.0528*</b><br>(0.0291)    | 0.0605<br>(0.0643)           | 0.0414<br>(0.0285)            | 0.0575<br>(0.0639)            | 0.0387<br>(0.0287)            | 0.0561<br>(0.0635)           |
| sCFO                | <b>-0.1698***</b><br>(0.0374) | <b>-0.1861***</b><br>(0.0385) | <b>-0.1753***</b><br>(0.0349) | <b>-0.1864***</b><br>(0.0386) | <b>-0.1656***</b><br>(0.0353) | <b>-0.1846***</b><br>(0.0391) | 0.0154<br>(0.1040)            | -0.0832<br>(0.1428)          | -0.0058<br>(0.0943)           | -0.0616<br>(0.1430)           | -0.0012<br>(0.0936)           | -0.0668<br>(0.1434)          |
| Lagged_DV           | <b>-0.0867***</b><br>(0.0116) | <b>-0.0496***</b><br>(0.0134) | <b>-0.0887***</b><br>(0.0116) | <b>-0.0564***</b><br>(0.0132) | <b>-0.0859***</b><br>(0.0115) | <b>-0.0561***</b><br>(0.0131) | <b>-0.0520**</b><br>(0.0263)  | -0.0132<br>(0.0275)          | <b>-0.0530**</b><br>(0.0261)  | -0.0165<br>(0.0276)           | <b>-0.0525**</b><br>(0.0261)  | -0.0175<br>(0.0275)          |
| SalesGrowth         |                               |                               | <b>0.0244*</b><br>(0.0130)    | <b>0.0384***</b><br>(0.0142)  | <b>0.0219*</b><br>(0.0129)    | <b>0.0348**</b><br>(0.0141)   |                               |                              | -0.0117<br>(0.0216)           | -0.0038<br>(0.0324)           | -0.0117<br>(0.0218)           | -0.0034<br>(0.0334)          |
| RDSales             |                               |                               | 0.0039<br>(0.0039)            | 0.0049<br>(0.0035)            | 0.0032<br>(0.0037)            | 0.0040<br>(0.0036)            |                               |                              | -0.0011<br>(0.0036)           | -0.0012<br>(0.0080)           | -0.0015<br>(0.0035)           | -0.0014<br>(0.0081)          |
| CashFlowAt          |                               |                               | -0.1186<br>(0.0772)           | <b>-0.1956*</b><br>(0.1034)   | <b>-0.1273*</b><br>(0.0761)   | <b>-0.1888*</b><br>(0.1022)   |                               |                              | <b>-0.3490**</b><br>(0.1409)  | -0.0747<br>(0.2240)           | <b>-0.3615**</b><br>(0.1417)  | -0.0803<br>(0.2264)          |
| DailyVola           |                               |                               | <b>-0.0019***</b><br>(0.0003) | -0.0004<br>(0.0003)           | <b>-0.0033***</b><br>(0.0004) | <b>-0.0015***</b><br>(0.0004) |                               |                              | <b>-0.0039***</b><br>(0.0006) | <b>-0.0021***</b><br>(0.0006) | <b>-0.0043***</b><br>(0.0009) | <b>-0.0019**</b><br>(0.0008) |
| Extended Controls   |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                              | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                          |
| Industry FE         | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                              | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                              |
| Firm FE             |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                          |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                          |
| Year FE             | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                          | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                              |
| Year-Quarter FE     |                               |                               |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                              |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                          |
| N                   | 13,666                        | 13,666                        | 13,057                        | 13,057                        | 13,057                        | 13,057                        | 3,518                         | 3,518                        | 3,404                         | 3,404                         | 3,404                         | 3,404                        |
| R <sup>2</sup>      | 0.249                         | 0.075                         | 0.253                         | 0.082                         | 0.260                         | 0.083                         | 0.231                         | 0.056                        | 0.256                         | 0.071                         | 0.254                         | 0.066                        |
| Adj. R <sup>2</sup> | 0.247                         | -0.002                        | 0.251                         | 0.004                         | 0.255                         | 0.000                         | 0.222                         | -0.043                       | 0.247                         | -0.029                        | 0.234                         | -0.051                       |

Notes: \*  $p < 0.10$ , \*\*  $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\*  $p < 0.01$  (two-tailed). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms).  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ).

Table 61: H20b Robustness: Orthogonal Speaker Partition

|                     | (1)                           | (2)                           | (3)                           | (4)                           | (5)                           | (6)                           | (7)                           | (8)                          | (9)                           | (10)                          | (11)                          | (12)                         |
|---------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|------------------------------|
|                     |                               |                               | ChangDebtChoice               |                               |                               |                               |                               |                              | ChangDebtChoice_lead          |                               |                               |                              |
| UncAnsCEO           | -0.0026<br>(0.0115)           | -0.0036<br>(0.0099)           | -0.0004<br>(0.0115)           | -0.0007<br>(0.0101)           | -0.0014<br>(0.0112)           | -0.0021<br>(0.0099)           | -0.0120<br>(0.0241)           | -0.0213<br>(0.0193)          | -0.0093<br>(0.0229)           | -0.0229<br>(0.0196)           | -0.0104<br>(0.0231)           | -0.0240<br>(0.0198)          |
| UncAnsNoCEO         | 0.0042<br>(0.0065)            | 0.0015<br>(0.0058)            | 0.0046<br>(0.0066)            | 0.0023<br>(0.0059)            | 0.0052<br>(0.0066)            | 0.0028<br>(0.0059)            | 0.0030<br>(0.0154)            | <b>-0.0189*</b><br>(0.0113)  | 0.0069<br>(0.0148)            | <b>-0.0181*</b><br>(0.0110)   | 0.0111<br>(0.0150)            | -0.0165<br>(0.0113)          |
| UncPreCEO           | -0.0125<br>(0.0129)           | -0.0026<br>(0.0116)           | -0.0120<br>(0.0131)           | 0.0006<br>(0.0118)            | -0.0128<br>(0.0130)           | -0.0006<br>(0.0117)           | -0.0263<br>(0.0267)           | 0.0065<br>(0.0221)           | -0.0237<br>(0.0260)           | 0.0033<br>(0.0222)            | -0.0222<br>(0.0261)           | 0.0053<br>(0.0220)           |
| UncPreNoCEO         | <b>0.0181*</b><br>(0.0096)    | 0.0079<br>(0.0113)            | 0.0159<br>(0.0098)            | 0.0052<br>(0.0116)            | 0.0155<br>(0.0097)            | 0.0028<br>(0.0117)            | 0.0091<br>(0.0203)            | 0.0282<br>(0.0273)           | 0.0106<br>(0.0197)            | 0.0388<br>(0.0276)            | 0.0097<br>(0.0198)            | 0.0358<br>(0.0277)           |
| InAssets            | <b>0.0543***</b><br>(0.0051)  | <b>0.0946***</b><br>(0.0177)  | <b>0.0506***</b><br>(0.0052)  | <b>0.1011***</b><br>(0.0184)  | <b>0.0460***</b><br>(0.0051)  | <b>0.0964***</b><br>(0.0182)  | <b>0.0649***</b><br>(0.0108)  | 0.0494<br>(0.0405)           | <b>0.0540***</b><br>(0.0107)  | 0.0632<br>(0.0416)            | <b>0.0538***</b><br>(0.0108)  | 0.0672<br>(0.0423)           |
| TobinsQ             | <b>-0.0246***</b><br>(0.0043) | <b>-0.0279***</b><br>(0.0060) | <b>-0.0252***</b><br>(0.0043) | <b>-0.0277***</b><br>(0.0059) | <b>-0.0262***</b><br>(0.0043) | <b>-0.0272***</b><br>(0.0061) | <b>-0.0111*</b><br>(0.0062)   | -0.0131<br>(0.0142)          | <b>-0.0108*</b><br>(0.0064)   | -0.0059<br>(0.0133)           | <b>-0.0109*</b><br>(0.0064)   | -0.0060<br>(0.0130)          |
| ROA                 | <b>0.2541***</b><br>(0.0486)  | 0.0970<br>(0.0683)            | <b>0.2619***</b><br>(0.0701)  | <b>0.1605**</b><br>(0.0800)   | <b>0.2266***</b><br>(0.0698)  | <b>0.1360*</b><br>(0.0804)    | <b>0.3781***</b><br>(0.0868)  | <b>0.3682**</b><br>(0.1475)  | <b>0.5641***</b><br>(0.1308)  | <b>0.4576**</b><br>(0.1868)   | <b>0.5667***</b><br>(0.1329)  | <b>0.4686**</b><br>(0.1889)  |
| Leverage            | <b>0.1518***</b><br>(0.0287)  | <b>0.1200***</b><br>(0.0453)  | <b>0.1658***</b><br>(0.0296)  | <b>0.1251***</b><br>(0.0457)  | <b>0.1743***</b><br>(0.0301)  | <b>0.1373***</b><br>(0.0454)  | 0.0074<br>(0.0602)            | <b>-0.2560**</b><br>(0.1168) | 0.0016<br>(0.0529)            | <b>-0.2472**</b><br>(0.1102)  | 0.0012<br>(0.0530)            | <b>-0.2546**</b><br>(0.1077) |
| Capex               | <b>0.2471**</b><br>(0.1255)   | <b>1.0041***</b><br>(0.2872)  | <b>0.3635***</b><br>(0.1308)  | <b>1.0366***</b><br>(0.2873)  | <b>0.3417***</b><br>(0.1286)  | <b>0.9345***</b><br>(0.2814)  | 0.2294<br>(0.2196)            | 0.0507<br>(0.4610)           | <b>0.4192*</b><br>(0.2297)    | 0.2101<br>(0.4528)            | <b>0.4433*</b><br>(0.2310)    | 0.3394<br>(0.4619)           |
| CashRatio           | <b>-0.4399***</b><br>(0.0507) | <b>-0.3310***</b><br>(0.0713) | <b>-0.4335***</b><br>(0.0540) | <b>-0.3230***</b><br>(0.0734) | <b>-0.4052***</b><br>(0.0535) | <b>-0.3151***</b><br>(0.0729) | <b>-0.3637***</b><br>(0.0949) | 0.0133<br>(0.1598)           | <b>-0.3166***</b><br>(0.0975) | -0.0110<br>(0.1500)           | <b>-0.3066***</b><br>(0.0978) | 0.0208<br>(0.1491)           |
| DivDummy            | <b>0.0606***</b><br>(0.0133)  | 0.0453<br>(0.0276)            | <b>0.0512***</b><br>(0.0134)  | 0.0410<br>(0.0275)            | <b>0.0437***</b><br>(0.0133)  | 0.0376<br>(0.0273)            | <b>0.0555*</b><br>(0.0288)    | 0.0902<br>(0.0662)           | 0.0433<br>(0.0283)            | 0.0879<br>(0.0657)            | 0.0409<br>(0.0285)            | 0.0859<br>(0.0649)           |
| sCFO                | <b>-0.1874***</b><br>(0.0484) | <b>-0.1812***</b><br>(0.0440) | <b>-0.1908***</b><br>(0.0450) | <b>-0.1794***</b><br>(0.0441) | <b>-0.1774***</b><br>(0.0423) | <b>-0.1772***</b><br>(0.0444) | 0.0223<br>(0.1058)            | -0.0736<br>(0.1396)          | 0.0108<br>(0.0933)            | -0.0615<br>(0.1338)           | 0.0156<br>(0.0929)            | -0.0595<br>(0.1355)          |
| Lagged_DV           | <b>-0.0846***</b><br>(0.0117) | <b>-0.0505***</b><br>(0.0136) | <b>-0.0858***</b><br>(0.0117) | <b>-0.0563***</b><br>(0.0134) | <b>-0.0830***</b><br>(0.0116) | <b>-0.0558***</b><br>(0.0132) | <b>-0.0515**</b><br>(0.0261)  | -0.0017<br>(0.0263)          | <b>-0.0513**</b><br>(0.0260)  | -0.0020<br>(0.0266)           | <b>-0.0508*</b><br>(0.0259)   | -0.0033<br>(0.0262)          |
| SalesGrowth         |                               |                               | 0.0201<br>(0.0139)            | <b>0.0344**</b><br>(0.0144)   | 0.0165<br>(0.0141)            | <b>0.0291**</b><br>(0.0144)   |                               |                              | -0.0177<br>(0.0237)           | -0.0108<br>(0.0334)           | -0.0183<br>(0.0239)           | -0.0102<br>(0.0342)          |
| RDSales             |                               |                               | 0.0023<br>(0.0040)            | 0.0044<br>(0.0035)            | 0.0019<br>(0.0037)            | 0.0032<br>(0.0036)            |                               |                              | -0.0043<br>(0.0035)           | -0.0067<br>(0.0078)           | -0.0046<br>(0.0036)           | -0.0066<br>(0.0079)          |
| CashFlowAt          |                               |                               | -0.1155<br>(0.0769)           | <b>-0.2147**</b><br>(0.1026)  | <b>-0.1257*</b><br>(0.0760)   | <b>-0.2074**</b><br>(0.1019)  |                               |                              | <b>-0.3839***</b><br>(0.1458) | -0.1882<br>(0.2276)           | <b>-0.3979***</b><br>(0.1469) | -0.2059<br>(0.2292)          |
| DailyVola           |                               |                               | <b>-0.0020***</b><br>(0.0003) | -0.0004<br>(0.0003)           | <b>-0.0035***</b><br>(0.0004) | <b>-0.0016***</b><br>(0.0004) |                               |                              | <b>-0.0040***</b><br>(0.0007) | <b>-0.0021***</b><br>(0.0006) | <b>-0.0042***</b><br>(0.0009) | <b>-0.0016**</b><br>(0.0008) |
| Extended Controls   |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                              | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                          |
| Industry FE         | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                              | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                              |
| Firm FE             |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                          |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                          |
| Year FE             | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                          | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                              |
| Year-Quarter FE     |                               |                               |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                              |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                          |
| N                   | 12,770                        | 12,770                        | 12,213                        | 12,213                        | 12,213                        | 12,213                        | 3,280                         | 3,280                        | 3,190                         | 3,190                         | 3,190                         | 3,190                        |
| R <sup>2</sup>      | 0.249                         | 0.076                         | 0.253                         | 0.084                         | 0.261                         | 0.085                         | 0.235                         | 0.065                        | 0.264                         | 0.083                         | 0.263                         | 0.079                        |
| Adj. R <sup>2</sup> | 0.247                         | -0.003                        | 0.250                         | 0.003                         | 0.256                         | -0.001                        | 0.226                         | -0.036                       | 0.254                         | -0.019                        | 0.241                         | -0.041                       |

Notes: \*  $p < 0.10$ , \*\*  $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\*  $p < 0.01$  (two-tailed). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms).  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ).



Table 62: H21: Speech Uncertainty and SEC Comment Letter Count

|                     | (1)                           | (2)                           | (3)                           | (4)                           | (5)                           | (6)                           |
|---------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|
|                     | SEC_Letters_fwd               |                               |                               |                               |                               |                               |
| UncAnsCEO           | -0.0027<br>(0.0086)           | -0.0030<br>(0.0085)           | -0.0032<br>(0.0088)           | -0.0028<br>(0.0087)           | -0.0029<br>(0.0088)           | -0.0026<br>(0.0087)           |
| UncPreCEO           | <b>0.0153**</b><br>(0.0078)   | 0.0090<br>(0.0082)            | <b>0.0137**</b><br>(0.0078)   | 0.0079<br>(0.0082)            | <b>0.0134**</b><br>(0.0078)   | 0.0073<br>(0.0082)            |
| UncAnsMgr           | -0.0102<br>(0.0111)           | -0.0043<br>(0.0112)           | -0.0086<br>(0.0113)           | -0.0045<br>(0.0115)           | -0.0109<br>(0.0114)           | -0.0074<br>(0.0116)           |
| UncPreMgr           | -0.0183<br>(0.0095)           | -0.0090<br>(0.0110)           | -0.0197<br>(0.0095)           | -0.0096<br>(0.0110)           | -0.0195<br>(0.0095)           | -0.0099<br>(0.0110)           |
| lnAssets            | <b>-0.0102***</b><br>(0.0022) | <b>0.0187***</b><br>(0.0068)  | <b>-0.0083***</b><br>(0.0023) | <b>0.0197***</b><br>(0.0072)  | <b>-0.0082***</b><br>(0.0023) | <b>0.0202***</b><br>(0.0072)  |
| TobinsQ             | <b>-0.0095***</b><br>(0.0019) | 0.0030<br>(0.0025)            | <b>-0.0086***</b><br>(0.0020) | 0.0031<br>(0.0027)            | <b>-0.0083***</b><br>(0.0020) | 0.0039<br>(0.0027)            |
| ROA                 | <b>-0.0800***</b><br>(0.0242) | <b>-0.0575**</b><br>(0.0292)  | -0.0433<br>(0.0312)           | -0.0529<br>(0.0355)           | -0.0392<br>(0.0313)           | -0.0524<br>(0.0356)           |
| Leverage            | <b>0.0337**</b><br>(0.0140)   | <b>0.0476**</b><br>(0.0225)   | <b>0.0272*</b><br>(0.0140)    | <b>0.0473**</b><br>(0.0231)   | <b>0.0262*</b><br>(0.0140)    | <b>0.0473**</b><br>(0.0232)   |
| Capex               | -0.0515<br>(0.0622)           | -0.0944<br>(0.0917)           | -0.0622<br>(0.0642)           | -0.0714<br>(0.0916)           | -0.0575<br>(0.0643)           | -0.0654<br>(0.0920)           |
| CashRatio           | -0.0136<br>(0.0211)           | <b>-0.0636**</b><br>(0.0294)  | -0.0187<br>(0.0216)           | <b>-0.0709**</b><br>(0.0299)  | -0.0212<br>(0.0216)           | <b>-0.0734**</b><br>(0.0299)  |
| DivDummy            | <b>-0.0348***</b><br>(0.0067) | -0.0105<br>(0.0106)           | <b>-0.0316***</b><br>(0.0068) | -0.0109<br>(0.0108)           | <b>-0.0311***</b><br>(0.0069) | -0.0106<br>(0.0108)           |
| sCFO                | -0.0070<br>(0.0092)           | -0.0095<br>(0.0070)           | -0.0079<br>(0.0091)           | -0.0101<br>(0.0068)           | -0.0088<br>(0.0088)           | <b>-0.0108*</b><br>(0.0065)   |
| Lagged_DV           | 0.0037<br>(0.0054)            | <b>-0.0647***</b><br>(0.0054) | 0.0039<br>(0.0055)            | <b>-0.0661***</b><br>(0.0056) | 0.0049<br>(0.0055)            | <b>-0.0652***</b><br>(0.0056) |
| SalesGrowth         |                               |                               | -0.0063<br>(0.0067)           | -0.0082<br>(0.0070)           | -0.0047<br>(0.0068)           | -0.0062<br>(0.0070)           |
| RDSales             |                               |                               | 0.0003<br>(0.0047)            | 0.0032<br>(0.0036)            | 0.0002<br>(0.0047)            | 0.0035<br>(0.0037)            |
| CashFlowAt          |                               |                               | -0.0104<br>(0.0360)           | 0.0343<br>(0.0417)            | -0.0153<br>(0.0361)           | 0.0263<br>(0.0419)            |
| DailyVola           |                               |                               | <b>0.0007***</b><br>(0.0002)  | <b>0.0003*</b><br>(0.0002)    | <b>0.0007***</b><br>(0.0002)  | 0.0002<br>(0.0002)            |
| Extended Controls   |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| Industry FE         | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               |
| Firm FE             |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |
| Year FE             | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               |
| Year-Quarter FE     |                               |                               |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| N                   | 66,886                        | 66,886                        | 64,172                        | 64,172                        | 64,172                        | 64,172                        |
| R <sup>2</sup>      | 0.004                         | 0.005                         | 0.004                         | 0.005                         | 0.004                         | 0.005                         |
| Adj. R <sup>2</sup> | 0.004                         | -0.022                        | 0.004                         | -0.023                        | 0.003                         | -0.024                        |

Notes: \*  $p < 0.10$ , \*\*  $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\*  $p < 0.01$  (one-tailed for IVs,  $\beta > 0$ ; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms).  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ).

Table 63: H21 Robustness: Orthogonal Speaker Partition

|                     | (1)                           | (2)                           | (3)                           | (4)                           | (5)                           | (6)                           |
|---------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|
|                     | SEC_Letters_fwd               |                               |                               |                               |                               |                               |
| UncAnsCEO           | -0.0105<br>(0.0060)           | -0.0071<br>(0.0059)           | -0.0104<br>(0.0061)           | -0.0070<br>(0.0060)           | -0.0113<br>(0.0061)           | -0.0083<br>(0.0060)           |
| UncAnsNoCEO         | -0.0023<br>(0.0038)           | -0.0010<br>(0.0038)           | -0.0015<br>(0.0038)           | -0.0006<br>(0.0039)           | -0.0022<br>(0.0039)           | -0.0014<br>(0.0039)           |
| UncPreCEO           | 0.0079<br>(0.0066)            | 0.0077<br>(0.0067)            | 0.0055<br>(0.0067)            | 0.0058<br>(0.0068)            | 0.0053<br>(0.0067)            | 0.0052<br>(0.0069)            |
| UncPreNoCEO         | -0.0017<br>(0.0049)           | 0.0020<br>(0.0060)            | -0.0021<br>(0.0050)           | 0.0019<br>(0.0060)            | -0.0019<br>(0.0050)           | 0.0020<br>(0.0061)            |
| InAssets            | <b>-0.0098***</b><br>(0.0022) | <b>0.0205***</b><br>(0.0069)  | <b>-0.0077***</b><br>(0.0023) | <b>0.0219***</b><br>(0.0072)  | <b>-0.0075***</b><br>(0.0023) | <b>0.0227***</b><br>(0.0072)  |
| TobinsQ             | <b>-0.0104***</b><br>(0.0019) | 0.0025<br>(0.0026)            | <b>-0.0096***</b><br>(0.0020) | 0.0024<br>(0.0027)            | <b>-0.0094***</b><br>(0.0020) | 0.0030<br>(0.0028)            |
| ROA                 | <b>-0.0795***</b><br>(0.0243) | <b>-0.0509*</b><br>(0.0286)   | -0.0490<br>(0.0313)           | -0.0453<br>(0.0351)           | -0.0434<br>(0.0314)           | -0.0426<br>(0.0352)           |
| Leverage            | <b>0.0392***</b><br>(0.0142)  | <b>0.0619***</b><br>(0.0232)  | <b>0.0327**</b><br>(0.0142)   | <b>0.0601**</b><br>(0.0238)   | <b>0.0316**</b><br>(0.0141)   | <b>0.0599**</b><br>(0.0239)   |
| Capex               | -0.0551<br>(0.0632)           | -0.0927<br>(0.0905)           | -0.0693<br>(0.0650)           | -0.0677<br>(0.0908)           | -0.0641<br>(0.0650)           | -0.0562<br>(0.0910)           |
| CashRatio           | -0.0085<br>(0.0216)           | <b>-0.0536*</b><br>(0.0300)   | -0.0135<br>(0.0220)           | <b>-0.0599**</b><br>(0.0303)  | -0.0165<br>(0.0220)           | <b>-0.0631**</b><br>(0.0304)  |
| DivDummy            | <b>-0.0357***</b><br>(0.0069) | -0.0120<br>(0.0103)           | <b>-0.0321***</b><br>(0.0070) | -0.0125<br>(0.0105)           | <b>-0.0314***</b><br>(0.0070) | -0.0119<br>(0.0105)           |
| sCFO                | -0.0060<br>(0.0089)           | <b>-0.0098*</b><br>(0.0052)   | -0.0067<br>(0.0087)           | <b>-0.0104**</b><br>(0.0049)  | -0.0076<br>(0.0084)           | <b>-0.0110**</b><br>(0.0046)  |
| Lagged_DV           | 0.0038<br>(0.0056)            | <b>-0.0657***</b><br>(0.0056) | 0.0039<br>(0.0057)            | <b>-0.0669***</b><br>(0.0057) | 0.0049<br>(0.0057)            | <b>-0.0660***</b><br>(0.0058) |
| SalesGrowth         |                               |                               | -0.0063<br>(0.0069)           | -0.0085<br>(0.0074)           | -0.0048<br>(0.0070)           | -0.0066<br>(0.0074)           |
| RDSales             |                               |                               | 0.0006<br>(0.0060)            | 0.0036<br>(0.0054)            | 0.0005<br>(0.0060)            | 0.0040<br>(0.0055)            |
| CashFlowAt          |                               |                               | 0.0045<br>(0.0365)            | 0.0465<br>(0.0425)            | -0.0001<br>(0.0365)           | 0.0387<br>(0.0426)            |
| DailyVola           |                               |                               | <b>0.0007***</b><br>(0.0002)  | <b>0.0004**</b><br>(0.0002)   | <b>0.0008***</b><br>(0.0002)  | 0.0003<br>(0.0002)            |
| Extended Controls   |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| Industry FE         | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               |
| Firm FE             |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |
| Year FE             | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               |
| Year-Quarter FE     |                               |                               |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| N                   | 62,704                        | 62,704                        | 60,199                        | 60,199                        | 60,199                        | 60,199                        |
| R <sup>2</sup>      | 0.004                         | 0.005                         | 0.005                         | 0.005                         | 0.005                         | 0.005                         |
| Adj. R <sup>2</sup> | 0.004                         | -0.024                        | 0.004                         | -0.024                        | 0.003                         | -0.025                        |

Notes: \*  $p < 0.10$ , \*\*  $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\*  $p < 0.01$  (one-tailed for IVs,  $\beta > 0$ ; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms).  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ).

Table 64: H22: Speech Uncertainty and Equity Financing Constraints

|                     | (1)                          | (2)                          | (3)                          | (4)                          |
|---------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------|
|                     |                              | EquityDelayCon_lead          |                              |                              |
| UncAnsCEO           | <b>0.0058*</b><br>(0.0042)   | 0.0039<br>(0.0041)           | <b>0.0059*</b><br>(0.0042)   | 0.0041<br>(0.0041)           |
| UncPreCEO           | 0.0030<br>(0.0028)           | 0.0025<br>(0.0038)           | 0.0027<br>(0.0027)           | 0.0028<br>(0.0039)           |
| UncAnsMgr           | -0.0038<br>(0.0049)          | -0.0032<br>(0.0052)          | -0.0089<br>(0.0048)          | -0.0036<br>(0.0052)          |
| UncPreMgr           | -0.0044<br>(0.0029)          | -0.0060<br>(0.0048)          | -0.0075<br>(0.0029)          | -0.0063<br>(0.0049)          |
| InAssets            | <b>0.0010*</b><br>(0.0006)   | 0.0026<br>(0.0026)           | <b>-0.0009**</b><br>(0.0004) | 0.0025<br>(0.0026)           |
| TobinsQ             | 0.0006<br>(0.0007)           | 0.0006<br>(0.0009)           | -0.0004<br>(0.0007)          | 0.0005<br>(0.0009)           |
| ROA                 | <b>-0.0119**</b><br>(0.0059) | 0.0075<br>(0.0088)           | -0.0086<br>(0.0087)          | 0.0023<br>(0.0091)           |
| Leverage            | 0.0052<br>(0.0043)           | -0.0133<br>(0.0082)          | 0.0064<br>(0.0042)           | -0.0129<br>(0.0083)          |
| Capex               | 0.0145<br>(0.0144)           | 0.0048<br>(0.0227)           | 0.0067<br>(0.0154)           | 0.0006<br>(0.0231)           |
| CashRatio           | <b>0.0215***</b><br>(0.0061) | <b>0.0158*</b><br>(0.0094)   | <b>0.0137**</b><br>(0.0056)  | 0.0146<br>(0.0097)           |
| DivDummy            | 0.0003<br>(0.0017)           | 0.0052<br>(0.0035)           | 0.0006<br>(0.0017)           | 0.0055<br>(0.0035)           |
| sCFO                | 0.0029<br>(0.0021)           | <b>-0.0040**</b><br>(0.0017) | 0.0024<br>(0.0023)           | <b>-0.0039**</b><br>(0.0016) |
| Lagged_DV           | <b>0.6600***</b><br>(0.0109) | <b>0.1811***</b><br>(0.0154) | <b>0.6641***</b><br>(0.0107) | <b>0.1841***</b><br>(0.0154) |
| SalesGrowth         |                              |                              | <b>0.0048**</b><br>(0.0023)  | 0.0013<br>(0.0020)           |
| RDSales             |                              |                              | <b>0.0027**</b><br>(0.0012)  | 0.0004<br>(0.0011)           |
| CashFlowAt          |                              |                              | 0.0023<br>(0.0098)           | 0.0165<br>(0.0106)           |
| DailyVola           |                              |                              | -0.0001<br>(0.0000)          | <b>0.0001**</b><br>(0.0000)  |
| Extended Controls   |                              |                              | Yes                          | Yes                          |
| Industry FE         | Yes                          |                              | Yes                          |                              |
| Firm FE             |                              | Yes                          |                              | Yes                          |
| Year FE             | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                          |
| N                   | 8,621                        | 8,621                        | 8,564                        | 8,564                        |
| R <sup>2</sup>      | 0.491                        | 0.041                        | 0.491                        | 0.043                        |
| Adj. R <sup>2</sup> | 0.489                        | -0.086                       | 0.489                        | -0.085                       |

Notes: \* $p < 0.10$ , \*\* $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\* $p < 0.01$  (one-tailed for IVs,  $\beta > 0$ ; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms).  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ).

Table 65: H22 Robustness: Orthogonal Speaker Partition

|                     | (1)                           | (2)                           | (3)                            | (4)                           |
|---------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|--------------------------------|-------------------------------|
|                     |                               | EquityDelayCon.lead           |                                |                               |
| UncAnsCEO           | 0.0033<br>(0.0027)            | 0.0022<br>(0.0032)            | 0.0004<br>(0.0026)             | 0.0022<br>(0.0032)            |
| UncAnsNoCEO         | -0.0003<br>(0.0017)           | 0.0004<br>(0.0019)            | -0.0023<br>(0.0016)            | 0.0004<br>(0.0019)            |
| UncPreCEO           | 0.0010<br>(0.0023)            | 0.0007<br>(0.0032)            | -0.0009<br>(0.0022)            | 0.0008<br>(0.0032)            |
| UncPreNoCEO         | -0.0026<br>(0.0013)           | -0.0030<br>(0.0022)           | -0.0040<br>(0.0013)            | -0.0029<br>(0.0023)           |
| lnAssets            | 0.0010<br>(0.0006)            | 0.0029<br>(0.0026)            | <b>-0.0010</b> ***<br>(0.0004) | 0.0028<br>(0.0026)            |
| TobinsQ             | 0.0006<br>(0.0007)            | 0.0007<br>(0.0009)            | -0.0004<br>(0.0007)            | 0.0005<br>(0.0009)            |
| ROA                 | <b>-0.0118</b> **<br>(0.0058) | 0.0079<br>(0.0089)            | -0.0077<br>(0.0088)            | 0.0026<br>(0.0092)            |
| Leverage            | 0.0049<br>(0.0044)            | <b>-0.0144</b> *<br>(0.0083)  | 0.0064<br>(0.0043)             | <b>-0.0140</b> *<br>(0.0084)  |
| Capex               | 0.0147<br>(0.0147)            | 0.0049<br>(0.0235)            | 0.0076<br>(0.0158)             | 0.0011<br>(0.0239)            |
| CashRatio           | <b>0.0215</b> ***<br>(0.0061) | 0.0150<br>(0.0096)            | <b>0.0134</b> **<br>(0.0057)   | 0.0139<br>(0.0099)            |
| DivDummy            | 0.0003<br>(0.0017)            | 0.0050<br>(0.0035)            | 0.0005<br>(0.0017)             | 0.0053<br>(0.0035)            |
| sCFO                | 0.0031<br>(0.0020)            | <b>-0.0040</b> **<br>(0.0016) | 0.0025<br>(0.0021)             | <b>-0.0039</b> **<br>(0.0016) |
| Lagged_DV           | <b>0.6540</b> ***<br>(0.0109) | <b>0.1799</b> ***<br>(0.0157) | <b>0.6580</b> ***<br>(0.0108)  | <b>0.1829</b> ***<br>(0.0157) |
| SalesGrowth         |                               |                               | <b>0.0049</b> **<br>(0.0024)   | 0.0017<br>(0.0021)            |
| RDSales             |                               |                               | <b>0.0027</b> **<br>(0.0011)   | 0.0007<br>(0.0012)            |
| CashFlowAt          |                               |                               | 0.0005<br>(0.0099)             | 0.0152<br>(0.0107)            |
| DailyVola           |                               |                               | -0.0001<br>(0.0000)            | 0.0001<br>(0.0000)            |
| Extended Controls   |                               |                               | Yes                            | Yes                           |
| Industry FE         | Yes                           |                               | Yes                            |                               |
| Firm FE             |                               | Yes                           |                                | Yes                           |
| Year FE             | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                            | Yes                           |
| N                   | 8,376                         | 8,376                         | 8,320                          | 8,320                         |
| R <sup>2</sup>      | 0.486                         | 0.041                         | 0.486                          | 0.043                         |
| Adj. R <sup>2</sup> | 0.484                         | -0.088                        | 0.484                          | -0.087                        |

Notes: \* $p < 0.10$ , \*\* $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\* $p < 0.01$  (one-tailed for IVs,  $\beta > 0$ ; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms).  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ).

Table 66: H23: Product-Market Competition and Uncertainty Language

|                         | (1)                           | (2)                           | (3)                           | (4)                           | (5)                           | (6)                           | (7)                          | (8)                          | (9)                          | (10)                         | (11)                         | (12)                         |
|-------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------|
|                         | Industry FE                   |                               |                               |                               |                               |                               | Firm FE                      |                              |                              |                              |                              |                              |
|                         | UncAnsMgr                     | UncAnsCEO                     | UncPreMgr                     | UncPreCEO                     | UncAnsNoCEO                   | UncPreNoCEO                   | UncAnsMgr                    | UncAnsCEO                    | UncPreMgr                    | UncPreCEO                    | UncAnsNoCEO                  | UncPreNoCEO                  |
| $z(\log(\text{TSIMM}))$ | <b>0.0090**</b><br>(0.0048)   | 0.0054<br>(0.0055)            | <b>0.0297***</b><br>(0.0075)  | <b>0.0304***</b><br>(0.0074)  | <b>0.0132**</b><br>(0.0062)   | 0.0089<br>(0.0124)            | -0.0012<br>(0.0059)          | -0.0061<br>(0.0090)          | 0.0058<br>(0.0091)           | <b>0.0302***</b><br>(0.0093) | 0.0018<br>(0.0095)           | -0.0239<br>(0.0171)          |
| UncQue                  | <b>0.0616**</b><br>(0.0078)   | <b>0.0625***</b><br>(0.0093)  | <b>0.0483***</b><br>(0.0094)  | <b>0.0398***</b><br>(0.0100)  | <b>0.0696***</b><br>(0.0115)  | <b>0.0548***</b><br>(0.0192)  | <b>0.0420***</b><br>(0.0061) | <b>0.0459***</b><br>(0.0078) | <b>0.0149**</b><br>(0.0062)  | 0.0084<br>(0.0073)           | <b>0.0453***</b><br>(0.0113) | <b>0.0250*</b><br>(0.0128)   |
| NegCall                 | <b>0.1109***</b><br>(0.0133)  | <b>0.0900***</b><br>(0.0153)  | <b>0.1553***</b><br>(0.0179)  | <b>0.2340***</b><br>(0.0201)  | <b>0.0928***</b><br>(0.0187)  | <b>0.0669*</b><br>(0.0361)    | <b>0.0690***</b><br>(0.0097) | <b>0.0648***</b><br>(0.0123) | <b>0.1370***</b><br>(0.0120) | <b>0.1698***</b><br>(0.0140) | <b>0.0508***</b><br>(0.0166) | <b>0.1069***</b><br>(0.0232) |
| lnAssets                | <b>-0.0207***</b><br>(0.0027) | <b>-0.0177***</b><br>(0.0031) | <b>-0.0374***</b><br>(0.0043) | <b>-0.0335***</b><br>(0.0038) | <b>-0.0349***</b><br>(0.0034) | <b>-0.0549***</b><br>(0.0078) | 0.0002<br>(0.0054)           | 0.0007<br>(0.0067)           | 0.0060<br>(0.0079)           | 0.0013<br>(0.0081)           | 0.0011<br>(0.0086)           | 0.0138<br>(0.0140)           |
| TobinsQ                 | <b>-0.0080***</b><br>(0.0024) | <b>-0.0089***</b><br>(0.0026) | -0.0014<br>(0.0034)           | -0.0007<br>(0.0037)           | <b>-0.0102***</b><br>(0.0029) | <b>-0.0110*</b><br>(0.0056)   | 0.0013<br>(0.0020)           | 0.0032<br>(0.0028)           | 0.0011<br>(0.0024)           | -0.0017<br>(0.0025)          | -0.0037<br>(0.0030)          | -0.0016<br>(0.0040)          |
| ROA                     | <b>0.0808***</b><br>(0.0230)  | <b>0.0778***</b><br>(0.0278)  | <b>0.1163***</b><br>(0.0322)  | <b>0.0681**</b><br>(0.0314)   | <b>0.1069***</b><br>(0.0313)  | 0.0952<br>(0.0595)            | <b>0.0601***</b><br>(0.0184) | <b>0.0405*</b><br>(0.0234)   | 0.0064<br>(0.0240)           | 0.0241<br>(0.0254)           | <b>0.0797**</b><br>(0.0317)  | -0.0610<br>(0.0420)          |
| CashRatio               | -0.0339<br>(0.0262)           | 0.0120<br>(0.0296)            | 0.0503<br>(0.0362)            | <b>-0.0803**</b><br>(0.0360)  | <b>-0.0785**</b><br>(0.0321)  | 0.0881<br>(0.0633)            | <b>0.0589***</b><br>(0.0222) | <b>0.0524*</b><br>(0.0268)   | -0.0130<br>(0.0292)          | 0.0022<br>(0.0306)           | 0.0637<br>(0.0398)           | -0.0776<br>(0.0533)          |
| DivDummy                | 0.0110<br>(0.0078)            | 0.0107<br>(0.0088)            | <b>-0.0425***</b><br>(0.0119) | -0.0060<br>(0.0117)           | 0.0000<br>(0.0105)            | <b>-0.0772***</b><br>(0.0221) | -0.0068<br>(0.0073)          | 0.0020<br>(0.0101)           | <b>-0.0163*</b><br>(0.0095)  | -0.0166<br>(0.0106)          | 0.0135<br>(0.0111)           | <b>-0.0355*</b><br>(0.0190)  |
| FirmMat                 | <b>0.0019***</b><br>(0.0006)  | <b>0.0014*</b><br>(0.0008)    | 0.0021<br>(0.0018)            | <b>0.0014**</b><br>(0.0007)   | -0.0001<br>(0.0030)           | 0.0007<br>(0.0031)            | <b>0.0027***</b><br>(0.0003) | <b>0.0028***</b><br>(0.0006) | 0.0002<br>(0.0006)           | 0.0003<br>(0.0004)           | -0.0030<br>(0.0020)          | 0.0003<br>(0.0011)           |
| EarnVol                 | -0.0105<br>(0.0091)           | -0.0181<br>(0.0126)           | -0.0106<br>(0.0145)           | -0.0210<br>(0.0152)           | -0.0107<br>(0.0106)           | -0.0156<br>(0.0209)           | -0.0020<br>(0.0072)          | -0.0079<br>(0.0131)          | 0.0088<br>(0.0073)           | -0.0114<br>(0.0146)          | -0.0031<br>(0.0086)          | 0.0222<br>(0.0175)           |
| UncPreMgr               | <b>0.1943***</b><br>(0.0128)  |                               |                               |                               |                               |                               | <b>0.1418***</b><br>(0.0104) |                              |                              |                              |                              |                              |
| UncPreCEO               |                               | <b>0.2491***</b><br>(0.0138)  |                               |                               |                               |                               |                              | <b>0.1687***</b><br>(0.0108) |                              |                              |                              |                              |
| UncPreNoCEO             |                               |                               |                               |                               | <b>0.0489***</b><br>(0.0114)  |                               |                              |                              |                              |                              | <b>0.0478***</b><br>(0.0115) |                              |
| Industry FE             | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                              |                              |                              |                              |                              |                              |
| Firm FE                 |                               |                               |                               |                               |                               |                               | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                          |
| Year FE                 | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                          |
| N                       | 20,768                        | 18,447                        | 20,774                        | 18,492                        | 20,236                        | 20,513                        | 20,768                       | 18,447                       | 20,774                       | 18,492                       | 20,236                       | 20,513                       |
| $R^2$                   | 0.104                         | 0.103                         | 0.064                         | 0.050                         | 0.029                         | 0.035                         | 0.038                        | 0.038                        | 0.017                        | 0.021                        | 0.006                        | 0.006                        |
| Adj. $R^2$              | 0.102                         | 0.102                         | 0.062                         | 0.048                         | 0.028                         | 0.033                         | -0.045                       | -0.050                       | -0.067                       | -0.068                       | -0.081                       | -0.080                       |

Notes: \* $p < 0.10$ , \*\* $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\* $p < 0.01$  (one-tailed for IVs,  $\beta > 0$ ; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). Unit of observation: firm-fiscal-year.  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ).

Table 67: H24: US Economic Policy Uncertainty and Call Language Uncertainty

|                         | (1)                           | (2)                           | (3)                           | (4)                           | (5)                           | (6)                           | (7)                          | (8)                          | (9)                          | (10)                         | (11)                         | (12)                         |
|-------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------|
|                         | Industry + Cal. Year FE       |                               |                               |                               |                               |                               | Firm + Cal. Year FE          |                              |                              |                              |                              |                              |
|                         | UncAnsMgr                     | UncPreMgr                     | UncAnsCEO                     | UncPreCEO                     | UncAnsNoCEO                   | UncPreNoCEO                   | UncAnsMgr                    | UncPreMgr                    | UncAnsCEO                    | UncPreCEO                    | UncAnsNoCEO                  | UncPreNoCEO                  |
| $\log(\text{US EPU})_t$ | <b>0.0141**</b><br>(0.0064)   | 0.0065<br>(0.0062)            | <b>0.0117*</b><br>(0.0072)    | <b>0.0211***</b><br>(0.0074)  | <b>0.0109*</b><br>(0.0081)    | 0.0008<br>(0.0079)            | <b>0.0147**</b><br>(0.0069)  | 0.0071<br>(0.0058)           | <b>0.0138**</b><br>(0.0077)  | <b>0.0239***</b><br>(0.0076) | 0.0098<br>(0.0084)           | 0.0006<br>(0.0070)           |
| UncQue                  | <b>0.0388***</b><br>(0.0032)  | <b>0.0115***</b><br>(0.0023)  | <b>0.0413***</b><br>(0.0035)  | <b>0.0164***</b><br>(0.0032)  | <b>0.0484***</b><br>(0.0062)  | <b>0.0115***</b><br>(0.0037)  | <b>0.0349***</b><br>(0.0029) | <b>0.0084***</b><br>(0.0023) | <b>0.0380***</b><br>(0.0031) | <b>0.0095***</b><br>(0.0028) | <b>0.0409***</b><br>(0.0059) | <b>0.0103***</b><br>(0.0039) |
| NegCall                 | <b>0.0707***</b><br>(0.0066)  | <b>0.0726***</b><br>(0.0059)  | <b>0.0670***</b><br>(0.0082)  | <b>0.1247***</b><br>(0.0089)  | <b>0.0618***</b><br>(0.0125)  | <b>0.0355***</b><br>(0.0078)  | <b>0.0600***</b><br>(0.0055) | <b>0.0928***</b><br>(0.0058) | <b>0.0621***</b><br>(0.0068) | <b>0.1385***</b><br>(0.0079) | <b>0.0376***</b><br>(0.0116) | <b>0.0611***</b><br>(0.0085) |
| InAssets                | <b>-0.0153***</b><br>(0.0018) | <b>-0.0128***</b><br>(0.0016) | <b>-0.0137***</b><br>(0.0022) | <b>-0.0143***</b><br>(0.0020) | <b>-0.0297***</b><br>(0.0027) | <b>-0.0143***</b><br>(0.0023) | -0.0004<br>(0.0045)          | 0.0028<br>(0.0046)           | 0.0011<br>(0.0063)           | 0.0038<br>(0.0063)           | -0.0042<br>(0.0083)          | 0.0037<br>(0.0066)           |
| TobinsQ                 | <b>-0.0071***</b><br>(0.0016) | 0.0011<br>(0.0012)            | <b>-0.0081***</b><br>(0.0018) | 0.0007<br>(0.0019)            | <b>-0.0097***</b><br>(0.0025) | -0.0017<br>(0.0015)           | 0.0023<br>(0.0017)           | 0.0015<br>(0.0014)           | 0.0025<br>(0.0024)           | 0.0007<br>(0.0018)           | 0.0006<br>(0.0027)           | -0.0017<br>(0.0021)          |
| ROA                     | <b>0.0607***</b><br>(0.0170)  | <b>0.0343***</b><br>(0.0121)  | <b>0.0837***</b><br>(0.0223)  | <b>0.0367**</b><br>(0.0168)   | <b>0.0633***</b><br>(0.0238)  | 0.0229<br>(0.0169)            | <b>0.0508***</b><br>(0.0160) | 0.0125<br>(0.0145)           | <b>0.0551***</b><br>(0.0193) | <b>0.0467**</b><br>(0.0191)  | 0.0314<br>(0.0252)           | -0.0078<br>(0.0203)          |
| CashRatio               | -0.0120<br>(0.0174)           | <b>0.0325***</b><br>(0.0119)  | 0.0185<br>(0.0220)            | -0.0079<br>(0.0187)           | <b>-0.0519**</b><br>(0.0251)  | 0.0209<br>(0.0160)            | <b>0.0534***</b><br>(0.0149) | 0.0061<br>(0.0161)           | <b>0.0604***</b><br>(0.0226) | 0.0305<br>(0.0231)           | 0.0428<br>(0.0293)           | -0.0196<br>(0.0247)          |
| DivDummy                | 0.0074<br>(0.0053)            | <b>-0.0167***</b><br>(0.0042) | 0.0104<br>(0.0064)            | -0.0074<br>(0.0061)           | 0.0047<br>(0.0078)            | <b>-0.0165***</b><br>(0.0058) | -0.0079<br>(0.0066)          | <b>-0.0101*</b><br>(0.0059)  | -0.0034<br>(0.0089)          | <b>-0.0157*</b><br>(0.0083)  | 0.0109<br>(0.0095)           | -0.0130<br>(0.0092)          |
| FirmMat                 | -0.0002<br>(0.0011)           | <b>0.0021***</b><br>(0.0007)  | -0.0005<br>(0.0015)           | 0.0009<br>(0.0008)            | 0.0006<br>(0.0019)            | <b>0.0021**</b><br>(0.0009)   | <b>0.0027*</b><br>(0.0015)   | 0.0008<br>(0.0013)           | <b>0.0039**</b><br>(0.0019)  | -0.0011<br>(0.0012)          | -0.0020<br>(0.0028)          | 0.0013<br>(0.0011)           |
| EarnVol                 | -0.0060<br>(0.0075)           | -0.0062<br>(0.0069)           | -0.0002<br>(0.0106)           | -0.0074<br>(0.0086)           | -0.0168<br>(0.0112)           | -0.0033<br>(0.0092)           | -0.0029<br>(0.0076)          | 0.0021<br>(0.0067)           | 0.0149<br>(0.0111)           | -0.0083<br>(0.0119)          | -0.0160<br>(0.0122)          | 0.0134<br>(0.0113)           |
| UncPreMgr               | <b>0.1223***</b><br>(0.0071)  |                               |                               |                               |                               |                               | <b>0.1126***</b><br>(0.0059) |                              |                              |                              |                              |                              |
| UncPreCEO               |                               |                               | <b>0.1384***</b><br>(0.0070)  |                               |                               |                               |                              |                              | <b>0.1043***</b><br>(0.0049) |                              |                              |                              |
| UncPreNoCEO             |                               |                               |                               |                               | <b>0.0563***</b><br>(0.0077)  |                               |                              |                              |                              |                              | <b>0.0614***</b><br>(0.0071) |                              |
| Lagged_DV               | <b>0.3333***</b><br>(0.0084)  | <b>0.6755***</b><br>(0.0101)  | <b>0.2986***</b><br>(0.0091)  | <b>0.5176***</b><br>(0.0131)  | <b>0.1937***</b><br>(0.0068)  | <b>0.7610***</b><br>(0.0107)  | <b>0.1367***</b><br>(0.0069) | <b>0.4185***</b><br>(0.0099) | <b>0.1103***</b><br>(0.0071) | <b>0.2626***</b><br>(0.0089) | <b>0.0762***</b><br>(0.0064) | <b>0.5359***</b><br>(0.0133) |
| Industry FE             | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                          |
| Firm FE                 | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                          |
| Year FE                 | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                          |
| N                       | 74,013                        | 75,142                        | 59,676                        | 60,503                        | 68,858                        | 73,835                        | 74,013                       | 75,142                       | 59,676                       | 60,503                       | 68,858                       | 73,835                       |
| $R^2$                   | 0.171                         | 0.484                         | 0.141                         | 0.292                         | 0.056                         | 0.592                         | 0.041                        | 0.186                        | 0.030                        | 0.084                        | 0.010                        | 0.291                        |
| Adj. $R^2$              | 0.171                         | 0.484                         | 0.141                         | 0.291                         | 0.055                         | 0.592                         | 0.017                        | 0.166                        | 0.002                        | 0.057                        | -0.016                       | 0.273                        |

Notes: \* $p < 0.10$ , \*\* $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\* $p < 0.01$  (one-tailed for IVs,  $\beta > 0$ ; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) two-way clustered (firm, calendar quarter). Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). Firms with fewer than 5 calls are excluded.  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ).

Table 68: H24b: Global Economic Policy Uncertainty and Call Language Uncertainty

|                       | (1)                           | (2)                           | (3)                           | (4)                           | (5)                           | (6)                           | (7)                          | (8)                          | (9)                          | (10)                         | (11)                         | (12)                         |
|-----------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------|
|                       | Industry + Cal. Year FE       |                               |                               |                               |                               |                               | Firm + Cal. Year FE          |                              |                              |                              |                              |                              |
|                       | UncAnsMgr                     | UncPreMgr                     | UncAnsCEO                     | UncPreCEO                     | UncAnsNoCEO                   | UncPreNoCEO                   | UncAnsMgr                    | UncPreMgr                    | UncAnsCEO                    | UncPreCEO                    | UncAnsNoCEO                  | UncPreNoCEO                  |
| $\log(\text{GEPU})_t$ | <b>0.0234***</b><br>(0.0099)  | <b>0.0131*</b><br>(0.0093)    | <b>0.0178*</b><br>(0.0109)    | <b>0.0271***</b><br>(0.0107)  | <b>0.0178*</b><br>(0.0128)    | 0.0078<br>(0.0123)            | <b>0.0242**</b><br>(0.0104)  | <b>0.0124*</b><br>(0.0086)   | <b>0.0212**</b><br>(0.0110)  | <b>0.0309***</b><br>(0.0108) | 0.0166<br>(0.0132)           | 0.0053<br>(0.0108)           |
| UncQue                | <b>0.0388***</b><br>(0.0032)  | <b>0.0115***</b><br>(0.0023)  | <b>0.0413***</b><br>(0.0035)  | <b>0.0164***</b><br>(0.0032)  | <b>0.0483***</b><br>(0.0062)  | <b>0.0114***</b><br>(0.0037)  | <b>0.0348***</b><br>(0.0029) | <b>0.0084***</b><br>(0.0023) | <b>0.0380***</b><br>(0.0031) | <b>0.0095***</b><br>(0.0028) | <b>0.0409***</b><br>(0.0059) | <b>0.0103***</b><br>(0.0039) |
| NegCall               | <b>0.0704***</b><br>(0.0065)  | <b>0.0724***</b><br>(0.0058)  | <b>0.0669***</b><br>(0.0083)  | <b>0.1247***</b><br>(0.0089)  | <b>0.0617***</b><br>(0.0124)  | <b>0.0352***</b><br>(0.0077)  | <b>0.0597***</b><br>(0.0054) | <b>0.0926***</b><br>(0.0058) | <b>0.0619***</b><br>(0.0067) | <b>0.1385***</b><br>(0.0063) | <b>0.0374***</b><br>(0.0115) | <b>0.0608***</b><br>(0.0085) |
| InAssets              | <b>-0.0153***</b><br>(0.0018) | <b>-0.0127***</b><br>(0.0016) | <b>-0.0136***</b><br>(0.0022) | <b>-0.0143***</b><br>(0.0020) | <b>-0.0297***</b><br>(0.0027) | <b>-0.0143***</b><br>(0.0023) | -0.0005<br>(0.0045)          | 0.0027<br>(0.0046)           | 0.0011<br>(0.0063)           | 0.0037<br>(0.0063)           | -0.0042<br>(0.0083)          | 0.0037<br>(0.0066)           |
| TobinsQ               | <b>-0.0071***</b><br>(0.0016) | 0.0011<br>(0.0012)            | <b>-0.0081***</b><br>(0.0018) | 0.0008<br>(0.0019)            | <b>-0.0097***</b><br>(0.0025) | -0.0017<br>(0.0015)           | 0.0023<br>(0.0017)           | 0.0015<br>(0.0014)           | 0.0025<br>(0.0024)           | 0.0007<br>(0.0018)           | 0.0006<br>(0.0027)           | -0.0017<br>(0.0021)          |
| ROA                   | <b>0.0606***</b><br>(0.0170)  | <b>0.0342***</b><br>(0.0122)  | <b>0.0836***</b><br>(0.0223)  | <b>0.0367**</b><br>(0.0168)   | <b>0.0632***</b><br>(0.0238)  | 0.0228<br>(0.0169)            | <b>0.0504***</b><br>(0.0160) | 0.0122<br>(0.0145)           | <b>0.0547***</b><br>(0.0193) | <b>0.0462**</b><br>(0.0191)  | 0.0311<br>(0.0252)           | -0.0079<br>(0.0203)          |
| CashRatio             | -0.0120<br>(0.0174)           | <b>0.0325***</b><br>(0.0119)  | 0.0184<br>(0.0220)            | -0.0080<br>(0.0188)           | <b>-0.0519**</b><br>(0.0251)  | 0.0209<br>(0.0160)            | <b>0.0536***</b><br>(0.0149) | 0.0062<br>(0.0161)           | <b>0.0605***</b><br>(0.0226) | 0.0304<br>(0.0231)           | 0.0429<br>(0.0293)           | -0.0195<br>(0.0247)          |
| DivDummy              | 0.0074<br>(0.0053)            | <b>-0.0167***</b><br>(0.0042) | 0.0104<br>(0.0064)            | -0.0074<br>(0.0061)           | 0.0047<br>(0.0078)            | <b>-0.0165***</b><br>(0.0058) | -0.0079<br>(0.0066)          | <b>-0.0101*</b><br>(0.0059)  | -0.0034<br>(0.0089)          | <b>-0.0156*</b><br>(0.0083)  | 0.0109<br>(0.0095)           | -0.0130<br>(0.0092)          |
| FirmMat               | -0.0002<br>(0.0011)           | <b>0.0021***</b><br>(0.0007)  | -0.0005<br>(0.0015)           | 0.0009<br>(0.0008)            | 0.0006<br>(0.0019)            | <b>0.0021**</b><br>(0.0009)   | <b>0.0027*</b><br>(0.0015)   | 0.0008<br>(0.0013)           | <b>0.0039**</b><br>(0.0019)  | -0.0011<br>(0.0012)          | -0.0020<br>(0.0028)          | 0.0013<br>(0.0011)           |
| EarnVol               | -0.0060<br>(0.0075)           | -0.0061<br>(0.0069)           | -0.0002<br>(0.0106)           | -0.0074<br>(0.0086)           | -0.0168<br>(0.0112)           | -0.0033<br>(0.0092)           | -0.0029<br>(0.0076)          | 0.0021<br>(0.0067)           | 0.0150<br>(0.0111)           | -0.0082<br>(0.0119)          | -0.0160<br>(0.0122)          | 0.0134<br>(0.0113)           |
| UncPreMgr             | <b>0.1223***</b><br>(0.0071)  |                               |                               |                               |                               |                               | <b>0.1126***</b><br>(0.0059) |                              |                              |                              |                              |                              |
| UncPreCEO             |                               |                               | <b>0.1384***</b><br>(0.0070)  |                               |                               |                               |                              |                              | <b>0.1043***</b><br>(0.0049) |                              |                              |                              |
| UncPreNoCEO           |                               |                               |                               |                               | <b>0.0563***</b><br>(0.0077)  |                               |                              |                              |                              |                              | <b>0.0614***</b><br>(0.0071) |                              |
| Lagged_DV             | <b>0.3334***</b><br>(0.0084)  | <b>0.6755***</b><br>(0.0101)  | <b>0.2986***</b><br>(0.0091)  | <b>0.5176***</b><br>(0.0131)  | <b>0.1937***</b><br>(0.0068)  | <b>0.7610***</b><br>(0.0107)  | <b>0.1368***</b><br>(0.0069) | <b>0.4185***</b><br>(0.0099) | <b>0.1103***</b><br>(0.0071) | <b>0.2626***</b><br>(0.0089) | <b>0.0762***</b><br>(0.0064) | <b>0.5359***</b><br>(0.0133) |
| Industry FE           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                          |
| Firm FE               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                          |
| Year FE               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                          |
| N                     | 74,013                        | 75,142                        | 59,676                        | 60,503                        | 68,858                        | 73,835                        | 74,013                       | 75,142                       | 59,676                       | 60,503                       | 68,858                       | 73,835                       |
| $R^2$                 | 0.171                         | 0.484                         | 0.141                         | 0.292                         | 0.056                         | 0.592                         | 0.041                        | 0.186                        | 0.031                        | 0.084                        | 0.010                        | 0.291                        |
| Adj. $R^2$            | 0.171                         | 0.484                         | 0.141                         | 0.291                         | 0.055                         | 0.592                         | 0.017                        | 0.166                        | 0.002                        | 0.057                        | -0.016                       | 0.273                        |

Notes: \* $p < 0.10$ , \*\* $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\* $p < 0.01$  (one-tailed for IVs,  $\beta > 0$ ; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) two-way clustered (firm, calendar quarter). Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). Firms with fewer than 5 calls are excluded.  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ).

Table 69: H25: Geopolitical Risk and Call Language Uncertainty

|                      | (1)                           | (2)                           | (3)                           | (4)                           | (5)                           | (6)                           | (7)                          | (8)                          | (9)                          | (10)                         | (11)                         | (12)                         |
|----------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------|
|                      | Industry + Cal. Year FE       |                               |                               |                               |                               |                               | Firm + Cal. Year FE          |                              |                              |                              |                              |                              |
|                      | UncAnsMgr                     | UncPreMgr                     | UncAnsCEO                     | UncPreCEO                     | UncAnsNoCEO                   | UncPreNoCEO                   | UncAnsMgr                    | UncPreMgr                    | UncAnsCEO                    | UncPreCEO                    | UncAnsNoCEO                  | UncPreNoCEO                  |
| $\log(\text{GPR})_t$ | -0.0112<br>(0.0087)           | 0.0073<br>(0.0061)            | -0.0059<br>(0.0102)           | <b>0.0147*</b><br>(0.0095)    | 0.0028<br>(0.0129)            | 0.0044<br>(0.0139)            | -0.0119<br>(0.0087)          | 0.0067<br>(0.0058)           | -0.0058<br>(0.0100)          | 0.0118<br>(0.0093)           | 0.0035<br>(0.0126)           | 0.0076<br>(0.0128)           |
| UncQue               | <b>0.0388***</b><br>(0.0033)  | <b>0.0115***</b><br>(0.0024)  | <b>0.0414***</b><br>(0.0036)  | <b>0.0165***</b><br>(0.0032)  | <b>0.0484***</b><br>(0.0062)  | <b>0.0115***</b><br>(0.0037)  | <b>0.0349***</b><br>(0.0030) | <b>0.0084***</b><br>(0.0023) | <b>0.0380***</b><br>(0.0032) | <b>0.0096***</b><br>(0.0028) | <b>0.0409***</b><br>(0.0059) | <b>0.0103***</b><br>(0.0039) |
| NegCall              | <b>0.0714***</b><br>(0.0065)  | <b>0.0730***</b><br>(0.0059)  | <b>0.0677***</b><br>(0.0081)  | <b>0.1260***</b><br>(0.0090)  | <b>0.0625***</b><br>(0.0124)  | <b>0.0355***</b><br>(0.0078)  | <b>0.0611***</b><br>(0.0057) | <b>0.0934***</b><br>(0.0059) | <b>0.0631***</b><br>(0.0068) | <b>0.1404***</b><br>(0.0082) | <b>0.0384***</b><br>(0.0117) | <b>0.0612***</b><br>(0.0085) |
| InAssets             | <b>-0.0153***</b><br>(0.0018) | <b>-0.0127***</b><br>(0.0016) | <b>-0.0136***</b><br>(0.0022) | <b>-0.0143***</b><br>(0.0020) | <b>-0.0296***</b><br>(0.0027) | <b>-0.0143***</b><br>(0.0023) | -0.0004<br>(0.0045)          | 0.0028<br>(0.0046)           | 0.0011<br>(0.0063)           | 0.0039<br>(0.0063)           | -0.0042<br>(0.0083)          | 0.0037<br>(0.0066)           |
| TobinsQ              | <b>-0.0071***</b><br>(0.0016) | 0.0011<br>(0.0012)            | <b>-0.0081***</b><br>(0.0018) | 0.0008<br>(0.0019)            | <b>-0.0097***</b><br>(0.0025) | -0.0017<br>(0.0015)           | 0.0022<br>(0.0017)           | 0.0015<br>(0.0014)           | 0.0024<br>(0.0024)           | 0.0007<br>(0.0018)           | 0.0006<br>(0.0027)           | -0.0017<br>(0.0021)          |
| ROA                  | <b>0.0609***</b><br>(0.0171)  | <b>0.0343***</b><br>(0.0121)  | <b>0.0838***</b><br>(0.0223)  | <b>0.0368***</b><br>(0.0168)  | <b>0.0634***</b><br>(0.0239)  | 0.0229<br>(0.0169)            | <b>0.0512***</b><br>(0.0161) | 0.0125<br>(0.0145)           | <b>0.0553***</b><br>(0.0194) | <b>0.0468**</b><br>(0.0192)  | 0.0315<br>(0.0252)           | -0.0079<br>(0.0202)          |
| CashRatio            | -0.0120<br>(0.0174)           | <b>0.0325***</b><br>(0.0119)  | 0.0185<br>(0.0220)            | -0.0079<br>(0.0187)           | <b>-0.0519**</b><br>(0.0251)  | 0.0209<br>(0.0160)            | <b>0.0527***</b><br>(0.0149) | 0.0059<br>(0.0161)           | <b>0.0598***</b><br>(0.0227) | 0.0295<br>(0.0229)           | 0.0425<br>(0.0293)           | -0.0196<br>(0.0247)          |
| DivDummy             | 0.0074<br>(0.0053)            | <b>-0.0167***</b><br>(0.0042) | 0.0104<br>(0.0064)            | -0.0073<br>(0.0061)           | 0.0047<br>(0.0078)            | <b>-0.0165***</b><br>(0.0058) | -0.0078<br>(0.0066)          | <b>-0.0101*</b><br>(0.0059)  | -0.0032<br>(0.0089)          | <b>-0.0154*</b><br>(0.0083)  | 0.0110<br>(0.0095)           | -0.0130<br>(0.0092)          |
| FirmMat              | -0.0002<br>(0.0011)           | <b>0.0021***</b><br>(0.0007)  | -0.0005<br>(0.0015)           | 0.0009<br>(0.0008)            | 0.0006<br>(0.0019)            | <b>0.0021**</b><br>(0.0009)   | <b>0.0027*</b><br>(0.0015)   | 0.0008<br>(0.0013)           | <b>0.0039**</b><br>(0.0019)  | -0.0011<br>(0.0012)          | -0.0019<br>(0.0028)          | 0.0013<br>(0.0011)           |
| EarnVol              | -0.0061<br>(0.0076)           | -0.0062<br>(0.0069)           | -0.0003<br>(0.0106)           | -0.0076<br>(0.0086)           | -0.0168<br>(0.0112)           | -0.0033<br>(0.0092)           | -0.0030<br>(0.0076)          | 0.0021<br>(0.0067)           | 0.0149<br>(0.0111)           | -0.0084<br>(0.0118)          | -0.0160<br>(0.0122)          | 0.0134<br>(0.0113)           |
| UncPreMgr            | <b>0.1224***</b><br>(0.0071)  |                               |                               |                               |                               |                               | <b>0.1127***</b><br>(0.0059) |                              |                              |                              |                              |                              |
| UncPreCEO            |                               |                               | <b>0.1385***</b><br>(0.0070)  |                               |                               |                               |                              |                              | <b>0.1045***</b><br>(0.0048) |                              |                              |                              |
| UncPreNoCEO          |                               |                               |                               |                               | <b>0.0563***</b><br>(0.0077)  |                               |                              |                              |                              |                              | <b>0.0614***</b><br>(0.0071) |                              |
| Lagged_DV            | <b>0.3332***</b><br>(0.0084)  | <b>0.6755***</b><br>(0.0101)  | <b>0.2986***</b><br>(0.0091)  | <b>0.5175***</b><br>(0.0131)  | <b>0.1937***</b><br>(0.0068)  | <b>0.7610***</b><br>(0.0107)  | <b>0.1366***</b><br>(0.0069) | <b>0.4185***</b><br>(0.0099) | <b>0.1103***</b><br>(0.0071) | <b>0.2626***</b><br>(0.0089) | <b>0.0761***</b><br>(0.0064) | <b>0.5359***</b><br>(0.0133) |
| Industry FE          | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                          |
| Firm FE              | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                          |
| Year FE              | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                          | Yes                          |
| N                    | 74,013                        | 75,142                        | 59,676                        | 60,503                        | 68,858                        | 73,835                        | 74,013                       | 75,142                       | 59,676                       | 60,503                       | 68,858                       | 73,835                       |
| $R^2$                | 0.171                         | 0.484                         | 0.141                         | 0.292                         | 0.056                         | 0.592                         | 0.041                        | 0.186                        | 0.030                        | 0.084                        | 0.010                        | 0.291                        |
| Adj. $R^2$           | 0.171                         | 0.484                         | 0.141                         | 0.291                         | 0.055                         | 0.592                         | 0.017                        | 0.166                        | 0.001                        | 0.057                        | -0.016                       | 0.273                        |

Notes: \* $p < 0.10$ , \*\* $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\* $p < 0.01$  (one-tailed for IVs,  $\beta > 0$ ; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) two-way clustered (firm, calendar quarter). Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). Firms with fewer than 5 calls are excluded.  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ).